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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp * * * * * WEDNESDAY, JUNE 25, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXV NO. 146 WSJ.com ★★★★ $5.00

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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Big banks are trying** to avoid scrutiny by Republican states that are putting pressure on companies for "woke" policies that conservative policymakers say are illegal and discriminatory. **A1**

◆ **Powell told lawmakers** that recent economic data would have likely justified continuing to cut interest rates if not for concerns that higher tariffs might derail the Fed's fight against inflation. **A2**

◆ **Benchmark U.S. oil** futures fell further to settle at $64.37 a barrel and stock indexes rose, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow gaining 1.1%, 1.4% and 1.2%, respectively. **B1**

◆ **U.S. consumer confidence** slipped in June, reversing an improvement in May, the Conference Board said. **A2**

◆ **The U.K.'s antitrust** authority proposed to designate Google as having strategic market status in general search and search advertising, paving the way for measures that could change how the company operates. **B1**

◆ **Carnival raised its** outlook for the year as the cruise line logged higher-than-expected quarterly profit and revenue, boosted by strong demand and consumer spending. **B1**

◆ **Amazon.com plans** to invest about $54 billion in the U.K. over the next three years, expanding its warehouse network and artificial-intelligence infrastructure. **B6**

◆ **Hackers suspected to be** behind recent data breaches at Marks & Spencer, Victoria's Secret and other retailers appears to be setting their sights on insurance companies, including Aflac. **B1**

World-Wide

◆ **A cease-fire between** Israel and Iran appeared to be holding on Tuesday after Trump unleashed an expletive-laced tirade aimed at the leaders of both countries in hopes of keeping the fragile peace. **A1, A6-7**

◆ **A preliminary** intelligence report found that the U.S. military's strikes on three Iranian nuclear facilities set back Tehran's nuclear ambitions by only a few months. **A1**

◆ **A formal announcement** of a pledge by NATO members to more than double their military spending was expected at a meeting of the alliance in The Hague on Wednesday. **A16**

◆ **Andrew Cuomo** conceded the Democratic primary in the New York City mayor's race to Zohran Mamdani, a favorite of progressives, but the ex-governor's team suggested he might still run in November. **A3**

◆ **Attorneys general** from 21 states sued the Trump administration for slashing billions of dollars in federal funding and justifying the cuts by citing shifting agency priorities. **A2**

◆ **Homeowners who** bought near the peak of the market are increasingly finding they owe more on their mortgages than their properties are worth. **A3**

◆ **Roughly six million** federal student-loan borrowers are 90 days or more past due, TransUnion said, and about a third of them could move into default in July. **A3**

◆ **Trump dared political** foes to try again to remove him from office, taking aim at comments by Democratic Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez. **A4**

◆ **Died: Bobby Sherman**, 81, teen idol in the '60s and '70s. **A2**

CONTENTS

Arts in Review	A11	Opinion	A13-15
Business & Finance	B2,6	Personal Journal	A9-10
Business News	B3	Property Report	B6
Crossword	A12	Sports	A12
Heard on Street	B12	Technology	B4-5
Markets	B11-12	U.S. News	A2-5
		World News	A6-8,16

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Iran-Israel Cease-Fire Appears to Hold

SAEED QAQ/APA IMAGES/ZUMA PRESS

Israeli rescue teams descended on the scene of a missile strike in a residential area of Beer Sheba. Four people were killed in southern Israel after Iran launched missile barrages toward the country early Tuesday, shortly before a truce took effect.

Both sides relent following Trump tirade fueled by alleged violations

A cease-fire between Israel and Iran appeared to be holding on Tuesday after President Trump unleashed an expletive-laced tirade aimed at the leaders of both countries in hopes of keeping the fragile peace.

By Yaroslav Trofimov, Alexander Ward, Jared Malsin and Summer Said

"We basically have two countries that have been fighting so long and so hard that they don't know what the f— they're doing," Trump said at the White House Tuesday morning when the truce looked in danger of breaking.

Trump was surprised to learn Tuesday morning that the war hadn't ended following his announcement of a truce on Monday. After Trump expressed deep frustration, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said Israel would refrain from further strikes on Iran following a call with the president.

It remains to be seen how long the truce will hold, and whether the U.S. and its allies will be able to use the leverage gained by the U.S. and Israeli strikes to reach a diplomatic deal that prevents Iran from obtaining a nuclear weapon in coming years.

Yet, the rapid move from a surprise airstrike to a cease-fire, with major policy pivots announced via social-media posts that gave whiplash to friends and foes alike, has showcased Trump's unorthodox approach to wielding power.

Please turn to page A6

◆ A weakened Iran remains lethal..... A6
◆ Strike on Iran sparks retaliation concerns..... A7
◆ Moscow fails to back Tehran..... A7
◆ Trump set for a win on NATO spending..... A16

U.S. Strikes Found to Cost Tehran A Few Months on Nuclear Program

Early intelligence report counters Trump; White House calls it 'flat out wrong'

A preliminary intelligence report found that the U.S. military's strikes last week on three Iranian nuclear facilities only set back Tehran's nuclear ambitions by a few months, countering claims made by President Trump and the White House, according to people familiar with the intelligence.

By Dustin Volz, Jared Malsin and Lara Seligman

The initial findings, written by the Defense Intelligence Agency, relied on military damage assessments following the bombings, the people said, adding that the assessment could change as more intelligence is collected.

A senior administration official confirmed the report's existence but said it hadn't risen to the level of being shared with Defense Department's top leaders. Multiple members of Congress, including full committees, have seen or have access to the report, lawmakers said.

U.S. intelligence agencies frequently produce classified reports that are later revised, sometimes substantially, as more information is collected. Such reports don't necessarily reflect the views of other spy agencies, and disagreement among the agencies isn't uncommon.

Karoline Leavitt, the White House press secretary, wrote in a post on X that the "alleged 'assessment' is flat out wrong," and described the report as classified at the top-secret level. She also blamed an "anonymous, low-level loser in the intelligence community" for leaking the report to the media. CNN earlier reported on the assessment.

The Office of the Director of National Intelligence, which oversees all intelligence agencies in the U.S. government, declined to comment. The Defense Intelligence Agency didn't respond to a request for comment.

The report contradicts statements from Trump, who has repeatedly said the targets of the raids were destroyed.

Please turn to page A8

INSIDE

SPORTS
The rookie sensation who throws 103 mph—and who's almost unhittable. **A12**

NTSB/AP

BUSINESS & FINANCE
Probe of door blowout faults both Boeing and air-safety regulators. **B1**

Lawyers Tout Huge Verdicts, But Clients Struggle to Collect

Gloria Allred, Lisa Bloom and others market victories against Alki David, but getting him to pay has been an ordeal

By Khadeeja Safdar

Elizabeth Taylor spent nearly a decade pursuing a sexual-harassment claim against her former boss at an online streaming company in Los Angeles. The long, grinding legal fight seemed worth it when a jury awarded her $8.4 million in late 2023.

Her lawyer, Lisa Bloom, was ebullient, splashing news of the verdict across her website, Instagram page and YouTube channel. She billed it as "one of the biggest sexual harassment verdicts of the year."

Some 18 months later, though, the 38-year-old hasn't received a cent. "I think I look stupid on her website," she said, referring to Bloom's marketing. "No one knows that I'm not a multimillionaire and that I don't have a dollar to my name." She said she sleeps in her mother's guest room in Jacksonville, Fla.

Taylor is one of several employees who have collected only small portions or none at all of the enormous civil judgments they won—more than $150 million in total—against their former boss Alkiviades "Alki" David, an heir to a Coca-Cola bottling fortune who was widely reported to be a billionaire.

Please turn to page A8

The Island Where Horses Rule

* * *

On Vieques, they run through surf and ruin gardens

By Juan Forero And Jenny Carolina González

VIEQUES, Puerto Rico—Denise González thought a garden would be the perfect finishing touch for the bungalow she was preparing to rent out to tourists. The 20 bushes she had brought in "would brighten things up," she said.

With the garden planted, the house—perched on a bluff with turquoise views and framed by mango and Spanish lime trees—seemed ready for visitors seeking laid-back Caribbean vibes.

Then came the horses.

"Oh my goodness! In a day the horses finished off the

Please turn to page A10

Big Banks Try to Avoid Running Afoul of GOP

Big banks are trying to get out of the crosshairs of Republican states that are cracking down on companies for "woke" policies that conservative policymakers say are illegal and discriminatory.

By Alexander Saeedy, AnnaMaria Andriotis and Dylan Tokar

Representatives from JPMorgan Chase, Citigroup, Wells Fargo and other big banks met in recent weeks with officials in states including Texas and Oklahoma to defend against allegations that they refuse to do business with industries such as gun manufacturing and fossil-fuel extraction, people familiar with the discussions said.

Banks are also worried about a bigger threat: that President Trump could turn the power of the federal government against banks, as he has with universities and big law firms.

The Trump administration is considering an executive order on "debanking," according to people familiar with the matter.

Leaders in a growing number of conservative states have accused banks of boycotting industries for political reasons, rather than based on traditional factors such as the ability to repay debts. States including Texas and Oklahoma have blacklisted some banks from state contracts as a result. Banks said they weigh risks when deciding who to do business with and limit ties with companies for financial, legal and reputational reasons.

"I'm not asking them to be MAGA banks," Todd Russ, Oklahoma's state treasurer, said in an interview. "I want them to manage my portfolio and stay out of these political ideologies. I think they realize

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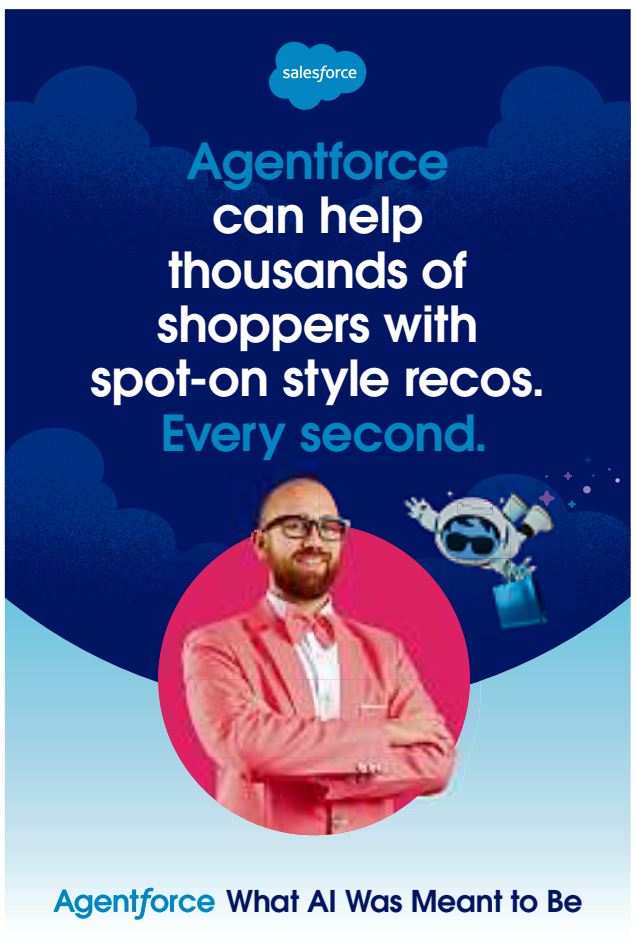

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U.S. NEWS

Powell Sticks to His Guns on Rate Cut

Fed chief testifies he is waiting for more data before cutting, citing tariffs

By Nick Timiraos

Federal Reserve Chair Jerome Powell told lawmakers Tuesday that recent economic data would have likely justified continuing to lower interest rates if not for concerns that higher tariffs might derail the central bank's yearslong fight to defeat inflation.

Powell said little to tee up a July rate cut without explicitly ruling one out. But his answers to lawmaker queries suggested it was more likely officials would wait until at least the September meeting to see if tariff-driven price increases are milder than expected before resuming rate cuts.

"If it turns out that inflation pressures do remain contained, we will get to a place where we cut rates sooner rather than later, but I wouldn't want to point to a particular meeting," Powell said at a House Financial Services Committee hearing.

Officials broadly expect tariffs to spur price growth to pick up this summer, interrupting an uneven but broad-based inflation slowdown. "We do expect [inflation] to move [up] in the summer and if we see it not happening, we will learn from that," Powell said.

The Fed is trying to see how the dust will settle from the aftereffects of President Trump's April 2 tariff announcements, among other policy changes. There is great uncertainty over when and how much businesses may pass along the cost of higher import taxes into consumer prices.

No rush

Powell also said officials would pay close attention to unemployment in considering whether to resume rate cuts. "If we were to see the labor market meaningfully weaken in a way that was concerning, that would matter for that decision," he said. "I don't think we need to be in any rush."

Trump has urged Powell to cut rates now and said Powell could then raise them later if inflation resurfaces. In an overnight social media post looking ahead to the hearing on Tuesday, Trump said, "I hope Congress really works this very dumb, hardheaded person, over."

While some Republicans diplomatically quizzed Powell over his more cautious position toward lowering rates, lawmakers mostly declined to vigorously press the line of criticism made by Trump and some of his appointees.

Fed officials held their short-term benchmark rate steady last week in a unanimous decision. But that surface unity masks a rift that is opening over the path forward.

A few have concluded that tariffs will have only modest effects on prices and want to resume rate cuts soon. If tariffs hit profit margins harder than prices, they could slow the economy and risk higher unemployment.

Two Fed officials appointed by Trump, Christopher Waller and Michelle Bowman, have in recent days indicated they could support lowering rates as soon as the Fed's next policy meeting at the end of July. Waller and Bowman said they expect tariffs will lead to a small, one-time increase in prices that won't generate higher inflation beyond the next year.

Others want to stay on hold for longer because they aren't sure of this and want to see more data. They are more concerned about having to reverse course later if inflation becomes a problem.

The most hawkish officials are particularly wary of steps that could boost demand at a time when businesses are looking to push on higher costs from tariffs to their customers. They are concerned that after four years in which inflation has run above the Fed's 2% goal, customers and businesses may be more tolerant of price increases, which could in turn lead to higher inflation.

Divide widens

Economic projections last week revealed this widening divide in rate-setters' expectations, with 10 officials penciling in at least two rate cuts this year and seven penciling in no cuts. Two others wrote down one cut. The projections show that a "significant majority" of officials expect rate cuts to be warranted later this year, "but also there's a pretty significant minority that doesn't agree," Powell said.

The Fed cut rates by a percentage point in the second half of 2024 after having raised rates and held them at a two-decade high in 2022 and 2023.

Officials who expect to resume rate cuts this year generally envision "some state of the world where inflation doesn't prove to be as high" as others do "or the labor market weakens, or some combination of those two things," Powell said.

Powell declined to embrace or refute the view advanced by Waller and Bowman that officials could prejudge that inflation will be mild enough to resume cuts soon.

"We're going to be learning. We will get an inflation number for June. We'll learn something. Then we'll get it for July," Powell said. "We're perfectly open to the idea that the pass through" of tariffs into retail prices "will be less than we think. And if so, that'll matter for our policy."

Conference Board indexes

Source: The Conference Board

Consumer Confidence Fell in June

By Matt Grossman

U.S. consumer confidence slipped in June, reversing an improvement in May, according to the Conference Board, a research organization.

The Conference Board's consumer-confidence index fell to 93, from 98.4 in May. The fall was a surprise to analysts polled by The Wall Street Journal, who were expecting the index to improve to 99.5.

Consumers remained nervous about tariffs even after the White House took steps to de-escalate its trade war, Conference Board economist Stephanie Guichard said. The survey's forward-looking expectations index fell to 69, from 73.6 a month earlier.

The Conference Board says that values below 80 often signal a recession ahead.

The survey's closely watched labor-market indicator degraded. The survey's labor-market differential fell to 11.1 percentage points, from 12.7 percentage points in May. The figure is calculated by subtracting the share of consumers who think jobs are "hard to get" versus the share who think they are "plentiful."

Consumers also turned more pessimistic about future business conditions. In June, 16.7% said they expect business conditions to improve in six months, down from 19.9% in May.

U.S. WATCH

OBITUARY

Sherman, Singer, Teen Heartthrob

Bobby Sherman, whose winsome smile and fashionable shaggy mop top helped make him into a teen idol in the 1960s and '70s with bubble-gum pop hits like "Little Woman," has died. He was 81.

His wife, Brigitte Poublon, announced the death Tuesday and family friend John Stamos posted her message on Instagram: "Bobby left this world holding my hand—just as he held up our life with love, courage, and unwavering grace." Sherman revealed he had Stage 4 cancer earlier this year.

Sherman was a squeaky-clean regular on the covers of Tiger Beat and Sixteen magazines, often with hair over his eyes and a choker on his neck. His face was printed on lunchboxes, cereal boxes and posters that hung on the bedroom walls of his adoring fans. He landed at No. 8 in TV Guide's list of "TV's 25 Greatest Teen Idols."

He was part of a lineage of teen heartthrobs who emerged as mass-market, youth-oriented magazines and TV took off.

Sherman had four Top 10 hits on the Billboard Hot 100 chart—"Little Woman," "Julie, Do Ya Love Me," "Easy Come, Easy Go," and "La La La (If I Had You)." He had six albums on the Billboard 200 chart, including "Here Comes Bobby," which spent 48 weeks on the album chart, peaking at No. 10.

After the limelight moved on, Sherman became a certified medical emergency technician and instructor for the Los Angeles Police Department, teaching police recruits first aid and CPR. He donated his salary.

—Associated Press

ABC PHOTO ARCHIVES/DISNEY GENERAL ENTERTAINMENT CONTENT/GETTY IMAGES

Bobby Sherman, a teen idol with several hit songs, appeared on the TV series 'Here Come the Brides,' which ran from 1968-1970.

CALIFORNIA

Bombing Suspect Found Dead

A man who was charged with helping bomb a California fertility clinic last month was found dead in a federal detention center, authorities said.

The Justice Department said Daniel Park, 32, was found unresponsive at the Metropolitan Detention Center in Los Angeles. A cause of death wasn't given.

Park was charged earlier this month with providing material support to a terrorist in connection with a car explosion that damaged a fertility clinic in Palm Springs, Calif.

—Joseph Pisani

MASSACHUSETTS

States Sue to Block U.S. Funding Cuts

A coalition of attorneys general from 21 states is suing the Trump administration for slashing billions of dollars in federal funding and justifying the cuts by citing shifting agency priorities.

The attorneys general from Democratic-led states, including New York, New Jersey and Illinois, said the Trump administration is using an obscure clause in regulations issued by the White House to justify the arbitrary termination of grants it doesn't want to award, according to the lawsuit filed in federal district court in Massachusetts on Tuesday.

The coalition said the Trump administration is unlawfully cutting the funds even when Congress has directed spending on a particular program.

"These cuts are simply illegal," said New York Attorney General Letitia James. "Congress has the power of the purse, and the president cannot cut billions of dollars of essential resources simply because he doesn't like the programs being funded."

The White House didn't respond to a request for comment.

The White House's Office of Management and Budget has issued regulations stating that federal agencies can cut a grant if it "no longer effectuates the program goals or agency priorities." Agencies need to document and provide evidence that a grant no longer advances an agency's goals before the funds can be withheld, the lawsuit said.

Multiple agencies have justified cuts, according to the lawsuit. The Justice Department canceled funds for state law enforcement to combat hate crimes. The Environmental Protection Agency used the justification to end funding to research new ways to eliminate certain chemicals from drinking water.

—Joseph De Avila

CORRECTIONS & AMPLIFICATIONS

A Kimpton Hotel Palomar is located in Los Angeles. A photo caption with a Page One article on Tuesday about Los Angeles's minimum wage incorrectly said it is in Beverly Hills, Calif.

Iran said it would stop attacks on Israel if Israel halted its strikes by 4 a.m. Tuesday in Tehran. In some editions Tuesday, a World News article about the Israel-Iran war incorrectly gave the deadline as 4 a.m. Monday.

The nightly price for one person at Battle Harbour Inn in the Canadian province of Newfoundland and Labrador starts at around $436 and includes ferry, accommodation and all meals. An Off Duty travel article on Saturday about visiting the island of Battle Harbour incorrectly said the nightly price with those amenities is around $215 a night.

Readers can alert The Wall Street Journal to any errors in news articles by emailing **wsjcontact@wsj.com** or by calling 888-410-2667.

Banks Race To Appease Republicans

Continued from Page One

that's a fair place to be."

Russ, a Republican, said JPMorgan, Bank of America and Wells Fargo have met with him to try to get off Oklahoma's blacklist of companies that discriminate against oil-and-gas companies.

Earlier this month, Citigroup met with Texas Gov. Greg Abbott, a Republican, to discuss the bank's decision to end its policy of not doing business with companies that sell firearms to people under the age of 21, a person familiar with the matter said.

Citigroup and JPMorgan updated their policies this year to clarify that they don't discriminate on political grounds, which the banks said were already part of their existing practices.

They were also among the big banks that recently left the Net-Zero Banking Alliance, an industry climate group targeted by Texas' attorney general.

Goldman Sachs, Morgan Stanley, JPMorgan and Wells Fargo have removed some limitations on working with the coal sector or have been discussing whether to do so, according to people familiar with the matter. Bank of America dropped its ban on coal companies in late 2023.

A spokeswoman for JPMorgan said, "We believe understanding policymakers' perspectives while sharing our own makes us a better bank." Bank of America said it serves clients in the oil-and-gas industry, as well as those working in clean and renewable energy.

Wells Fargo and Citigroup declined to comment.

A cause célèbre

Alleged discrimination in banking has become a cause célèbre under Trump, with a coalition of Christians, conservatives, and crypto groups accusing big banks of denying them services on political grounds. The Trump Organization sued Capital One in March over the bank's decision in 2021 to shut down hundreds of its corporate accounts. Capital One disputed in a court filing that the account closures occurred because of disagreement with Trump's politics.

"I would love to see some of the big banks go extinct, because, honestly, they deserve it," Eric Trump, one of the president's sons, said in May at a crypto conference in Las Vegas.

Banks can shut down accounts without explanation for a number of reasons, which has long fueled allegations of discrimination.

In recent years, banks also limited their ties with some industries as they sought to incorporate environmental, social and corporate-governance standards into how they do business.

The moves fueled a backlash. Texas and Oklahoma passed laws forbidding state agencies from doing business with companies they say discriminate against the gun or oil-and-gas industries. Tennessee and Idaho passed similar laws more recently.

Banks on states' blacklists could lose state pension funds as clients and other state business. The risks can be bigger. In Florida, the law cites the possibility for "dissolution or reorganization" if banks are found to be making decisions based on customers' political or religious views.

An executive order from Trump could also jeopardize banks' ties with the federal government, such as the sale of Treasury bonds. Drafting of the executive order could be taken up by Trump's Domestic Policy Council, run by Vince Haley, with other White House departments weighing in, people familiar with the matter said.

Stepped-up talks

Many large banks' meetings with Republican states have increased this year, according to people familiar with the matter.

Russ, Oklahoma's treasurer, credited JPMorgan for leaving a number of climate alliances, which he said proves the bank is serious about changing its policies. But the bank remains on the state's blacklist, along with Bank of America, Wells Fargo and others.

"There's been a lot of political posturing and philosophical interjections into the financial decisions that these big companies have been making," Russ said. "We want them to work right down the middle. No activism, no politics, no philosophical assertions."

Big banks have also told Republican leaders on the Senate Banking Committee that regulators required them to consider reputational risks posed by their customers, including negative press about companies.

Sen. Tim Scott (R., S.C.), chair of the Senate Banking Committee, proposed legislation in March that would prohibit regulators from considering reputational risks. Since then, regulators under Trump have moved to eliminate the concept from their bank exams, with the Federal Reserve Board on Monday becoming the latest to do so.

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Cuomo Concedes Mayoral Primary to Mamdani

Former Gov. Andrew Cuomo called to offer congratulations to challenger Zohran Mamdani Tuesday night after the Queens Assemblyman racked up a significant lead in New York City's Democratic mayoral primary.

By Alyssa Lukpat, Victoria Albert and Jasmine Li

Cuomo's team said he will look at the numbers and "leave the door open for November," suggesting he could run again in the general election that doesn't feature ranked-choice voting.

Mamdani had about 43% of the counted vote after polls closed at 9 p.m., according to preliminary results from the city board of elections. Cuomo had about 36% of the ballots counted. Mamdani had over 425,000 votes, to Cuomo's roughly 350,000, BOE said, with nearly 95% of votes counted.

"Tonight was not our night," Cuomo told supporters. "Tonight was Assemblyman Mamdani's night and he put together a great campaign and he touched young people and he inspired them."

City Comptroller Brad

CHRISTIAN MONTERROSA/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Zohran Mamdani has rallied young and left-leaning voters.

Lander was in a distant third place with around 12% of the vote, followed by City Council Speaker Adrienne Adams with over 4%, according to the elections board.

The Board of Elections isn't expected to call the final result until at least July 1, the last day the board can receive mail-in ballots. Only registered Democratic voters were allowed to vote in the party's primary, which had a field of more than a half-dozen candidates.

In the ranked-choice contest, voters can list up to five candidates in order of preference. A candidate needs more than 50% support to win. If no one hits that benchmark, the candidate with the fewest votes will be eliminated. Voters with that person as their top pick will have those votes transferred to their next highest ranked candidate. The process continues until one candidate reaches a majority. In 2021, Mayor Eric Adams won after several rounds.

A progressive favorite, Mamdani has rallied young and left-leaning voters with vows to make buses free, invest $70 billion in publicly subsidized housing, freeze rents on rent-stabilized apartments and more. He landed endorsements from Vermont Sen. Bernie Sanders and Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez.

Voters braved heat that topped 100 degrees in parts of the city to cast ballots for primaries that include City Council races and other positions, according to the city's Board of Elections. More than 380,000 early votes were received between June 14 and June 22.

Mamdani, 33, and Cuomo, 67, were the top contenders in a crowded mayoral race. Cuomo was fighting for political redemption after he resigned as New York governor in 2021.

The Democratic primary winner will still face competition in the November general election. Along with Republican candidate Curtis Sliwa and independent Jim Walden, the Democratic nominee will need to beat Mayor Adams. The incumbent opted to skip the primary and run on his own party lines in November.

More Homeowners Slip Underwater

By Veronica Dagher

Homeowners who bought around the peak of the market are increasingly finding they owe more on their mortgages than their properties are worth.

The number of owners who are underwater is small but growing, and they have recently been concentrated in pandemic boomtowns such as Austin, Texas, and Cape Coral, Fla. A rapid rise in prices in these areas was followed by drops of nearly 20% in some of them. Those who bought at the top have seen value slip out of their homes since then.

Being underwater can have real consequences for, say, homeowners who want to sell. They might hold off if it also means writing a check for the remaining balance to the mortgage company. During the financial crisis of 2008, many owners walked away from their underwater homes, allowing the lender to foreclose, though there is little sign of it happening now.

Homeowners nationwide still have tens of trillions of dollars in equity overall. While some pockets of the U.S. housing market have softened, prices remain high overall, one reason that home sales are relatively sluggish.

A typical decade's worth of home-value growth was packed into just five years, starting in 2020, said Kara Ng, a senior economist at Zillow. Housing demand was driven by a perfect blend of low mortgage rates, high consumer savings and more people desiring larger spaces. Just about every major market experienced robust price growth, but the trend was turbocharged in some Sunbelt cities where remote workers flocked during the pandemic.

The record-fast growth cooled off around when mortgage rates began to rise in 2022 and affordability became stretched. A construction boom added supply to meet demand. There is now a more balanced market between buyers and sellers.

Today's sellers who bought recently are less likely to come out ahead compared with those who bought before the pandemic, according to a Redfin analysis.

Tim Hur, a real-estate agent in Atlanta, is seeing more people willing to sell at a loss because they are fearful their equity will turn negative.

One of his clients had bought a roughly 1,600 square-foot, three-bedroom home for about $400,000 around three years ago. The house is now on the market for around $385,000. He isn't underwater yet. "He wants out now before prices drop further," said Hur.

A growing subset of homeowners is underwater, particularly if they bought after prices had already risen. In April, the number of such homeowners surpassed half a million, the highest April reading in five years, said Andy Walden, head of mortgage and housing market research at Intercontinental Exchange.

Areas such as San Antonio and New Orleans have some of the largest shares of underwater homes.

The net effect of being underwater for owners is that they can get effectively trapped in their homes, real-estate agents say. They are generally unable to sell their properties without bringing cash to the closing table to cover the difference between the sale price and their outstanding mortgage balance.

Lenders are also typically unwilling to refinance mortgages when an owner is underwater. So even if mortgage rates go down later this year or next year, it likely won't help people who are underwater.

Still, negative equity largely has little impact on homeowners' daily financial lives as long as they can afford to stay in their homes and don't plan to sell in the near future. Assuming home prices bounce back in these areas, their equity could turn positive again.

A big problem leading up to 2008 is that lenders extended mortgages to buyers who couldn't afford the payments. That left less reason for them to hold on to their houses after values collapsed. These days, lending standards are much tighter.

Even people who find themselves underwater on their mortgages generally don't have a major cause for alarm, provided they can consistently make payments and keep their jobs, said Chen Zhao, an economist at Redfin.

Zhao expects a slight national home price drop of 1% by the end of the year, which might lead to more people being underwater. But she said that a surge in foreclosures was unlikely. The more stringent lending practices ensure that homeowners are typically able to handle financial fluctuations.

During the pandemic homebuying frenzy, many people made substantial down payments on their homes. They had a store of equity if home prices were to decline, especially compared with those who put down less money.

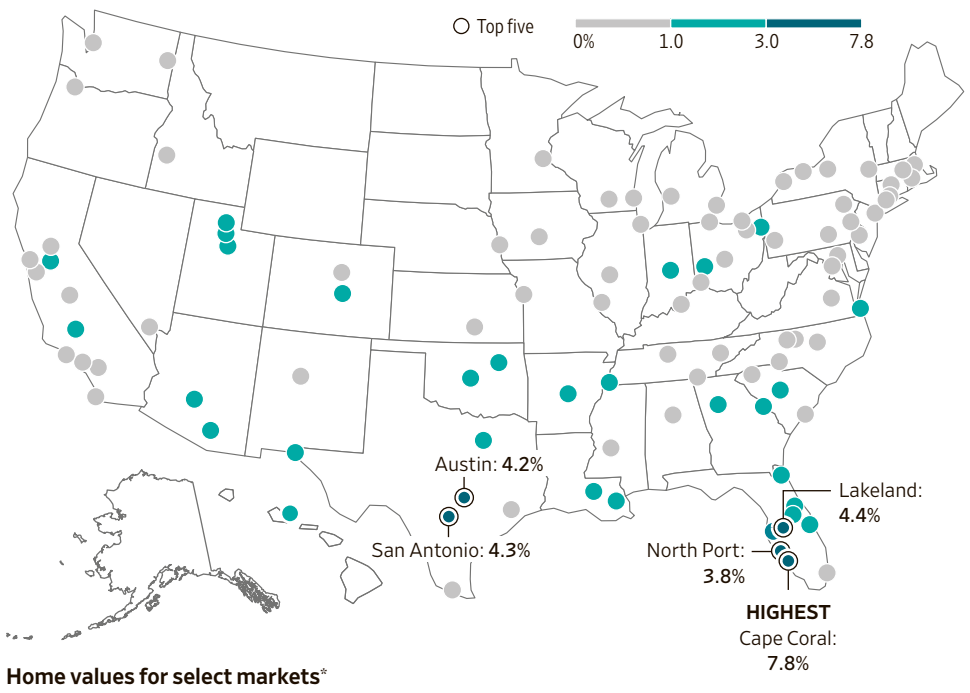
People who used low-down-payment loans, including those backed by the Federal Housing Administration and Department of Veterans Affairs, started with less equity, which made them more vulnerable to even slight dips in home prices, said Walden.

Such loans tend to be used by people of modest means, such as first-time buyers, and there are signs that more of them are stressed financially.

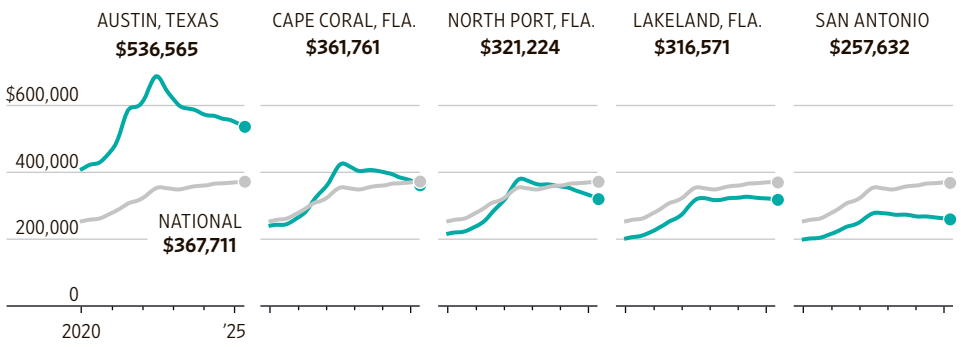
BRONTE WITTPENN FOR WSJ

Areas such as San Antonio, above, and New Orleans have large shares of underwater homes.

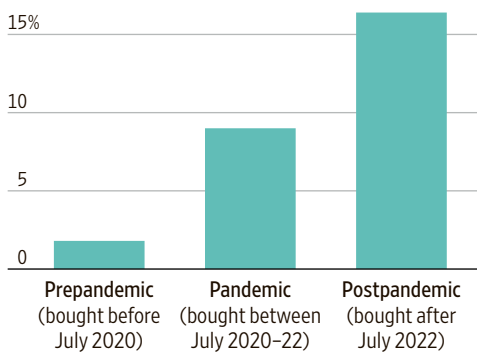
Share of homes that are underwater by market



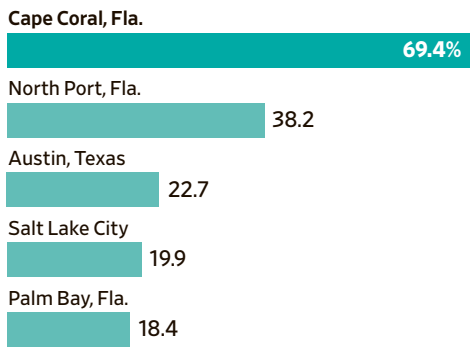
Home values for select markets*



Share of active home listings at risk of selling at a loss



Share of FHA mortgages originated in 2024 where homes are underwater, by select market



*Data as of April; smoothed and seasonally adjusted.
Sources: Intercontinental Exchange (underwater home share, mortgage share); Zillow (home values); Redfin (active home listings)

Mortgage Rates Stifle Price Rise

U.S. home prices rose at the slowest annual pace in nearly two years as mortgage prices continued to stretch affordability.

The S&P CoreLogic Case-Shiller National Home Price Index, which measures home prices across the U.S., rose 2.7% in the 12 months to April, the slowest on-year appreciation since mid-2023 and cooling from 3.4% in March, data Tuesday showed.

Mortgage rates continued at a mid-6% range throughout April, keeping monthly payment burdens near generational highs and pricing out significant segments of potential buyers, said Nicholas Godec, head of fixed income tradables and commodities at S&P Dow Jones Indices.

The data suggests affordability constraints have hit previously overheated markets hardest, while traditionally stable markets with more reasonable price levels are attracting renewed interest, Godec continued.

"We're witnessing a housing market in transition. The era of broad-based, rapid price appreciation appears over, replaced by a more selective environment where local fundamentals matter more than national trends," Godec added.

Across 20 key U.S. cities, the price index saw a deceleration in prices, rising 3.4% on year in April from 4.1% a month earlier. Economists polled by The Wall Street Journal expected a larger 4.0% increase.

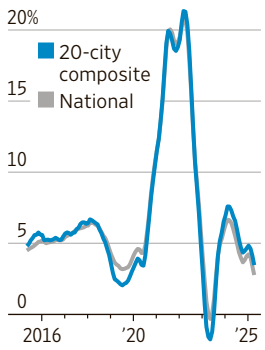
New York again saw the sharpest rise in home prices among the 20 cities, at 7.9% on year, while Tampa, Fla., saw prices fall 2.2%.

Housing supply remains severely constrained, with new construction failing to meet demand, providing the market with a price floor and preventing sharp falls that some had feared, Godec said.

The Case-Shiller index, which measures repeat-sales data, reports on a two-month delay and reflects a three-month moving average. The April data are based on purchase decisions made around the start of the year.

—Ed Frankl

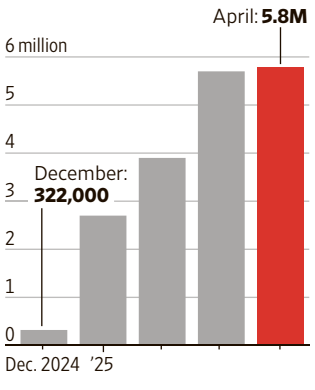
S&P CoreLogic Case-Shiller home price indexes



Note: Seasonally adjusted
Source: S&P Dow Jones Indices via St. Louis Fed

Two Million Student Borrowers at Risk of Docked Pay

Federal student-loan borrowers who are 90 days or more past due



Source: TransUnion

By Oyin Adedoyin

Nearly two million student-loan borrowers are at risk of having their wages garnished this summer.

Roughly six million federal student-loan borrowers are 90 days or more past due after a pandemic-era reprieve ended, according to TransUnion. The credit-reporting company estimates that about a third of them, or nearly two million borrowers, could move into default in July and start having their pay docked by the government. That's up from the 1.2 million that TransUnion had estimated in early May.

An additional one million borrowers are on track to default by August, followed by another two million in September. Borrowers fall into default when they are 270 days past due.

Some borrowers might be having communication issues with their student-loan servicers, while others might be too financially stretched to make payments, said Joshua Turnbull, head of consumer lending at TransUnion.

The Education Department restarted collections on defaulted student loans in May, something it hadn't done since before the pandemic. The department sent notices to borrowers saying their tax refunds and federal benefits could be withheld starting in June if they don't take steps to resume payments.

Wage garnishment is also set to restart this summer. Until past due payments are paid in full or the default status is resolved, borrowers could see up to 15% of their wages automatically deducted from their paychecks.

Student-loan payments were paused during the pandemic. In 2023, the Biden administration gave borrowers a 12-month "on-ramp" period where late or missed payments wouldn't hurt their credit scores. That period ended last fall.

Borrowers who have been newly reported as delinquent since then on their student loans have seen an average 60-point drop in their credit scores, according to TransUnion. Nine percent of borrowers who fell into delinquency were current on their payments by April, according to TransUnion.

The Education Department has been urging borrowers to resume payments and emphasizing the consequences. Roughly 43 million borrowers owe more than $1.6 trillion in student-loan debt.

GOP Races to Settle on a Tax Bill

By Richard Rubin
And Siobhan Hughes

WASHINGTON—President Trump is urging Republicans to get their spending and tax bill to his desk by July 4, but lawmakers face a series of hurdles and headaches on issues ranging from artificial intelligence to deficit spending to rural hospitals.

Senate GOP leaders are revising their version in advance of potential votes this week, searching for a mix that can garner a majority in the chamber, which is divided 53-47. Anything that gets through the Senate must pass the House, which is divided 220-212 in Republicans' favor; any subsequent House changes would require another Senate vote. Lawmakers are scheduled to leave Washington for a recess next week but signaled they were prepared to stay to finish the bill.

"No one goes on vacation until it's done," said Trump in an all-caps post on Truth Social on Tuesday.

The House and Senate bills both would extend tax cuts set to expire at year-end. They would also create versions of Trump's promises to remove income taxes on tips, overtime and Social Security benefits while lowering projected spending on Medicaid and nutrition assistance. The legislation would provide more money for border security and national defense.

On Tuesday, members of several House factions—moderates concerned about Medicaid, conservatives seeking more spending cuts and New Yorkers insisting on a $40,000 state and local tax deduction cap—expressed opposition to the emerging Senate plan.

In each round of the process so far, most GOP holdouts ended up voting "yes" to keep things moving forward.

"When push comes to shove, you're looking at whether you're going to allow the perfect to become the enemy of the good," Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R., S.D.) said Tuesday.

TOM WILLIAMS/CQ ROLL CALL/ZUMA PRESS

GOP Sen. Josh Hawley has warned about the effects of Medicaid spending cuts.

Here's a look at some key outstanding issues:

Deficits

The House bill clocked in a $2.4 trillion increase in budget deficits through 2034, compared with letting tax cuts expire Dec. 31. Dozens of House members said that is as high as they want to go.

What is unknown is just how the Senate version compares and how large a deficit can attract a majority of senators. The tax piece of the bill includes about $400 billion more in tax cuts than the House version, the Joint Committee on Taxation said.

Some key spending cuts have fallen out of the Senate bill after the parliamentarian determined they don't qualify for the fast-track budget reconciliation process. Sen. Markwayne Mullin (R., Okla.) said the items tossed by the parliamentarian had put as much as a $300 billion hole in the bill.

Medicaid

Senators such as Josh Hawley (R., Mo.) and Susan Collins (R., Maine) have been warning about the effects of Medicaid spending cuts.

A main focus is the Senate Republicans' proposed changes to levies known as Medicaid provider taxes, a mechanism that lets states increase their federal subsidies. A tighter limit on those taxes would reduce money to hospitals.

Spending hawks such as Sen. Rick Scott (R., Fla.) have sought more-expansive cuts that would reduce federal spending on the childless, able-bodied adults who gained Medicaid coverage under the Affordable Care Act.

Energy

Compared with the House, the Senate proposed a much slower phaseout of the clean-energy tax breaks that Democrats created in the Inflation Reduction Act in 2022.

Producers of wind, solar and geothermal energy would have more time to start projects and still qualify for tax credits.

SALT

A core bloc of House Republicans from New York, New Jersey and California say they can't support any bill unless it sets the cap on state and local tax deductions, or SALT, at $40,000, up from the current $10,000. They have enough votes to sink the bill.

The House approved the $40,000 number, but high-tax states don't have a Senate Republican making their case, and the change could reduce revenue by hundreds of billions of dollars.

Mullin said late Monday that he saw acceptance, though not agreement, on keeping a $40,000 cap but changing the income thresholds. But Rep. Nick LaLota (R., N.Y.) warned it was a tough sell.

AI

Senate Republicans aim to protect artificial-intelligence projects from state-level regulation by withholding broadband funds from any states that impose AI rules.

The provision is another way to achieve a goal similar to one pursued by the House, which included a moratorium on all AI regulations at the state level. Some Senate Republicans are balking at the AI measure. Hawley said that he wasn't a big fan of the revised proposal.

AOC Impeachment Talk Draws Trump Defiance

By Katy Stech Ferek

WASHINGTON—President Trump dared political foes to try again to remove him from office, taking aim at comments by Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez (D., N.Y.)

"Go ahead and try Impeaching me, again, MAKE MY DAY!" he said on Truth Social.

Ocasio-Cortez, a leading voice in the Democratic Party, said Trump's strikes on Iranian nuclear facilities without congressional approval are "clearly grounds for impeachment." But other Democrats on Capitol Hill said that any talk of impeaching Trump was premature or unhelpful, particularly because any such action wouldn't be possible unless Democrats regain the majority in January 2027. Many focused on criticizing Trump for striking Iran without authorization from Congress and seeking to force votes on the matter.

"We've got to be realistic about what we can do and what we can't, and the distraction of having an artificial discussion about something that's just not going to happen doesn't bode well for the actions we need to really be watching, like cuts to Medicaid," said Rep. Troy Carter (D., La.) on Monday.

Hours after Trump's comments, a majority of Democrats joined with Republicans in a 344-79 vote to block an impeachment proposal from Rep. Al Green (D., Texas). On impeachment, the House Republicans' campaign arm said Democrats "are the boy who cried wolf: loud, desperate, and completely unserious."

AL DRAGO/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez

In an interview, Ocasio-Cortez defended her perspective.

"I think there are some individuals in the party who think we need to roll over and play dead until an election," she said, while she focuses on showing voters how Democrats would act if in charge.

There is a risk in fully opposing the attacks, one Democratic strategist said, as they could end up being viewed as a successful disarming of a dangerous regime. Preventing Iran from obtaining nuclear weapons has been a bipartisan goal.

Lawmakers expected more information from intelligence officials in briefings, pushed to Wednesday from Tuesday for the Senate, enabling Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and Secretary of State Marco Rubio to attend, and scheduled for Friday for the House.

Asked about impeachment Monday, House Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries (D., N.Y.) demurred, emphasizing the need for briefings from the administration and a possible vote on a war-powers resolution.

"There is not an appetite with leadership to go through this," said Rep. Shri Thanedar (D., Mich.), who threatened to force an impeachment vote earlier this year and faced significant backlash from colleagues.

The House impeached Trump in 2019 over his pressuring Ukraine to investigate the Biden family, and in 2021 over his role in the Jan. 6 Capitol riot. Both times, he was acquitted in the Senate.

One House Democratic aide said moderates are hesitant to throw the I-word around at the risk of cheapening its meaning. The Constitution reserves impeachment for "high crimes and misdemeanors."

Democrats were more inclined to back a resolution meant to prevent future Iran strikes without congressional support. By Monday evening, more than 65 had signed on.

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Abortion Ban Led to Risk For Republican

Rep. Cammack says 'fearmongering,' not Florida law, caused doctors to hesitate

By Katy Stech Ferek

ALYSSA SCHUKAR FOR WSJ

Florida Republican Rep. Kat Cammack, pictured this month, got a shot of methotrexate to help expel her 2024 ectopic pregnancy.

Rep. Kat Cammack arrived at the emergency room in May 2024 terrified by what she had just learned: Her pregnancy could kill her at any moment.

It would only get worse. The Florida Republican needed a shot of methotrexate to help expel her ectopic pregnancy, in which there is no way for the embryo to survive. Her state's six-week abortion ban had just taken effect. She said doctors and nurses who saw her said they were worried about losing their licenses or going to jail if they gave her drugs to end her pregnancy.

She began arguing her case. The staff resisted, she said, even though doctors earlier that day estimated she was just five weeks pregnant. There was no heartbeat, and her life was at risk. She pulled up the state law on her phone for hospital workers to read. She said she called the governor's office late at night for help, but no one picked up.

Hours later, doctors finally agreed to give her the methotrexate, Cammack said.

The Florida ban, which took effect May 1, 2024, made abortions illegal after six weeks with limited exceptions. It didn't ban procedures for ectopic pregnancies, but concern about the law's wording made doctors hesitant, said patients and physicians. Months later, Florida regulators gave guidance to make clear that doctors should intervene in cases such as Cammack's.

Pregnant again and due this summer, Cammack said the politics of the incident linger with her. While Cammack opposes abortion and co-chairs the House Pro-Life Caucus, she supports exceptions for reported cases of rape and incest in the first trimester and in instances in which the mother's life is at risk.

Cammack doesn't fault the Florida law for her experience. Instead, she accuses the left of scaring medical professionals with messaging that stressed that they could face criminal charges for violating the law. She said she feels those efforts gave medical staff reason to fear giving drugs even under legal circumstances.

"It was absolute fearmongering at its worst," she said.

Abortion-rights advocates say the law created the problems. While Florida regulators say ectopic pregnancies aren't abortions and are exempt from restrictions, the law doesn't define ectopic pregnancy, and it isn't always easy for doctors to tell where an embryo has implanted, said Molly Duane, a senior attorney at the Center for Reproductive Rights.

Serious enforcement

Asked whether abortion-rights groups contributed to confusion, Duane said Florida regulators had stressed how seriously they planned to enforce the ban. She said blaming medical workers echoes the "playbook of antiabortion extremists that for decades have been blaming and villainizing doctors."

Dr. Alison Haddock, president of the American College of Emergency Physicians, said it is common for doctors in states that have restricted abortion access to worry "whether their clinical judgment will stand should there be any prosecution."

She called early pregnancy care, including instances of ectopic pregnancies, a "medically complicated space" where uncertainty in diagnoses and treatment plans is common. "This has been a real stress point for a lot of our physicians," she said.

The Florida lawmaker spoke about her miscarriage for the first time.

In a 90-minute interview, Cammack, 37, spoke publicly about her miscarriage for the first time. She said she hopes sharing her experience steers conversations toward common ground. "I would stand with any woman—Republican or Democrat—and fight for them to be able to get care in a situation where they are experiencing a miscarriage and an ectopic" pregnancy, she said.

In her first year in Congress, she testified about her family's ties to the issue. Her mother, a stroke survivor, was told by doctors to terminate her pregnancy with Cammack, warning that it put her at risk of another stroke. She went on to deliver Cammack without problems.

From her office couch on Capitol Hill, Cammack recounted her health scare, pausing several times to clutch her third-trimester belly and count baby kicks.

Last year, she and her husband, Matt Harrison, began trying to have a baby. On May 21, she woke up bleeding heavily. She pulled out a pregnancy test that came with the ovulation kit she ordered off Amazon. It was positive.

"Then it's this emotional roller coaster of, 'Oh, my God. Am I pregnant? And am I losing the baby?' " she said.

Her doctor confirmed that she might be miscarrying. There was no treatment to offer. So Cammack said she put on "the biggest maxi pad" she could find and got on a plane to D.C.

She loaded her schedule with decoy dentist appointments to slip away for blood draws to test the level of pregnancy hormones, which continued to rise.

On May 31, back in Florida, a doctor found the embryo implanted where the fallopian tube meets the uterus, considered a cornual ectopic pregnancy. "If this ruptures, it'll kill you," he told her.

Medical professionals said surgery to remove the embryo put her at risk of losing her uterus. She opted for the shot of methotrexate, which blocks folic acid needed by the embryo to grow.

Outnumbered

Cammack said she believes her perspective is an important counterweight on policy issues among House Republicans, where the average lawmaker age is nearly 60 and men outnumber women by around 6 to 1.

One of her male Republican colleagues "almost sunk under the table" when she mentioned breast-feeding to him recently.

As a member of the Committee on Energy and Commerce's health subcommittee and founder of the Republican Women's Caucus, Cammack has criticized what she sees as low federal spending on research and development related to women's health. She voted to pass President Trump's tax and spending megabill but said concerns she had about its cuts potentially leading to hospital closures weren't fully addressed.

An Ugly Texas Senate Primary Is Giving the GOP a Headache

When deciding whether to seek re-election next year, Texas Sen. John Cornyn said one consideration rose above all: A desire to thwart the other GOP hopeful, state Attorney General Ken Paxton.

*By **Elizabeth Findell, Lindsay Wise** and **Mark Maremont***

MANDEL NGAN/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

TOM WILLIAMS/CQ ROLL CALL/ZUMA PRESS

Ken Paxton, left, is looking to unseat Sen. John Cornyn.

"I refuse to let someone of his character—or lack of character—represent Texas in the Senate," Cornyn said in an interview. "I consider this to be drawing a line in the sand."

Texans are gearing up for an ugly primary between Cornyn, a two-decade senator, and Paxton, a MAGA combatant who has prevailed in Texas politics despite repeated accusations of legal and ethical wrongdoing.

Their party is gearing up for a headache.

Republican leaders fear nominating Paxton, who has an edge with the furthest-right voters, could hand Democrats their best opportunity for a win in Texas in decades.

With that in mind, Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R., S.D.) and Sen. Tim Scott of South Carolina, chair of Senate Republicans' campaign arm, both asked President Trump to endorse Cornyn before Paxton announced his campaign. Cornyn himself asked, too. But Trump has so far refused to endorse either Cornyn or Paxton.

A representative for Paxton's campaign declined to answer questions. In a statement, the attorney general called Cornyn's attacks desperate and fake.

Cornyn, a onetime Texas Supreme Court justice, has a staunchly right-wing voting record but has grappled with the Trump-era perception that he isn't MAGA enough. He was booed at the state party convention in 2022, after helping negotiate a bipartisan gun-safety bill in the wake of the elementary school shooting in Uvalde, Texas. Paxton, who has been helped by Christian oil billionaires, is known for filing dozens of lawsuits against the Biden administration. In 2020, he sought to block the electoral votes of four other states in an effort to overturn Trump's loss.

Rep. Wesley Hunt, a Houston-area congressman, has met with national Republicans about a possible candidacy. A person familiar with the conversations said Hunt made the case that only he can win both a primary and a general election without draining GOP coffers.

Cornyn said he would be willing to step aside for the right candidate to defeat Paxton, but he doesn't believe Hunt could win.

Paxton was re-elected twice while under indictment on securities fraud charges. (Prosecutors dropped the charges last year in exchange for Paxton paying $271,000 in restitution to the alleged victims.) Eight of his top-ranking deputies reported to the Federal Bureau of Investigation that Paxton was illegally using his office to benefit a donor. (Paxton denied the allegations, and they didn't result in charges.)

In 2023, Paxton became the third official in Texas history to be impeached. The state Senate acquitted and reinstated him. Earlier this year, a judge found that Paxton had improperly fired four of the aides who reported him to the FBI and awarded them $6.6 million in damages.

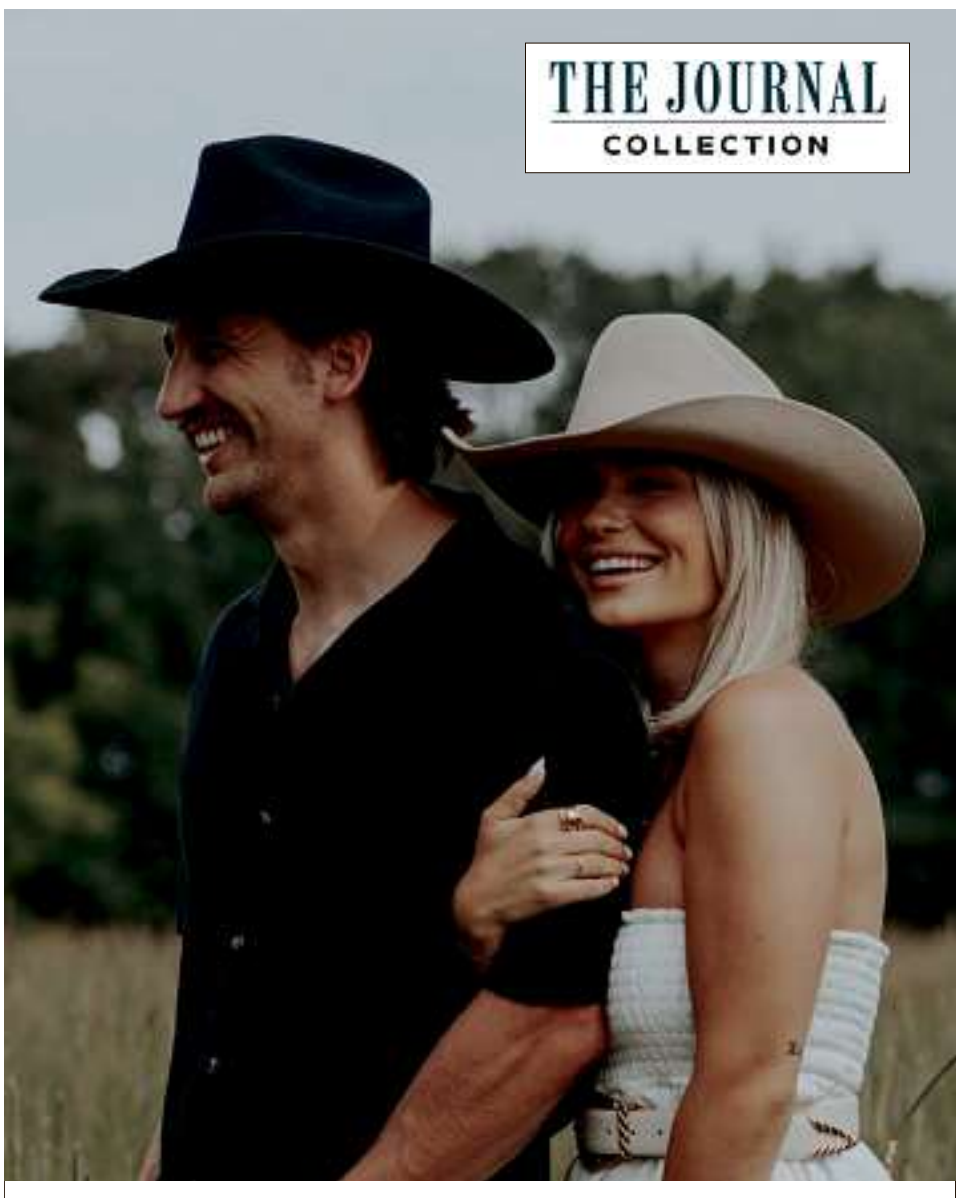
Cornyn has said he intends to make a campaign issue of Paxton's history, including a property-buying spree he and his wife, a state senator, underwent after the pandemic. The couple own at least 10 residential properties, most purchased since he was elected attorney general in 2014.

Most recently, documents reviewed by The Wall Street Journal indicate that Paxton and his wife represented on mortgage documents that at least one of the homes they own in Austin was their principal residence, even as they lived, voted and held office in the Dallas area from a house on which they receive a homestead tax break. Misrepresenting the Austin property as a principal residence, which typically results in a lower interest rate on the loan, could constitute mortgage fraud, real-estate experts said.

Paxton's campaign wouldn't comment on the property.

Polls have shown Cornyn behind among primary voters. One survey in May by Texas Southern University found Paxton leading both Cornyn and Hunt, but with the narrowest margins in hypothetical matchups with Democrats.

A survey earlier in the month by the Senate Leadership Fund showed Cornyn 16 points down in the Republican primary, but Paxton likely to lose to Democrat Colin Allred in the general election. Allred, a former congressman who challenged Sen. Ted Cruz last year, hasn't said whether he will run for the seat.



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WORLD NEWS

A Weakened Iran Remains Lethal

Tehran likely will rebuild conventional arsenal and possibly its nuclear program

EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

A Maxar Technologies satellite image shows damage at Iran's Isfahan nuclear-technology center after the U.S. airstrikes.

DUBAI—Israel and the U.S. delivered powerful blows to the pillars of Iran's theocracy, degrading nuclear and missile capabilities, the highest military echelons and institutions of governance.

Yet the regime, while weakened, is still intact, capable of recuperating and emerging more dangerous and unpredictable. A fragile cease-fire hasn't alleviated tensions that soared during more than a week of war.

By ***Sudarsan Raghavan, Omar Abdel-Baqui*** *and* ***Laurence Norman***

Israeli and U.S. warplanes pummeled Iran's nuclear supply chain and Israel killed 11 veteran nuclear scientists. They destroyed Iranian missile launchers, air defenses, state media and prison buildings. But Tehran still has a pathway—albeit a risky one—to a nuclear weapon.

"The regime is wounded, but still lethal," said Behnam Ben Taleblu, an Iran expert at the Foundation for Defense of Democracies, which promotes relations with Israel in Washington. "Any victory lap now, despite the real successes, the real military successes, would still be premature."

Iran's two known uranium-enrichment sites were hit hard. Damage assessments are still being done at the Fordow facility the U.S. struck with "bunker buster" bombs to reach deep under a mountain. U.N. atomic energy agency chief Rafael Grossi said Monday he suspects it was seriously damaged.

Iran's oldest enrichment site at Natanz was hit harder. Grossi said all its centrifuges might have been wiped out. Israel and the U.S. also knocked out facilities capable of converting uranium into a form in which it can be enriched and turning fissile material into uranium metal. Factories for centrifuge parts were destroyed.

Yet, the attacks likely left Tehran in control of the main ingredients for a bomb. U.S. officials have signaled Iran still has control of about 400 kilograms of highly enriched uranium it has produced since 2021. The whereabouts of the stockpile aren't known—Grossi said it could have been moved from a facility in Isfahan before it was bombed.

"The country's nuclear program remains large and distributed with significant redundancy in expertise and leadership," said Nicole Grajewski, a fellow in the Nuclear Policy Program at the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace. Iran "could develop a smaller, focused capability sufficient for weapons production."

Israel also targeted Iran's conventional weapons, leaving the nuclear targets vulnerable to attack. Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu has said Israel destroyed about half of Iran's missile launchers. Israel has said it disabled dozens of Iranian air-defense missile batteries and destroyed their production sites. Israel estimates Iran began the war with 2,500 ballistic missiles on track to possess 8,000 within two years.

"Israel was shooting at the archer rather than the arrow," said Fabian Hinz, a research fellow for missile technologies and drones at the International Institute for Strategic Studies.

Building more launchers and restoring air defenses that Israel first struck last year will take time, analysts said.

"What Israel bought itself is time," said Michael Horowitz, an Israel-based geopolitical analyst. "The question is for what?"

Israel could face renewed menace from Iran's proxy militias, known as the Axis of Resistance. Lebanon's Hezbollah, once Iran's most powerful allied militia, is still reeling from a punishing Israeli military campaign last year that decimated its leadership and military. The Houthis in Yemen largely sat out this month's conflict.

Iran could seek to rouse them now.

"As Iran figures out what is going to be the anchor of its deterrence strategy going forward—and the role of its proxy network—then it is in their interest to preserve whatever is left of Hezbollah," said Randa Slim, a fellow at the Johns Hopkins University-based Foreign Policy Institute.

But, Slim said, "There is a sentiment among Hezbollah supporters that Iran wasn't there for them when they needed them most."

On Tuesday, Iran's theocratic leaders declared victory over Israel. But the regime could be headed for internal turmoil as ambitious officials vie to fill power vacuums and seek recrimination for intelligence and security failures that left Iran vulnerable to attack.

Some hard-line members of Iran's parliament are calling for the regime to build a nuclear weapon to deter future attacks. Iran's leaders might determine that is too great a risk for now.

"This is potentially just a pause and escalation can kick up at any time unless a proper deal is done," said Sanam Vakil, director of the Middle East and North Africa program at Chatham House in London.

Cease-Fire Appears To Hold

Continued from Page One

It isn't just allies who were bypassed. U.S. officials who would normally play a role during such a crisis were also left out of the loop, administration officials said.

Almost immediately after the U.S. B-2 strikes, Trump called Netanyahu and told him it was time to end the war, a senior administration official said.

Trump's message: The U.S. had completed its military mission and would cease offensive operations and Israel needed to do the same, the official said.

Vice President JD Vance has described the events of recent days as a new U.S. foreign-policy doctrine focused on clearly defining national interests, aggressively negotiating to achieve them and the use of overwhelming force if necessary.

The force in this case was a fleet of B-2 stealth bombers that struck underground Iranian nuclear sites at Fordow and Natanz with a total of 14 30,000-pound Massive Ordnance Penetrator bombs. It achieved what the Israeli military—despite gaining air superiority over Iran more than a week earlier—was unable to do. The underground facilities at Fordow were likely very significantly damaged and the enrichment plant at Natanz was hit, the International Atomic Energy Agency said.

During the conflict, Israeli cities sustained several hits from Iranian ballistic missiles, and Iranian military targets were subjected to widespread bombing. Neither side wanted the war to go on much longer, at least at that intensity, and both were eager for a way out that they could portray as a victory.

By then, Israel had hit what it considered the most important Iranian military targets and saw limited upside in a continued air campaign, people familiar with Israeli government thinking said.

Iran, meanwhile, had been exchanging separate messages with Washington via Arab intermediaries for days.

On Saturday evening, Trump's Middle East envoy Steve Witkoff, informed several Arab countries that a U.S. strike on Iran was imminent, Arab officials said. After the attack, at Trump's direction, Witkoff exchanged direct messages with Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi, the senior administration official said.

Witkoff told Araghchi that Iran needed to come back to the negotiating table, saying the U.S. could inflict more damage on the country, the official said.

Arab leaders also told Iran it was time to offer concessions to Washington, but Iran's foreign minister responded that Iran wouldn't negotiate under fire and wouldn't abandon its nuclear program, Arab officials briefed on the diplomacy said.

Once Fordow, Natanz and a separate site in Isfahan were struck by the U.S., Iran's top military commander vowed to retaliate, saying the U.S. had violated its sovereignty.

Tehran's move, a limited missile salvo fired at Al Udeid air base in Qatar, seemed designed to avoid further escalation.

It remains to be seen if the truce will hold and if it can spur a nuclear deal.

Around noon on Monday, moments before the missiles launched, Iranian officials called Qatar to deliver a warning that the base would be hit, Middle Eastern officials familiar with the situation said. Qatar relayed the Iranian message to the U.S.

U.S. officials told Qatar later Monday that Washington also anticipated the attack, and that the U.S. didn't plan to retaliate, U.S. and Middle East officials said. Iran passed messages to Qatar that the attack would target solely the base, not the civilian areas of Qatar, those officials said.

That gave the U.S. military, which had removed aircraft and many troops from the base, sufficient time to move remaining personnel, and for the U.S. Embassy in Doha to warn U.S. citizens to "shelter in place."

Qatar then closed the country's airspace to commercial flights as it awaited the Iranian barrage—a total of 19 missiles, Qatar said. All were intercepted by air defenses, except one that fell harmlessly near the base. The interceptors collided with the missiles, leaving streaks in Doha's summer night sky.

Qatari Prime Minister Mohammed bin Abdulrahman al-Thani said on Tuesday that his country had received prior intelligence that allowed the country and the U.S. to prepare.

Shortly after the barrage, Vance spoke with the Qatari prime minister around 5 p.m., and Trump spoke with Emir Tamim bin Hamad al-Thani minutes later, a person familiar with the calls said. Trump asked the emir if he would call Iran and ask if the Iranian government was open to a cease-fire. He obliged, and Iran agreed.

Trump—who just hours earlier publicly contemplated regime change in Iran—announced the cease-fire after the calls, posting on social media: "CONGRATULATIONS TO EVERYONE!"

Diplomats who would normally provide talking points for calls with regional leaders weren't asked for help, U.S. officials said.

Despite Trump's social-media victory lap, Israel and Iran were still exchanging further blows. Four hours before the cease-fire was set to take effect at 7 a.m. local time Tuesday, Israel launched a massive wave of strikes in Tehran, killing hundreds of security-force personnel, Netanyahu said on X.

Among the targets was the headquarters of Iran's Organization of Defensive Innovation and Research, a defense ministry research institution, the Israeli military said.

Minutes before the cease-fire deadline, an Iranian missile struck a seven-story residential building in the city of Beer Sheba, killing four people—one of the deadliest episodes of the war for Israeli civilians. Rescue workers the next day combed through piles of rubble at the site.

Three more missiles were fired from Iran after 7 a.m., without causing casualties or damage, Netanyahu said. Israel threatened further retaliation.

"In light of the severe violation of the cease-fire carried out by the Iranian regime, we will respond with force," warned Lt. Gen. Eyal Zamir, the Israeli military's chief of the general staff.

Trump was surprised to learn Tuesday morning that the cease-fire was in danger. He stepped out on the South Lawn before boarding a helicopter on his way to a NATO summit in Europe and rebuked both countries for threatening the cease-fire, especially the U.S.'s closest Middle East ally.

After boarding a helicopter for a short flight to his presidential plane, Trump tapped out an all-caps warning to Israel: "DO NOT DROP THOSE BOMBS. IF YOU DO IT IS A MAJOR VIOLATION. BRING YOUR PILOTS HOME, NOW!"

Thirty-eight minutes later, following a call with Netanyahu, Trump announced the Israeli warplanes were turning around. "Nobody will be hurt, the Ceasefire is in effect!" Trump posted on social media.

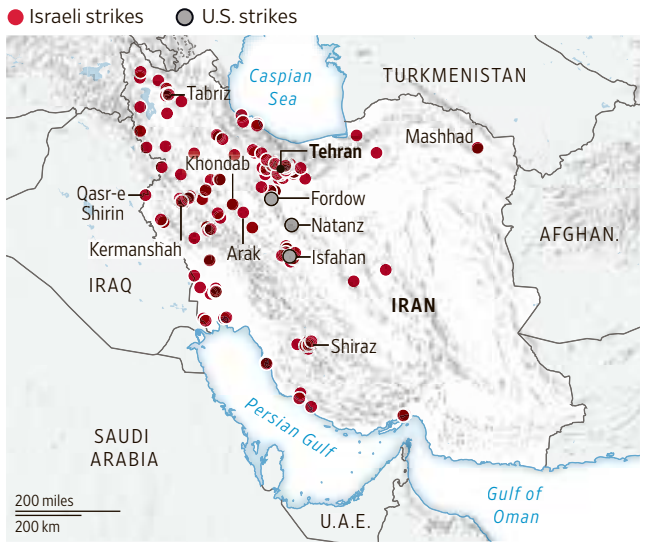
Netanyahu said Israel destroyed a radar installation near Tehran and, following the call from Trump, refrained from further attacks. Israel had "achieved all of its objectives for the war," he said.

Iran's Supreme National Security Council proclaimed that it had delivered a "crushing response to every act of hostility by the enemy" and "shattered the enemy's primary strategic goal."

LEO CORREA/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A rescue team works at the site of a deadly Iranian missile strike in southern Israel's Beer Sheba.

Isreali and U.S. strikes in Iran since June 13



Note: As of 5 p.m. ET on June 23
Sources: Institute for the Study of War and AEI's Critical Threats Project; staff reports
DANIEL KISS/WSJ

Briefings Delayed In Congress

The classified briefings on Iran for House and Senate lawmakers that were scheduled Tuesday afternoon were abruptly canceled, angering Democrats who have criticized the Trump administration for failing to provide key details about this past weekend's strikes.

"It's outrageous. It's evasive. It's derelict," said Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer (D., N.Y.). "There is a legal obligation for the administration to inform Congress about precisely what is happening. What are they afraid of? Why won't they engage Congress in the critical details?"

The Senate briefing was pushed to Wednesday, a move that will enable Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and Secretary of State Marco Rubio to attend.

House lawmakers haven't been informed of their new briefing date.

—Katy Stech Ferek

U.N. Presses Site Inspections

U.N. atomic energy agency chief Rafael Grossi has written to Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi in his quest to regain access for international inspectors to Iran's nuclear facilities and its enriched uranium stockpile.

"IAEA inspectors have remained in Iran throughout the conflict and are ready to start working as soon as possible, going back to the country's nuclear sites and verifying the inventories of nuclear material," the International Atomic Energy Agency said on Tuesday.

"Resuming cooperation with the IAEA is key to a successful diplomatic agreement to finally resolve the dispute over Iran's nuclear activities," Grossi said.

He reaffirmed that there had been "no radiological impact to the population and the environment in neighboring countries" from the U.S. and Israeli strikes.

—Laurence Norman

Trump: China Can Buy Iran Oil

President Trump said China can buy Iranian oil, despite his administration's imposition of sanctions designed to stop such trade. The U.S. has sanctioned Chinese refineries, port operators and other firms for importing Iranian crude as part of its campaign against Tehran.

The announcement, however, raises legal questions, said Eddie Fishman, a former senior State Department sanctions official. "Trump can waive the sanctions if he judges it is vital to the national interests of the United States, but he would need to formally submit a waiver to Congress first," he said.

By far Iran's biggest source of foreign revenue in recent years is its oil sales to China. Iran used various circuitous routes to make the sales to China, raising the costs for Iran. China formally stopped marking Iranian oil imports as coming from Iran in 2023.

—Georgi Kantchev and Laurence Norman

Gulf Shipping Still At Risk

Houthi militants aren't bound by the truce between Israel and Iran, said Mohammed al-Bukhaiti, a senior political official and spokesman for the Yemeni rebels. Military operations against Israel will continue "until the aggression against Gaza stops and the siege is lifted," he told The Wall Street Journal.

Despite the cease-fire, the maritime industry should remain on high alert, said the Joint Maritime Information Center, which informs shippers on behalf of the U.S. and U.K. Navies.

"Underlying geopolitical tensions remain unresolved," it said.

The report recommends keeping security measures such as emergency plans to reroute or relying more heavily on radar-based navigation, "given the prevalence of electronic interference."

—Saleh al-Batati and Benoit Faucon

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Iran Attack Sparks Retaliation Concerns

U.S. federal officials urge vigilance amid an environment of heightened threats

By Sadie Gurman And Dustin Volz

WASHINGTON—Federal law-enforcement officials are on high alert for domestic retaliation in response to the U.S. bombing in Iran, warning of potential Tehran-backed plots and cyberattacks.

Federal Bureau of Investigation officials in cities including New York, Los Angeles, Chicago and Philadelphia were told on Monday that they should shift resources toward Iran and domestic threats, after manpower in recent months had been focused on the Trump administration's priority of immigration enforcement, a person familiar with the matter said.

FBI leadership in a weekend internal email instructed field offices to monitor intelligence and stay in close contact with the Defense Department and National Guard, as military facilities could be targets of retaliation.

In a Sunday conference call, officials from the FBI and Department of Homeland Security said they hadn't seen the Iranian regime call for violence in the U.S. in response to the strike but urged their state and local counterparts to be alert, a person on the call said. An FBI official told attendees the bureau was closely monitoring its intelligence network.

DHS issued a bulletin on Sunday warning the public that the domestic threat level was higher because of the Iran conflict, which it said could spur hate crimes by violent extremists against perceived Jewish or pro-Israel targets, as well as Iranian state-backed cyberattacks.

"The risk of Iranian plotting has only increased. The FBI and Justice Department have to be extremely vigilant going forward to detect and disrupt these plots before they are carried out," said Matt Olsen, head of the department's national-security division during the Biden administration.

The danger comes as the Trump administration has shifted domestic law-enforcement priorities to focus on combating illegal immigration, even directing counterterrorism teams to spend their time helping with arrests and deportations. Some current and former employees worried the diversion of resources to immigration enforcement would weaken the FBI's ability to thwart more-pressing threats.

ABEDIN TAHERKENAREH/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Demonstrators in Tehran on Tuesday held up signs featuring anti-American slogans.

The FBI declined to comment on its operational decisions.

In some locations, federal agents joined immigration officials in searching for Iranians who had overstayed their visas or were otherwise in the country illegally, people familiar with the matter said, a tactic that can also be used to gather intelligence on potential plots.

A Homeland Security spokeswoman said the agency "has been full throttle on identifying and arresting known or suspected terrorists and violent extremists that illegally entered this country" but said such roundups of undocumented immigrants happen daily and weren't specifically focused on Iranians.

In New York and Washington, D.C., police said they had ramped up their presence at religious institutions and cultural diplomatic sites.

"What takes place on the global stage often is found on our local streets here in New York. And so, we must be prepared whenever there's an action," Mayor Eric Adams said.

U.S. Bombing Adds to Economic Uncertainty at Home

By Jeanne Whalen

The U.S. bombing of Iran and direct involvement in Israel's conflict has added a fresh dose of uncertainty to a U.S. economic picture that was already looking pretty muddled.

Recent gyrations in policy and global events have left economists and consumers in a state of confusion. On Monday night, just hours after Iran's retaliatory strike on a U.S. base and while talk of regime change was still in the air, President Trump announced a cease-fire deal between Iran and Israel.

Add the geopolitical whipsaw to Trump's on-again/off-again tariff plan and to deportations that sparked mass protests and spooked the hotel and agriculture industries. Businesses have slowed hiring considerably, partly out of concern about tariffs and rising costs, but they aren't engaging in big layoffs and the unemployment rate remains low. Even the Federal Reserve, the steward of the U.S. economy, is torn on where things are headed and whether to cut interest rates.

"If you were to ask me, give me a description of the United States economy, it's 'pervasive uncertainty,' " said Joe Brusuelas, chief economist at RSM, an audit, tax and consulting firm. "There is too much risk on the table right now. We just don't know in which direction we are truly headed."

Nick Bloom, an economics professor at Stanford, oversees an index that tracks economic uncertainty in the U.S. and globally, based on the number of news articles expressing the sentiment. Readings in recent months have soared, hitting quadruple the long-running average, he said.

"The Iranian conflict will fit exactly in this, this kind of deluge," Bloom said. "Every theater of economics and politics seems to be impacted by political and economic uncertainty."

The danger of that is if it hampers investment and hiring, he said. "If you are running a business or you are thinking about going out and buying a car or buying some new clothes, if you are uncertain about the future, you pause," he said.

Economists said they were encouraged by the conflict's muted impact on oil prices. U.S. benchmark crude started climbing after Israel began bombing Iran on June 13 but has turned down, falling 7% on Monday, to $68.51 a barrel.

Despite threats, Iran hasn't blocked tanker traffic in the Strait of Hormuz, through which about 20% of the world's oil-supply flows, according to the U.S. Energy Information Administration.

A conflict that did cause oil prices to surge would risk igniting another round of inflation at a delicate time for the U.S. economy. A 10% rise in oil prices would cause the core components of the Federal Reserve's preferred inflation gauge, the personal-consumption-expenditures index, to rise by 0.04 percentage point, according to analysis by Goldman Sachs.

The bank also estimates that a $10-per-barrel increase in oil prices would lower U.S. GDP growth by 0.1 percentage points, after balancing the drag on consumption against the economic boost from investment in the energy sector.

Trump has badgered the Federal Reserve to cut interest rates, arguing that the Fed is needlessly inflating federal borrowing costs. Any new hints of inflation heating up again could make it harder for the Fed to justify a rate cut in the months to come.

On Monday, Trump cautioned against increases in oil prices. "Everyone, keep oil prices down," he wrote on social media. "I'm watching. You're playing right into the hands of the enemy."

The U.S. economy isn't as vulnerable to Middle Eastern conflict as it was during the Arab oil embargo of the 1970s.

Still, the potential for escalation in the conflict with Iran adds uncertainty to an economic outlook that was already confusing many economists and consumers.

Most economists expect tariffs to lift prices over the coming months, causing new handwringing at the Fed about how quickly to cut rates.

Moscow Fails to Back Tehran

By Thomas Grove And Bojan Pancevski

President Vladimir Putin of Russia met his Iranian counterpart at the Kremlin at the start of the year to sign a new strategic partnership to seal the budding alliance between the two countries that had spent the last decade trying to undermine the U.S.-led world order.

Now, after a tenuous cease-fire ended more than a week of punishing Israeli and U.S. airstrikes, that partnership is doing Tehran little good.

ALEXANDER KAZAKOV/REUTERS

President Putin met with Iranian Ambassador to Russia Kazem Jalali, right, and Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi.

When Putin met with Iran's top diplomat, Abbas Araghchi, on Monday, the Kremlin leader gave a stony-faced assessment of the U.S. strikes. He called the attacks unjustified and unprovoked, and said Russia wanted to help the Iranian people. But the Kremlin leader made no mention of military support in his public remarks ahead of the talks. Instead, he suggested they discuss an exit ramp out of the conflict. "This gives us a chance to...think together about how it would be possible to get out of this situation," Putin said.

Israeli strikes targeted Iran's nuclear program, missiles and top military figures, with the U.S. joining over the weekend by using its most powerful bunker busters. Iran, meanwhile, has gotten little more than rhetorical support from its most powerful backers, including Russia and China.

The partnership between Moscow and Tehran has been a thorn in the side of Western interests in Europe and the Middle East. The two cooperated for nearly a decade in Syria to keep President Bashar al-Assad in power. And after Moscow fumbled the initial stages of its invasion of Ukraine, Iran boosted Russia's war effort with ammunition, artillery shells and thousands of drones.

But Moscow is unlikely to return the favor. With Iran facing its most existential challenge in decades and even signals from President Trump about regime change, Russian military aid is unlikely to come through, analysts said. While the strategic partnership reached between the two countries didn't include a mutual defense pact, it did strengthen intelligence sharing and prohibit the countries from helping each other's enemies in conflicts.

"Iran can ask Russia to back it up in retaliation to the U.S., but Moscow will never accept it," said Nikolay Kozhanov, an expert on Russian-Iranian relations and a professor at Qatar University.

The move underscores the transactional nature of even Putin's strongest partnerships as the Kremlin is mired in Ukraine and vulnerable to Western sanctions. He wants to avoid an escalation of violence that could end badly for Iran and Russia. He also wants to preserve an on-again-off-again relationship with Israel and his ties with Trump, who has held back on sanctioning Russia despite the Kremlin's resistance to engaging in substantive peace talks with Ukraine.

That is unlikely to satisfy—or surprise—Iran, which has faced disappointment from the Russians before.

The month after the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas-led attack killed more than 1,200 Israelis, the Iranian government said it completed a deal for Moscow to supply Sukhoi Su-35 jet fighters, Mi-28 attack helicopters, S-400 air-defense systems and Yak-130 training jets.

The only delivery it got was the training jets. Production problems and diplomatic pressure from other Gulf countries prompted Russia to withhold more sensitive and powerful technology, said Nicole Grajewski, a fellow with the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace and author of a book on Iran and Russia.

Last year, Israeli strikes took out some of Iran's best air-defense systems that had been provided by the Russians. In the months that followed, Russia was either unable or unwilling to replace them. On Monday, Araghchi asked Putin for new air-defense systems and help in restoring its nuclear energy network, according to a person briefed on the talks.

Last week, when pressed by reporters about why Russia wasn't supplying arms to help Iran counter Israel's attacks, Putin said Iran hadn't made any specific new requests.

Iran is the most recent Russian partner to experience a cold shoulder from Moscow. Armenia, which has a mutual-defense treaty with Russia, got no help from Moscow as its forces in the breakaway Nagorno-Karabakh region of Azerbaijan were decimated by Baku's troops in 2020 and 2023. The debacle accelerated Armenia's fundamental shift toward partnership with the U.S.

Similarly, when Syria's Assad was toppled last year, Putin merely offered asylum to the former strongman.

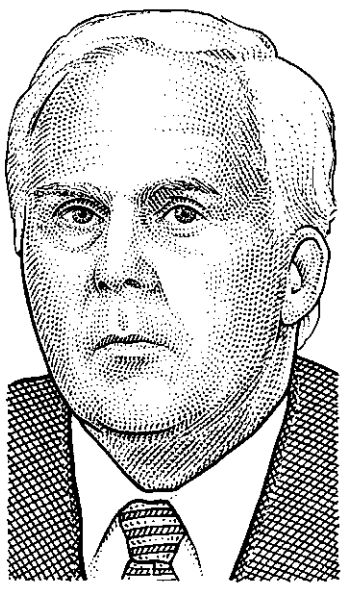
"Putin often turns his back on his autocratic friends when they need him," said Fabrice Pothier, a former top adviser to North Atlantic Treaty Organization leadership.

Putin has sought to position himself as a potential mediator. Trump has dismissed that, saying he should focus on mediating the Ukraine war.

In Memoriam

Frederick W. Smith

1944-2025



We celebrate the life of Fred Smith, the visionary founder and longtime CEO of FedEx, who passed away at the age of 80. Mr. Smith was also a founding member of The Wall Street Journal CEO Council, where he was always willing to share his unique insights with others. He leaves behind a legacy of innovation, leadership, and global impact.

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FROM PAGE ONE

Strikes Cost Iran Months On Program

Continued from Page One

"Those targets were obliterated," he said on Tuesday morning. Some independent nuclear security experts have also said they believe that Iran sustained significant to severe damage to its nuclear program.

Secretary of Defense Pete Hegseth also challenged the intelligence report. "Based on everything we have seen, and I've seen it all, our bombing campaign obliterated Iran's ability to create nuclear weapons," he said, adding: "Anyone who says the bombs were not devastating is just trying to undermine the president and the successful mission." Trump posted Hegseth's comments on social media.

The administration delayed a classified briefing about Iran that had been scheduled for lawmakers Tuesday. That has led some in Congress—mainly Democrats—to question whether U.S. intelligence matches up with public statements from Trump, a Republican.

The strikes over the weekend shut the entrances to underground facilities at two of the sites, but didn't collapse their underground structures, the report said, according to an official familiar with the assessment.

One of the people familiar with the intelligence said that the facilities were degraded, but not severely, and that Iran still retained the ability to enrich uranium. Iran might have also moved enriched material from the sites before they were destroyed, and might have other covert sites to enrich uranium, the person said.

Early last week, days before the U.S. strikes on Iran, a senior U.S. intelligence official said the consensus intelligence community view at the time was that Israel's bombing campaign had already set back Iran's nuclear program by five to six months.

The U.S. strikes targeted three key Iranian nuclear sites: Natanz, Isfahan and Fordow. U.S. B-2 stealth bombers dropped a total of 14 30,000-pound GBU-57 Massive Ordnance Penetrator bunker-buster bombs at targets including Fordow, which has an underground nuclear facility. U.S. submarines also fired Tomahawk cruise missiles at the Isfahan site.

The director general of the International Atomic Energy Agency, Rafael Mariano Grossi, said on Monday that the strikes likely caused "significant damage" at Fordow, but that no one, including the agency, was in a position to fully assess the damage at the underground site.

A fuel enrichment plant was hit at Natanz, Grossi told the IAEA board of governors on Monday. At Isfahan, other buildings were hit, as were entrances to tunnels used for storing enriched nuclear material, he said.

The strikes followed days of Israeli bombing at Iranian military and government sites. Israel and the Trump administration said the strikes were intended to stop Iran from acquiring nuclear weapons. Iran has said its nuclear program is peaceful.

Clients Struggle To Collect

Continued from Page One

Some of those plaintiffs, including two represented by women's rights lawyer Gloria Allred, Bloom's mother, have been waiting about six years.

David, who left the U.S. even before the final verdicts rolled in, has denied all the allegations of workplace misconduct, dismissing some of the alleged behavior as workplace high-jinks and accusing the lawyers of orchestrating the cases for financial gain.

"Even if I had all the wealth in the world, I wouldn't give them a penny anyway," he said in an interview. "Why would I do that?"

The cases reveal an unpleasant reality about #MeToo verdicts and other civil judgments: Winning is hard enough, but collecting can be even harder. A pack of debt-collecting lawyers and finance companies have entered the picture, offering to help pursue David's wealth for a cut of the money. David, who has been spending much of his time in London and the Caribbean nation of Antigua and Barbuda, is fighting them at every turn.

For plaintiffs, the collection expenses come on top of the sizable percentages due to the lawyers who brought the cases, potentially reducing their share of money recovered to as little as 30 cents on the dollar. So far, most of the several million dollars that have been extracted from David have gone to pay the cuts owed to trial lawyers, collection lawyers and a funding firm, and it isn't clear how much more is available to make good.

That hasn't stopped some of the lawyers who won the cases against David on behalf of former employees from featuring the headline-making awards on their websites and other promotional material.

◆ In addition to the $8.4 million judgment for Taylor, Bloom has highlighted a $11 million sexual-harassment award in 2019 to another client, Chasity Jones.

◆ Allred has been touting a $58 million sexual-harassment award in 2019 to client Mahim Khan, and a $5 million verdict that same year for a second client, Lauren Reeves.

◆ Lawyers at JML Law highlight a $7 million judgment awarded to Karl Zirpel in a 2021 whistleblower case against one of David's businesses.

◆ Los Angeles lawyer Gary Dordick has been displaying on his home page a $900 million jury award last year to an employee who accused David of rape—even though a judge reduced the amount to $90 million.

All these numbers should have an asterisk next to them," said Zirpel, who was fired by David after reporting safety concerns. The former vice president for Hologram USA, an entertainment company, said he hasn't received any of the money about four years after the verdict.

Taylor said the legal process has been nearly 10 years of suffering, and that she isn't willing to accept that her share of recovery could be so small. "I wish anyone would have made clear to me that it would be this retraumatizing and this hard to collect," she said. "I wouldn't have ruined my life."

Bloom said the David cases are the only times clients of hers have had to try to enforce a judgment, that David has gone out of his way to defy the legal process, and that Taylor hasn't retained any collections lawyers. She said her firm represented Taylor on a contingency basis and hasn't collected anything for years of work. Bloom provided a written statement that she said was from Jones, her other client who sued David, saying she was pleased with her firm.

Allred said her firm does civil litigation and isn't a collections firm. She declined to discuss clients, and provided statements from Khan and Reeves indicating they were pleased with Allred's firm and the firm they hired to enforce the judgments.

Nicholas Sarris, co-managing partner of JML Law, said the firm is working on a contingency basis and hasn't been paid either. Dordick said sexual-assault judgments against individuals are often difficult to collect, and defended the way his firm highlighted the jury verdict. "We're not advertising that it was collected," he said.

'Go full Karen'

David, who is 57 years old, was born in Nigeria to a wealthy Greek family that holds a major stake in Coca-Cola HBC, a bottling business in 29 countries across Europe and Africa. He has owned luxury homes in California, London, Switzerland and Greece. He launched several media ventures in Los Angeles.

David shared medical evaluations with the Journal that indicated he has been diagnosed with a traumatic brain injury and paranoia. The damage to his brain, he said, contributes to impulse control issues and angry outbursts that make him "go full Karen."

He cited the brain injury in court and on his Instagram feed where he lambastes lawyers and the California court system. He also has staged and filmed public encounters with lawyers. In a YouTube video posted in 2022, he confronted Allred in a parking lot and yelled expletives at her while she loaded up her car.

David, who isn't a U.S. citizen, said immigration issues have prevented him from reentering the country in recent years. He said he recently filed a lawsuit in Antigua accusing former employees and various lawyers of fraudulent litigation, suppression of exculpatory evidence and psychological abuse. He also questioned the credibility of the Journal and threatened to add the newspaper to the Antigua lawsuit.

One of his properties, a beachfront home in Malibu, Calif., was the subject of an extended standoff between David and one of the lawyers chasing his assets. In 2023, a court-appointed receiver took possession of the house. The property was sold last year for less than what was owed on the mortgage, according to the receiver.

Collection lawyers identified a U.S. bank account with roughly $3.7 million. After a mortgage lender on the Malibu home took a portion, Bloom's client Jones split the remaining amount with Allred's clients, who used most of that money for their lawyers' cuts and fees related to the collection effort.

Lawyers also seized more than $3 million from the sale of a Swiss chalet that David co-owned, and nearly all of those funds went to fund the collection effort, documents show.

More than $13 million was set aside from the sale of a property David owned on the Greek island of Spetses, but more than half of that was slated to pay lawyers, according to documents.

Themis Sofos, a lawyer for David in Greece, said he is appealing the enforcement of the U.S. judgment in Greece.

Trial lawyers typically outsource efforts to collect civil judgments.

Taylor met David in 2015 after responding to a Craigslist ad for a job at FilmOn, one of his businesses. She said that David had groped her and held her upside down by the ankles, among other things, and she had reported him for sexual harassment. David denied either sexually harassing or otherwise mistreating her.

She hired Bloom in early 2017 and introduced the firm to Jones, another employee with allegations against David, she said. Two other employees who had allegations against David—Reeves and Khan—hired Allred's firm.

Taylor expected her trial to go first, but Jones's case did so. Taylor said she didn't know the order could affect her chances of recovering money. Bloom denied that it did.

During three separate trials in 2019, juries awarded Jones and Allred's two clients a total of about $73 million. That September, a jury failed to reach a verdict on Taylor's sexual-harassment and wrongful termination claims, resulting in a mistrial.

Taylor was devastated. She said Bloom told her the jury didn't side with her because she was unlikable on the stand, and that only attractive people win trials. Bloom denied saying that.

Taylor said she wouldn't have pursued the case had she known it would dominate her life. She said she was expected to reply to outreach by the Bloom firm within 24 hours. "I kept being told a few more months, and a few more months, and all of a sudden it was years," she said.

Bloom said her firm always updates clients about their cases, as they did with Taylor in early 2020 when they learned David was making moves to avoid paying judgments or when they encountered delays. She said her firm hasn't charged Taylor for more than 4,000 hours of legal work or more than $200,000 in expenses.

It wasn't until 2023, nearly eight years after Taylor was fired from David's company, that her case went to trial again, and the jury awarded her $8.4 million.

Bloom's firm arranged for Joseph Chora, a lawyer whose firm specializes in enforcing judgments by tracking and seizing assets, to collect on the $11 million verdict won by her other client, Jones, which led him to pursue the Malibu house. He also testified as an expert witness when Taylor's case against David went to trial for the second time.

At the trial, Chora estimated David's net worth to be between $2 billion and $3 billion. He said David used limited-liability companies, trusts and other tactics to prevent his firm from enforcing the judgment. David has money for spending, Chora said, including $130,000 to clone his dying Doberman, Vader.

In an interview, Chora said David pulled most of the equity out of his Malibu house and transferred assets to a trust in South Dakota that he said was for his children. That frustrated collection efforts, he said. "Alki David had millions of dollars," he said. "How much exactly, I don't know."

David has disputed Chora's characterization of his wealth, and said he once paid a journalist to get on a billionaire list.

Collections industry

Allred, Bloom and other trial lawyers typically outsource efforts to collect civil judgments.

Plaintiffs, on top of what they pay lawyers handling their lawsuits, must pay for time spent by the judgment enforcers, or give them a cut of any amounts collected. The plaintiffs have to cover some costs upfront, so they sometimes turn to firms that finance such work. Those specialty funders often take a first cut of any recoveries.

To collect the 2019 judgments against David, Allred's two clients turned to Oren Warshavsky, a lawyer at BakerHostetler who specializes in international asset tracking. To fund that effort, those clients turned to Omni Bridgeway, a firm that funds litigation.

When BakerHostetler eventually seized more than $3 million from the sale of the ski chalet in Switzerland last year, most of the proceeds went to pay back Omni, documents show.

Omni declined to discuss specific clients, but said funders typically are entitled to priority repayment because they provide risk capital that clients aren't obligated to repay unless funds are recovered.

BakerHostetler's Warshavsky also declined to comment on clients, but said that when the firm works on a contingency basis, it receives "significantly less than the client's share."

Zirpel, the whistleblower, said that after he won his 2021 case his lawyers at JML Law pointed him to Chora's firm. He said he was surprised to find out he was expected to pay 36% of the money recovered to Chora's firm, in addition to the 50% he already agreed to pay his trial lawyers. Chora's firm also expected him to pay thousands of dollars in investigative and other costs. Zirpel said he decided not to hire that firm.

By the time Taylor's second trial was set to begin in late 2023, it was clear that collecting from David would be difficult. Taylor said she felt that Bloom would help her obtain any money she won because that's what Bloom told her.

In an Instagram video in May of that year, Bloom said, "Under our system of justice, paying judgments is not optional." Bloom said her firm had been pursuing David since 2019 for her other client and that it was on the verge of taking his house. "We will pursue him until we get every dollar for our client," Bloom said in the video.

Taylor said she was surprised when Bloom's law partner, Arick Fudali, told her in a series of calls starting that October that she was unlikely to get any money. He told her, she recalled, that she would need to find a judgment enforcement firm, and she shouldn't use Chora because he already was working for Bloom's other client, Jones.

Taylor said she became distraught on the calls, questioning why the law firm helped collect for another client. Fudali, she said, played down Bloom's social-media comments and said Chora's collections efforts had been largely unsuccessful and costly.

In November 2023, Bloom told Taylor in an email that they should try to settle with David if given the opportunity. "You must understand that it is extremely unlikely (if not impossible) that even if you win, you would ever receive any money from Alki David," Bloom wrote. "Further, it would cost you money out of your own pocket to pay a debt collection attorney to try and collect from him—potentially hundreds of thousands of dollars."

But David wasn't serious about settling, Taylor said.

Bloom declined to discuss conversations with Taylor but said: "Most firms would have dropped a client after learning she almost lost a jury trial because the jury did not find her credible" and after learning that it would be "next to impossible" to recoup their costs on the case. "But we kept fighting for her."

That December, a Los Angeles jury awarded Taylor $8.4 million. Bloom filmed videos with Taylor shortly after. In one, Bloom said: "What I do for a living is bring money to victims, and I'm very proud of it...I take money from the bad guys, and I give it to good people like Elizabeth."

ZACK WITTMAN FOR WSJ

'No one knows that I'm not a multimillionaire and that I don't have a dollar to my name.'

Elizabeth Taylor, who won a sexual-harassment case

Images from a YouTube video showing Alki David confronting lawyer Gloria Allred in a parking lot.

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Inside Complex, Petty Prenups Of the Super Wealthy's Mergers

Lawyers lift the lid on the pre-wedding agreements as Jeff Bezos and Lauren Sánchez head to the altar. Amazon's founder didn't negotiate one before his previous marriage.

By Dalvin Brown

When Jeff Bezos and MacKenzie Scott divorced in 2019, they didn't have a prenuptial agreement to govern the division of their assets. She received a stake in Amazon valued at more than $35 billion.

Now, as the world's third richest man prepares to marry Lauren Sánchez in a multiday Venetian extravaganza, onlookers can't help but wonder whether there is a prenup and what it looks like.

It couldn't be learned whether they have one. A spokesman for Bezos declined to comment.

But divorce attorneys say Bezos, now worth over $200 billion, would be mad not to have one. The reason is simple: It is one of the most important tools the ultrawealthy use to protect their fortunes.

Attorneys say that prenups are only becoming more common for people of all wealth levels. For those with net worths that are nine figures or larger, these agreements become sophisticated legal instruments to protect assets, business empires and family dynasties.

Prenups can dictate who gets access to the private jet, how the thoroughbred horses are cared for and who gets to say what about the divorce on social media. The embedded confidentiality agreement can even prohibit disclosing the existence of the prenup itself, says Doug Julian, co-founder of HelloPrenup, a prenup website.

Ultrawealthy prenups must address assets that can't be easily split or sold, such as startup equity that can't be traded in the public markets; carried interest in private-equity funds; royalty streams from intellectual property and family trusts with complex distribution rules.

Without proper planning in a prenup, the illiquidity of these assets can lead to painful trade-offs. Selling company shares to fund a settlement can trigger massive capital-gains taxes. Dividing voting shares may shift control of a company. Transferring assets between spouses can create unexpected tax bills.

For the ultrawealthy, negotiating a prenup often focuses on preserving lifestyle and acknowledging the relationship's importance, while keeping business interests and major assets off the table in a divorce.

"You don't want them to have access to anything that would significantly change their wealth," says Robert Cohen, a New York attorney whose firm handles dozens of prenups annually for clients worth over $100 million.

Cohen, like other attorneys interviewed for this article, didn't work with Bezos or Sánchez.

Ultrawealthy individuals have multiple homes in different states and countries. That means they have legal exposure in multiple places. A divorce could be filed anywhere.

The stakes are high: A prenup that is enforceable in New York might be tossed in London. That is why top-tier prenups often include choice-of-law clauses, locking in which jurisdiction's rules apply regardless of where a divorce unfolds.

"We have the agreements vetted by lawyers in those jurisdictions to make sure there's not going to be a problem," says Cohen. "I recently worked on a case where we had to consult lawyers in eight different jurisdictions—all over the world."

Prenups can lay out who in a divorce supervises the packing of personal belongings, or can require a spouse to move out within 30 days.

Some clients demand their prenups stipulate that a spouse maintain a specific weight—say, within 20 pounds of what it was on their wedding day—or exercise four times a week during the marriage. Others want financial penalties for cheating: one attorney described a client seeking a $1 million payment for each affair.

Randall Kessler, an Atlanta-based divorce attorney, recounts one professional basketball player client who insisted his prenup acknowledge that "NBA players are known to have affairs" so cheating couldn't trigger costly penalties.

Judges may view behavioral clauses like weight requirements as overly invasive or punitive. They can also create endless disputes.

Courts also typically won't honor prenuptial terms that dictate child custody or support.

Still, these agreements often reflect an anxiety about losing control.

"Every prenuptial agreement is a power play," says Nancy Chemtob, a New York divorce attorney. "It's exciting for them to have this control."

The leverage often goes to whoever cares less about the marriage. "If you're willing to walk away, you hold all the cards," Kessler says.

Divorce lawyers say they detect inklings of deeper insecurities in this maneuvering. "Very wealthy people are typically accustomed to being in total control of every aspect of their life," says Jodi Furr Colton, a Florida attorney. "They often don't deal well with discomfort and uncertainty."

Most ultrawealthy clients aren't trying to leave their spouses with nothing. "I find that they're often willing to provide enough in the prenup so it won't be a big negotiation," says Cohen.

Prenups can include "sunset clauses" where the agreement expires after 10 or 20 years—a way to acknowledge that long marriages grow into genuine partnerships. These days, ultrawealthy clients increasingly prefer stepped agreements, where a spouse might receive $5 million if they divorce after five years of marriage and $20 million after 10, attorneys say.

One thing these agreements can reliably deliver is silence. While courts may toss sweeping confidentiality demands, narrowly written nondisparagement clauses typically hold up.

High-profile couples often use them to bar ex-spouses from sharing intimate details, financial records, or embarrassing stories with the media.

"Wealthy people are insecure, just like you and me," says Peter Walzer, a California family law attorney.

"They want to be loved. The wealth becomes an impediment because they're afraid of being taken advantage of," he said.

Jeff Bezos and Lauren Sánchez are set to wed this weekend in Venice. A spokesman for Bezos declined to comment on any prenup.

EMIL LENDOF/WSJ; MICHAEL TRAN/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES; STEFANO RELLANDINI/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGE

From Amazon Stock to Property To Jets, a Look at Mogul's Wealth

Jeff Bezos used to drive a 1997 Honda Accord and repurposed surplus wooden doors as desks. Now he is one of the wealthiest people in the world.

His vast sums have allowed Bezos to spend on passion projects such as Blue Origin rockets, and a Venice wedding to fiancée Lauren Sanchez that some estimate could cost $15 million to $20 million.

Total wealth

Bezos is among the richest billionaires, according to The Wall Street Journal, which in February estimated his net worth at $263.8 billion.

■ Bezos owns about 8.6% of Amazon, a percentage valued at roughly $190.56 billion as of early June, per FactSet.

■ In 2024, Bezos sold about $13.5 billion of Amazon shares.

■ The billionaire's private investment firm, called Bezos Expeditions, manages his personal wealth and investments. It has around $107.8 billion of assets, the Sovereign Wealth Fund Institute estimated. The firm's website said it has invested in companies such as Airbnb, Uber Technologies, Perplexity and the Washington Post, as well as space-transportation company Blue Origin.

Real estate

Bezos is the country's 23rd-largest landowner, with 420,000 acres across the U.S., according to the Land Report, a trade publication. He has also spent hundreds of millions of dollars on homes, including:

◀ **The Warner Estate** in Beverly Hills, Calif., at left, which he paid $165 million to buy in 2020.

■ A 14-acre compound in Maui that cost Bezos $78 million in 2021.

■ Three properties in Indian Creek—an exclusive island near Miami—that Bezos bought for a total of $234 million in 2023 and 2024

■ Three apartments at 212 Fifth Avenue in Manhattan, costing a collective $80 million in 2019.

Jets and a superyacht

Bezos has become a collector of fancy planes. He also owns a huge yacht that he primarily parks in Port Everglades, Fla.

■ The 417-foot-long superyacht, named Koru, cost at least $500 million, according to luxury lifestyle publication Robb Report.

Its support vessel, the Abeona, cost an additional $75 million and features a helipad, the publication said.

▲ Bezos owns two jets and two helicopters, according to Jack Sweeney, who tracks celebrity jets. Bezos' Gulfstream G650ER jet costs more than $50 million, while his **G700**, above, sells for around $75 million.

—Meg Tanaka and Sebastian Herrera

EAGLEVIEW; SEONGJOON CHO/BLOOMBERG NEWS

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K-Pop Fans Rejoice as BTS Completes Its Military Duty

All seven members of the popular boy band have completed their conscription in South Korea; After a three-year hiatus for the group, fans are ready for a reunion and new music

By Helena Getahun-Hawkins

For millions of fans of the K-pop band BTS, the date June 14, 2022 is seared into memory. It was the day the band announced that it would be going on hiatus to pursue solo projects. Soon after, members confirmed plans to do their mandatory service with the South Korean military.

Kaylei Brown, a 25-year-old veterinary technician from Atlanta, feared the hiatus might mark the end of the group. "Any ARMY would immediately know what a chaotic, terrible experience that was," said Brown, using the acronym for BTS fans that stands for Adorable Representative M.C. for Youth.

HYBE, the band's label, said in fall 2022 that the band would reconvene "around 2025 following their service commitment." Now, the worst of it appears to be over: All seven members have now completed their military service. Fans hope that means a reunion could be on the horizon.

"I'm going to be on cloud nine this weekend," said Brown, who is traveled to New York to celebrate the discharge of her favorite band member, Suga, and the band's anniversary with her friends.

Since its debut in 2013, the Korean-pop boy band, whose initials stand for Bangtan Sonyeondan–Bulletproof Boy Scouts in Korean–has captured the hearts of millions of fans around the world with songs like "Dynamite" and "Boy With Luv." The seven-person group has performed at the Grammy Awards, topped the Billboard Hot 100 and received an invitation to visit the White House.

In South Korea, all able-bodied men are required to complete military service for a minimum of 18 months, starting at 18 years old. The government has allowed some prestigious athletes and musicians to sit out military service in the past. In 2020, the government amended the conscription law, allowing accomplished artists to postpone their military service.

The band's eldest member, Kim Seok-jin, known as Jin to fans, delayed his service by less than two years, beginning his service in December 2022. The rest of his bandmates eventually followed. Since 2024, members have been trickling out of the military, five of them discharged in June.

As fans celebrate the end of their military service, new solo music releases and the band's anniversary, June has been a busy month for ARMY.

Above, RM (left) and V celebrate after completing their service. At left, fans waiting for the BTS members after their discharge.

As of Tuesday, there has been no official statement from HYBE, the band's label, on when exactly BTS will release music together again. The company has not responded for comment.

J-Hope, a rapper with the group, released a new single, "Killin' It Girl," with American rapper GloRilla on June 13.

The same day, Sherrie Chavez, the operator of Hana Cafe, part of the K-pop event space Hana House in Brooklyn, N.Y., hosted a celebration for the band's anniversary. There were many tears, she said, as, earlier in the day, fans had watched all seven members reunite at a J-Hope concert in Seoul.

On June 20, in honor of Suga's discharge, Chavez hosted another celebration at the event space. It featured New York's only "photoism" booth, a Korean photo booth which contains templates so fans can take realistic photos of themselves and their favorite K-pop idols.

"They are a bright light for people," Chavez said of the band members. Fans, she says, feel a "big weight" off their shoulders now that all the band members are able to reunite.

Jackie Alvarez is the chief financial officer of the nonprofit US BTS ARMY, which acts as a news source for many fans. She spends an average of 10 to 15 hours a week updating fans on their merchandise drops, encouraging them to stream music releases and hosting weekly streaming parties. She says she's even warned colleagues, "be prepared for me to be speaking nonstop BTS for the next month or so."

CHUNG SUNG-JUN/GETTY IMAGES; HEON-KYUN/EPA-EFE/SHUTTERSTOCK/SHUTTERSTOCK

On This Island, Horses Rule—for Better and for Worse

Continued from Page One

plants," said José Silva, the gardener.

Three days of work and $450 were lost—thanks, as always it seems, to the equines that give this 21-milelong strip in the Caribbean its nickname, Isla de Caballos: Horse Island.

"You sacrifice so things look right and then these animals, which have no owner, come in and tear things up," González said.

Vieques, a short ferry ride from the eastern coast of Puerto Rico, is overrun by the horses—both a symbol of its heritage and a major headache. Nearly 3,000 roam freely, outnumbering most other things in this community of barely 8,000 people.

First brought to the island by Spanish conquistadors, the horses now run along the island's narrow country lanes, rummage through garbage and amble into gardens. They park themselves in front of stores, use their hooves to bust pipes for a drink of water and introduce themselves to startled tourists on white-sand beaches.

Visitors often leave delighted.

"I'm a nature girl. I love animals," said Jasmine Ruiz, an actress from New York who vacationed in Vieques in December. "And when I got there, it was so cool to see them. They're on the side of the road. They're grazing. There's so many of them."

Mayor José Corcino isn't so enamored.

A former police officer attuned to danger, Corcino says the horses sometimes get hit by cars. They leave droppings wherever they go. And he worries the ticks they carry could cause disease.

"Little by little they procreated until today it is a big and serious problem that we have with the horses," Corcino said.

For decades, the horses mostly roamed the two-thirds of the island that the U.S. Navy used for bombing exercises and weapons testing.

Residents celebrated when the Navy pulled out in 2003 after years of protests. But the military's presence, it turned out, had helped keep the horses largely contained. Once its fences came down, the horses were suddenly everywhere.

Many of the horses actually have owners, according to officials. But without the money to feed them or put them in a stable, they let them run loose.

"Our generation, you had the horses at your house," said Erica Boulogne, 46, who grew up with eight horses. "Now, people let them go. They let them run free so they can have access to food and water."

Owners are required to take care of the animals under threat of fines, though sanctions are rare. Another rarity: someone taking responsibility when a horse feasts on freshly pruned flowers or collides with a car.

'They're on the side of the road. They're grazing. There's so many of them.'

"Many people have accidents and don't report it to the police because they know no one will pay," said Luis González.

The musician was driving home one night in 2022 after performing at a dance when "suddenly, a bunch of horses came out of nowhere," the 50-year-old recounted. "I thought I'd hit a wall."

The horse he had hit died. His van, worth $6,000, was a total loss.

Officials say no humans have been seriously injured in the collisions, but vehicles do get damaged and, in a few cases, injured horses have had to be put to sleep.

That's not to say the horses aren't beloved by the residents of Vieques. Spotting a horse running through the surf is an experience few ever forget. Some children ride the horses to school. There are even riding schools and a racing circuit.

"What's wrong with the horses of Vieques?" asked Johnny Colon. "To me, there is no problem."

The 41-year-old and his wife offer horseback tours for tourists and have a riding school for children. "The horses are part of our culture, they represent happiness," he said. "I don't see anything bad about it, though some people get upset because they mess up the garbage."

Islanders, with help from the Humane Society and other organizations, have done what they could to bring the problem under control.

A few years ago, that included firing contraceptive darts from compressed-air rifles. Educational campaigns have sought to ensure residents keep their horses fed and penned up. The latest plans come from Puerto Rican Sen. Carmelo Ríos, who is trying to drum up public funding to create a sanctuary on Vieques to care for the horses.

"They are abandoned," he said. "They do have needs. They do get sick."

Ruiz, the actress who visited in December, said she doesn't see what the big fuss is about. She suggests residents drive more slowly to avoid collisions, and says homeowners should stop worrying about their lawns.

"I thought they were so cute," she said about the horses. "I really, really loved it, and it made my stay so much better. And there were a lot of chickens, too, chickens everywhere."

At Caracas Beach, a horse waits for a possible snack as a tourist guards her family's belongings.

ERIKA P. RODRIGUEZ FOR WSJ

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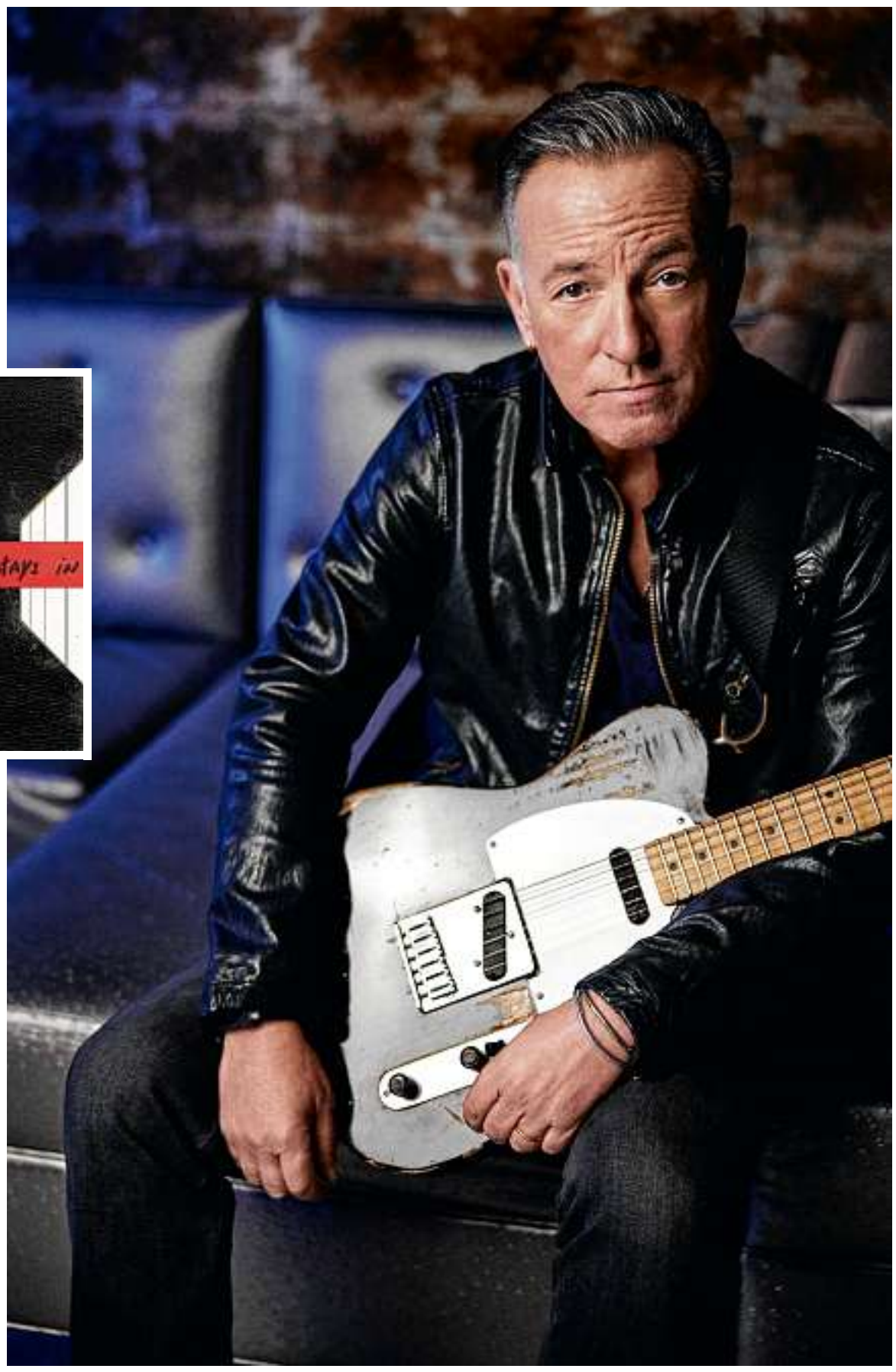
ARTS IN REVIEW

MUSIC REVIEW | MARK RICHARDSON

How the Boss Stayed Busy

Full of surprising experiments in genres and styles, a boxed set of previously unreleased material from the 1980s, '90s and beyond offers a new perspective on Bruce Springsteen's art and career

For years, the line on Bruce Springsteen in the 1990s was that he was either creatively adrift or set music aside while raising his children. Either way, he'd lost relevance. The pair of albums he released in 1992, "Human Touch" and "Lucky Town," had a handful of excellent songs between them, but they mostly comprised down-the-middle singer-songwriter rock fare. "The Ghost of Tom Joad" from 1995, an acoustic record in the vein of 1982's "Nebraska," was a curveball, and some fans consider it a major work. But the timing was off, and it didn't quite fit in a decade defined by a new generation's alternative music. It wasn't until Mr. Springsteen returned with 2002's "The Rising," an E Street Band LP shaped by the attacks of 9/11, that he fully reclaimed his place in popular music, and he hasn't lost his grip on it since.



Mr. Springsteen, right; his new seven-disc set, 'Tracks II: The Lost Albums,' comes out Friday.

DANNY CLINCH

With the arrival of the large and expensive boxed set "Tracks II: The Lost Albums" (Columbia), out Friday, we have a better sense of how Mr. Springsteen spent what was perceived to be downtime: He made strong albums and didn't release them. Three of the seven LPs included in this set were conceived and at least partly recorded in the '90s and a fourth is rooted in his experiments during the decade. Along with this bounty, there's a collection of material cut between "Nebraska" and 1984's blockbuster, "Born in the U.S.A.," plus two sets of more recent vintage. Taken as a whole, "Lost Albums" offers an intriguing glimpse of an alternate career for Mr. Springsteen, one a little more freewheeling, where he zigzags between genres and styles.

As a songwriting showcase, "L.A. Garage Sessions '83" is a snapshot of Mr. Springsteen at the peak of his powers. One could imagine almost every song on it serving as a cherished deep cut on "Born in the U.S.A." The disc includes an intriguingly spare demo version of "My Hometown" from that record, and a different version of the haunting "Shut Out the Light," the B-side for that album's title-track single. But while the material is terrific, the sound is frustratingly lo-fi—Mr. Springsteen's voice is coated in reverb and slapback echo, and the instrumentation sounds distant and thin. Still, "L.A. Garage Sessions '83" would on its own be a major release.

Almost as strong, and much better sounding, is "Streets of Philadelphia Sessions," which gathers songs written around the time of Mr. Springsteen's 1994 hit of that title. Moody synths and drum loops predominate, and the feeling of music made by a lone, isolated figure lends thematic weight. On tracks like "Blind Spot" and "We Fell Down," the mix of atmosphere and steady rhythmic pulse, along with the shadowy exploration of troubled relationships, suggests the expansive electro-folk Sarah McLachlan was making during this period.

Two very different albums, "Somewhere North of Nashville" and "Inyo," connect directly to "The Ghost of Tom Joad." The former was cut simultaneously with "Joad" and was at one point considered for release alongside it as part of a longer album. But where "Joad" was ultra-spare and downcast, the other product of the sessions is often raucous and celebratory. Pedal steel guitarist Marty Rifkin is the star of the show—his warm and gliding lines are high in the mix, and animate roadhouse-rock numbers like "Tiger Rose" and "Delivery Man."

Several tracks on "Inyo" can be traced to the same period, and others were written around the time of Mr. Springsteen's 2005 acoustic set "Devils & Dust." These are narratives that explore the desperate lives of impoverished Mexican and American characters in the American Southwest. Rapidly strummed nylon-string guitars and an occasional horn section connect the songs to the region's folk styles, and while the notion of Mr. Springsteen singing mariachi music looks highly questionable on paper, he pulls it off, his commitment to the material transcending kitsch.

The "Faithless" album, originally written as a soundtrack to a movie that was never made, also finds Mr. Springsteen exploring unfamiliar terrain. The story was apparently a spiritually minded western, and in notes included in the box Mr. Springsteen mentions being inspired by Ry Cooder's work on such films as 1982's "The Border." Several evocative instrumentals will put images of desert vistas and rolling tumbleweeds in your mind, and many of the songs Mr. Springsteen sings, such as "Where You Going, Where You From," are steeped in religious imagery and backed by a choir that sounds as if it's on loan from a roadside chapel.

All the records discussed so far are surprisingly rich in melody. Mr. Springsteen's lyrical acumen has remained sharp throughout his career, but he's been less consistent with memorable tunes. "Twilight Hours," recorded at the same time as Mr. Springsteen's 2019 album "Western Stars," highlights some of his shortcomings in this regard. It's an ambitious concept, with Mr. Springsteen paying tribute to the grandly orchestrated pop of the late 1960s and early '70s—think early Scott Walker or Burt Bacharach. But while the arrangements are lovely and Mr. Springsteen admirably and convincingly sings at the extremes of his range, these tunes wouldn't have cut it on AM radio when heard next to the Carpenters, and together they lack the thematic unity of "Western Stars."

Much of this material comes from what has often been thought of as a fallow period for the rock star.

The final disc in the set, "Perfect World," collects mostly rock numbers from across the past few decades, including several co-written with and previously recorded by Pittsburgh singer-songwriter Joe Grushecky. It's better than Mr. Springsteen's 2014 LP "High Hopes," which was itself a hodgepodge, but it feels a little tacked on next to the genre experimentation elsewhere in the set.

When "Lost Albums" was first announced, it was hard to get excited by so much unreleased music drawn from Mr. Springsteen's quietest decade. If what came out was just OK, how much could we hope for from what he kept in the vault? Given those modest expectations, the result is a triumph.

Mr. Richardson is the Journal's rock and pop music critic. Follow him on X @MarkRichardson.

TELEVISION REVIEW | JOHN ANDERSON

'My Mom Jayne': A Daughter's Tribute

IT MIGHT BE ARGUED that Hollywood sex symbol Jayne Mansfield is more famous now for being the mother of Mariska Hargitay than for her own status as a prototypical '50s bombshell and star of such films as "The Girl Can't Help It." Ms. Hargitay's tenure as Olivia Benson on "Law and Order: SVU," after all, has lasted twice as long as her mother's entire film career.

But Mansfield, who died in a violent car crash in 1967, does occupy a singular if amorphous place in the pop-culture pantheon, and Ms. Hargitay's mission as director and producer of "My Mom Jayne" is multifold: rehabilitate her mother's reputation as one of the "dumb blondes" who rode the wake of Marilyn Monroe (Diana Dors and Mamie Van Doren were others); examine Mansfield as an example of manufactured Hollywood product; and come to grips with her own trauma concerning parentage and inheritance. It is a very personal documentary, a designation that can connote the good, the not-so bad and the distinctly uncomfortable. "My Mom Jayne" has it all, including a puzzle that Ms. Hargitay pursues throughout.

Revealing the payoff, such as it is, to "My Mom Jayne" would be a spoiler, though it seems to be common knowledge to members of the Mansfield fan base-cum-cult. But even without the family tie, Ms. Hargitay would have a terrific subject on her hands. In the archival interviews used throughout (the editing by J.D. Marlow is first-rate), Mansfield is as open as she can be about having used her "pin-up" assets, as she calls them, to advance her career. She had aspirations to be a serious actress, although it was probably her physical attributes that helped relegate her to the daffy blonde roles for which she was overqualified. She had excelled academically as a young woman, studying languages as well as piano and violin, and we get to see her perform on both during Ms. Hargitay's film. Do you play well, TV host Jack Paar asks, as Mansfield prepares to perform a short violin piece. "I play," she responds, a moment that is self-deprecating, deadpan and charming.

Mariska Hargitay with her mother, Hollywood star Jayne Mansfield, who died in a car crash in 1967.

HBO

Ms. Hargitay was a 3-year-old child when her 34-year-old mother died—a child no one realized at first was tucked in the wreckage of the car, under the passenger seat. (The more gruesome details of the crash, some of which are strictly rumors, are left unaddressed here.) Mansfield was 3 when her own father suffered a fatal heart attack at the wheel, and she, too, was in the car. No one pretends this is some cosmic link between mother and daughter, but Ms. Hargitay looks for connections, because she has no real memories of her mom. Her older half-sister, Jayne Marie, the child of Mansfield's marriage to publicist Paul Mansfield in 1950, provides far more in terms of real-time recollections of Jayne, as do Ms. Hargitay's older brothers, Miklós and Zoltán, whose father was Hungarian athlete and bodybuilder Mickey Hargitay, easily the most sympathetic character in the entire film.

At about two hours, "My Mom Jayne" feels a bit bloated, with the emotional beats played too long and too often and being a bit obvious besides. Ms. Hargitay also treats her mother's story like a mystery when it was really anything but—Mansfield knew what she had, used it to her best advantage, was nobody's fool, liked men enough to marry three times if not always wisely, and was willing to play her personal life out in tabloid headlines if it served her aims as an actress. That she left her daughter with a messy legacy is unquestionable, as is the fact that she never freed herself from the stereotypes connected to being blond, built and beautiful. But it could also be argued that she never really got the chance.

My Mom Jayne
Friday, 8 p.m., HBO

Mr. Anderson is the Journal's TV critic.

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SPORTS

The Rookie Sensation Who Throws 103 MPH—and Has Been Almost Unhittable

Ever since Jacob Misiorowski made his major-league debut for the Milwaukee Brewers this month, he's been making MLB batters look silly

By Jared Diamond

Travis Lallemand, the baseball coach at Crowder College for the past two decades, remembers the exact moment he realized Jacob Misiorowski was unlike anyone he had ever seen in the junior college ranks.

It was a little after 10 a.m. in Grand Junction, Colo., on May 29, 2022, and Misiorowski was pitching at the JUCO World Series. His first fastball of the morning crackled toward the plate at a blistering 101 mph.

Before long, word began to spread through town that there was a kid on the mound at Suplizio Field blowing hitters away with triple-digit heaters—and he had to be seen to be believed.

"We started with 4,000 that day," Lallemand says. "I bet there were 9 to 10,000 in the ballpark by the time our game ended."

It turns out the people in the stands that day were among the first to discover what the rest of the baseball world is just starting to learn—never in the history of the sport has there been a pitcher with abilities quite like Misiorowski.

In his major-league debut for the Milwaukee Brewers earlier this month, the 23-year-old Misiorowski worked five innings without allowing a hit. He followed up that performance last Friday by carrying a perfect game into the seventh. In the process, he became the only starter since at least 1900 to begin his career with 11 hitless innings. Through two starts, he has more wins (two) than hits allowed (one).

He has done it by unleashing some of the most dominant stuff ever recorded on a baseball field. Misiorowski's fastball has averaged 99.7 mph, the hardest among all starters. He's had two pitches clocked at above 102. His slider has averaged 94.6 mph, a full 4 mph harder than anyone else.

If there is any comparison to what Misiorowski is doing, it might be last year's rookie pitching sensation Paul Skenes—who happens to be Misiorowski's opponent Wednesday. The hotly anticipated matchup between these young flamethrowers will offer a glimpse at the kind pitching prowess that not long ago would've been unfathomable.

Brewers rookie Jacob Misiorowski has pitched 11 innings in the majors, recording 11 strikeouts and just one hit.

ESSE JOHNSON-IMAGN IMAGES

"I'm not comparing them," Brewers manager Pat Murphy says. "I'm just saying he has those types of qualities that make you think of a guy like Skenes."

Misiorowski grew up in a Kansas City suburb and had initially hoped to sign a pro contract directly out of high school. But when the Covid-19 pandemic canceled his senior season in 2020, he changed course to attend junior college, preserving his eligibility to be drafted the next year.

That didn't work out, either. He suffered a knee injury that cost him virtually all of his freshman season and forced him to return to Crowder, a community college 30 minutes southeast of Joplin, Mo., in a city called Neosho.

It was the best thing that happened to him.

After two seasons away, he overpowered the JUCO circuit as a sophomore, striking out 16 batters per nine innings. In one start against Jefferson College, he whiffed 18. His fastball, which was around 95 mph in high school, had now reached triple digits.

Misiorowski planned to transfer to LSU, where he would've joined forces with Skenes, who pitched for the Tigers in 2023. Instead, the Brewers made sure he never enrolled. They took him in the second round of the 2022 draft and "came with an offer where I was like, 'I can't say no to this,'" Misiorowski said.

The Brewers paid him a bonus of $2.35 million—more than double the recommended amount for the 63rd overall selection.

They felt like they had to, Brewers general manager Matt Arnold said, because if Misiorowski had gone to LSU and continued his trajectory, "This guy had the ingredients to go in the top five of the draft."

Suffice to say the Brewers haven't regretted their investment. After struggling with his command at times in the minors, the 6-foot-7 Misiorowski has started to put everything together, combining his otherworldly power with finesse.

He had a 2.13 ERA in Triple-A this season, where his fastball was clocked at 103 mph, and he's been even better since arriving in Milwaukee. All told: 11 innings, one hit, 11 strikeouts.

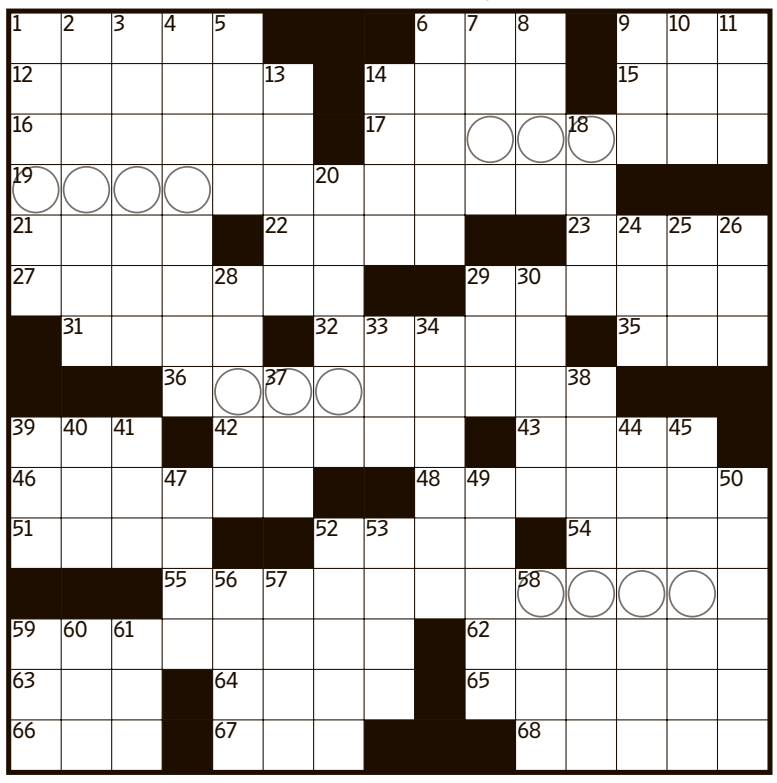
"He puts you on the edge of your seat every pitch in a way where you want to see what's next," Arnold says.

What's next is a date with Skenes in a showcase of two of the most powerful right arms ever to grace a MLB mound.

In an alternate reality, Skenes and Misiorowski could've been teammates at LSU. On Wednesday, they will share a major-league field.

"Facing a pitching staff with Skenes and Misiorowski on back-to-back days," Lallemand says, "I think you'd rather face a firing squad at that point."

The WSJ Daily Crossword | Edited by Mike Shenk



BOOMERANG EFFECT | By Zhouqin Burnikel

Across

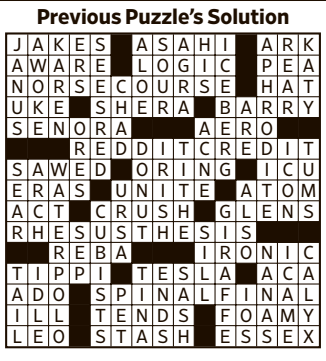
1 Preachy pamphlet
6 Cardinal cap letters
9 "What ___ friends for?"
12 Bat mitzvah language
14 Cyclotron particle
15 Preferred pronoun option
16 Dress
17 Blood vessel to the heart
19 Mocking words of sympathy
21 Cyclotron particles
22 Oscar night dress
23 Bring in
27 Unexpected hit
29 Take out
31 Miss, in Mex.
32 Scoring result?
35 Relay segment
36 Alluring trait
39 Brick oven residue
42 Big name in life insurance
43 Freeway entrance
46 They have big shoes to fill
48 Brews from the leaves of rooibos shrubs
51 Roman wrap
52 Slightest trace
54 Otherwise
55 Brown v. Board of Education, for one
59 Have exactly the wrong effect, and what 17-, 19-, 36- and 55-Across all have
62 Come a little closer
63 "Me, me, me" trait
64 Comparable
65 Page of "The Umbrella Academy"
66 Original content creator?
67 Hi-___ images
68 Texas home of Frito-Lay

Down

1 "In other words..."
2 Updates, as a factory
3 It can help in getting a six-pack
4 Baby bedding buys
5 1,000 times giga-
6 Hardly lenient
7 Award for "A Strange Loop"
8 "u r hilarious!"
9 "Just as I suspected!"
10 Al Sharpton nickname
11 Unit in history class
13 Club in a sand trap
14 Declare openly
18 Dumbbell exercise
20 Page layout
24 Caterpillar roll ingredient
25 Enjoyed a caterpillar roll, e.g.
26 Knob for string tension
28 Hymn of praise
29 Run out of juice
30 Virtual greeting
33 Original "Veronica Mars" airer
34 Peloponnesian War winner
37 Crosses (out)
38 Ref's whistle after the play
39 Talent show segment
40 ___-mo
41 Gluttonous sort
44 Michelle's successor
45 Heat of the moment?
47 Go on strike
49 "Guitar Town" singer Steve
50 Handled
52 "Luther" star Elba
53 Comet's appearance, perhaps
56 Way out there
57 Parent company of Converse
58 Makeup of underwater forests
59 Seek a treat, maybe
60 In the past
61 Chip shop fish

▶ Solve this puzzle online and discuss it at **WSJ.com/Puzzles.**

Previous Puzzle's Solution



America's Ryder Cup Captain Faces a Selection Conundrum: Himself

By Andrew Beaton

KEEGAN BRADLEY had just driven home from the Travelers Championship last summer and put his children to bed when he plopped down in his chair and began looking forward to a few weeks off.

That's when his phone started buzzing with a call that left him completely stunned: Bradley had been tapped as the U.S. Ryder Cup captain, making him the youngest American to assume the role in over half a century.

Ever since, Bradley has spent the last year obsessing over how to assemble a team of Americans to wrest the cup back from Europe at Bethpage Black in September. Along the way, he has been serenaded as "Captain America" by fans wherever he goes.

But at the Travelers Championship this past weekend, he had to start confronting an uncomfortable reality: One of the players he should pick is named Keegan Bradley.

When Bradley, 39 years old, won the Travelers with a birdie on the final hole on Sunday, it warped the calculus for an American roster that is riddled with question marks. Bradley had previously said he wouldn't pick himself, but even he acknowledged afterward that it's something he now has to consider.

"I never would have thought about playing if I hadn't won," he said. "This definitely opens the door."

Bradley, the winner of the 2011 PGA Championship, was a surprising choice as captain from the outset. After playing on the team in 2012 and 2014, he nearly made it again in 2023, only for Zach Johnson to leave him off the roster in favor of players who had accrued fewer points.

But what made Bradley's selection so odd wasn't how long he had been absent from the team. It was his age.

Ryder Cup captains are typically so far past their primes that they never factor into team selection as players. Bradley's appointment made him the youngest American in the job since 1963, when a 34-year-old Arnold Palmer captained the U.S. team.

Now Bradley has to decide if he wants to follow in Palmer's footsteps in another way—that year, he was also the last player captain.

What makes the situation particularly thorny is the process for picking the roster. Six players qualify automatically based on points they rack up throughout the year. Which means the likes of Scottie Scheffler have already secured a spot on the team.

But the final six slots are left up to the captain's discretion—and that's exactly where Bradley finds himself now.

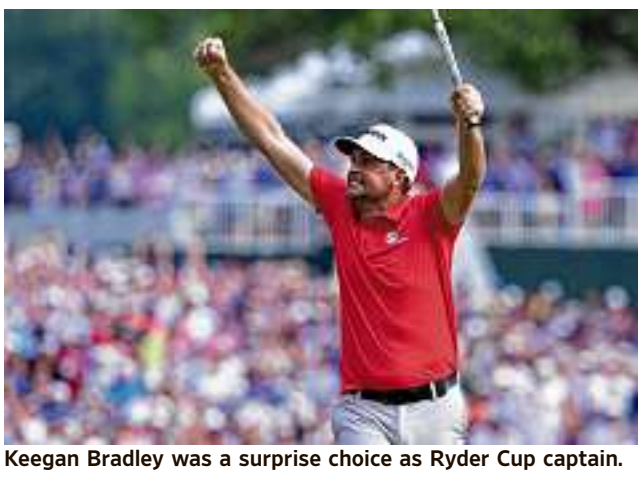
With his win at the Travelers, a Connecticut tournament where the New England-native is always a local favorite, Bradley vaulted into ninth place in the points standings. That means while it's possible he could push his way into the top six—and force his way onto the roster—it's more likely he would have to call his own name.

"I don't know if I'm going to do it or not," he said, "but I certainly have to take a pretty hard look at what's best for the team."

At this point, Bradley not picking himself would almost count as dereliction of his duties. By just about any metric, he should be a no-brainer to make the roster. The Official World Golf Ranking pegs him as the game's No. 7 player, while the analytics website Data Golf places him at No. 9, the fifth highest position of any American.

He's also finding his form at just the right moment. Sunday's win means Bradley has placed in the top-10 in three of his last four events. This the highest he's ever stood in the world rankings.

That makes Bradley nothing like the elder statesmen who typically occupy the captain's chair. Luke Donald, his counterpart, is 47 years old and long removed from his heyday. Johnson, Bradley's predecessor, was ranked lower than 200th when he took charge.



Keegan Bradley was a surprise choice as Ryder Cup captain.

BILL STREICHER/REUTERS

That's an epiphany Bradley had at the PGA Championship last month, when fans kept chanting "U-S-A, U-S-A" whenever he was nearby.

"I don't think any player in the history of the game has experienced what I'm experiencing," he said. "I'm a Ryder Cup captain, [and] in my eyes still one of the best players in the world trying to win majors and tournaments."

Bradley says he has tried to feed off the crowd's energy, including on the final hole on Sunday when he was feted like a superhero. He also knows there's one place that is certain to be even louder a few months from now:

Bethpage Black for the Ryder Cup.

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OPINION

New Life for Nonproliferation

BUSINESS WORLD
By Holman W. Jenkins, Jr.

No good deed usually goes unpunished. President Trump's Iran strike may prove the exception to the rule, and North Korea points to why.

A Trump walk-off home run already seemed a faint possibility last week given the distress the Israelis inflicted on the Iranian regime. Now it seems barely far-fetched after Iran's conspicuously token attack Monday on a U.S. base in Qatar, followed hours later by a Trump cease-fire that actually seems to be holding.

If so, Donald Trump the Peacemaker may have ended not only the war but Iran's nuclear threat. Garlands would descend upon his shoulders from the fair-minded. That'll be nice for him. The bigger payoff would come when he's long retired, and only if future U.S. leaders and allies are as determined as Mr. Trump seems to be in cutting off the rise of nuclear rogue states.

A tweet ought to have you questioning the intelligence of the American elite. It was provided by Obama veteran Ben Rhodes: "Trump's message to the world: if you have nukes like North Korea I'll trade love letters with you, if you don't I'll pull out of agreements you're keeping and bomb you during diplomacy."

Good heavens. North Korea had the bomb and the means to deliver it thanks to the ineffective diplomacy of the Clinton and George W. Bush administrations. That's exactly what we're trying to avoid with Iran. And Mr. Trump is following the same path now he followed then, offering friendship but zero compromise on giving up their nukes.

In a more perfect world, Pyongyang would be the next stop for our B-2s. In a less perfect world, Mr. Trump at least makes a start on correcting the poor incentives in the West's Russia dealings. Vladimir Putin has been allowed to understand he can end the Ukraine war whenever he wants. The West will let him keep what he has. He won't be punished, he will be rewarded with sanctions relief.

The West will do nothing to destabilize his regime because of his nukes.

This is an inducement to keep fighting to see what else he might gain.

A week ago I would have bet on a can-kicking Iran settlement from Mr. Trump. A can-kicking certainly would have come from his 2024 opponents. Joe Biden's puppeteers would have had no choice because Mr. Biden couldn't serve as the face of an overtly risk-taking strategy. Kamala Harris's leadership attributes? Not evident in the presidential campaign.

With his Iran actions, Mr. Trump makes clear he dominates his coalition rather than being dominated by it. He enjoys an idiosyncratic legitimacy, having repeatedly been raised up by the voting public in defiance of universal establishment resistance.

That resistance continues. If puppies and unicorns spring forth now from a democratizing Iran, the permanent state would be no less bent on discrediting a Trump presidency.

Which brings us to an irony. "If you follow regularly what is said by those who are in charge of the federal government right now, there is a weak commitment to . . . our understanding of how a liberal democracy is supposed to work," intoned President Obama to an audience of Long Island swells last week.

In a better world, the B-2's next stop would be Pyongyang.

The problem is real. Mr. Obama's concern is fake, a partisan weapon. In fact, no politician has been more victimized by the lying of the U.S. government than Mr. Trump even as he remains wildly careless himself in many of his claims.

His re-elevation to the presidency, moreover, was the direct, head-smacking consequence of the means by which the establishment, *starting with the Obama administration*, tried to suppress him, culminating in the Biden fiasco of 2024.

Mr. Obama has shrunk in his postpresidency. He will shrink further when history reckons with this part of his record.

Mr. Trump was already rated our worst president by historians almost before he took his first oath of office. On present trend, though, he won't leave 535,000 Americans marooned in a futile war as LBJ did. He won't lose 36,500 because he failed to make U.S. enemies aware of our red lines as Truman did.

His term will be a mixed bag like any president's but he's already done more than the last three to adapt the U.S. to the changing strategic reality of the world.

The Constitution will survive despite Democrats constantly insisting otherwise to justify their own behavior. Indeed, a streak of recklessness has characterized Mr. Trump's critics, who had so much to criticize legitimately but preferred self-exploding lies and exaggerations. If you want to feel sorry for an astronaut and military veteran, listen to Democratic Sen. Mark Kelly's interview with NPR on Monday desperately trying to benefit from any reverse the U.S. might yet experience in its Iran showdown.

Mr. Trump seemingly hinted at a bomb targeted at Iran's supreme leader to give encouragement to talks. U.S. vulnerabilities aren't just troops at bases in the region. Ten former FBI officials issued a warning letter about unusual numbers of young single men entering the country during the Biden open border.

After the Strike, Iran Remains Unpredictable

POLITICS & IDEAS
By William A. Galston

Critics have rushed to judge President Trump's decision to strike Iran's main nuclear facilities, while supporters have been as quick to praise it, but an honest assessment of the situation raises as many questions as it answers.

Assessing even the immediate effects of military actions is difficult—the notorious "fog of war" problem. In a speech Saturday, the president claimed the strike had "completely and totally obliterated" the nuclear facilities at Fordow, Isfahan, and Natanz. On Sunday, Pentagon officials said the sites had sustained "extremely severe damage," leaving open the possibility that parts remained intact. In an interview on NBC's "Meet the Press," Vice President JD Vance managed to have it both ways, saying "we destroyed the Iranian nuclear program," then retreating to the claim that the program had been set back "substantially."

A major uncertainty is the fate of the Fordow facility, much of which was built hundreds of feet under a mountain. We know that U.S. bombers dropped several 30,000-pound "bunker buster" bombs on this site, some of which hit at or close to a vulnerable point.

Did the bombs reach Fordow's underground caverns containing more than 1,000 centrifuges? Aerial inspection can't give us the full answer. According to the New York Times, an initial assessment by the Israeli military found that the facility had sustained "serious damage" but wasn't destroyed. We don't know for sure. Nor do we know whether the Iranians had already removed enriched uranium from the site and dispersed it, as credible reports suggest.

The attacks were intended to set back Iran's nuclear program and convince the country's leaders that their pursuit of nuclear weapons is futile. While it may have this effect, it could convince the regime that racing to build a bomb is its best hope of survival. The amount of enriched uranium that may have been transferred from Fordow to unknown facilities could be enough to build nuclear weapons if these facilities hold the equipment needed to transform it into weapons-grade material. We don't know.

Mr. Trump seems to be hoping for a repetition of his 2020 killing of Quds Force commander Qassem Soleimani, which didn't trigger a massive Iranian response. It's possible that Iran will lick its wounds and quietly accept the cease-fire with Israel Mr. Trump announced on Monday, vindicating his "one and done" strategy. It's also possible that the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps and other hard-liners are biding their time before mounting an aggressive response to the U.S. bombing.

Tehran has military and economic levers. The U.S. has major military facilities in the Middle East, which Iran could attack, as it did when it struck a U.S. base in Qatar Monday. Ayatollah Ali Khamenei could order the IRGC to interdict international shipping in the Red Sea, and Yemen's Houthis could support the regime by threatening missile strikes. Iran could also go after soft U.S. targets around the world.

Tehran might keep a peace deal, but it could just be buying time to retaliate.

Taking this road would likely prove self-destructive for Tehran, but it remains a possibility. If the Iranians spurn a potential peace deal and retaliate, the Trump administration would have to get more deeply involved for longer. This could trigger bad memories of "endless wars" in the region, risking a loss of public support.

On the one hand, a substantial majority of Americans believe Iran's nuclear program poses a serious threat to the U.S. On the other, in an Economist/YouGov poll days before the strike on Iran, only 16% of Americans supported military action while 60% opposed it, including 53% of Republicans.

If Mr. Trump was expecting the strike to trigger a rally around the flag, he must be disappointed. A survey conducted within 24 hours of the attack found that while 68% of Republicans swung behind the president's decision, Democrats and independents remained largely opposed. Only 35% of Americans thought he did the right thing.

The public's skepticism was likely tied in part to the sense that Iran has the capacity and the intention to retaliate against the U.S. Seventy-one percent said they expected Iran to attack U.S. bases in the Middle East, and 54% said they expected Iranian attacks on U.S. soil. This poll was conducted before Mr. Trump's announcement of a pending cease-fire between Iran and Israel, and Americans' sentiments may change if the cease-fire holds. Still, it's unclear whether a promise not to attack the U.S. is part of the deal, and meaningful retaliation on American interests would diminish its positive effect on public opinion.

Mr. Trump must hope that developments convince skeptics that he did the right thing. This could happen, but only if the Iranians have truly been deterred from responding in ways that suck the U.S. into a wider conflict. While events have played out favorably for the president since the bombing, he continues to bet his administration's standing on an unpredictable future.

The Key to the Young Male Vote: Beer

By Scott Johnston

Democrats are spending $20 million to understand the great mystery of young men—probably the simplest creatures on earth. Here's an idea for you, Democrats: lower the drinking age, at least for beer.

Congress established a federal drinking age of 21 in 1984 to combat drunk-driving fatalities, of which there were 21,000 in 1983. States were coerced with the threat of withheld highway funds. They caved in quickly. Louisiana was the last holdout.

Since then, the rate of drunk-driving deaths has dropped almost 50%. Mothers Against Drunk Driving, a powerful lobby, will tell you it's because of the age increase, but does anyone really think college-age kids have stopped drinking because it's illegal?

In reality, drivers of all ages have responded to much tougher enforcement and severely increased penalties. Back in the day, it was, "Get home safe, son." Now it's the slammer for a night and huge fines. Technology has also changed, creating safe alternatives. Uber wasn't an option in the 1980s.

Democrats should embrace a reduction in the drinking age. (Republicans too.)

It's time to lower the drinking age. Current law is not a deterrent, and it has had negative cultural effects, particularly on our nation's campuses. Start with the binge drinking of hard alcohol. Beer, the college beverage of choice since the first student was forced to read Sartre, has faded away. It's too bulky to sneak into your dorm room. Vodka is today's poison. It's clear and mixes with about anything.

Not surprisingly, this has made campus drinking a bigger problem than ever. When I was in college, I didn't hear of anyone going to the hospital because he drank too much beer—and people tried.

The higher age has also affected college culture, and not in a good way. In the halcyon early 1980s, we had big, campuswide events. It was very social and egalitarian.

In fact, my very first day, Yale's president, Bart Giamatti, welcomed all freshmen to his house with an open bar. Imagine! Now, students squirrel away, pregaming, consuming what they want in places they won't be caught by resident assistants and other mandated busybodies. This has made college social life cliquey and balkanized, self-selecting mostly along demographic lines. DEI administrators, take note.

In 2008, 130 college presidents signed a petition that declared "twenty-one is not working" and urged "an informed and dispassionate public debate." They saw the damage firsthand and have been forced to set up expensive compliance regimes. Complicating matters, most seniors and some juniors can legally partake, creating a schism between haves and have-nots.

A change is needed. Democrats, this is your opening. Republicans, it could be yours too. Lowering the age for beer would steer college kids toward safer forms of consumption.

The best part is that it's the right thing to do. Eighteen-year-olds can legally drive, sign contracts, get married, take a bullet in foreign wars—everything except have a beer. It's inconsistent and patronizing, and it's time to change it. As long as we treat alcohol like forbidden fruit, the thrill remains.

Mr. Johnston's novels include "Campusland" and "The Sandersons Fail Manhattan."

BOOKSHELF | By Melanie Kirkpatrick

An Agent Of Society

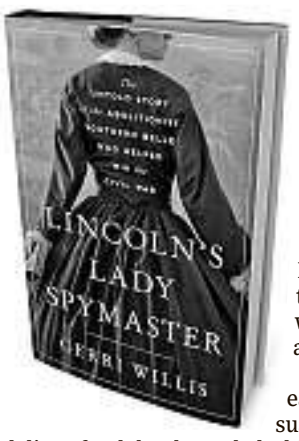
Lincoln's Lady Spymaster

By Gerri Willis
Harper, 288 pages, $28.99

Elizabeth Van Lew was rich, beautiful, charming and plugged into 19th-century Virginia high society, whose aristocracy included President Jefferson Davis. Motivated by her abhorrence of slavery and opposition to the dissolution of the Union, Van Lew (1818-1900) used her elite social position to set up a spy ring that helped the North win the Civil War.

In "Lincoln's Lady Spymaster," Gerri Willis relates with verve and rich detail the extraordinary story of Van Lew's espionage career. With the help of liberal quotations from Van Lew's diary, the author brings to life her subject's generous yet pugnacious personality and her moral certainty about the dangerous life she chose. Ms. Willis, an anchor for Fox Business, is the author of two previous books on personal finance.

Van Lew's pro-Union attitudes grew out of her Northern roots. He father was an "ambitious New Yorker from Long Island" who established a successful hardware business in Richmond, Va. Her maternal grandfather served in the Continental Army during the Revolutionary War and was one of the first members of the Pennsylvania Abolition Society, which, in 1790, petitioned Congress to abolish slavery. Elizabeth's parents sent her to school in Philadelphia, where she was exposed to antislavery views.



Her career as a spy began early in the war when she persuaded prison officials to let her deliver food, books and clothing to captured Union soldiers. It wasn't long before she realized that some prisoners had information that could be valuable to the Union's war effort. She also overheard sensitive information from prison officials, who weren't always careful when speaking around a Southern lady.

She devised clever ways of smuggling information out of the prison. Messages were sewn into clothing or stashed in a shoe's hidden compartment. The bottom of a custard cup, intended for hot water, was repurposed into a tool of the spy trade. A book loaned to a prisoner could be returned with vital information penciled in between the lines.

For prisoners who broke out, the Van Lew mansion became a stop on the escape route; fugitives would hide in a secret room on the third floor until it was safe to go. When detectives searched her house for incriminating evidence of anti-Confederate operations, Van Lew played the gracious hostess, diverting their attention by inviting them for tea and applesauce cookies downstairs.

She used her intimate knowledge of Richmond's social scene to identify, organize and train Union sympathizers. A clerk in the adjutant general's office provided information about troop movements. Several of the city's German residents, who were generally opposed to slavery, joined her team. Local farmers gave escapees beds for the night. But the nucleus of Van Lew's ring was composed of slaves and freemen, Ms. Willis writes. A free black man who worked at a Confederate prison helped POWs break out. Others volunteered as couriers, delivering information behind Union lines.

Legend has it that Van Lew arranged to lend one of her own household slaves, Mary, to Confederate first lady Varina Davis. Mary was told "to scour the desk of Jefferson Davis, memorizing the details of his letters and maps" and at night transcribe them, Ms. Willis relates. Mary then would pass along her notes to a seamstress who was part of the Van Lew ring, or hand them off to a trustworthy baker on his early-morning delivery run. The signal that Mary had something to report was a piece of red clothing clipped to the clothesline of the executive mansion.

Elizabeth Van Lew of Richmond, Va., was a Southern belle with Northern sympathies. She secretly aided the Union war effort.

As the years ground on, Van Lew took more risks, providing some of the most critical intelligence of the war. Her reports "helped the Northern commanders determine the timing of the war's final critical assault," Ms. Willis describes, with "each of her missives painting a detailed picture of the Rebel capital and the strength and location of Confederate army forces." The author does a superb job of detailing the menacing environment in which Van Lew operated—at a time, Ms. Willis writes, when the country was "gripped by unreason and hate."

In setting the context for Van Lew's actions, Ms. Willis provides brief, serviceable accounts of well-known historical events, such as John Brown's failed attempt to incite a slave uprising at Harpers Ferry and John Wilkes Booth's conspiracy to assassinate Lincoln. New to me was the Dahlgren Affair. When Ulric Dahlgren, a young Union colonel, was killed in 1864 while leading a raid on Richmond, on his person were found orders to hang Davis and torch the city. Southerners were enraged by the orders (which may have been forged), while Northern sentiments were set aflame by the Confederates' mistreatment of Dahlgren's corpse. An irate Van Lew risked exposure by organizing a midnight plot to exhume Dahlgren's mutilated body, rebury it in a secret location and hold a funeral. (Today Dahlgren rests at Laurel Hill Cemetery in Philadelphia.)

Van Lew survived the war without discovery of her extensive spy operations. She had an early scare when the Richmond Examiner published an article noting that she and her mother were "giving comfort to the miscreants who have invaded our sacred soil." After that, she was careful to display outward loyalty to the Confederacy, even to the extent of giving a home to the new head of a prison complex and his family.

But her most effective shield was the idealized image of feminine incapacity held by the society of the day. No one would suspect a Southern belle of spying for the North.

Ms. Kirkpatrick is a former deputy editor of the Journal's editorial page and a senior fellow at the Hudson Institute.

Van Lew on Slavery

"Slave power crushes freedom of labor. Slave power is arrogant—is jealous and intrusive—is cruel—is despotic—not only over the slave, but over the community, the State."
—Elizabeth Van Lew

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OPINION

REVIEW & OUTLOOK

After the 'Cease-Fire,' Tests for Iran

Trump can demand that Tehran let in the IAEA and drop its forever war.

President Trump brought the Middle East's "12-Day War" to an end with a hammer blow to the Iranian nuclear program and then diplomatic pressure. The attack made the U.S. and the region safer, but did the diplomacy? The answer depends on how Mr. Trump plays it from here.

If the cease-fire is a prelude to Iranian concessions, then it will be an historic step toward a larger peace. Iran would dismantle what's left of the nuclear program and end its proxy warfare across the region in return for an end to sanctions.

But if the cease-fire is a way for Mr. Trump to call it a day by handcuffing Israel, it will give Iran time to rebuild and retool for the next round of war. That kind of cease-fire would be an historic mistake and squander the gains of the last fortnight.

Israel had established air supremacy over Iran and was striking the regime's instruments of domestic repression. Iran had no substantial reply to U.S. strikes on its most valuable assets. Yet it was allowed a cease-fire without any public commitments. This raises the question of Iranian intent after the shooting has stopped. If the regime still plans to build nuclear weapons and destroy Israel, then Mr. Trump's "Peace and Harmony" is a desert mirage.

Mr. Trump could offer two tests of the regime's willingness to change. First, will it grant the International Atomic Energy Agency's inspectors immediate access to examine its nuclear sites? If not, Iran has no intention of dismantling what remains, especially since it isn't clear how much enriched uranium Iran retains.

Second, will Iran publicly recognize Israel's right to exist and renounce its desire to wipe the Jewish state off the map? That's the Iranian regime's forever war. If its leaders won't renounce it, they aren't interested in peace, only in tapping along Mr. Trump until they can recover and fight again. That's something the President needs to know to prosecute the peace.

Vigilance will be required to secure the war's gains, and the signs Tuesday from Mr. Trump are cause for concern. Israel and Iran exchanged serious fire in the hours before the cease-fire, as is common, but Iran fired three missiles after the truce went into effect. In response Mr. Trump unloaded his anger on . . . Israel, for planning to retaliate.

"I understand that Israel is angry about one missile that didn't hit anyone. They need to calm down now," he said Tuesday. That's the essence of what Israelis call the Oct. 6 mind-set—from before Oct. 7, 2023, which rightly changed how Israel thinks about its security. When Hezbollah tested the Jewish state after their November cease-fire by firing two mortars, Israel responded with 40 air strikes. Hezbollah has since stayed quiet.

By coming down hard on Israel, Mr. Trump solidified his cease-fire. But he also sent Iran the message that the U.S. will restrain Israel to preserve quiet. That won't convince Iran never to rebuild its nuclear facilities, as Mr. Trump promises. Iran needs to know that Israel has his backing to stop any renewed nuclear effort before it becomes deadly.

Mr. Trump also wrote on Truth Social that "China can now continue to purchase Oil for Iran." A senior White House official says this merely acknowledged that oil from the Strait of Hormuz won't be disrupted, and wasn't a signal of sanctions relief. Sanctions are crucial leverage to change Iranian behavior. On Tuesday Iran's nuclear chief said that his agency is assessing the damage to its nuclear industry and is making arrangements to restore it.

The President seemed to treat Israel and Iran as two equivalent threats to his diplomacy. "We basically have two countries that are fighting so long and so hard that they don't know what the f— they're doing," Mr. Trump said. Here's what they're doing: Iran fights because it is devoted to Israel's destruction. Israel fights because it is devoted to not being destroyed.

Israel took on the bulk of the risk and the fighting against Iran, which dramatically improved America's position in the region. The U.S. contributed by doing what only it can. Now the peace is up to Mr. Trump—is he offering Iran a reckoning or a reprieve?

Brandon Johnson's Hot Summer Nights

Chicago's mayor vetoes a measure intended to keep children safe.

Chicago's Brandon Johnson isn't America's worst mayor for nothing. He works hard at it. Consider his veto Friday of a teen curfew ordinance that would have let Chicago police disperse late-night gatherings or "teen takeovers" that get out of hand.

The policy, passed by the City Council 27-22, was intended to prevent the violence and public disorder that have plagued Chicago in recent years as tent cities sprawled and crime crested. But Mayor Johnson said that he won't support "a policy that we already know historically leads to criminalization and incarceration. Why on God's green earth would I actually repeat the sins of those who came before us?"

Well, teen curfews on the city's parks and streets lead to incarceration only when police must contend with unruly crowds that become dangerous and refuse to disperse. Mr. Johnson's view that a curfew leads to "criminalization" is a tacit acknowledgment that the teen takeover crowds are prone to lawbreaking.

Chicago's permissive crime environment has led to more incidents of wilding among teenagers, and with tragic consequences. In March a 15-year-old boy was shot in Chicago's Streeterville neighborhood during a teen takeover. In 2023 two people were shot and 15 arrested when a teen mob took over downtown.

Critics say the restriction on public gatherings might trigger First Amendment concerns, but the curfew isn't a bar on public gatherings, only allowing police to disperse those that become unruly. Most parents would prefer to see their children shuffled along home than get caught in a summer melee. Using curfews to disperse unruly crowds is a safer way for law enforcement to manage violent flare-ups on summer nights.

Mr. Johnson says crime rates in Chicago have been falling, as they have across the nation, but the improvement isn't an excuse for refusing to keep city streets calm at night. Chicago residents are watching to see if the city can regain some of the common sense it has lost during Mr. Johnson's tenure.

Closing the SALT Business Loophole

If the deduction cap rises, at least eliminate the state workarounds.

Senate Republicans appear to be acquiescing to demands by House Republicans from high-tax states to raise the $10,000 limit on the state-and-local tax deduction to $40,000. In return for this gift to spendthrift progressive states, they should at least close a giant loophole in the cap.

The $10,000 cap on the state-and-local tax deduction was one of the 2017 GOP tax reform's main achievements. But the dirty little secret is that many wealthy denizens of high-tax states aren't affected since three dozen states have created a loophole for owners of and partners in pass-through business entities.

Here's how it works: Small-business income typically flows to the owners and partners, who pay tax on it at the individual income rate. However, the Trump Treasury Department in 2020 let pass-throughs pay state taxes on their earnings at the entity level, which would be fully deductible on federal tax returns.

States, in turn, give pass-through owners or partners a tax credit commensurate to their stake in the business to offset their individual tax liability. Individuals are then supposedly held harmless—paying no more in state or federal tax than they did before the $10,000 cap took effect.

Consider a small business with two partners that have an equal equity stake. A state would assess tax on the pass-through's earnings, typically at the highest marginal tax rate. If the pass-through pays $100,000 in state tax, each partner would get a $50,000 credit to offset his state income-tax liability on his share of the business's earnings.

This example isn't illustrative of all cases since partners in pass-through entities often live in different states with disparate tax regimes. Massachusetts only gives owners a credit worth 90% of a pass-through's tax payments. In Wisconsin, pass-throughs pay a flat 7.9% tax rate, which is higher than the state's top marginal rate of 7.65%. Though individuals may pay more in state tax because of the workaround, they are still better off because they can fully deduct their SALT bills.

This loophole has created enormous distortions in the tax code and arbitrary winners. Partners in law and accounting firms, hedge funds, consulting shops and physician practices can fully deduct their state-and-local income taxes. Not so lawyers, accountants, consultants, investment bankers or doctors on employer payrolls.

The House tax bill attempts to crack down on such SALT workarounds by eliminating the benefit for most white-collar professions while maintaining it for restaurants, manufacturers and plumbers. But the Senate Finance draft caps the workaround benefit at $40,000 or half of a pass-through's state tax payments, whichever is greater.

Alas, both effectively bless the workarounds, which undermine the 2017 reform. Democrats in New York enacted their state workaround when they raised the state's top rate to 10.9% from 8.82%. Many of the highest earners saw their overall tax bills decline because of the workaround, blunting the political impact.

The workaround enables and encourages states to raise their top marginal rates. Some Republicans say prohibiting the workaround will result in a tax increase on small business. The solution, then, is to increase the 20% pass-through deduction (the House bill increases it to 23%) or lower the top marginal rate.

If Republicans from high tax states insist on raising the $10,000 cap, they should at least end the carve-outs. The worst outcome would be a higher cap with a huge loophole for the friends of Gavin Newsom and J.B. Pritzker.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The Islamic Republic Has Taken Iran Hostage

Bartle Bull's piece "Iran's Mediocre Supreme Leader" (Houses of Worship, June 20) captures the slick phoniness of Ali Khamenei. He is an avatar of the entire Islamic Republic, which is a farce from top to bottom.

The regime presents itself as the guardian of Iran while plundering its oil for an insular few and neglecting to provide basic water infrastructure to the rest. Rather than invest the nation's wealth in its citizens, the mullahs have wasted billions on a nuclear-weapons program. It despises the civilization it claims to lead. For nearly half a century the ruling class has tried to erase the cultural, intellectual and moral foundations of Iran and replace them with imperial ideas about jihadist conquests from Najaf to Karbala. In its fanaticism, the regime even cracks down on the annual celebration of one of Persia's greatest figures, Cyrus II, calling the event a "Zionist plot."

Every Iranian understands the leadership. Mr. Khamenei most of all knows what he is: a middling cleric elevated by raw politics, without scholarly authority or moral standing. As Mr. Bull notes, his career is built on the manipulation of religion to justify power.

For decades, Iranian dissidents have tried to explain this reality to the world. The regime survives through repression and distractions from abroad, not through any sincere base of support. But the West has been so traumatized by its experiences with "nation building" that it tends to conflate Iran with its neighbors.

My homeland is a modern country with an overwhelmingly young, educated and America-loving population. Iranians who come to the West thrive in its markets. My nation's history, literature, culture and political traditions complement and admire those of America and its allies. These characteristics are deep—they predate the Islamic Republic and will outlast it.

Yet criminally, Iran's gross domestic product per capita is $4,500. It should be $45,000. With its natural resources, talent and global connections, the country belongs on the same level as the most successful in the world. Instead, it languishes, impoverished.

Thankfully I trust that this won't always be the case. Mr. Khamenei's mediocrity isn't an accident—it defines the system. The regime elevates the small and the dishonest, silences the bold and punishes excellence. It can't be reformed because it was never built to succeed. It will collapse eventually, at which point Iranians can realize their goals of dignity, freedom and the right to build a future in their own name.

After Mr. Khamenei's regime is on the ash heap of history, the U.S. and the international community will find no better friend in peace and prosperity.

REZA PAHLAVI
London

Mr. Pahlavi is the eldest son of Shah Mohammad Reza Pahlavi.

Pride When the U.S. Army Goes Rolling Along

Regarding "Patriotism and Protests Stir the Nation" (U.S. News, June 16): I want to land firmly on the "pro" side and thank President Trump and the organizers. Every aspect of the parade touched me personally.

My father enlisted in January 1944 and served in the Army until his death in 1973. While in the Counter-intelligence Corps, he was awarded multiple medals including a Bronze Star, and he is buried in Arlington National Cemetery. I spent most of my childhood overseas, where an Army parade was a very anticipated and celebrated event, in part because there were none of the usual community activities enjoyed in civilian America. The parades always included marching soldiers in perfect cadence, a color guard carrying the U.S. and regimental flags, and a military band playing patriotic songs. At Christmas since there were no department stores featuring Santa Claus, he would arrive in a helicopter on the parade grounds.

An Army parade is a tribute to the soldiers and their families, in recognition of their service and sacrifices. It also serves to remind civilians that our country is worth fighting for, and within our nation are men and women who are willing to give their lives for its founding principles. While watching the parade from home I glanced at the nearby table where my father's folded casket flag rests, and I felt so proud that he was part of this amazing legacy.

ELLEN NITKOSKI SAPPINGTON
Apollo Beach, Fla.

Cool Heads Prevailed in the Strait of Hormuz

Your editorial "Iran's Strait of Hormuz Gambit" (June 23) rightly notes the waterway's importance. Much of the global economy depends on the 20% of the world's oil supply that travels through the strait.

Yet even as the Iranian parliament voted to close the strait, the shipping industry reacted with remarkable sanguinity. Oil prices rose, and maritime insurers' long-standing requirements for voyages through the strait remained in place, but ships sailed through at an almost-normal pace. On June 20, 104 ships transited, and on June 21, 122 ships did so. On June 22, as the U.S. bombed three Iranian nuclear sites, 117 sailed through. In June 2024, an average of 114 ships transited the strait each day. The shipping industry has learned to distinguish between threats and realities, knowing that Iran depends on the passage too. The industry also knows that the Iranian regime remembers the chaos and hardship caused by the 1980s "Tanker War" between Iran and Iraq. The 451 attacks, most of which were carried out by Iraq, struck 340 ships, killed 116 seafarers and caused enormous disruption to merchant shipping.

The industry calculated that Iranian leaders would act out of self-interest and leave the strait open—precisely what Tehran did. The regime chose instead to retaliate with modest strikes on U.S. bases in Qatar and Iraq.

The past is famously no guarantee for the future, and preparing for a potential Iranian blockade was a prudent step. But if we focus on a Hormuz blockade as an almost given, we risk whipping global markets into an unhealthy frenzy each time tensions flare up. And they will flare up again.

ELISABETH BRAW
Atlantic Council
Washington

About Those Medicaid 'Cuts'

Melinda Lemos-Jackson worries about the "strain of deep Medicaid cuts" for families like her own (Letters, June 16). Yet changes to the program for the able-bodied shouldn't be viewed as "cuts"—they amount to a restoration of the moral principle that we should be helping those who need it and that those who don't should be contributing to that assistance.

Resources for those with special needs, for instance, are suboptimal because of the bad incentives in ObamaCare's expansion: The feds provide states with more generous reimbursements for able-bodied, childless adults than for the disabled. That states took the bait is a shame, as resources are always limited. As Congress tries to right the ship, it's working for people exactly like Ms. Lemos-Jackson's family—the originally intended "face of Medicaid."

DAVID SARVADI
Bonita Springs, Fla.

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Colonial Privileges for Thee?

Regarding Allysia Finley's "How Progressive Government Set the Stage for the L.A. Riots" (Life Science, June 16): One of the recent progressive talking points has been that pro-immigration uprisings are acceptable because California and other southwestern states were "originally Mexican land." Never mind that the Mexicans were only on that land because they also colonized, displacing and dispossessing Native Americans themselves. Apparently leftwing radicals think such an inconvenient truth can be overlooked and forgiven.

This Brit wants to know: Come the next Democratic administration, will the party maintain that principle by arranging for the cession of the 13 colonies back to the U.K.? Or do some colonial empires get privileges over others?

ROBERT FRAZER
Salford, England

Pepper ... And Salt

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL

"I can trace my ancestors back to the common shrew."

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OPINION

U.S. Credibility Returns to the Middle East

By Karen Elliott House

President Trump's dramatic weekend strike may or may not have obliterated Iran's nuclear potential, but it has restored U.S. deterrence and credibility. Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, leader of a theocracy that held the Mideast in a grip of terror for nearly half a century, is cowering in an underground bunker. He fears even to use a cellphone lest Israel's superior intelligence and air power combine to eliminate him along with his nation's nuclear ambitions.

While Israel obviously is the big winner from the war it launched against Iran just over a week ago, Saudi Arabia stands to emerge as the other major regional beneficiary.

Apart from Israel, Saudi Arabia is the region's big winner. Its crown prince is eager to modernize.

Gone is Iran's "Axis of Resistance," which encircled the region and tormented Saudi Arabia. Of all the regimes in the Middle East, only Israel, the "little Satan," and Saudi Arabia, the "small and puny Satan," were earmarked for elimination. Iran coveted not only Saudi Arabia's oil but, more important, its guardianship of Islam's two holiest sites, Mecca and Medina.

On Monday the wounded and frightened Iranian regime lashed out with a missile attack on a U.S. air base in Qatar. Tehran could also seek to retaliate by closing the Strait of Hormuz or unleashing its terrorists to attack Americans. But Israel, Saudi Arabia and other Mideast partners now have ample demonstration of U.S. reliability, which has been in short supply for a decade. Mistrust of the Biden administration led Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman, known as MBS, to hedge his bets by establishing diplomatic relations with Tehran in 2023. And hoping to ward off any Iranian retaliation against the kingdom now, the Saudi foreign minister quickly tweeted the country's "great concern" for the "sisterly Islamic Republic of Iran." But make no mistake: Riyadh is thrilled.

With a single blow, Mr. Trump restored America's reputation in the region. At the same time, Russia and China, Iran's supposed loyal allies, look impotent watching their partner being mauled. Equally important for the Saudis, the humiliation of Mr. Khamenei, the great leader of Shiism, explodes the myth that God is on the side of Islamists. If, as seems likely, the 86-year-old ayatollah is either killed or sidelined, the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps, which underpins the theocracy, will likely keep Iran's 90 million economically deprived citizens under control with force, not appeals to Allah.

A wounded Iran also bolsters Saudi Arabia's goal of stabilizing Syria. MBS persuaded Mr. Trump to recognize Syria during his recent

DAVID GOTHARD

visit to the kingdom. This allowed Damascus to secure international economic help to stabilize its nascent government. Israel, too, seeks a stable Syria and is asserting its right to control a larger slice of southern Syria to protect the Golan Heights, which Israel occupied in 1967 and annexed in 1981.

To the extent that Iran's government now needs to focus internally rather than externally, Saudi Arabia's agenda for development at home and political influence in the region will be freed from fear of its rival. If the U.S. and Israel persist in destroying not only the regime's nuclear ambitions but also its ballistic-missile program, the largest in the region, the crown prince will emerge as the key Arab leader. With a population of 30 million, the kingdom is far larger than any of the wealthy Gulf Arab states. Egypt's population is nearly four times Saudi Arabia's, but Cairo long ago lost most of its regional influence.

MBS's ambition more than matches the kingdom's economic resources. In less than a decade, he has transformed Saudi Arabia's culture and economy, among other things by freeing the kingdom's educated women to work in any job, not merely teach in girls' schools. He is bent on transforming the country, breaking its dependence on oil revenue and developing income from tourism, sports and minerals. He wants Saudi Arabia to be a top five global economy by 2050. It's now ranked 16th.

To achieve his lofty goals, the crown prince is investing heavily in artificial intelligence. He is determined to transform Saudi Arabia into a global AI hub capable of competing with the U.S. Low-cost energy gives the kingdom an advantage given the industry's gargantuan power needs. With Iran's ability to make mischief in the Middle East seriously diminished, MBS is free to pursue his vision of using Saudi capital and Israeli technology to create a commercial zone connecting Asia to Europe. All this portends the eventual recognition of Israel by Saudi Arabia, one of Mr. Trump's major goals.

Doubtlessly there will be more bumps in the road. Nothing in the Middle East comes easily. A 1977 visit to Jerusalem by Egypt's President Anwar Sadat triggered great optimism about a new Mideast built on Arab-Israeli peace. Islamists assassinated Sadat in 1981, and nearly a half-century later, regional peace remains elusive. But with Iran no longer able to play the Palestinian card, and with growing alignment between Saudi and Israeli development strategies, the crown prince, who got where he is by cunning and courage, not cautious calculation, seems certain to follow his core creed. "If you don't stand out, you might as well disappear," he told me once. "If you see something to do, do it." Do it regardless of what others think.

Ms. House is a former publisher of the Journal and author of "The Man Who Would Be King," forthcoming in July.

What Public Schools Could Learn From Fred Smith

UPWARD MOBILITY
By Jason L. Riley

FedEx founder Fred Smith, who died last week at age 80, was a committed philanthropist. He sank millions into renovating sports stadiums, funded zoo exhibits, and endowed scholarships at historically black colleges and universities. Like other visionary businessmen, however, Smith's legacy almost certainly will be how he made his riches rather than how he spent them.

It's fashionable these days to dump on "oligarchs." Sen. Bernie Sanders and Rep. Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez have drawn large crowds at left-wing political rallies denouncing the supposed villainy of billionaire moguls. But many of our greatest industrial pioneers—from Thomas Edison and Andrew Carnegie to Bill Gates—amassed their fortunes by increasing social mobility and enriching the lives of others.

The Ford Foundation has spent billions of dollars on poverty initiatives, human-rights advocacy and other selected causes, yet Henry Ford's most significant achievement was developing the moving assembly line in the 1910s, which transformed manufacturing. Ford made automobiles accessible to America's burgeoning middle class, expanded job opportunities, and accelerated the expansion of related rubber and steel industries.

John D. Rockefeller likewise grew fabulously wealthy by revolutionizing an entire industry while improving the lives of others in the process. The rise of Standard Oil led to cheaper prices for oil and oil byproducts, including kerosene and gas. More goods could be transported over greater distances at lower cost and in less time. The everyday man could illuminate his home at night and no longer had to stop working when the sun went down. Rockefeller's money gave us the University of Chicago, Colonial Williamsburg, and New York City's Museum of Modern Art, but his ambition made immeasurable contributions to U.S. productivity.

Smith didn't invent parcel delivery. Directly and indirectly, however, he made mail service more efficient and reliable than it had been before FedEx was launched in the early 1970s. By then, postal delivery was facing a crisis. Costs were rising, and service was poor. The Post Office Department, predecessor to the U.S. Postal Service, hadn't upgraded its equipment in decades, and it ran a deficit of more than $1 billion.

Smith saw an opportunity. The U.S. Postal Service had a monopoly on certain types of mail delivery. The result, as ever, was bureaucratic inertia and mismanagement. Customers suffered because they could be

The FedEx founder gave the Postal Service the competition it needed to become better at its job.

taken for granted. Smith came up with a way to deliver documents faster and more reliably. He was so successful that the company's name eventually became a verb—"I'll FedEx you the package overnight"—and it changed forever the way billions of people in hundreds of countries send and receive parcels.

The Postal Service had no choice but to respond to the challenge. It invested in technological upgrades—including, eventually, online tracking and mobile apps—and improved on-time delivery rates and customer satisfaction. More mailing options led to more and better services to meet market demand.

The FedEx experience has long served as a model for education reformers, who liken the Postal Service to the traditional public-school system. Needed improvement won't come from within the education establishment, they argue, unless outside pressure is brought to bear in the form of charter schools, parochial schools, vouchers, tax credits and other innovations.

Mike Feinberg, who co-founded the KIPP charter school network in the 1990s, has said that Smith's company was a major inspiration. "FedEx didn't hurt the post office. It made it better," Mr. Feinberg once told a reporter. "I want the monopoly mindset broken up," he has also said. "Without competition, neighborhood schools behave like monopolies, delivering low quality at high cost."

Empirical studies have supported these claims. Research by Caroline Hoxby, an economist at Stanford, demonstrated that schools respond positively to deregulation and competition in the same way that other sectors do. Deregulation of the trucking industry in the 1970s resulted in faster and more-specialized customer service than before at the same price. Competition from foreign automakers has enhanced the quality of domestic vehicles.

"In parcel services, the introduction of competition improved productivity not only because the private firms (United Parcel Services, Federal Express, DHL Worldwide Express, etc.) had higher productivity and productivity growth," Ms. Hoxby wrote. "The competition also induced the U.S. Postal Service to raise substantially its own productivity."

The goal of school reformers isn't simply to create more alternatives for parents but also to provide incentives for underperforming schools to improve or risk losing students to better schools. The most efficient way to improve K-12 education is to make schools compete for students. As Fred Smith and so many other successful entrepreneurs well-understood, more competition makes organizations strive to do better. Less competition breeds complacency.

Support for Trump in a NATO Front-Line State

By Jillian Kay Melchior

Tallinn, Estonia

President Trump wants America's European allies to spend more on defense. So has every other recent president, but this one is expressing it in "brutal ways," says Estonia's Foreign Minister Margus Tsahkna. Which is fine with him: "That's the position I like, and Estonia likes—really."

"You didn't pay? You're delinquent?" Mr. Trump riffed during a February 2024 campaign rally. "No, I would not protect you. In fact, I would encourage them"—the Russians—"to do whatever the hell they want. You gotta pay. You gotta pay your bills."

Mr. Tsahkna says Mr. Trump poses "a rightful question: Why do U.S. people need to pay for European defense? If you see the figures, it's totally out of balance." The former and future president's remarks rattled America's friends across the Atlantic, but Mr. Tsahkna says Mr. Trump's ultimatum has also given European leaders political cover to raise defense spending: "On a strategic-communications level, it gives us a lot of opportunity to say that he's not coming to help."

Europe hit snooze after Russia invaded Georgia in 2008 and Ukraine in 2014. Even after Russia's full-scale invasion in 2022, the continent's initial response was lethargic. "My question has been, and the Estonian question, always: What does it take to wake up?" Mr. Tsahkna says. "I would have been more happy if it would have had happened like 10 years ago."

In January Mr. Trump said North Atlantic Treaty Organization members should increase defense spending to 5% of gross domestic product. On Monday NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte said the "key deliverable" of this week's summit would be a new defense-investment plan that raises the benchmark to that level. He said NATO members want a "fairer" alliance—in addition to a "stronger" and "more lethal" one.

Earlier NATO announcements about the new 5% target suggest that 1.5% can go to defense and security-related projects like infrastructure or resiliency, but 3.5% is for core military spending. On Monday Mr. Rutte described "a fivefold increase in air defense capabilities," "thousands more tanks and armored vehicles," and "millions of rounds of artillery ammunition," among other improvements.

Unlike some of Mr. Trump's critics, Mr. Tsahkna doesn't view the U.S. as a fickle ally: "There was a first part as well" to the American president's ultimatum. The key word was "if." Poland and the Baltic states were already pulling more than their weight, and next year Estonia will spend 5.4% of GDP on its military.

Mr. Tsahkna notes that during the notorious February Oval Office meeting between Mr. Trump and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky, the U.S. president reiterated his commitment to the security of Poland and the Baltics: "These assurances they have said on all different levels to us, and we see as well the U.S. troops in the Baltic region." In March Secretary of State Marco Rubio determined the U.S. will continue providing the Baltics with grants and loans to purchase weapons. Mr. Tsahkna is confident that NATO would respond militarily if Russia ever tried to seize even a small Estonian border village.

What about Vice President JD Vance's concerns that Europe is failing to live up to its professed democratic values? At the Munich Security Conference in February, he criticized

The Estonians already spend more than 5% of GDP on defense. They want other allies to do so.

Germany, Romania, the U.K. and Sweden for infringing free speech and other political rights. But he had no such complaint about Poland or the Baltics.

Estonia's high defense spending reflects its citizens' commitment to freedom and democracy, Mr. Tsahkna suggests. Estonia emerged from World War II as a Soviet constituent state. "We remember the killings, the deportations," Mr. Tsahkna says. "I'm born in 1977, and we had no right to celebrate Christmas. Our national flag—it was the highest crime to have it at home. We have decided that we will never let it happen again, whatever the costs are."

Mr. Tsahkna suggests Vladimir Putin "is actually afraid of Trump" and draws a contrast with Barack Obama: "Obama failed totally in Syria with the red lines, so-called, of using chemical weapons." In April 2017, Damascus carried out "a well-organized test" of the new Trump administration in the form of the Khan Shaykhun chemical attack. "There was 59 Tomahawk [cruise missiles] as a response," Mr. Tsahkna recalls. "Everyone understands that Trump is backing up his words by force well." (I met Mr. Tsahkna before the U.S. strike on Iran's nuclear facilities.)

Mr. Tsahkna observes that Mr. Trump "has this kind of style" during foreign-policy negotiations where "he is punching the others out of balance and then starting to negotiate." The exception is Russia, which Mr. Trump is "offering a very peaceful process and asked Putin what he wants."

Why? "For Trump it's not Ukraine, it's not even Russia—it's about China," Mr. Tsahkna says. "There is some kind of idea as well that maybe it is possible for the U.S. to bring Russia out from the China influence."

The foreign minister is skeptical: "We don't see that Putin wants to have any kind of peace." If Mr. Putin fails to reciprocate Mr. Trump's respect "the price may be high" for Russia, Mr. Tsahkna says—though he allows that "we don't know that." Still, the president has made peace in Ukraine a prominent objective of his second term. If Mr. Putin defies without consequence, Mr. Trump will lose some of the fearsome credibility that has underpinned foreign-policy successes.

Ms. Melchior is a London-based member of the Journal's editorial board.

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Notable & Quotable: Kagan

Robert Kagan writing for the Atlantic, June 21:

You would never know, as *The New York Times* churns out its usual policy-option thumb-suckers, that the United States is well down the road to dictatorship at home.

That is the context in which a war with Iran will occur. Donald Trump has assumed dictatorial control over the nation's law enforcement. The Justice Department, the police, ICE agents, and the National Guard apparently answer to him, not to the people or the Constitution. . . . And, most relevant in Iran's case, he is actively and openly turning the U.S. military into his personal army, for use as he sees fit, including as a tool of domestic oppression. . . . When he celebrates the bombing of Iran, he will be celebrating himself and his rule. The president ordered a military parade to honor his birthday. Imagine what he will do when he proclaims military success in Iran. The president is working to instill in our nation's soldiers a devotion to him and him alone. Imagine how that relationship will blossom if he orders what he will portray as a successful military mission.

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Trump Set for a Win on NATO Spending

Europeans, Canada commit to more than double their military investment

By Daniel Michaels And Alexander Ward

CHRISTIAN HARTMANN/REUTERS

Heads of state and government of the 32-member alliance, with other officials and one queen.

THE HAGUE—Amid continuing repercussions of U.S. airstrikes on Iran's nuclear facilities, President Trump is poised to claim one of the biggest foreign-policy wins of his second term: a pledge by NATO allies to more than double their military spending.

On his way to the summit, Trump shared on his Truth Social platform a message he received from NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte praising not only his "decisive action in Iran," but his getting the defense-spending deal.

To be formally announced Wednesday, the agreement almost collapsed over last-minute objections from Spain. Negotiations also continued until recent days over how the summit communiqué would address the issues of Ukraine and Russia. Europeans have wanted strong statements on both, echoing past North Atlantic Treaty Organization declarations, but the Trump administration had resisted.

The concluding document will have just five paragraphs, according to diplomats, and will effectively say that NATO is united and commits to the spending boost, with only passing mention of the war in Ukraine. The document will call Russia a threat, according to the diplomats. Europeans pushed hard to include that, arguing it is vital for justifying big increases in military spending, the diplomats said.

Many officials at NATO still worry that Trump will do something unexpected, as at past NATO summits. Asked on Tuesday whether he was still committed to supporting Article Five of NATO's founding treaty—which stipulates that an attack on one member is considered an attack on all—Trump was vague.

"There's numerous definitions of Article Five," he told reporters on Air Force One. "I'm committed to being their friends. You know, I've become friends with many of those leaders, and I'm committed to helping them."

Officials say an unstated goal of the gathering is simply to conclude without incident or disruptive disagreement.

Still, the prospect of agreement and unity—if only around limited goals—is an unexpected turn for many involved, considering Trump's repeated excoriating of NATO.

Trump's attendance was even in doubt following the U.S. bombing of Iran. Iran, which is outside NATO's remit, won't be on the agenda but is likely to be a hot topic on the sidelines.

When Trump early this year said allies should raise military outlays to 5% of economic output from 2%, many European diplomats and former U.S. NATO officials dismissed the idea as unachievable. But NATO's European members and Canada, which Trump has long criticized for low military spending, also wanted to avoid giving him reason to disengage from the 32-country alliance.

Rutte, in coordination with U.S. NATO Ambassador Matthew Whitaker and other diplomats, developed a plan to hit Trump's target while working to fulfill new military plans being developed in response to renewed Russian aggression. Those plans, prepared by NATO's military staff, envision expanding Europe's combat capabilities to levels not seen since the Cold War. Officials said realizing the blueprints would cost around 3.5% of gross domestic product for Europeans and Canada, up from the 2% target set in 2014.

The rise to 3.5% was already a stretch for most members when Trump proposed 5%. Rather than rejecting the higher figure, Rutte in March pitched a new approach: The additional 1.5% of GDP would be spent on generally nonlethal investments vital to military activities and homeland defense but outside NATO's traditional definition of military spending. Defense-related fields include support for armament manufacturing, boosting cybersecurity, and adapting critical infrastructure. Rutte's idea quickly gained support as ambitious but realistic for most NATO members.

"The 5% commitment is the single most important step NATO can take to ensure it remains strong and ready for the future," Whitaker said Monday. "This summit is really about NATO's credibility."

Spain's objection to the 5% target prompted intense negotiations over the weekend, ending with a compromise that appears to have papered over differences, at least temporarily, but left many people close to NATO feeling that alliance unity had been harmed.

Car Carrier Sinks in Pacific

By Costas Paris

U.S. COAST GUARD/AIR STATION KODIAK/REUTERS

Smoke rose from a fire aboard the cargo vessel Morning Midas on June 3.

The Morning Midas car carrier sank in the Pacific Ocean late Monday, weeks after a fire started on a deck that was carrying electric vehicles.

The ship's sinking leaves investigators with few clues to what caused the blaze.

The 600-foot-long vessel had been adrift since June 3, when a fire broke out and forced the crew to abandon the ship.

London-based Zodiac Maritime, the ship's owner, said fire damage, compounded by heavy weather, caused the vessel to sink about 400 miles off the Alaska coast.

The Morning Midas was carrying 3,000 cars, including about 800 electric vehicles, said Zodiac Maritime.

Most of the vehicles on the Morning Midas, including the EVs, were manufactured in China and bound for Mexico, The Wall Street Journal earlier reported.

The lithium batteries used in many electric vehicles are highly flammable. No ship fires have been directly blamed on EVs.

In 2022, a 60,000-ton cargo ship carrying thousands of luxury cars sank in the Atlantic Ocean after a fire burned for nearly a week.

Experts contracted to salvage the ship—the Panama-flagged Felicity Ace—said the presence of a large number of lithium-ion batteries likely caused the fire to spread and complicated efforts to extinguish it.

In a report last month, Insurer Allianz warned of the dangers of shipping vehicles containing lithium-ion batteries, citing several fires and near misses in the maritime and logistics industries that were linked to batteries.

WORLD WATCH

GAZA

At Least 44 Killed Trying to Get Aid

Israeli forces and drones opened fire toward hundreds of Palestinians waiting for aid in separate incidents in southern and central Gaza early Tuesday, killing at least 44, witnesses and hospitals said, as health authorities announced the number of Palestinians killed in the war has risen above 56,000.

The food-distribution sites run by an American contractor, with U.S. and Israeli government support, have been scenes of violence and chaos since opening last month.

Palestinian witnesses and health officials say Israeli forces have repeatedly opened fire on crowds heading to the sites for food, killing hundreds. The military says it has fired warning shots at people it said approached its forces in a suspicious manner while going to the sites.

—Associated Press

UKRAINE

Russian Hit Leaves 26 Civilians Dead

Russian drones, missiles and artillery killed at least 26 civilians and injured more than 200 in Ukraine, officials said Tuesday, as President Volodymyr Zelensky sought guarantees at a NATO summit of further help. Russian forces have struck civilian areas throughout the three-year war. More than 12,000 Ukrainian civilians have been killed, according to the United Nations. Ukraine has also hit residential areas in Russia.

A Russian missile attack on Dnipro hit multiple civilian sites in the central Ukrainian city around midday Tuesday, officials said. Russia shelled residential neighborhoods and infrastructure across the southern Kherson region, while in the Sumy region in the northeast, a drone attack late Monday killed three civilians, local authorities said.

—Associated Press

MOZAMBIQUE

Insurgents Abduct Dozens of Children

At least 120 children have been kidnapped by jihadist insurgents in northern Mozambique in recent days, Human Rights Watch said Tuesday.

They are reportedly being used by an Islamic State-linked group known locally as al-Shabaab to transport looted goods, provide labor, and in some cases serve as soldiers or be forced into marriage.

Mozambique has been battling the Islamist insurgency in Cabo Delgado province since 2017, with help from troops sent by Rwanda, South Africa and other regional partners. In 2020, the insurgents carried out attacks in which they beheaded dozens of people, including children. The violence has displaced more than 600,000 people and spilled into neighboring provinces, according to the United Nations.

—Associated Press

INDONESIA

Fallen Hiker Found Dead on Volcano

A young Brazilian hiker who fell hundreds of meters from the ridge of an Indonesian volcano and was trapped there for almost four days was found dead on Tuesday, Brazil's government said. Her story has riveted her home country, with millions following the dramatic search-and-rescue efforts since news broke of her fall.

Juliana Marins, 26 years old, began summiting Mount Rinjani with a guide and five other foreigners on June 21 when she fell some 2,000 feet, authorities said. The rescue team said it found the body beside a crater using a thermal drone after four days of searches complicated by harsh terrain and weather.

Marins, a dancer who lived outside Rio de Janeiro, had been traveling across Asia since February, her family said.

—Associated Press

MATTHIAS OESTERLE/ZUMA PRESS

RISING EXCITEMENT: A rearing horse drew cheers Tuesday at the St. John Festival in Ciutadella on the island of Minorca.

Political Uncertainty Clouds Thai Rate Call

By Amanda Lee

Thailand's central bank makes its rate decision on Wednesday against a tense backdrop marked by political tension at home and uncertainty abroad.

Last week's exit of the second-largest party in Thailand's ruling coalition has left Prime Minister Paetongtarn Shinawatra's Pheu Thai Party hanging by a thread, amid calls for her resignation, some analysts say.

"Political uncertainty now casts a pall on an already weak economy," Vishnu Varathan of Mizuho Securities said in a note, adding that it exacerbates the threat posed by tariff-related tensions.

Some analysts say the Bhumjaithai Party's withdrawal followed political infighting, but the final straw was a scandal over a leaked phone call with former Cambodian leader Hun Sen.

A party's exit from the ruling coalition has rattled financial markets.

There is a lack of trust in Shinawatra after the call, in which she allegedly criticized the Thai army, DBS senior economist Chua Han Teng said in a recent note.

The political instability has rattled financial markets, with Thailand's benchmark SET Index marking its lowest close in over five years on June 19—the day after the Bhumjaithai Party announced its defection. The index is down by over 20% this year, weighed by weak business confidence and a sluggish economy.

Thailand's latest bout of political turbulence comes as external headwinds, including U.S. tariffs and Middle East tensions, add volatility.

On Monday, as global markets reeled from an escalation in the Israel-Iran conflict, Thailand's stock exchange implemented temporary measures to curb volatility. It cited unrest in the Middle East, flagging concerns about regional stability and global economic trends.

Although oil prices, after jumping, have retreated on hopes of a cease-fire, uncertainty lingers. As a net oil importer, Thailand is vulnerable to swings in crude prices.

Udith Sikand at Gavekal Research noted that the country's net oil deficit is nearly 7.5% of gross domestic product, raising the risk that its modest current-account surplus will slip into deficit, as it did in 2022.

Still, low inflation gives Thailand some buffer against an oil-driven shock.

The central bank's policymakers will also be weighing the looming deadline for the U.S.'s "reciprocal" tariffs to take effect. Thailand could also face a 36% duty under U.S. President Trump's measures, if it fails to secure a trade deal with the U.S.

The Bank of Thailand has warned that the lack of clarity on tariffs makes assessing the economic outlook more challenging, with both direct and indirect implications for the economy.

With time running out, domestic politics could distract the Thai government away from U.S. negotiations, which have made limited progress, Nomura economists said in a note.

Domestic political uncertainty may also weaken Thailand's bargaining power, said Erica Tay, an economist at Maybank.

The renewed political volatility does little to brighten the outlook for Thailand's already tepid growth.

With the economy at a critical juncture, political issues may prevent policymakers from tackling long-term challenges such as high household debt, Maybank's Tay said.

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BUSINESS & FINANCE

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S&P 6092.18 ▲ 1.11% S&P FIN ▲ 1.50% S&P IT ▲ 1.61% DJ TRANS ▲ 1.84% WSJ $ IDX ▼ 0.46% 2-YR. TREAS. yield 3.811% NIKKEI (Midday) 38877.49 ▲ 0.22% See more at WSJ.com/Markets

U.K. Set to Rein In Google Search

Antitrust regulator says changes would be its first steps to improve competition

By Adrià Calatayud

The U.K.'s antitrust authority said it has proposed to designate Google as having strategic market status in general search and search advertising, paving the way for measures that could change how the U.S. tech company operates.

The move comes under the umbrella of a new U.K. law governing the digital economy. The Digital Markets, Competition and Consumers Act gives antitrust officials new powers to rein in Big Tech companies. **Alphabet**-owned Google became the first company probed under the law in January, shortly after the rules came into force at the beginning of the year.

The Competition and Markets Authority said Tuesday that it has proposed the so-called designation of strategic market status for Google. This means the regulator would be able to introduce measures aimed at addressing certain aspects of how the search engine works if the decision is confirmed after a consultation.

Early priorities include requiring screens to give users the choice between different search providers and ensuring that businesses appearing on Google search are treated with fair ranking principles, the regulator said.

The CMA also plans to prioritize measures aimed at providing more transparency and control for publishers whose content appears in search results and portability of consumer-search data, it said.

The regulator will now seek feedback on its proposal before making a final decision in October, it said.

Google will continue working constructively with the CMA, the company's senior director for competition, Oliver Bethell, said.

The outcome of the CMA's proposed decision could have significant implications for businesses and consumers in the U.K., he said.

"We're concerned that the scope of the CMA's consider-

Please turn to page B5

Oil Falls, Stocks Rally After Mideast Cease-Fire

By Alexander Osipovich And Caitlin McCabe

Oil prices slid further and the S&P 500 approached a record on Tuesday after President Trump brokered a shaky cease-fire between Israel and Iran, fueling hopes that the Middle East could avoid a protracted regional war.

Benchmark U.S. oil futures fell 6% to settle at $64.37 a barrel, below where they stood when Israel launched a surprise attack on Iran's nuclear program and military leadership earlier this month, kicking off the hostilities.

The drop extended Monday's 7.2% decline in U.S. oil prices, and it accelerated after Trump said Tuesday morning that China could continue to purchase Iranian oil, a sign he might be open to easing pressure on Iran. His administration has imposed numerous sanctions designed to impede Iranian oil sales.

Stocks in the U.S. and overseas rallied after Trump announced the cease-fire Monday evening. The truce came as a relief to investors who had feared broad economic fallout after the U.S. joined the Israeli campaign over the weekend, dropping powerful bombs on Iranian nuclear sites. But Tehran's retaliation—a missile barrage aimed at a U.S. base in Qatar—caused no casualties, and it appeared to be aimed at avoiding escalation.

The S&P 500 climbed 1.1% on Tuesday, to within 1% of the record closing high it reached in February. The Dow Jones Industrial Average advanced 507 points, or 1.2%.

The technology-heavy Nasdaq Composite rose 1.4%. Its sister index, the Nasdaq-100, advanced 1.5% to set a record.

Tuesday's gains were broad-based, as investors piled into shares of economically sensitive companies. Cruise operator **Carnival** jumped 6.9%. Chip makers **Intel** and **Advanced Micro Devices** both gained more than 6%. Shares of **Robinhood Markets** jumped 7.4%. Energy stocks were the main losers

Please turn to page B11

Boeing And FAA Faulted in Door-Plug Blowout

By Allison Pohle

Federal investigators said that **Boeing's** failure to provide adequate training, guidance and oversight for its manufacturing operations was to blame for the door plug that flew off a Boeing 737 MAX plane last year.

The National Transportation Safety Board also found that ineffective regulatory enforcement contributed to the accident, which terrified passengers and crew on an Alaska Airlines flight year but didn't result in any deaths or serious injuries.

Boeing is still grappling with fallout from the incident, which led to more stringent federal oversight of Boeing's manufacturing operations and leadership changes at the company.

The NTSB held a public meeting Tuesday to share findings of its investigation into the door plug blowout.

"An accident like this only happens when there are multiple system failures," NTSB chairman Jennifer Homendy said at the meeting.

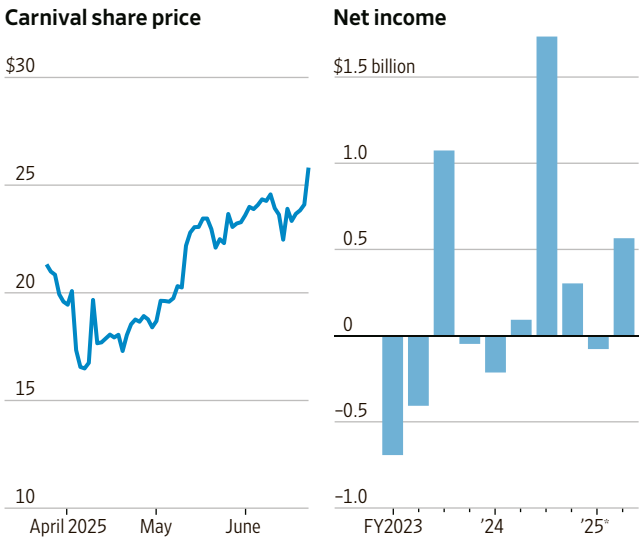
The door plug left Boeing's factory in Renton, Wash., without four bolts needed to keep its fuselage panel in place.

The panel had shifted upward during prior flights the aircraft made after it went in service, but not enough for crew to notice during preflight

Please turn to page B6

DAVE CULLEN/EEM/SIPA USA/SPORTPIX/REUTERS

The Miami-based cruise line on Tuesday said it now expects full-year adjusted net income of $2.69 billion.



*Most recent quarter ended May 31
Sources: FactSet (shares); S&P Capital IQ (income)

Carnival Results Beat Expectations

By Connor Hart

Carnival Corp. raised its outlook for the year as it logged higher-than-expected profit and revenue in its fiscal second quarter, boosted by strong demand and consumer spending.

The Miami-based cruise line on Tuesday said it now expects full-year adjusted net income of $2.69 billion, or $1.97 a share, up from a prior outlook of $2.49 billion, or $1.83 a share. Analysts polled by FactSet expect adjusted net income of $2.58 billion, or $1.88 a share.

For the current quarter, Carnival guided for adjusted net income of $1.8 billion, or $1.30 a share, compared with Wall Street views for adjusted net income of $1.84 billion, or $1.33 a share.

Chief Executive Officer

Please turn to page B6

Cable vs. Wireless War Lowers Internet Price

By Patience Haggin

Cable companies and mobile carriers are in a bitter battle for your home internet bill—and it is driving prices down.

This spring, major home-internet providers including **Verizon**, **Comcast** and **T-Mobile** launched a flurry of price-lock guarantees, promising steady rates for as long as five years. **Charter** unveiled a three-year deal last year.

Cable companies have struggled to retain internet subscribers since mobile carriers began offering more affordable 5G fixed-wireless internet service in 2018. Fixed wireless, which relies on cell towers instead of cables, brought competition into markets where cable companies had long enjoyed being the only game in town. Now both types of providers are growing more aggressive to attract—and keep—customers.

"The cable companies went from gaining subscribers and raising rates every year to declining subscribers and giving people price locks," said John Hodulik, a UBS analyst. "They're seeing churn rise in their broadband subscriber base. And they're trying to nip that in the bud."

Fixed wireless can some-

Please turn to page B2

INSIDE

BUSINESS NEWS
Krispy Kreme said it will no longer sell its doughnuts at McDonald's. **B3**

PROPERTY REPORT
Amazon is investing $54 billion in the U.K. to expand warehouses and boost AI. **B6**

Insurers Are 'Under Siege' By Notorious Hacking Group

By Angus Loten And James Rundle

A group of hackers suspected to be behind recent data breaches at **Marks & Spencer**, Victoria's Secret and other retailers appears to be setting its sights on insurance companies.

Aflac, one of the largest insurance companies in the U.S., is investigating a cyberattack on its systems that might have exposed claims information, health details, Social Security numbers and other personal data.

An Alfac representative on Monday told The Wall Street Journal that the attack was "perpetrated by a highly sophisticated and well-known group that has the insurance industry under siege."

No malware or ransomware was deployed and the firm's operations haven't been interrupted, the representative said.

Erie Indemnity and Philadelphia Insurance this month reported similar attacks.

All three companies were hit within the same five-day period.

"At this time, the full scope and potential ultimate impact on the company are not known," Aflac said Friday in a securities filing.

In an update last week, Erie said it had regained control of its system and was "working around the clock to restore access for customers, agents and employees."

Erie on Monday said to date "there is no evidence of ransomware and no indication of ongoing threat actor activity."

Philadelphia Insurance has "transitioned from containment of the threat to recovery of our business operations," according to the firm's latest update.

On Monday, online links to the firm were routed to the same temporary webpage with contact information for core

Please turn to page B5

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Wireless, Cable in Price War

Continued from page B1

times cost half as much as a cable-provided internet plan. Though network congestion and other connectivity issues can be an issue for some users, the lower price point has been luring cable customers away.

T-Mobile, Verizon and **AT&T** added a combined 3.7 million fixed-wireless customers in 2024. Meanwhile, Comcast's Xfinity and Charter's Spectrum lost more than 900,000 subscribers.

"Our pricing wasn't breaking through in the marketplace," said Steve Croney, chief operating officer for Comcast's connectivity and platforms business. He said the company's five-year price lock, introduced in April, competes well against the telecom companies' offerings.

Frank Boulben, chief revenue officer at Verizon's consumer group, said his company has been trying to address the "pain points" customers have with cable companies, such as price hikes.

The increased competition has driven down the cost of internet service, a welcome break for consumers when prices are rising for many other essential products. The price of home internet service fell 3.1% in May from a year earlier, while the overall consumer-price index rose 2.4%, according to the Labor Department.

Richard Young in Walnut Creek, Calif., used to subscribe to cable and internet provider Astound Broadband but called it "the last straw" when his home internet bill reached just under $100 last year. He switched to T-Mobile in October and took a $50-per-month fixed-wireless plan.

"Astound constantly raised costs and fees to the point it was frustrating," Young said. He had been skeptical that T-Mobile's home internet service would be as stable as his old provider but hasn't had any major issues since switching.

Astound Broadband Chief Executive Jim Holanda said the company offers low-cost packages for customers who use less data, and its price increases often accompany speed increases to maintain the plan's value proposition.

Verizon, AT&T and T-Mobile are winning converts at a faster pace than many anticipated, said Jonathan Chaplin, a managing partner at equity research firm New Street Research. Charter agreed to buy Cox last month for $21.9 billion in equity and assume $12 billion of its outstanding debt, in part to acquire scale to better compete with fixed wireless. But fixed-wireless growth can't last indefinitely.

The wireless networks on which they run will eventually hit capacity, limiting how many subscribers they can add. Chaplin estimates the networks can support around 19 million total fixed-wireless subscribers—which he predicts they will reach in about five years, accounting for planned network expansions. When that limit is reached, cable companies may regain the upper hand and keep growing their fiber customer base, Chaplin said.

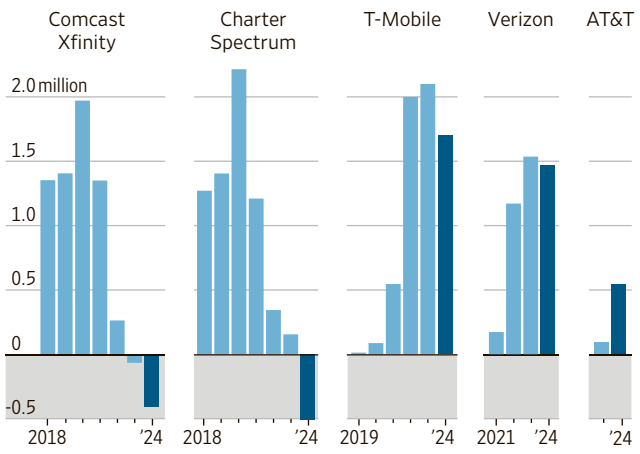
Wireless companies are preparing for that moment, too. AT&T, Verizon and T-Mobile have all been investing in fiber-based wired networks via build-outs and acquisitions. AT&T is bringing new customers in with fixed wireless, with the long-term goal to convert them to fiber-based service, said Erin Scarborough, who runs that company's broadband initiative.

Verizon's Boulben said his company would focus on selling fiber service to customers as it becomes available to them.

KRISTON JAE BETHEL FOR WSJ

While fixed wireless gains customers, cable providers such as Comcast's Xfinity (a Philadelphia store, above) have lost subscribers.

Net change in cable and fixed-wireless home internet subscribers



Note: U.S. figures. Xfinity and Spectrum include cable broadband; T-Mobile, Verizon and AT&T include fixed wireless.
Source: the companies

INDEX TO BUSINESSES

These indexes cite notable references to most parent companies and businesspeople in today's edition. Articles on regional page inserts aren't cited in these indexes.

A
Advanced Micro Devices..B1
Aflac....B1
Alphabet....B1
Amazon.com....B6
American Express....B12
Anthropic....B5
AT&T....B2

B
Banco Bilbao Vizcaya Argentaria....B11
Banco de Sabadell....B11
Bank of America....A2
Boeing....B1

C
Capital One....A2
Carnival....B1
Charter Communications....B1
Circle Internet....B12
Citigroup....A1
Coinbase Global....B12
Comcast....B1

E
Erie Indemnity....B1
Exxon Mobil....B12

F
FedEx....B3

G
Goldman Sachs....A2

I
Intel....B1
Interpublic....B4

J
JPMorgan Chase....A1

K
KB Home....B6
Krispy Kreme....B3

M
Marks & Spencer....B1
Mastercard....B12
McDonald's....B3
Meta Platforms....B5
Morgan Stanley....A2

N
Nvidia....B12

O
Omnicom....B4

R
Robinhood....B1

S
Starbucks....B12

T
T-Mobile....B1

V
Verizon Communications....B1
Victoria's Secret....B1
Visa....B12

W
Wells Fargo....A1

INDEX TO PEOPLE

A
Amaral, Luiz....B6

B
Barr, Randolph....B5
Bezos, Jeff....A9
Bloom, Nick....A7
Boulben, Frank....B2
Brusuelas, Joe....A7
Buetikofer, Alyssa....B3

C
Carusone, Angelo....B4
Chaplin, Jonathan....B2
Charlesworth, Josh....B3
Croney, Steve....B2

D
Dietrich, John....B3
Dell, Ben....B12
Dikbiyik, Ferhat....B5

F
Furman, Jeff....B3

H
Hayes, Thomas....B11
Hodulik, John....B1
Holanda, Jim....B2
Hultquist, John....B5

J
Jaber, Ahmed Al....B12
Jassy, Andy....B6
Jenkins, Bruce....B5

K
Kennedy, David....B6
Kull, Matt....B4

M
Mezger, Jeffrey....B6
Musk, Elon....B4

N
Ng, Kara....A3

R
Rao, Shiv....B4

S
Scarborough, Erin....B2
Schwamm, Lee....B4
Sikand, Udith....A16
Subramaniam, Raj....B3

T
Tay, Erica....A16
Turnbull, Joshua....A3

V
Varathan, Vishnu....A16
Vila, Carlos Torres....B11

W
Walden, Andy....A3
Weinstein, Josh....B6
Wren, John....B4

Y
Yergin, Daniel....B12

Z
Zhao, Chen....A3

Krispy Kreme Deserts McDonald's

Partnership to sell treats at chain failed to help doughnut maker's bottom line

By Connor Hart

JASON J. MOLYET/NEWS JOURNAL/USA TODAY NETWORK/REUTERS

Krispy Kreme unveiled its partnership with McDonald's last year, aiming to make its doughnuts available in more places.

Krispy Kreme said it would no longer sell its doughnuts at **McDonald's** restaurants, as the partnership wasn't helping the doughnut maker's bottom line.

Chief Executive Josh Charlesworth said Tuesday that the company initially partnered closely with the burger chain to bring its products to about 2,400 McDonald's restaurants across the U.S.

"Ultimately, efforts to bring our costs in line with unit demand were unsuccessful, making the partnership unsustainable for us," he said.

Krispy Kreme unveiled its partnership with McDonald's last year, as the Charlotte, N.C., chain aimed to make its doughnuts available in more places and become a national brand.

Last month, however, the company said it was reassessing the partnership's deployment schedule while it worked to achieve a profitable business model for both parties. The disclosure came as Krispy Kreme withdrew its outlook for the year and said it would stop paying a quarterly dividend, exercising a more cautious approach amid an uncertain economic climate.

Krispy Kreme said it would now focus on driving sustainable growth by making its doughnuts available in more high-volume retail locations and capital-light international franchise growth.

Its doughnuts represented a small, nonmaterial part of McDonald's breakfast business, according to Krispy Kreme and McDonald's.

The Chicago-based fast-food giant noted that breakfast remained a core pillar of its business strategy, and that it would continue to focus on providing affordable and convenient breakfast options to customers.

"We had strong collaboration with Krispy Kreme and they delivered a great, high-quality product for us," said Alyssa Buetikofer, McDonald's USA chief marketing and customer experience officer.

She noted that while the partnership met McDonald's expectations, "this needed to be a profitable business model for Krispy Kreme as well."

FedEx Outlook Subdued, Pacific Delivery Falls

By Katherine Hamilton

FedEx is expecting mixed results in its current first quarter as tariffs weigh on its international shipping business.

The package-shipping company said Tuesday it logged some of the biggest declines in shipping across the Pacific Ocean during the recently ended fourth quarter, as China-to-U.S. trade fell sharply after new tariffs were announced in April. FedEx is also cutting some of its European workforce as it continues cost-cutting efforts and looks to navigate uncertain customer demand in the year ahead.

"There's a lot happening outside of FedEx. Trade policies are evolving and trade patterns are changing," Chief Executive Raj Subramaniam said during a call with analysts.

Shares fell 5% in after-hours trading.

FedEx expects revenue to be flat or increase up to 2% in its fiscal first quarter. Analysts were anticipating a sales increase of about 0.6%. Earnings per share are projected to be $2.90 to $3.50, below the $3.83 a share analysts were forecasting.

The company didn't provide a full-year outlook, as it has in the past.

It is anticipating tariffs will add a $170 million cost in adjusted operating income during the current quarter, Chief Financial Officer John Dietrich said. International demand tracked tariff headlines during the quarter, falling in early April after President Trump's tariff announcements, and remained soft through May. Management expects international challenges will continue into the next fiscal year, particularly in China and across the Pacific.

"The macroeconomic environment remains uncertain," Dietrich said. "Our outlook is therefore based on current tariff rates, recent trends we're seeing, as well as that which we're hearing from our customers."

Subramaniam said FedEx is evaluating trade patterns and prepared to alter routes and capacity commitments if demand shifts. That evaluation is focused on Asia, Latin America and Europe. He will share details later this month about the planned layoffs in Europe, which are expected to save $150 million annually.

Job-Search Platform Sets Sales, Files for Bankruptcy

By Soma Biswas

CareerBuilder + Monster filed for bankruptcy Tuesday with plans to sell various business lines to different buyers.

The Apollo Global Management-backed company, once one of the leading job-search platforms, said it reached a deal to sell its job-board business to JobGet. Monster media properties, which include Fastweb.com and Military.com, would be sold to Valnet. And Monster Government Services, which provides software to state and local governments, would be sold to Valsoft.

CareerBuilder is actively cutting costs across its U.S. businesses and evaluating strategic options for certain international divisions, the company said.

"Like many others in the industry, our business has been affected by a challenging and uncertain macroeconomic environment," Jeff Furman, chief executive of CareerBuilder, said.

JobGet, Valnet and Valsoft will serve as stalking-horse, or lead, bidders in a court-supervised sale process, subject to higher and better offers.

The company is finalizing a $20 million loan from Blue Torch Capital to help finance its chapter 11.

CareerBuilder said it plans to pay its vendors to its U.S. businesses in full in the normal course during its bankruptcy proceedings.

Last year Randstad NV, the world's largest employment agency, formed a joint venture between its Monster job board business and Apollo portfolio company CareerBuilder.

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Who's Who of Distinguished Leaders: 2025 Honorees

Since 1898, Marquis Who's Who has remained the standard for reliable and comprehensive biographical reference material. We are proud to highlight hand-selected listees who have been recognized as *Distinguished Leaders* in their fields of endeavor.

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Tieg Bean, CPA
Vice President of Finance
CyberQP

Alan D. Brandis, PhD
Licensed Clin. Psychologist
Atlanta Area Psych. Assoc.

Robert Warren Button, PhD
Senior Analyst (Adjunct)
RAND Corporation

Ray A. Cameron
Sr. Exec., Financial Svcs.

Yuvraj "Yuvi" Chopra
Owner
Tribeca Hotel FiDi

Vivek Kesarwani
Enterprise Architect
HCL Tech

Robert J. Levenson
Managing Member
Lenox Capital Group, LLC

Who's Who of Distinguished Leaders 2025 Honoree

Robert Perl
Senior Consulting Engineer
Northrop Grumman

Judith Pratt, MFA
Professional Visual Artist
Judith Pratt Studio

Pablo G. Rivera
State Court Specialist
Skadden, Arps, Slate, et al.

Hector Jose Rodriguez
Area Director of Banquets
Loews Hotels & Co

Mark Thompson, CPA
CEO
Mark Thompson CPA

Mattielyn B. Williams
Administrative Judge (Ret.)
Tennessee Dept. of State

L. Jeffrey Zeldman
Executive Creative Director
Automattic

Doctors' Note-Taking AI Raises $300 Million

Abridge app tunes in to doctor-patient talks, transcribes the conversations

By Belle Lin

Abridge, a startup that has automated doctors' note-taking with artificial intelligence, on Tuesday said it had raised $300 million in funding.

The round, led by venture-capital firm Andreessen Horowitz with participation from Khosla Ventures, values the startup at $5.3 billion. In February, Abridge raised $250 million at a valuation of $2.75 billion.

The new capital infusion will go to hiring scientists, machine-learning experts and software developers who will focus on developing new products and building advanced AI infrastructure to support large customers, said Co-founder and Chief Executive Dr. Shiv Rao.

The fundraise comes at a time where so-called ambient-listening tech, which tunes in to the exchanges between doctor and patient and then transcribes the conversations, is gaining traction at hospitals and health systems.

The technology is lauded for reducing physician burnout and allows them to spend more time focused on patients without needing to scribble notes after hours.

Abridge's technology is now used in over 150 large health systems nationwide, the startup said, expanding from just a handful a few years ago when the Pittsburgh- and San Francisco-based startup was still piloting its technology with a few hospitals, said Rao.

The rapid growth of generative AI-based services and products has meant that nearly every sector—from financial services and life sciences to the skilled trades—is starting to be transformed by the technology.

But wide-scale adoption doesn't necessarily keep step with deployment.

For instance, about 800 of Yale New Haven Health System's roughly 3,000 employed physicians are actively using Abridge's platform, though that number is expected to double in the coming year, said Dr. Lee Schwamm, the health system's senior vice president and chief digital health officer.

But of those doctors who do use Abridge, 60% to 70% continue to do so, Schwamm said, and they report a major reduction in burnout. "It will become imperative for our physicians to use it, just like we require physicians to use the electronic health record," Schwamm said.

ABRIDGE (2)

Abridge's technology is now used in over 150 large health systems nationwide.

Matt Kull, chief information and digital strategy officer of Inova Health System, said the Northern Virginia-based health system is expanding the use of Abridge's product from its 2,000 doctors to include its 6,000 nurses.

Soon, nurses will be able to walk through inpatient suites and check vitals while talking to an Abridge-connected device, Kull said.

Over the past few years, Abridge's technology has become more sophisticated alongside the advanced AI models that power it, recognizing hard-to-pronounce medical terms and also generating notes relevant to each specialty, Rao said.

As part of its fundraise, Abridge is also embedding the checking and validating of medical billing codes during patient conversations, making documentation more compliant and simplifying processes like coding, billing and auditing.

FTC Clears Omnicom-IPG Merger With No-Boycott Pledge

By Patrick Coffee

Advertising holding company **Omnicom Group** can proceed with its proposed acquisition of rival **Interpublic Group** after the companies promised not to collude on politically motivated ad boycotts, the Federal Trade Commission said.

Omnicom, which owns agencies including BBDO and TBWA, in December agreed to buy IPG, whose portfolio includes McCann Worldgroup, in a transaction that would create the world's largest advertising company. The all-stock deal values IPG at around $13 billion and will create a conglomerate with about $25 billion in net revenue, based on 2024 figures.

Executives at Omnicom and IPG had expressed confidence that the government would approve their plan, calling the incoming Trump administration more business-friendly. However, the FTC in March requested additional information from Omnicom and IPG, signaling a review of the deal.

The commission has also been investigating whether advertising holding companies and left-leaning advocacy groups broke antitrust laws by steering ad spending away from platforms such as Elon Musk's X.

In the agreement announced on Monday, the companies pledged not to collude with other firms to move advertising dollars away from media outlets based on their perceived political or ideological alignment. The agreement doesn't include any admission of violations by Omnicom or IPG.

"Today's decision and order eliminates the potential for costly litigation while ensuring that Omnicom and IPG abide by the antitrust laws postmerger," FTC Chairman Andrew N. Ferguson said. "Moreover, this agreement requires Omnicom and IPG to cooperate with the commission in any investigation relating to media-buying services—and I have already noted that investigating and policing censorship practices that run afoul of the antitrust laws is a top priority of the Trump-Vance FTC."

They promised not to collude on politically motivated ad boycotts.

Omnicom also agreed not to develop so-called exclusion lists of sites or platforms where it doesn't recommend advertising, unless requested by individual clients, and said it would submit an annual report for the next five years demonstrating its compliance with the agreement.

"This is an important step toward the completion of the proposed acquisition and creating a new era in which we help clients grow with a comprehensive range of marketing and sales solutions, incorporating both creativity and technology," said John Wren, chief executive of Omnicom.

The FTC's approval is technically provisional, subject to 30 days of public comment and a final vote from the commission. The agreement, when final, will also release Omnicom and IPG from demands for information the commission made this month as part of its probe into alleged politically motivated ad boycotts against sites like X.

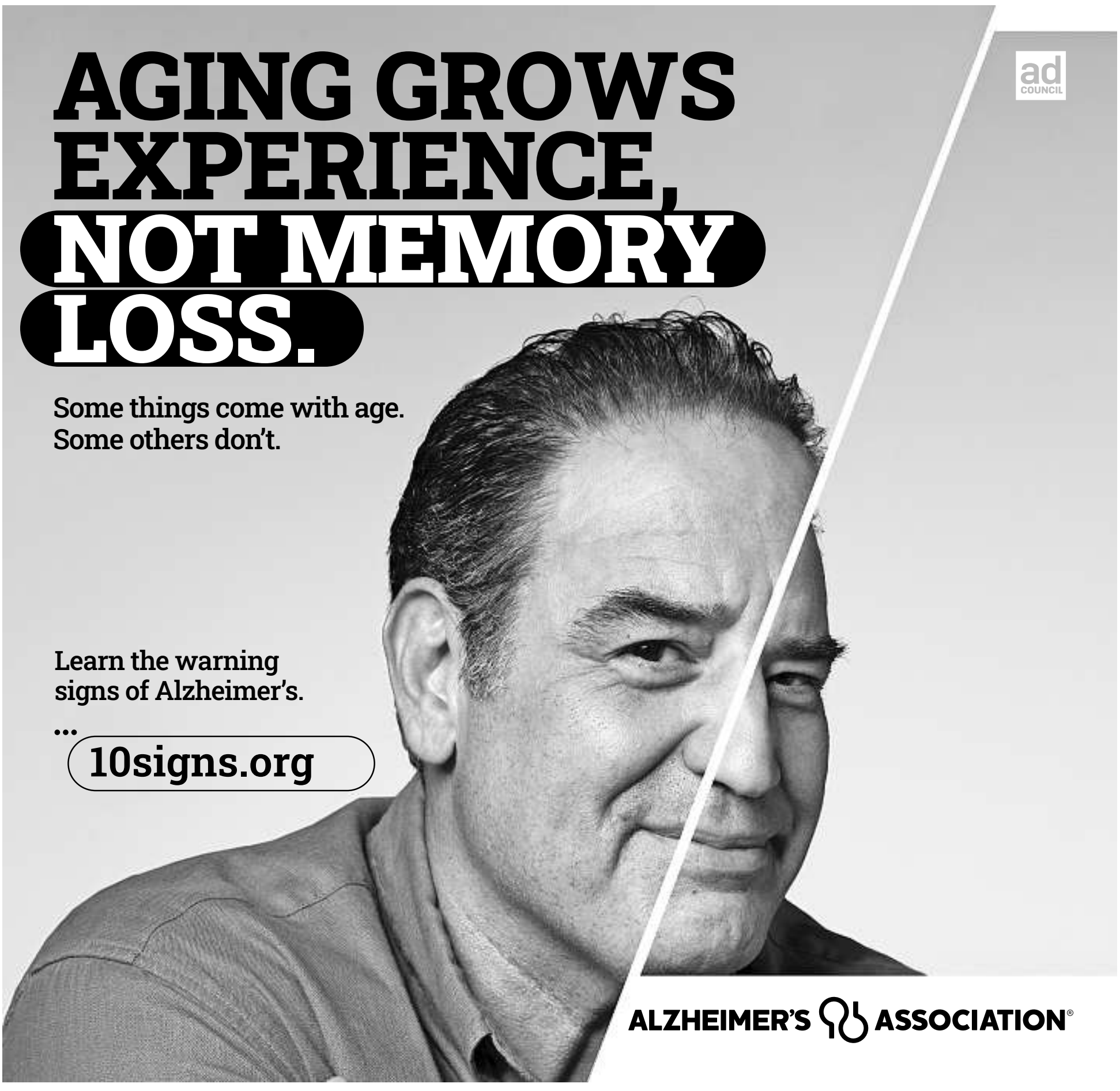
Other disputes over advertising and ideology continue. After a significant pullback in advertising on X, formerly known as Twitter, the social-media company sued both marketers and watchdog organizations such as Media Matters for allegedly colluding in an illegal ad boycott. X has threatened to drag more advertisers into court if they don't increase their spending on its platform, The Wall Street Journal reported this month.

Media Matters on Monday sued the FTC, arguing that the commission was trying to silence the group on behalf of Musk.

"This is a significant free-speech issue, and Media Matters will not back down from this fight," Chairman and President Angelo Carusone said.

And probes of the Omnicom-IPG merger remain open elsewhere. Regulatory agencies in the U.K. and Australia have each opened the deal to public comment to determine whether it would violate existing laws by creating an uneven playing field among companies that offer advertising- and media-buying services.

Omnicom and IPG have said they expect the deal to close during the second half of this year.



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TECHNOLOGY

Judge Supports Anthropic's Use Of Bought Books

By Meg Tanaka

A federal judge found the startup Anthropic's use of books to train its artificial-intelligence models was legal in some circumstances, a ruling that could have broad implications on AI and intellectual property.

Judge William Alsup of the Northern District of California ruled Monday that Anthropic's use of copyrighted books for AI model training was legal under U.S. copyright law if it purchased those books. The ruling is set to help shape future litigation against AI companies, legal experts said.

"The court treats the AI as akin to a human learning from copyrighted material," said Christina Frohock, professor of legal writing at the University of Miami School of Law. "It's fair use if you and I pick up a book and read it and develop our own thoughts," and the court made the same conclusion about AI systems, she said.

Copyright holders including musicians, filmmakers, authors and news outlets sued companies including OpenAI, **Meta Platforms**, Midjourney and others over unauthorized use of their copyrighted material for AI model training.

The ruling doesn't apply to more than 7 million books that Anthropic obtained through "pirated" means, the judge said. Anthropic used purchased and pirated books to create a central library that it drew from to train its Claude AI models.

The company will face another trial over its use of pirated works, which doesn't amount to "fair use" even if not all of those books were used for training. The ruling also doesn't address the legal question of whether the answers provided by AI models violate copyright law.

Anthropic said it was pleased that the court found its use of purchased books was legal and disagreed with the decision to hold a separate trial. The company remains confident in its overall case and is evaluating all options for review, according to a spokeswoman.

Authors Andrea Bartz, Charles Graeber and Kirk Wallace Johnson filed the class action lawsuit last year, alleging the company used pirated works to train its AI systems, which are called large-language models, or LLMs.

A number of AI companies made licensing agreements with media companies and discussions for additional deals are continuing.

Insurers Report Breaches

Continued from page B1

services.

Scattered Spider, a hacking group known to pose as employees seeking help from a company's call center or tech support team, has a history of focusing on one sector at a time, said John Hultquist, Google Threat Intelligence Group's chief analyst.

"I don't think it has anything to do with any innate weakness in the sector," Hultquist said. "It's just the way that they organize their activity."

Scattered Spider specializes in social-engineering operations, in which hackers pose as a co-worker or other contact to trick employees into giving up credentials, or support staff into granting them access to accounts.

Once inside, attackers can install malicious software to steal or lock data, spy on a company, or disrupt operations.

In a report Friday, cybersecurity firm Halcyon said the group "delivers sustained operational disruption, week-slong downtime, steep recovery costs, regulatory penalties, brand damage, and potential existential risk to businesses of all sizes."

"Scattered Spider doesn't rely on malware to get in," said Ferhat Dikbiyik, chief intelligence and research officer at cybersecurity firm Black Kite. "They rely on human behavior. They like to be buzzed in instead of breaking in."

On top of having the right defensive technology in place, he said, the key question for cybersecurity teams is "can someone call in, sound confident and get exactly what they want? That's the battleground."

Part of the reason for the group's success is in its members' backgrounds.

Scattered Spider's members are believed to largely speak English as their native language, giving them a leg up in social-engineering schemes.

Scattered Spider has a history of focusing on one sector at a time.

"Even well-trained employees can fall victim when the attacker's approach mimics legitimate business processes," said Randolph Barr, chief information security officer at cyber firm Cequence Security.

The weakest link isn't the employee, Barr said, "it's the lack of layered security controls that can detect and stop unauthorized data access in real time."

Law-enforcement agencies in the U.S. and U.K. said Scattered Spider is behind a spate of attacks in recent years that have included digital assaults on the gambling industry, retail giants and now major insurers.

British police are investigating whether the group was behind recent cyberattacks that affected supermarket chain Marks & Spencer and the high-end department store Harrods, among others.

The group has also been linked to attacks on Caesars Entertainment and MGM Resorts International in 2023 that closed large parts of the Las Vegas Strip for days.

"The retail exploits show how effective the group is, underscoring that the threat to insurance companies is very real," Bruce Jenkins, chief information security officer at Black Duck, a Burlington, Mass.-based application-security firm.

U.K. Set To Rein In Google

Continued from page B1

ations remains broad and unfocused, with a range of interventions being considered before any evidence has been provided," Bethell said.

Google search accounts for more than 90% of all online general searches in the U.K. and more than 200,000 businesses in the country rely on its search-advertising services, according to the CMA.

The regulator took into account how generative artificial intelligence is changing the search market, it said. The proposed strategic-market-status designation for Google would include AI-based features in searches, the CMA said.

The CMA said the measures outlined Tuesday would represent its first steps to improve competition in search services in the U.K., but that it plans to consider a second category of actions. The future measures would address more complex issues starting in the first half of 2026, the regulator said.

This announcement is neither an offer to purchase nor a solicitation of an offer to sell Shares (as defined below). The Offer (as defined below) is being made only by the Offer to Purchase, dated June 25, 2025 (the "Offer to Purchase") and the related Letter of Transmittal, as each may be amended or supplemented from time to time, and is being made to all holders of Shares. THE OFFER IS NOT BEING MADE TO (NOR WILL TENDERS BE ACCEPTED FROM OR ON BEHALF OF) HOLDERS OF SHARES IN ANY JURISDICTION IN WHICH THE MAKING OF THE OFFER OR ACCEPTANCE THEREOF WOULD NOT BE IN COMPLIANCE WITH THE LAWS OF SUCH JURISDICTION. IN THOSE JURISDICTIONS WHERE APPLICABLE LAWS OR REGULATIONS REQUIRE THE OFFER TO BE MADE BY A LICENSED BROKER OR DEALER, THE OFFER SHALL BE DEEMED TO BE MADE ON BEHALF OF PURCHASER (AS DEFINED BELOW) BY ONE OR MORE REGISTERED BROKERS OR DEALERS LICENSED UNDER THE LAWS OF SUCH JURISDICTION TO BE DESIGNATED BY PURCHASER.

Notice of Offer to Purchase
All Outstanding Shares of Common Stock
of

Verve Therapeutics, Inc.

at

$10.50 per share, net in cash,
without interest and less any applicable tax withholding,
***plus* one non-tradable contingent value right ("CVR") per share,**
which represents the contractual right to receive a contingent payment of up to $3.00 per CVR, net to the stockholder in cash, without interest and less any applicable tax withholding, upon the achievement of a certain specified milestone

by

Ridgeway Acquisition Corporation

an indirect wholly-owned subsidiary
of

Eli Lilly and Company

Ridgeway Acquisition Corporation, a Delaware corporation ("Purchaser") and an indirect wholly-owned subsidiary of Eli Lilly and Company, an Indiana corporation ("Lilly"), is offering to purchase all of the issued and outstanding shares of common stock, par value $0.001 per share (the "Shares"), of Verve Therapeutics, Inc., a Delaware corporation ("Verve"), in exchange for (i) $10.50 per Share, net to the stockholder in cash, without interest (the "Cash Consideration") and less any applicable tax withholding, *plus* (ii) one non-tradable CVR per Share, which represents the contractual right to receive a contingent payment of up to $3.00 per CVR, net to the stockholder in cash, without interest and less any applicable tax withholding, upon the achievement of a certain specified milestone, all in accordance with the terms and subject to the conditions and other provisions of a contingent value rights agreement (the "CVR Agreement") to be entered into by and among Parent, Purchaser, Computershare Inc., a Delaware corporation, and its affiliate, Computershare Trust Company, N.A., a federally chartered trust company (the Cash Consideration *plus* one CVR, collectively, the "Offer Price"), upon the terms and subject to the conditions set forth in the Offer to Purchase and in the related Letter of Transmittal (which, together with the Offer to Purchase, as each may be amended or supplemented from time to time, collectively constitute the "Offer").

Tendering stockholders who are holders of record of their Shares and who tender directly to Computershare Trust Company, N.A., the depositary and paying agent for the Offer (in such capacity, the "Depositary"), will not be obligated to pay brokerage fees or commissions or, except as otherwise provided in Section 6 of the Letter of Transmittal, stock transfer taxes with respect to the purchase of Shares by Purchaser pursuant to the Offer. Stockholders who hold their Shares through a broker, dealer, commercial bank, trust company or other nominee should consult such broker, dealer, commercial bank, trust company or other nominee as to whether it charges any service fees or commissions.

Each CVR represents a non-tradable contractual right to receive a contingent payment of up to $3.00 per CVR, net to the stockholder in cash, without interest and less any applicable tax withholding (the "Milestone Payment"), payable upon the dosing of the first human subject in the United States in a Phase 3 clinical trial for the CVR Product (as defined in the Offer to Purchase) targeting atherosclerotic cardiovascular disease (the "Milestone"), if the Milestone is achieved prior to both (i) 12:00 a.m., Eastern Time, on the date that is the tenth anniversary of the closing date of the Merger (as defined below) and (ii) the termination of the CVR Agreement. The amount paid under the CVR could be offset by up to an amount equal to (a) 50% of any (x) payments made, or to be made, by Purchaser (or its controlled affiliates) for it (or its controlled affiliates) to obtain an exclusive license or retain sole ownership under the Relevant Patents (as defined in the Offer to Purchase) due to a Final Resolution (as defined in the Offer to Purchase), and (y) attorneys' fees, expert fees and costs, court and arbitration expenses, and similar other out-of-pocket fees and costs, in each case, reasonably incurred and reasonably documented by Purchaser (or its controlled affiliates) in connection with any Final Resolution or otherwise in connection with a dispute related to the ownership of Relevant Patents, divided by (b) the total number of CVRs held by all holders of CVRs as reflected on the CVR Register (as defined in the Offer to Purchase) as of the close of business on the date of the Milestone Notice (as defined in the CVR Agreement); provided that such offset amount will in no event exceed $0.50. This means that the aggregate consideration per CVR could be lower than $3.00 (but no lower than $2.50) even if the Milestone is met.

THE OFFER AND WITHDRAWAL RIGHTS WILL EXPIRE AT ONE MINUTE PAST 11:59 P.M., EASTERN TIME, ON JULY 23, 2025, UNLESS THE OFFER IS EXTENDED OR EARLIER TERMINATED.

The Offer is being made pursuant to an Agreement and Plan of Merger, dated June 16, 2025 (as it may be amended from time to time, the "Merger Agreement"), by and among Verve, Lilly and Purchaser, pursuant to which, after consummation of the Offer and subject to the satisfaction or waiver of certain conditions, Purchaser will merge with and into Verve pursuant to Section 251(h) ("Section 251(h)") of the General Corporation Law of the State of Delaware (the "DGCL"), upon the terms and subject to the conditions set forth in the Merger Agreement, with Verve continuing as the surviving corporation and becoming an indirect wholly-owned subsidiary of Lilly (the "Merger"). At the effective time of the Merger (the "Effective Time"), each Share issued and outstanding immediately prior to the Effective Time (other than (i) Shares held in the treasury of Verve or owned by Verve, (ii) Shares owned by Lilly, Purchaser or any direct or indirect wholly-owned subsidiary of Lilly or Purchaser or (iii) Shares that are held by stockholders who are entitled to demand and properly exercised and perfected their respective demands for appraisal for such Shares in accordance with Section 262 of the DGCL will be converted into the right to receive the Offer Price, without interest, from Purchaser, less any applicable tax withholding.

The Offer and the Merger are not subject to any financing condition. The obligation of Purchaser to accept for payment and pay for Shares validly tendered (and not validly withdrawn) pursuant to the Offer is subject to the satisfaction of the conditions set forth in Section 15 of the Offer to Purchase (collectively, the "Offer Conditions"), including the Minimum Tender Condition (as defined below), the Antitrust Condition (as defined below) and the Legal Restraint Condition (as defined below).

The "Minimum Tender Condition" means that there will have been validly tendered in the Offer and not validly withdrawn prior to the Expiration Time (as defined below) that number of Shares that, together with the number of Shares, if any, then beneficially owned by Lilly and Purchaser (together with their wholly-owned subsidiaries), would represent a majority of the Shares outstanding as of the consummation of the Offer.

The "Antitrust Condition" means that any applicable waiting period under the Hart-Scott-Rodino Antitrust Improvements Act of 1976, as amended, in respect of the transactions contemplated by the Merger Agreement (the "Transactions"), and any agreement with a governmental authority not to consummate or to delay consummation of the Transactions, has expired or been terminated.

The "Legal Restraint Condition" means that no court of competent jurisdiction or other governmental body has issued an order, decree, or ruling, enacted any law or taken any other action restraining, enjoining, or otherwise prohibiting the Offer or the Merger.

The term "Expiration Time" means one minute past 11:59 p.m., Eastern Time, on July 23, 2025, unless the expiration of the Offer is extended to a subsequent date in accordance with the terms of the Merger Agreement, in which case the term "Expiration Time" means such subsequent time on such subsequent date. The Merger Agreement does not provide for a "subsequent offering period" in accordance with Rule 14d-11 under the Exchange Act without the prior written consent of Verve.

The Board of Directors of Verve (the "Verve Board") unanimously (i) determined that the Merger Agreement and the Transactions are advisable, fair to, and in the best interests of, Verve and its stockholders, (ii) duly authorized and approved the execution and delivery of the Merger Agreement, the performance by Verve of its covenants and other obligations thereunder, and the consummation of the Transactions upon the terms and subject to the conditions set forth therein, (iii) resolved that the Merger Agreement and the Transactions will be governed by and effected under Section 251(h) and other relevant provisions of the DGCL and (iv) resolved to recommend that Verve stockholders accept the Offer and tender their Shares pursuant to the Offer.

Descriptions of the reasons for the Verve Board's recommendation and approval of the Offer are set forth in Verve's Solicitation/Recommendation Statement on Schedule 14D-9 (the "Schedule 14D-9"), which is being mailed to Verve stockholders together with the Offer materials (including the Offer to Purchase and the related Letter of Transmittal). Stockholders should carefully read the information set forth in the Schedule 14D-9, including the information set forth in Item 4 thereof under the sub-headings "Background of the Offer" and "Reasons for the Recommendation of the Company Board."

The Merger Agreement contains provisions that govern the circumstances under which Purchaser is required or permitted to extend the Offer. Specifically, the Merger Agreement provides that: (i) if, at the scheduled Expiration Time, any Offer Condition other than solely (x) the Minimum Tender Condition and (y) any such conditions that by their nature are to be satisfied at the Expiration Time, has not been satisfied or waived, Purchaser will extend the Offer for one or more consecutive increments of up to five business days each (or for such longer period as may be agreed to by Lilly and Verve), until such time as such conditions have been satisfied or waived; (ii) Purchaser will extend the Offer for any period required by any rule, regulation, interpretation or position of the Securities and Exchange Commission (the "SEC"), the staff thereof or The Nasdaq Stock Market LLC applicable to the Offer; and (iii) if, at the scheduled Expiration Time, each Offer Condition (other than the Minimum Tender Condition and any such conditions that by their nature are to be satisfied at the Expiration Time) will have been satisfied or waived and the Minimum Tender Condition will not have been satisfied, Purchaser may elect to (and if so requested by Verve, Purchaser will) extend the Offer for one or more consecutive increments of such duration as requested by Verve (or if not so requested, as determined by Purchaser) but not more than five business days each (or for such longer period as may be agreed to by Verve and Lilly); however, Verve may not request Purchaser to, and Purchaser will not be required to, extend the Offer on more than three occasions. In each case, Purchaser will not, without the prior written consent of Verve, and will not be required to, extend the Offer beyond the Outside Date. However, if the Antitrust Condition has not been satisfied, the Outside Date would be automatically extended until the date that is 210 days from the date of the Merger Agreement in order to allow additional time to obtain the required antitrust approval. The "Outside Date" means October 14, 2025, unless otherwise extended pursuant to the terms of the Merger Agreement, as summarized in Section 11 of the Offer to Purchase.

If the Offer is consummated, Purchaser will not seek the approval of Verve's remaining stockholders before effecting the Merger. Lilly, Purchaser and Verve have agreed to take all necessary action to cause the Merger to become effective as soon as practicable following the consummation (within the meaning of Section 251(h)(6) of the DGCL) of the Offer without a vote of holders of the Shares in accordance with Section 251(h).

Purchaser expressly reserves the right, in its sole discretion, to waive any Offer Condition or modify the terms of the Offer, in whole or in part, including the Offer Price, except that Verve's prior written consent is required for Purchaser to: (i) decrease the Cash Consideration or amend the terms of the CVRs or the CVR Agreement; (ii) change the form of the consideration payable in the Offer; (iii) decrease the maximum number of Shares sought pursuant to the Offer; (iv) amend or waive the Minimum Tender Condition or the Termination Condition (as defined in the Offer to Purchase); (v) add to or modify the Offer Conditions in a manner adverse to holders of Shares; (vi) extend the Expiration Time except as required or expressly permitted by the Merger Agreement or provide any "subsequent offering period" (or any extension thereof) within the meaning of Rule 14d-11 under the Securities Exchange Act of 1934, as amended (the "Exchange Act"); or (vii) make any other change to the terms or conditions of the Offer that is adverse to holders of Shares.

Any extension, delay, termination or amendment of the Offer will be followed as promptly as practicable by a public announcement thereof, and such announcement in the case of an extension will be made no later than 9:00 a.m., Eastern Time, on the business day after the previously scheduled Expiration Time. Without limiting the manner in which Purchaser may choose to make any public announcement, Purchaser intends to make announcements regarding the Offer by issuing a press release and making any appropriate filing with the SEC.

Purchaser is not providing for guaranteed delivery procedures. Therefore, Verve stockholders must allow sufficient time for the necessary tender procedures to be completed during normal business hours of The Depository Trust Company ("DTC"), which end earlier than the Expiration Time. Normal business hours of DTC are between 8:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m., Eastern Time, Monday through Friday. **Verve stockholders must tender their Shares in accordance with the procedures set forth in the Offer to Purchase and the related Letter of Transmittal prior to the Expiration Time. Tenders received by the Depositary after the Expiration Time will be disregarded and of no effect.**

For purposes of the Offer, Purchaser will be deemed to have accepted for payment, and thereby purchased, Shares validly tendered to Purchaser and not validly withdrawn as, if and when Purchaser gives oral or written notice to the Depositary of Purchaser's acceptance for payment of such Shares pursuant to the Offer. Upon the terms and subject to the conditions of the Offer, payment for Shares accepted for payment pursuant to the Offer will be made by deposit of the Cash Consideration for such Shares with the Depositary, which will act as agent for tendering stockholders for the purpose of receiving payments from Purchaser and transmitting such payments to tendering stockholders whose Shares have been accepted for payment. If Purchaser extends the Offer, is delayed in its acceptance of Shares for payment or is unable to accept Shares for payment pursuant to the Offer for any reason, then, without prejudice to Purchaser's rights under the Offer and the Merger Agreement, the Depositary may retain tendered Shares on Purchaser's behalf, and such Shares may not be withdrawn except to the extent that tendering stockholders are entitled to withdrawal rights as described in Section 4 of the Offer to Purchase. However, Purchaser's ability to delay the payment for Shares that it has accepted for payment is limited by Rule 14e-1(c) under the Exchange Act, which requires Purchaser to pay the consideration offered or return the securities deposited by or on behalf of stockholders promptly after the termination or withdrawal of the Offer. **Under no circumstances will Purchaser pay interest on the Offer Price for Shares accepted for payment in the Offer, including by reason of any extension of the Offer or any delay in making such payment.**

In all cases, Purchaser will pay for Shares validly tendered and accepted for payment pursuant to the Offer only after timely receipt by the Depositary of (i) to the extent the Shares are not already held with the Depositary, the certificates evidencing such Shares (the "Share Certificates") or confirmation of a book-entry transfer of such Shares into the Depositary's account at DTC (such a confirmation, a "Book-Entry Confirmation") pursuant to the procedures set forth in Section 3 of the Offer to Purchase, (ii) the Letter of Transmittal, properly completed and duly executed, with any required signature guarantees (or, in the case of a book-entry transfer or a tender through DTC's Automated Tender Offer Program, an Agent's Message (as defined in the Offer to Purchase) in lieu of the Letter of Transmittal) and (iii) any other documents required by the Letter of Transmittal or the Depositary, in each case prior to the Expiration Time. Accordingly, tendering stockholders may be paid at different times depending upon when the Share Certificates and Letter of Transmittal, or Book-Entry Confirmations and Agent's Message, in each case, with respect to Shares that are actually received by the Depositary.

Shares tendered pursuant to the Offer may be withdrawn at any time prior to the Expiration Time. Thereafter, tenders are irrevocable, except that if Purchaser has not accepted your Shares for payment within 60 days of commencement of the Offer, you may withdraw them at any time after August 23, 2025, the 60th day after commencement of the Offer, until Purchaser accepts your Shares for payment.

For a withdrawal of Shares to be effective, the Depositary must timely receive a written notice of withdrawal at one of its addresses set forth on the back cover of the Offer to Purchase. Any notice of withdrawal must specify the name of the person who tendered the Shares to be withdrawn, the number of Shares to be withdrawn and the names in which the Share Certificates are registered, if different from the person who tendered such Shares. The signature(s) on the notice of withdrawal must be guaranteed by an Eligible Institution (as defined in the Offer to Purchase), unless such Shares have been tendered for the account of an Eligible Institution. If Shares have been tendered pursuant to the procedures for book-entry transfer as set forth in Section 3 of the Offer to Purchase, any notice of withdrawal must specify the name and number of the account at DTC to be credited with the withdrawn Shares. If Share Certificates representing the Shares to be withdrawn have been delivered or otherwise identified to the Depositary, then, prior to the physical release of such Share Certificates, the name of the holder(s) of record and the serial numbers shown on such Share Certificates must also be furnished to the Depositary.

Withdrawals of tenders of Shares may not be rescinded and any Shares validly withdrawn will be deemed not validly tendered for purposes of the Offer. Withdrawn Shares may, however, be retendered by following one of the procedures for tendering Shares described in Section 3 of the Offer to Purchase at any time prior to the Expiration Time.

All questions as to the validity, form, eligibility (including time of receipt) and acceptance for payment of any tender of Shares will be determined by Purchaser in its sole discretion, which determination will be final and binding on all parties, subject to the rights of holders of Shares to challenge such determination with respect to their Shares in a court of competent jurisdiction and any subsequent judgment of any such court. Purchaser reserves the absolute right to reject any and all tenders determined by the Purchaser not to be in proper form or the acceptance for payment of which may, in Purchaser's opinion, be unlawful. Purchaser also reserves the absolute right to waive any defect or irregularity in the tender of any Shares of any particular stockholder, whether or not similar defects or irregularities are waived in the case of other stockholders. No tender of Shares will be deemed to have been validly made until all defects and irregularities have been cured or waived to Purchaser's satisfaction. None of Purchaser, Lilly or any of their respective affiliates or assigns, the Depositary, Georgeson LLC (the "Information Agent") or any other person will be under any duty to give any notification of any defects or irregularities in tenders or incur any liability for failure to give any such notification. Subject to the terms of the Merger Agreement and the rights of holders of Shares to challenge any interpretation with respect to their Shares in a court of competent jurisdiction and any subsequent judgment of any such court, Purchaser's interpretation of the terms and conditions of the Offer (including the Letter of Transmittal and the instructions thereto) will be final and binding.

The information required to be disclosed by paragraph (d)(1) of Rule 14d-6 of the General Rules and Regulations under the Exchange Act is contained in the Offer to Purchase and is incorporated herein by reference.

Verve has provided Purchaser with its stockholder list and security position listings for the purpose of disseminating the Offer to Purchase, the related Letter of Transmittal and other materials related to the Offer to holders of Shares. The Offer to Purchase, the related Letter of Transmittal and other materials related to the Offer, including the Schedule 14D-9, will be mailed to record holders of Shares whose names appear on Verve's stockholder list and will be furnished for subsequent transmittal to beneficial owners of Shares to brokers, dealers, commercial banks, trust companies and other nominees whose names, or the names of whose nominees, appear on Verve's stockholder list or, if applicable, who are listed as participants in a clearing agency's security position listing.

The exchange of Shares for cash and CVRs pursuant to the Offer or the Merger will be a taxable transaction to a U.S. Holder (as defined in the Offer to Purchase) for U.S. federal income tax purposes. The amount of gain or loss a U.S. Holder recognizes, and the timing and character of such gain or loss depend on the U.S. federal income tax treatment of the CVRs. The installment method of reporting any gain attributable to the receipt of a CVR generally will not be available with respect to the disposition of Shares pursuant to the Offer or the Merger because the Shares are traded on an established securities market. There is no legal authority directly addressing the U.S. federal income tax treatment of the receipt of the CVRs in connection with the Offer or the Merger, and the U.S. federal income tax treatment of the CVRs is subject to uncertainty. Lilly intends to treat a stockholder's receipt of a CVR pursuant to the Offer or the Merger as the receipt of additional consideration paid in the Offer or the Merger as part of a "closed transaction." As part of a closed transaction for U.S. federal income tax purposes, a U.S. Holder who sells Shares pursuant to the Offer or receives cash and CVRs in exchange for Shares pursuant to the Merger generally will recognize capital gain or loss for U.S. federal income tax purposes in an amount equal to the difference, if any, between (i) the amount of cash received *plus* the fair market value (determined as of the closing of the Offer or the Effective Time, as the case may be) of any CVRs received and (ii) the U.S. Holder's adjusted tax basis in the Shares sold pursuant to the Offer or converted pursuant to the Merger. See Section 5 of the Offer to Purchase for a more detailed discussion of the U.S. federal income tax treatment of the Offer. You are urged to consult with your tax advisor as to the particular tax consequences to you of the Offer and the Merger in light of your particular circumstances (including the application and effect of any U.S. federal, state, local or non-U.S. income and other tax laws).

The Offer to Purchase and the related Letter of Transmittal contain important information, and Verve's stockholders should read both carefully and in their entirety before making a decision with respect to the Offer.

Questions or requests for assistance may be directed to the Information Agent at the address and telephone numbers listed below. Additional copies of the Offer to Purchase, the related Letter of Transmittal and other materials related to the Offer may be obtained at no cost to stockholders from the Information Agent. Additionally, copies of the Offer to Purchase, the related Letter of Transmittal and any other materials related to the Offer are available free of charge at www.sec.gov. Stockholders may also contact their brokers, dealers, commercial banks, trust companies or other nominees for assistance. Neither Lilly nor Purchaser will pay any fees or commissions to any broker, dealer, commercial bank, trust company or to any other person (other than to the Depositary and the Information Agent) in connection with the solicitation of tenders of Shares pursuant to the Offer.

The Information Agent for the Offer is:

Georgeson

Georgeson LLC
51 West 52nd Street, 6th Floor
New York, NY 10019
Shareholders, Banks and Brokers
Call Toll Free: 888-686-7459
Outside U.S. and Canada: 434-207-8557
Via Email: Verveoffer@georgeson.com

June 25, 2025

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THE PROPERTY REPORT

Amazon to Invest Around $54 Billion in U.K.

Thousands of jobs to be added in plan to boost AI, expand warehouse network

By Najat Kantouar

Amazon.com plans to invest about $54 billion in the U.K. over the next three years, expanding its warehouse network and artificial-intelligence infrastructure to bulk up its e-commerce and cloud operations.

The U.S. tech company said Tuesday that its investment of 40 billion pounds, equivalent to $54.10 billion, would create thousands of jobs and contribute to the country's economy and AI ambitions. U.K. Prime Minister Keir Starmer called the move a vote of confidence in the country.

News of Amazon's investment came shortly after the U.K. government launched its industrial strategy, a 10-year plan that aims to attract investment in key sectors to drive economic growth.

Amazon set out plans for multibillion-dollar investments in several parts of the U.S. and countries like Australia and Taiwan in recent weeks. Most of those outlays seek to bolster its data-center network to meet booming global demand for AI computing.

In the U.K., the company is also looking to expand the infrastructure that underpins its core e-commerce operations, by investing in building new warehouses, adding delivery stations and upgrading its transportation network.

Amazon said it expects to create 2,000 jobs at a previously announced fulfillment center in Hull that is set to open this year, another 2,000 positions at a new facility in Northampton, and additional roles at new sites in the East Midlands. The investment will also result in additional jobs at delivery stations across the country, the company said.

The plan comes after Amazon Chief Executive Andy Jassy last week outlined plans to reduce the company's workforce in the coming years due to the increasing use of AI. Jassy said the efficiency gains from using generative AI would result in cuts, but didn't specify how much the size of Amazon's workforce would be reduced.

The company currently employs more than 75,000 people in the U.K. and is a top 10 private-sector employer, it said.

Amazon's U.K. investment plan includes part of the £8 billion it earmarked last year for building, operating and maintaining data centers in the country through 2028, it added.

The company also plans to allocate funds to original TV and film productions and to redevelop the historic Bray Film Studios in Berkshire.

The U.K. government is seeking to spur business investment in sectors like advanced manufacturing, defense, technology and the creative industries.

The number of foreign-direct-investment projects into the U.K. declined last year, similar to other leading European economies, but the country continues to be the top destination for tech investments, according to a report by EY published in May. The U.K.'s share of foreign-direct-investment projects in Europe fell to 15.9% last year from 17.3% five years before, according to EY.

NATHAN STIRK/GETTY IMAGES

The company plans to expand its warehouse network and AI infrastructure.

Fast Delivery Expands in U.S.

Amazon.com is bringing its same-day and next-day delivery to more communities in the U.S., extending the service to thousands of smaller towns and cities across the country.

The e-commerce and tech giant's new focus will bring its Prime fast delivery service to over 4,000 smaller cities and rural communities and millions of online shoppers by the end of the year.

In April, Amazon announced it was investing over $4 billion to the end of 2026 to expand its rural delivery network, with a focus on small towns across the country's less densely populated areas.

Since the launch of Amazon Prime, Amazon's super-fast delivery has redefined consumer expectations, making expedited delivery a baseline expectation for online shoppers.

—Adriano Marchese

KB Home Reports Decline in Sales, Cuts Outlook Amid Sluggish Market

By Kelly Cloonan

KB Home cut its outlook for the year again after posting lower profit and sales for its fiscal second quarter as housing-market conditions remain sluggish.

The home builder said Monday it now expects housing revenue of $6.3 billion to $6.5 billion for fiscal 2025, down from its prior guidance of $6.6 billion to $7 billion from March. The company had initially guided for full-year sales in a range of $7 billion to $7.5 billion in January.

Analysts polled by FactSet expect home-building sales of $6.55 billion for the fiscal year.

The company also lowered the top end of its expected average selling price, guiding for a range of $480,000 to $490,000, compared with a previous outlook of $480,000 to $495,000.

The lowered views come as would-be buyers continue to stay on the sidelines as mortgage rates and prices remain high. Sales of existing homes rose slightly in May, up 0.8% from the prior month, but still neared historically low levels, the National Association of Realtors said Monday.

"Consumers are continuing to demonstrate a lack of confidence about the short-term, which has impacted their home purchase decisions," KB Home Chief Executive Jeffrey Mezger said during a call with analysts, pointing to persistent affordability challenges as well as macroeconomic and geopolitical uncertainties.

Quarterly earnings came in at $1.50 a share, above the $1.46 a share expected by analysts polled by FactSet.

Revenue fell to $1.53 billion from $1.71 billion a year ago. Analysts forecast $1.5 billion.

MIKE BLAKE/REUTERS

The lowered view come as buyers are staying on the sidelines.

BUSINESS & FINANCE

Net-Zero Push Persists, Says Standards Setter

By Yusuf Khan

Sustainability efforts have been under attack, but many companies insist the business case for pursuing net-zero emissions remains strong, the new leader of the nonprofit that sets climate action standards said.

The flow of companies signing up to have their transition targets validated by the Science Based Targets initiative shows many firms aren't backing away from sustainability goals despite the political and investor backlash. Submissions to the SBTi are up 30% year to date, said David Kennedy, chief executive, and that comes after a record number last year.

"This is not about business doing the right thing," said Kennedy, who took the top job at SBTi in March. "It is about business managing its transition risk and SBTi being part of that, which ultimately has benefits from the world. But those do need to align with the commercial realities and they can do. There is a sweet spot where science meets business, and it's a win-win."

Kennedy stressed he wants to take a pragmatic and nonconfrontational approach to companies that continue to work on cutting emissions, even if they fall short of targets.

"For those who've made serious efforts but have fallen a bit short, we are not in the shaming business," he said.

Kennedy highlighted the importance of engaging hard-to-abate industries, such as oil and gas, heavy industry and chemicals, which are responsible for the majority of corporate emissions. However, he said taking a pragmatic approach would be key.

He noted that in certain sectors such as steel, issues around technology and supply are hindering moves to green production, and the transition may take longer.

"There's a really important point that you've got to be science-based as that gives you a global CO_2 pathway," he said. "But you've got to translate that through economics and technology lenses to what should happen in different sectors, and clearly not all sectors should move at the same pace."

He added that working with financial institutions would be key to this and that the SBTi would be publishing a new net-zero standard for financial institutions in the coming weeks. "We've got about 150 financial institutions with targets," he said. "We were really pleased that ING recently, a big Dutch bank, signed up with us."

Submissions to the SBTi are up 30% year to date, said the nonprofit's CEO.

He said the new standard would be more tailored to financial institutions, to better reflect "the levers that those banks, and other financial sector players, have got available."

"The best thing you can do is ensure that your key clients are net-zero-aligned, and that is one of the key pillars of the new approach," he said.

Kennedy cemented the charity's position on carbon credits. Earlier this year, the organization proposed a number of changes to its net-zero standard. These changes are being discussed by companies and academics, ahead of moving to the SBTi's technical committee later this year, and companies are expected to be able to set targets against it in early 2026.

"The main thing has to be that corporations drive down their carbon footprint," said Kennedy. He highlighted three ways companies could have a holistic net-zero strategy.

First, companies that fall short of targets should be able to purchase high-integrity credits to fulfill goals. Second, credits should play a part in negating ongoing emissions. Finally, credits should play a role in mitigating residual emissions in hard-to-abate sectors, those emissions that are almost impossible to cut through conventional means like switching energy sources.

The guidance published earlier this year related only to direct emissions, otherwise known as Scope 1.

Kennedy arrived at the SBTi during one of the most tumultuous times in its brief 10-year history. Its previous CEO, Luiz Amaral, resigned nine months earlier, amid a furor around carbon credits and the board's role in how the charity is run, which led to an internal revolt and criticism from the climate community.

Questions over funding arose, and while the charity remains fully funded for this year and next, it is looking to philanthropic causes to help finance its mission. Currently, about 75% of funding comes from validation fees, with the rest from grants.

"We are the standard around which the whole system functions and so we're an attractive proposition to various funders," Kennedy said.

Probe Faults Boeing and Regulators

Continued from page B1

walkarounds, NTSB investigators said. They determined that even one properly installed bolt at the bottom of the panel would have held it in place. It was supposed to have four for redundancy.

The investigators noted problems with several of Boeing's processes, including worker training and repair documentation. For example, workers didn't document the door plug work, so there is no final determination on who removed the panel, investigators said.

At the time of the accident, Boeing had 24 technicians working on doors at its Renton factory, investigators found. Of those technicians, only one had experience opening a door plug in the past, and he was on vacation during the time of the service.

The NTSB also highlighted ineffective oversight from the Federal Aviation Administration. At the time of the accident, the FAA only maintained records dating back five years, which meant it wasn't properly auditing systemic issues related to removals, the investigators said.

The investigation didn't find any issues with Alaska Airlines' preflight inspections.

The FAA said it has fundamentally changed how it oversees Boeing since the door-plug incident and will continue aggressive oversight, including weekly meetings with the company to review progress.

Boeing said it would review the NTSB's final report and recommendations as it keeps making improvements. "We at Boeing regret this accident and continue to work on strengthening safety and quality across our operations," the company said.

Carnival Raises Its Outlook

Continued from page B1

Josh Weinstein said travelers are looking to Carnival as their preferred vacation choice. "Even with the price increases we have achieved over the last few years, our tremendous value compared to land-based alternatives has supported our ability to continue demonstrating remarkable resilience amid heightened volatility," he said.

Onboard spending and close-in demand, the latter of which accounts for last-minute bookings, were strong during the recent quarter, Weinstein added. Looking forward, he said the company's booking curve "continues to be the furthest out on record."

For its three months ended May 31, Carnival posted net income of $565 million, or 42 cents a share, compared with $92 million, or 7 cents a share, a year earlier.

Stripping out certain one-time items, adjusted per-share earnings came in at 35 cents, topping the 25 cents that analysts projected.

Revenue rose 9.5% to $6.33 billion. Analysts modeled revenue of $6.21 billion.

The company's shares rose 6.9% to $25.70 on Tuesday.

Inside The Disney-Inspired Office Campus with 13,000 Employees

JORDAN POST

Scan this code for a video: Epic is the leading provider of electronic medical records in the U.S., but its Wisconsin headquarters looks nothing like a typical tech campus. It features treehouses, yellow brick roads, and even sheep fitted with AirTags. WSJ's Open Office video series takes viewers inside standout spaces to see what separates them from the rest.

COMMODITIES

wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Futures Contracts

Metal & Petroleum Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Copper-High (CMX)-25,000 lbs.; $ per lb.							
June	4.8635	4.8735		4.8635	**4.8670**	0.0240	1,225
Sept	4.9400	5.0010		4.8960	**4.9245**	0.0220	91,129
Gold (CMX)-100 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
June	3358.00	3358.00		3301.00	**3317.40**	–60.30	149
July	3361.20	3369.70		3296.40	**3320.00**	–60.60	6,857
Aug	3383.80	3385.00		3308.30	**3333.90**	–61.10	332,177
Sept	3386.00	3388.70		3324.90	**3348.60**	–61.20	844
Oct	3400.00	3405.10		3336.70	**3361.40**	–61.10	21,369
Nov	3406.00	3407.90		3375.00	**3376.10**	–61.10	130
Palladium (NYM) - 50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
June	1091.50	1096.00		1084.00	**1067.00**	–21.60	4
Sept	1085.00	1090.00		1064.00	**1066.30**	–20.40	19,086
Platinum (NYM)-50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
June	1337.70	1345.80	▲	1303.00	**1304.20**	20.80	50
Oct	1304.40	1336.50	▲	1281.50	**1322.20**	27.30	70,004
Silver (CMX)-5,000 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
June	35.830	35.830		35.600	**35.701**	–0.452	8
Sept	36.410	36.505		35.535	**36.067**	–0.461	101,041
Crude Oil, Light Sweet (NYM)-1,000 bbls.; $ per bbl.							
Aug	67.74	67.83		64.00	**64.37**	–4.14	307,025
Sept	66.48	66.64		62.84	**63.15**	–4.12	240,899
Oct	65.53	66.09		62.00	**62.22**	–4.06	141,000
Dec	64.50	64.72		61.31	**61.40**	–3.83	252,581
June'26	63.89	64.00		61.41	**61.50**	–2.86	111,970
Dec	63.53	63.90		61.68	**61.75**	–2.15	151,283
NY Harbor ULSD (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.							
July	2.3221	2.3408		2.2200	**2.2851**	–.0780	22,537
Aug	2.3124	2.3181		2.2014	**2.2496**	–.0886	86,416
Gasoline-NY RBOB (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.							
July	2.1950	2.1950		2.0841	**2.0857**	–.1325	34,691
Aug	2.1647	2.1745		2.0691	**2.0709**	–.1282	118,856
Natural Gas (NYM)-10,000 MMBtu.; $ per MMBtu.							
July	3.681	3.684		3.530	**3.537**	–.161	21,500
Aug	3.781	3.791		3.648	**3.655**	–.155	145,869
Sept	3.775	3.778		3.643	**3.651**	–.151	172,426
Oct	3.858	3.865		3.739	**3.746**	–.142	142,265
Nov	4.210	4.248		4.126	**4.134**	–.117	114,660
Jan'26	5.057	5.072		4.980	**4.994**	–.090	137,520

Agriculture Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Corn (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
July	419.00	422.50	▼	415.00	**416.25**	–3.00	199,288
Dec	434.25	434.50	▼	428.50	**429.00**	–4.75	562,415
Oats (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
July	364.50	384.00		363.25	**363.50**	–3.25	490
Dec	358.25	361.75		344.00	**344.25**	–11.75	1,714
Soybeans (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
July	1055.00	1062.25		1046.25	**1046.75**	–12.00	107,225
Nov	1040.75	1049.75		1036.50	**1037.00**	–9.75	352,795
Soybean Meal (CBT)-100 tons; $ per ton.							
July	282.40	284.30	▼	280.10	**280.50**	–1.90	72,325
Dec	296.80	299.60	▼	294.90	**295.30**	–1.40	244,758
Soybean Oil (CBT)-60,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
July	52.75	52.93		51.77	**52.17**	–1.07	48,756
Dec	53.00	53.46		52.16	**52.61**	–1.14	246,947
Rough Rice (CBT)-2,000 cwt.; $ per cwt.							
July	13.36	13.62		13.33	**13.56**	.15	2,228
Sept	13.63	13.93		13.62	**13.90**	.21	6,390
Wheat (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
July	552.00	553.00		535.00	**535.75**	–17.00	41,434
Sept	569.50	569.50		551.50	**552.00**	–17.50	184,957
Wheat (KC)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
July	550.25	551.00		534.25	**534.75**	–15.25	29,213
Sept	565.00	565.00		549.25	**549.75**	–15.25	144,545
Lumber (CME)-27,500 bd. ft., $ per 1,000 bd. ft.							
July	611.00	613.50		607.50	**609.50**	–2.50	3,907
Sept	640.50	641.50		638.00	**639.00**	–3.00	3,191
Milk (CME)-200,000 lbs., cents per lb.							
June	18.68	18.68		18.67	**18.67**	...	3,445
July	17.28	17.36	▼	16.95	**16.96**	–.30	3,965
Cocoa (ICE-US)-10 metric tons; $ per ton.							
July	8,621	9,410		8,605	**9,436**	247	907
Sept	8,572	8,835		8,459	**8,763**	229	39,760
Coffee (ICE-US)-37,500 lbs.; cents per lb.							
July	323.75	325.55		317.75	**315.35**	–14.95	789
Sept	326.00	326.00		311.00	**311.35**	–15.20	73,282
Sugar-World (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
July	15.95	16.17	▼	15.71	**15.77**	–.27	79,814
Oct	16.49	16.71		16.27	**16.36**	–.21	400,005
Sugar-Domestic (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
Sept	34.95	34.95	▼	34.95	**34.95**	...	742
Jan'26	34.02	34.02	▼	34.02	**34.70**	–.10	1,462
Cotton (ICE-US)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
July	64.70	67.03		64.67	**66.01**	2.05	276
Dec	67.40	68.40		67.34	**67.79**	.38	158,317
Orange Juice (ICE-US)-15,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
July	231.45	236.10		226.75	**228.80**	–5.20	1,536
Sept	235.25	237.90		227.20	**231.00**	–5.00	5,787

Interest Rate Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Ultra Treasury Bonds (CBT) - $100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
Sept	117-070	118-070		116-120	**118-020**	17.0	1,884,756
Treasury Bonds (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
Sept	114-010	114-260		113-180	**114-230**	12.0	1,753,562
Dec	113-190	114-140		113-070	**114-110**	12.0	2,037
Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
Sept	111-080	111-220		111-050	**111-210**	6.5	4,850,417
Dec	111-070	111-195		111-035	**111-190**	6.5	3,962
5 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
June	108-227	108-232		108-137	**108-217**	5.2	2,003
Sept	108-145	108-240		108-130	**108-227**	3.5	7,028,282
2 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$200,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
June	103-137	103-212		103-202	**103-218**	2.1	53
Sept	103-255	103-292		103-249	**103-288**	1.1	4,128,006
30 Day Federal Funds (CBT)-$5,000,000; 100 - daily avg.							
June	95.6700	95.6725	▼	95.6700	**95.6700**		355,017
July	95.6750	95.6750	▼	95.6700	**95.6750**		460,916
Three-Month SOFR (CME)-$1,000,000; 100 - daily avg.							
April	95.6675	95.6700		95.6675	**95.6700**		8,349
June	95.6800	95.6825		95.6700	**95.6750**	–.0050	1,293,133

Currency Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Japanese Yen (CME)-¥12,500,000; $ per 100¥							
July	.6875	.6935		.6858	**.6928**	.0070	1,877
Sept	.6905	.6985		.6903	**.6977**	.0070	316,318
Canadian Dollar (CME)-CAD 100,000; $ per CAD							
July	.7290	.7315		.7290	**.7294**	.0008	556
Sept	.7311	.7341		.7310	**.7317**	.0008	199,043
British Pound (CME)-£62,500; $ per £							
July	1.3556	1.3648	▲	1.3524	**1.3632**	.0110	749
Sept	1.3528	1.3656	▲	1.3525	**1.3638**	.0110	174,005
Swiss Franc (CME)-CHF 125,000; $ per CHF							
Sept	1.2442	1.2576		1.2427	**1.2562**	.0123	68,269
Dec	1.2628	1.2710		1.2567	**1.2699**	.0124	377
Australian Dollar (CME)-AUD 100,000; $ per AUD							
July	.6473	.6516		.6459	**.6507**	.0049	926
Sept	.6468	.6530		.6466	**.6516**	.0050	150,269
Mexican Peso (CME)-MXN 500,000; $ per MXN							
July	.05194	.05258		.05212	**.05253**	.00041	156
Sept	.05179	.05230		.05176	**.05216**	.00040	147,477
Euro (CME)-€125,000; $ per €							
July	1.1610	1.1656	▲	1.1592	**1.1640**	.0050	4,871
Sept	1.1640	1.1707	▲	1.1638	**1.1689**	.0049	740,405

Index Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Mini DJ Industrial Average (CBT)-$5 x index							
Sept	42902	43515		42896	**43424**	523	80,422
Dec	43366	43814		43188	**43726**	538	402
Mini S&P 500 (CME)-$50 x index							
Sept	6078.00	6155.25		6075.25	**6146.25**	69.25	1,844,523
Dec	6126.00	6206.00		6125.75	**6197.25**	70.25	8,254
Mini S&P Midcap 400 (CME)-$100 x index							
Sept	3073.00	3111.30		3072.30	**3103.20**	28.50	36,294
Dec	...	3112.00		3096.10	**3124.50**	29.00	n.a.
Mini Nasdaq 100 (CME)-$20 x index							
Sept	22079.00	22448.25		22065.75	**22412.75**	339.25	240,488
Dec	22274.25	22664.75		22274.25	**22629.25**	341.00	287
Mini Russell 2000 (CME)-$50 x index							
Sept	2150.20	2182.80		2148.70	**2177.90**	28.40	394,303
Dec	2170.50	2198.50		2165.20	**2194.40**	29.20	288
Mini Russell 1000 (CME)-$50 x index							
Sept	3353.20	3368.60		3328.30	**3364.20**	39.00	5,358
U.S. Dollar Index (ICE-US)-$1,000 x index							
Sept	97.85	97.88		97.31	**97.45**	–.56	30,739
Dec	97.50	97.50	▼	97.00	**97.10**	–.55	459

Source: FactSet

Bonds | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Tracking Bond Benchmarks

Return on investment and spreads over Treasurys and/or yields paid to investors compared with 52-week highs and lows for different types of bonds

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Broad Market Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2166.53	3.5	U.S. Aggregate	4.580	4.100	5.110
U.S. Corporate Indexes Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
3308.86	3.6	U.S. Corporate	5.070	4.640	5.550
3253.36	4.0	Intermediate	4.740	4.400	5.420
4253.83	2.8	Long term	5.780	5.070	6.150
624.81	3.2	Double-A-rated	4.770	4.260	5.200
903.97	3.7	Triple-B-rated	5.250	4.850	5.810
High Yield Bonds ICE BofA					
591.35	3.9	High Yield Constrained	7.169	6.975	8.654
603.19	2.2	Triple-C-rated	12.486	11.050	14.946
3973.63	4.9	High Yield 100	6.228	6.208	7.793
515.34	3.7	Global High Yield Constrained	6.943	6.808	8.254
386.32	2.8	Europe High Yield Constrained	5.442	5.219	6.567
U.S Agency Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
1900.73	3.1	U.S Agency	4.300	3.960	5.000
1687.85	3.1	10-20 years	4.230	3.920	4.990
3525.86	3.1	20-plus years	5.030	4.240	5.320
2915.51	4.1	Yankee	4.760	4.380	5.360
Mortgage-Backed Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2143.71	3.7	Mortgage-Backed	5.000	4.340	5.520
2109.18	3.6	Ginnie Mae (GNMA)	5.020	4.460	5.580
1265.02	3.8	Fannie mae (FNMA)	5.000	4.310	5.500
1954.41	4.0	Freddie Mac (FHLMC)	4.830	4.150	5.450
590.20	-0.7	Muni Master	3.725	3.074	4.179
421.60	0.7	7-12 year	3.468	2.858	4.016
468.82	-2.5	12-22 year	4.430	3.469	4.704
442.19	-3.6	22-plus year	4.933	3.959	5.143
Global Government J.P. Morgan†					
553.61	1.7	Global Government	3.550	3.010	3.740
835.86	0.9	Canada	3.250	2.820	3.610
365.65	0.8	EMU§	3.088	2.726	3.403
661.99	1.0	France	3.270	2.900	3.530
469.46	-0.2	Germany	2.580	2.080	2.860
262.88	-2.7	Japan	1.910	1.220	2.040
511.98	-0.3	Netherlands	2.790	2.290	3.060
804.97	2.9	U.K.	4.710	4.030	5.070
940.51	4.8	Emerging Markets **	7.363	7.084	8.073

*Constrained indexes limit individual issuer concentrations to 2%; the High Yield 100 are the 100 largest bonds † In local currency § Euro-zone bonds

** EMBI Global Index

Sources: ICE Data Services; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; J.P.Morgan

Global Government Bonds: Mapping Yields

Yields and spreads over or under U.S. Treasurys on benchmark two-year and 10-year government bonds in selected other countries; arrows indicate whether the yield rose(▲) or fell (▼) in the latest session

Coupon (%)	Country/ Maturity, in years	Yield (%) Latest(●)	Previous	Month ago	Year ago	Spread Under/Over U.S. Treasurys, in basis points Latest	Prev	Year ago
3.875	**U.S.** 2	3.811 ▼	3.829	3.985	4.734			
4.250	10	4.291 ▼	4.321	4.508	4.248			
4.750	**Australia** 2	3.242 ▼	3.283	3.418	4.044	-57.9	-58.7	-68.8
2.750	10	4.164 ▼	4.228	4.431	4.227	-13.2	-12.1	-1.0
0.750	**France** 2	2.154 ▲	2.152	1.910	3.107	-166.8	-171.8	-162.5
3.200	10	3.252 ▲	3.231	3.279	3.130	-104.5	-111.8	-110.7
1.700	**Germany** 2	1.858 ▲	1.843	1.763	2.824	-196.3	-202.7	-190.8
2.500	10	2.547 ▲	2.510	2.572	2.422	-174.9	-183.9	-181.5
2.550	**Italy** 2	2.082 ▼	2.110	2.034	3.516	-173.9	-176.0	-121.6
3.650	10	3.467 ▼	3.482	3.605	3.928	-82.9	-86.7	-30.9
0.800	**Japan** 2	0.735	0.735	0.725	0.309	-308.6	-313.5	-442.4
1.400	10	1.420 ▲	1.411	1.549	0.991	-287.6	-293.9	-324.6
2.500	**Spain** 2	1.985 ▼	2.028	1.968	3.140	-183.6	-184.3	-159.2
3.150	10	3.136 ▼	3.142	3.205	3.289	-116	-120.7	-94.8
4.125	**U.K.** 2	3.878 ▼	3.890	3.975	4.190	5.7	2.0	-54.2
4.250	10	4.479 ▼	4.496	4.683	4.084	18.3	14.7	-15.3

Source: Tullett Prebon, Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close

Corporate Debt

Prices of firms' bonds reflect factors including investors' economic, sectoral and company-specific expectations

Investment-grade spreads that tightened the most...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Spread*, in basis points Current	One-day change	Last week
Coca–Cola	KO	3.000	5.36	March 5, '51	50	–16	62
New York Life Global Funding	...	4.400	4.00	April 25, '28	24	–13	44
John Deere Capital	...	4.950	4.09	July 14, '28	33	–8	36
Banque Federative du Credit Mutuel	...	4.753	4.49	July 13, '27	65	–7	n.a.
CSX	CSX	6.150	5.20	May 1, '37	90	–7	105
Mutual of Omaha Insurance	...	6.800	5.62	June 15, '36	132	–7	157
Toyota Motor Credit	...	5.550	4.52	Nov. 20, '30	63	–7	n.a.
American Honda Finance	...	5.125	4.47	July 7, '28	69	–6	n.a.

...And spreads that widened the most

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
American National Global Funding	...	5.250	5.19	June 3, '30	133	11	n.a.
Siemens Funding	...	4.350	4.10	May 26, '28	35	7	32
Ovintiv	OVV	6.500	6.04	Aug. 15, '34	175	6	194
Caterpillar Financial Services	...	4.375	4.31	Aug. 16, '29	41	4	n.a.
GlaxoSmithKline Capital	...	5.375	4.80	April 15, '34	50	4	55
Shell International Finance	...	6.375	5.30	Dec. 15, '38	101	4	96
Athene Global Funding*	...	5.322	5.27	Nov. 13, '31	142	3	142
John Deere Capital	...	4.700	4.37	June 10, '30	52	3	50

High-yield issues with the biggest price increases...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Bond Price as % of face value Current	One-day change	Last week
Telecom Italia Capital	...	7.200	6.53	July 18, '36	105.213	0.90	104.200
Verde Purchaser	...	10.500	7.67	Nov. 30, '30	108.352	0.75	107.200
Navient	NAVI	5.625	7.25	Aug. 1, '33	90.150	0.71	89.928
Venture Global Calcasieu Pass	...	4.125	5.74	Aug. 15, '31	91.750	0.65	91.297
Bath & Body Works	BBWI	6.875	6.59	Nov. 1, '35	102.104	0.60	100.750
Bombardier	...	7.450	6.19	May 1, '34	108.500	0.53	107.409
Sealed Air	SEE	6.875	5.83	July 15, '33	106.660	0.41	106.398
Walgreen	...	4.400	5.20	Sept. 15, '42	91.000	0.31	90.250

...And with the biggest price decreases

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
Transocean	RIG	6.800	11.16	March 15, '38	70.750	–3.63	75.250
Paramount Global	PARA	4.375	7.11	March 15, '43	72.695	–0.14	72.068
Prime Security Services Borrower	...	5.750	5.29	April 15, '26	100.354	–0.02	100.375
FiberCop	...	6.375	6.83	Nov. 15, '33	97.143		97.000

*Estimated spread over 2-year, 3-year, 5-year, 10-year or 30-year hot-run Treasury; 100 basis points=one percentage pt.; change in spread shown is for Z-spread.
Note: Data are for the most active issue of bonds with maturities of two years or more

Source: MarketAxess

Exchange-Traded Portfolios | wsj.com/market-data/mutualfunds-etfs

Largest 100 exchange-traded funds. Preliminary close data as of 4:30 p.m. ET

Tuesday, June 24, 2025

ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)
CommSvsSPDR	XLC	105.23	1.29	8.7
CnsmrDiscSel	XLY	215.59	0.56	-3.9
DimenUSCoreEq2	DFAC	35.25	1.02	1.9
EnSelSectorSPDR	XLE	84.91	-1.30	-0.9
FidWiseBTC	FBTC	92.23	2.35	13.1
FinSelSectorSPDR	XLF	51.58	1.50	6.7
HealthCrSelSect	XLV	133.78	1.23	-2.8
IndSelSectorSPDR	XLI	145.06	0.83	10.1
InvscNasd100	QQQM	222.15	1.53	5.6
InvscQQQI	QQQ	539.78	1.53	5.6
InvscS&P500EW	RSP	180.18	0.95	2.8
iShBitcoin	IBIT	60.06	2.37	13.2
iShBrdUSDHYCpBd	USHY	37.31	0.26	1.4
iShCoreDivGrowth	DGRO	63.23	0.75	3.1
iShCoreMSCIEAFE	IEFA	81.95	1.16	16.6
iShCoreMSCIEM	IEMG	59.51	2.52	14.0
iShCoreMSCITotInt	IXUS	76.24	1.49	15.3
iShCoreS&P500	IVV	609.51	1.09	3.5
iShCoreS&P MC	IJH	61.53	0.92	-1.3
iShCoreS&P SC	IJR	108.64	1.00	-5.7
iShCoreS&PTotUS	ITOT	132.72	1.19	3.2
iShCoreS&PUSGrw	IUSG	146.94	1.42	5.4
iShCoreS&PUSVal	IUSV	93.59	0.75	1.1
iShCoreTotUSDBd	IUSB	46.02	0.33	1.8
iShCoreUSAggBd	AGG	98.82	0.41	2.0
iShEdgeMSCIMinUSA	USMV	93.15	0.52	4.9
iShEdgeMSCIUSAQual	QUAL	179.61	1.13	0.9
iShGoldTr	IAU	62.68	-1.55	26.6
iShiBoxx$IGCpBd	LQD	108.92	0.47	1.9
iShMBS	MBB	93.52	0.52	2.0
iShMSCIACWI	ACWI	126.50	1.32	7.7
iShMSCI EAFE	EFA	88.04	1.22	16.4
iShMSCIEAFEValue	EFV	62.75	0.98	19.6
iShNatlMuniBd	MUB	104.21	0.12	-2.2
iSh1-5YIGCpBd	IGSB	52.63	0.15	1.8
iSh1-3YTreaBd	SHY	82.72	0.08	0.9
iShRussMC	IWR	91.34	1.15	3.3
iShRuss1000	IWB	333.50	1.10	3.5
iShRuss1000Grw	IWF	414.00	1.45	3.1
iShRuss1000Val	IWD	192.57	0.83	4.0
iShRuss2000	IWM	214.47	1.27	-2.9
iShS&P500Grw	IVW	107.48	1.47	5.9
iShS&P500Value	IVE	193.13	0.76	1.2
iSh7-10YTreaBd	IEF	95.26	0.35	3.0
iShShortTreaBd	SHV	110.35	0.01	0.2
iSh20+YTreaBd	TLT	87.40	0.73	0.1
iShUSTreasuryBd	GOVT	22.87	0.26	-0.5
iSh0-3MTreaBd	SGOV	100.63	0.01	0.3
JPMNasdEqPrem	JEPQ	53.76	1.01	-4.6
JanusHendersonAAA	JAAA	50.70	-0.04	-0.0
JPM EqPrem	JEPI	56.57	0.78	-1.7
JPM UltShIncm	JPST	50.61	0.02	0.5
PacerUSCashCows	COWZ	54.72	0.37	-3.1
ProShUltPrQQQ	TQQQ	78.10	4.55	-1.3
SPDRBbg1-3MTB	BIL	91.66	...	0.3
SPDR DJIA Tr	DIA	430.79	1.19	1.2
SPDR Gold	GLD	306.19	-1.57	26.5
SPDRPtfDevxUS	SPDW	39.89	1.42	16.9
SPDRS&P500Value	SPYV	51.77	0.76	1.2
SPDRPtfS&P500	SPLG	71.59	1.13	3.8
SPDRS&P500Growth	SPYG	93.03	1.47	5.8
SPDR S&P 500	SPY	606.78	1.10	3.5
SchwabIntEquity	SCHF	21.92	1.34	18.5
SchwabUS BrdMkt	SCHB	23.48	1.12	3.4
SchwabUS Div	SCHD	26.74	0.15	-2.1
SchwabUS LC	SCHX	24.12	1.22	4.1
SchwabUS LC Grw	SCHG	28.54	1.49	2.4
SPDR S&PMdCpTr	MDY	562.22	0.92	-1.3
TechSelectSector	XLK	247.24	1.80	6.3
VanEckSemicon	SMH	271.54	3.67	12.1
VangdSC Val	VBR	194.45	0.83	-1.9
VangdExtMkt	VXF	191.18	1.43	0.6
VangdDivApp	VIG	203.03	1.00	3.7
VangdFTSEAWxUS	VEU	66.33	1.52	15.5
VangdFTSEDevMk	VEA	56.15	1.32	17.4
VangdFTSE EM	VWO	48.99	2.17	11.2
VangdFTSE Europe	VGK	76.43	1.33	20.4
VangdGrowth	VUG	428.36	1.49	4.4
VangdHiDiv	VYM	131.62	0.77	3.2
VangdInfoTech	VGT	646.58	1.80	4.0
VangdIntermBd	BIV	76.95	0.31	3.0
VangdIntrCorpBd	VCIT	82.45	0.40	2.7
VangdIntermTrea	VGIT	59.56	0.25	2.7
VangdLC	VV	280.89	1.16	4.1
VangdMegaGrwth	MGK	357.85	1.43	4.2
VangdMC	VO	277.79	0.94	5.2
VangdRealEst	VNQ	91.42	0.26	2.6
VangdRuss1000Grw	VONG	106.52	1.45	3.1
VangdS&P500ETF	VOO	559.44	1.10	3.8
VangdST Bond	BSV	78.54	0.18	1.6
VangdSTCpBd	VCSH	79.31	0.18	1.7
VangdShortTrea	VGSH	58.68	0.10	0.9
VangdSC	VB	236.16	1.09	-1.7
VangdTaxExemptBd	VTEB	48.91	...	-2.4
VangdTotalBd	BND	73.28	0.30	1.9
VangdTotIntlBd	BNDX	49.47	0.02	0.9
VangdTotIntlStk	VXUS	68.14	1.52	15.6
VangdTotalStk	VTI	299.71	1.17	3.4
VangdTotWrldStk	VT	126.49	1.26	7.7
VangdValue	VTV	175.92	0.74	3.9

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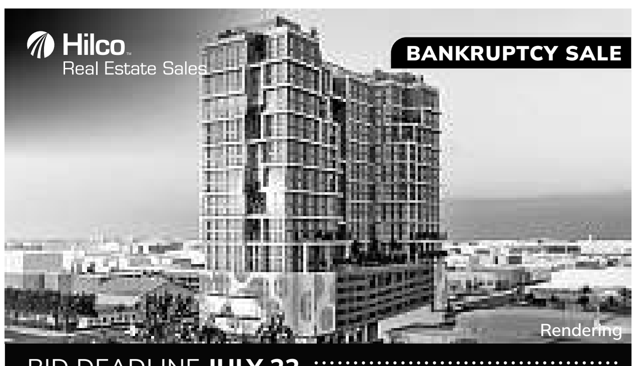

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Subject to approval by U.S. Bankruptcy Court District of Florida (Miami).
Petition No: 1:25-bk-11136-LMI | *In re:* Sky Gardens Residences, LLC.

ILLINOIS

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AUGUST 12, 2025

135,000 SQ. FT. INDUSTRIAL/COMMERCIAL FENCED-IN COMPLEX ON 24.97 ACRES
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The property is in a high-traffic area with many nearby commercial and residential properties. One-story brick and steel frame building with many sections built between 1919 and 1984. Ceiling heights over 25 ft. in parts of the building and numerous overhead doors. Currently used for RV, boat, vehicle and miscellaneous storage. Current income approximately $150,000 annually from some full-time, and some seasonal tenants, approximately $12,000 annual taxes. Substantial upside potential as much of the property is underutilized.

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PUBLIC NOTICES

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT, DISTRICT OF NEW JERSEY

IN RE BECTON, DICKINSON AND COMPANY STOCKHOLDER DERIVATIVE LITIGATION

Master File No. 2:20-cv-15474-SRC-CLW

SUMMARY NOTICE OF PENDENCY AND PROPOSED SETTLEMENT OF STOCKHOLDER ACTION

SUMMARY NOTICE OF PENDENCY AND PROPOSED SETTLEMENT OF STOCKHOLDER ACTION

TO: ALL RECORD AND BENEFICIAL OWNERS OF BECTON, DICKINSON AND COMPANY ("BD") COMMON STOCK AS OF JUNE 5, 2025, EXCLUDING THE INDIVIDUAL DEFENDANTS, THE OFFICERS AND DIRECTORS OF BD, MEMBERS OF THEIR IMMEDIATE FAMILIES, AND ANY ENTITY IN WHICH INDIVIDUAL DEFENDANTS HAVE OR HAD A CONTROLLING INTEREST ("CURRENT BD STOCKHOLDERS").

THIS NOTICE IS GIVEN pursuant to an order of the U.S. District Court for the District of New Jersey (the "Court"), to inform you of a proposed stipulated settlement (the "Settlement") in the above-captioned derivative action (the "Consolidated Federal Derivative Action") and substantially similar actions defined collectively with the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action in a Stipulation of Settlement dated June 5, 2025 ("Stipulation") as the "Derivative Actions." The Derivative Actions involve claims filed by stockholders derivatively on behalf of BD against certain of its officers and directors alleging breaches of fiduciary duties relating to alleged misstatements in certain of BD's filings with Securities and Exchange Commission and other public statements prior to February 2020. The Consolidated Federal Derivative Action also involves claims for unjust enrichment, contribution under the Sections 10(b) and 21D of the Securities Exchange Act, insider selling and violations of Section 14(a) of the Securities Exchange Act.

Defendants, individually and collectively, have denied and continue to deny each and all of the allegations, claims and contentions in the Derivative Action, including all charges of fault, wrongdoing or liability arising out of any of the conduct, statements, acts or omissions alleged, or that could have been alleged, in the Derivative Action. Nonetheless, Defendants have agreed to the Settlement on the terms and subject to the conditions in the Stipulation. Under the terms of the Stipulation, BD has agreed that within sixty (60) days of the Effective Date (as defined in the Stipulation), BD will adopt certain corporate governance modifications ("Modifications"), which BD shall maintain for a period of not less than four (4) years. In addition, within twenty (20) business days of the order preliminarily approving the Settlement, BD's Directors & Officers insurance carriers will cause the sum of $9,000,000 (the "Settlement Fund") to be paid into a settlement account, the balance of which, after deduction of notice costs and any Fee and Expense Amount and Service Awards (as defined in the Stipulation), Plaintiffs' counsel will cause to be paid to the Company within ten (10) business days of the Effective Date. The Parties agree that the initiation, pendency and settlement of the Derivative Actions, and the Plaintiffs' efforts in connection therewith, were the cause of the Settlement Fund and a material factor in the implementation of the Modifications. The Parties further agree that the Modifications confer a material benefit on the Company and that the Settlement is in all respects fair, reasonable, and in the best interests of the Company and its stockholders.

In connection with a motion for final approval of the Settlement, Plaintiffs' counsel will seek approval of the Fee and Expense Amount in the amount of $3,470,000, to be paid out of the Settlement Fund. Plaintiffs' counsel may also apply on behalf of Plaintiffs for Service Awards of $5,000 in recognition of Plaintiffs' participation and efforts in the prosecution of the Derivative Actions (as defined in the Stipulation), to be funded from the Fee and Expense Amount.

YOU ARE HEREBY NOTIFIED THAT a hearing (the "Settlement Hearing") will be held on August 11, 2025, at 10:00 a.m., before the Honorable U.S. District Judge Stanley R. Chesler of the U.S. District Court for the District of New Jersey, in Courtroom 2 at the Martin Luther King Building & U.S. Courthouse, 50 Walnut Street Newark, NJ 07102, for the purpose of determining whether the Settlement should be approved as fair, reasonable, and adequate and whether the Fee and Expense Amount, including the Service Awards, should be approved. The Court may decide to approve the Settlement without a hearing and without further notice to BD stockholders or move the Settlement Hearing to Zoom or another similar virtual platform without further notice to BD stockholders.

As this is a stockholder derivative action brought for the benefit of BD, no individual Current BD Stockholder has the right to receive any individual compensation as a result of the Settlement. This is not a "class action." Thus, there is no common fund upon which you can make a claim for a monetary payment.

IF YOU ARE AN OWNER OF BD COMMON STOCK, YOUR RIGHTS MAY BE AFFECTED BY THE SETTLEMENT. This notice contains only a summary of the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action and the terms of the Settlement. The terms and conditions of the proposed Settlement are set forth fully in the Stipulation described above. If you are a Current BD Stockholder, you may obtain a copy of a detailed notice to Current BD Stockholders (the "Notice") describing the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action, the proposed Settlement, and the rights of Current BD Stockholders with regard to the Settlement, as well as a copy of the Stipulation, by visiting the website https://investors.bd.com/.

Should you have any other questions regarding the proposed Settlement, please contact the following counsel for Plaintiffs:

ROBBINS LLP	GLANCY PRONGAY & MURRAY LLP	DILWORTH PAXSON LLP	HERMAN JONES LLP
BRIAN J. ROBBINS CRAIG W. SMITH SHANE P. SANDERS 5060 Shoreham Place, Suite 300 San Diego, CA 92122 Telephone: (619) 525-3990 Facsimile: (619) 525-3991 brobbins@robbinsllp.com csmith@robbinsllp.com ssanders@robbinsllp.com *Counsel for Plaintiff Jeff Schranz and Co-Lead Counsel for Plaintiffs in the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action*	BENJAMIN I. SACHS-MICHAELS MATTHEW M. HOUSTON 745 Fifth Avenue, Fifth Floor, New York, NY 10151 Telephone: (212) 935-7400 Facsimile: (212) 756-3630 bsachsmichaels@glancylaw.com mhouston@glancylaw.com ROBERT V. PRONGAY PAVITHRA RAJESH 1925 Century Park East, Suite 2100, Los Angeles, CA 90067 Telephone: (310) 201-9150 rprongay@glancylaw.com, prajesh@glancylaw.com *Counsel for Plaintiff Ronald Jankowski and Co-Lead Counsel for Plaintiffs in the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action*	LISA J. RODRIGUEZ 1500 Market Street, Suite 3500E Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19102 Tel: (856) 675-1926 lrodriguez@dilworthlaw.com *Counsel for Plaintiff Ronald Jankowski and Co-Liaison Counsel for Plaintiffs in the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action and Counsel for Plaintiff Agnes Lotz in the Consolidated State Court Action*	SERINA M. VASH 153 Central Avenue #131 Westfield, NJ 07090 Telephone: (404) 504-6516 Facsimile: (404) 504-6501 svash@hermanjones.com *Counsel for Plaintiff Jeff Schranz and Co-Liaison Counsel for Plaintiffs in the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action*

Any Current BD Stockholder may object and/or appear and show cause, if he, she, or it has any concern, why the Settlement should not be finally approved as fair, reasonable, and adequate, why the Judgment should not be entered thereon, or why the Fee and Expense Amount and any Service Awards should not be finally approved; provided, however, that unless otherwise ordered by the Court, no Current BD Stockholders shall be heard or entitled to contest the approval of the terms and conditions of the Settlement, or, if approved, the Judgment to be entered approving the Settlement, or the Fee and Expense Amount, or Service Awards, unless that stockholder has filed ***at least fourteen (14) days prior to the Settlement Hearing*** an objection with the Court. Any objection to the Settlement, the Fee and Expense Amount, or the Service Awards must be filed, in accordance with the procedures set forth in the Notice, with the Clerk of the Court (Honorable U.S. District Judge Stanley R. Chesler of the U.S. District Court for the District of New Jersey, in Courtroom 2 at the Martin Luther King Building & U.S. Courthouse, 50 Walnut Street Newark, NJ 07102), no later than July 28, 2025, and served by hand or first class mail (postage prepaid) for delivery by the same date on counsel for the Federal Derivative Action Plaintiffs (at the addresses listed above) and on counsel for Defendants (at the addresses listed below):

ROBBINS LLP	GLANCY PRONGAY & MURRAY LLP	DILWORTH PAXSON LLP
BRIAN J. ROBBINS CRAIG W. SMITH SHANE P. SANDERS 5060 Shoreham Place, Suite 300 San Diego, CA 92122 Telephone: (619) 525-3990 Facsimile: (619) 525-3991 brobbins@robbinsllp.com csmith@robbinsllp.com ssanders@robbinsllp.com *Counsel for Plaintiff Jeff Schranz and Co-Lead Counsel for Plaintiffs in the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action*	BENJAMIN I. SACHS-MICHAELS MATTHEW M. HOUSTON 745 Fifth Avenue, Fifth Floor, New York, NY 10151 Telephone: (212) 935-7400 bsachsmichaels@glancylaw.com mhouston@glancylaw.com ROBERT V. PRONGAY PAVITHRA RAJESH 1925 Century Park East, Suite 2100, Los Angeles, CA 90067 Telephone: (310) 201-9150 rprongay@glancylaw.com, prajesh@glancylaw.com *Counsel for Plaintiff Ronald Jankowski and Co-Lead Counsel for Plaintiffs in the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action*	LISA J. RODRIGUEZ 1500 Market Street, Suite 3500E Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19102 Tel: (856) 675-1926 lrodriguez@dilworthlaw.com *Counsel for Plaintiff Ronald Jankowski and Co-Liaison Counsel for Plaintiffs in the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action and Counsel for Plaintiff Agnes Lotz in the Consolidated State Court Action*

HERMAN JONES LLP	WINSTON & STRAWN LLP	McCARTER & ENGLISH LLP
SERINA M. VASH 153 Central Avenue #131 Westfield, NJ 07090 Telephone: (404) 504-6516 Facsimile: (404) 504-6501 svash@hermanjones.com *Counsel for Plaintiff Jeff Schranz and Co-Liaison Counsel for Plaintiffs in the Consolidated Federal Derivative Action*	JAMES P. SMITH III MATTHEW DIRISIO 200 Park Avenue New York, New York 10166 Tel: (212) 294-6700 jpsmith@winston.com mdirisio@winston.com	MATTHEW A. SKLAR Four Gateway Center 100 Mulberry Street, Newark, New Jersey 07102 Tel: (973) 624-4444 msklar@mccarter.com *Counsel for Nominal Defendant Becton, Dickinson and Company, and Defendants Vincent A. Forlenza, Thomas E. Polen, Christopher R. Reidy, Catherine M. Burzik, R. Andrew Eckert, Claire M. Fraser, Jeffrey W. Henderson, Christopher Jones, Marshall O. Larsen, David F. Melcher, Claire Pomeroy, Rebecca W. Rimel, Timothy M. Ring, and Bertram L. Scott*

PLEASE DO NOT CALL OR WRITE THE COURT, BD, OR THE INDIVIDUAL DEFENDANTS REGARDING THIS NOTICE.

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COMMERCIAL REAL ESTATE

NOTICE OF FORECLOSURE SALE OF REAL PROPERTY - MANHATTAN

UNITED STATES DISTRICT COURT, SOUTHERN DISTRICT OF NEW YORK

WILMINGTON TRUST, NATIONAL ASSOCIATION, AS TRUSTEE FOR THE BENEFIT OF THE REGISTERED HOLDERS OF WELLS FARGO COMMERCIAL MORTGAGE TRUST 2018 C44, COMMERCIAL MORTGAGE PASS THROUGH CERTIFICATES, SERIES 2018 C44, acting by and through its special servicer, Rialto Capital Advisors, LLC, as Special Servicer under the Pooling and Servicing Agreement dated as of May 1, 2018, Plaintiff against 31 PRINCE STREET, LLC, et al., Defendant(s). Pursuant to that certain Order & Judgment ("Judgment") entered herein and dated May 29, 2025, I, the undersigned Referee, with the assistance of Auctioneer, will sell at public auction outside the main entrance of 31 Prince Street a/k/a 242-244 Mott Street, New York, New York 10012 on July 24th, 2025 at 3:00 p.m. Prevailing Eastern Time, the following Property.

PARCEL A: Situated, lying and being in the Borough of Manhattan, County, City and State of New York, Parcel A is bounded and described as follows: BEGINNING at a point formed by the intersection of the northerly side of Prince Street with the easterly side of Mott Street; RUNNING THENCE northerly along the said easterly side of Mott Street, 79 feet 2 inches; THENCE in an easterly direction, 27 feet 6 3/4 inches to a point, distant 82 feet 6 1/2 inches northerly from the northerly side of Prince Street, measured on a line drawn parallel to Mott Street, and intersecting the northerly side of Prince Street, at a point distant 27 feet 11 1/4 inches measured in an easterly direction from the northeasterly corner of Mott Street and Prince Street; THENCE southerly along said line drawn parallel with Mott Street, and part of the way through party walls, 82 feet 6 1/2 inches to the said northerly side of Prince Street; THENCE westerly along the said northerly side of Prince Street, 27 feet 11 1/4 inches to the point or place of BEGINNING. Block: 508 Lot: 53.

Parcel A is known as 31 PRINCE STREET a/k/a 242 244 MOTT STREET, NEW YORK, NY 10012 ("Parcel A").

PARCEL B: Situated, lying being in the Borough of Manhattan, County, City and State of New York, Parcel B is bounded and described as follows: BEGINNING at the corner formed by the intersection of the southerly side of Prince Street and the easterly side of Mulberry Street; RUNNING THENCE easterly along the southerly side of Prince Street a distance of 25 feet 4 inches to a point; THENCE southerly along a line forming an angle of 101 degrees 53 minutes 00 seconds on its westerly side with the southerly side of Prince Street a distance of 69 feet 5 inches to a point; THENCE westerly along a line forming an angle of 90 degrees 51 minutes 00 seconds on its northerly side with the last mentioned course a distance of 24 feet 10 inches to a point on the easterly side of Mulberry Street; THENCE northerly along the easterly side of Mulberry Street, a distance of 75 feet to the corner formed by the intersection of the southerly side of Prince Street and the easterly side of Mulberry, the point or place of BEGINNING. Block: 494 Lot: 14.

Parcel B is known as 46 PRINCE STREET a/k/a 250 MULBERRY STREET, NEW YORK, NY 10012 ("Parcel B").

PARCEL C: Situated, lying and being in the Borough of Manhattan, County, City and State of New York, Parcel C is bounded and described as follows: BEGINNING at the point of intersection of the southerly side of Spring Street with the westerly side of Mulberry Street; RUNNING THENCE westerly along the southerly side of Spring Street, 25 feet 3 inches (25 feet 11 inches per survey); THENCE southerly on a line parallel or nearly so parallel with Mulberry Street, 98 feet 9 inches (99 feet 2 inches per survey); THENCE easterly at right angles or near at right angles with Mulberry Street, 25 feet (25 feet 3 inches per survey) to Mulberry Street; THENCE northerly along the westerly side of Mulberry Street, 93 feet (93 feet 3-3/4 inches per survey) to the point or place of BEGINNING. Said premises being known as and distinguished by lot number 1063, heretofore conveyed by Nicholas Bayard and wife to Philip Livingston and others, bounded in front on Spring Street, east by Mulberry Street, on the south by lot number 1062 and on the west by lot number 1064, as and by the map or chart thereof may appear. Block: 481 Lot: 22.

Parcel C is known as 48 SPRING STREET a/k/a 207 211 MULBERRY STREET, NEW YORK, NY 10012 ("Parcel C").

Interested bidders must appear at the aforementioned location, time, and day of the public auction with at least ten percent (10%) of the sum bid, with all certified and bank checks made payable to "Richard J. Madison, as referee." Interested bidders who do not appear with funds, pursuant to Judgment, may not be permitted to bid or otherwise participate in the auction.

The approximate amount of the lien, pursuant to Judgment, is $60,539,920.44 plus default interest & costs.

Parcel A, Parcel B, and Parcel C, collectively the Property ("Property"), will be sold together as a single parcel and is further subject to the provisions of the filed Judgment and forthcoming terms of sale.

Case Number 22-cv-5855 (JGK).

Richard J. Madison, court appointed Referee

Matthew D. Mannion, of Mannion Auctions, LLC, court appointed Auctioneer

Holland & Knight, LLP, as Attorney(s) for Plaintiff

787 Seventh Avenue, 31st Floor

New York, New York 10019

SECURED PARTY'S SALE AT PUBLIC AUCTION

Sale of Loan Secured By Former Marriott Courtyard Hotel

THURSDAY, JUNE 26, 2025 AT 11:00 AM EASTERN TIME at

Riemer & Braunstein LLP

Time Square Tower, Suite 2506 | Seven Times Square | New York, New York 10036

All right, title and interest of BC2 Beaumont LLC, a Delaware limited liability company, in and to a certain loan arrangement between BC2 Beaumont LLC, as lender, and Dave Raj Brothers LP, a Texas limited partnership, as borrower, in the original principal amount of $7,250,000, including a Deed of Trust, Security Agreement and Financing Statement with respect to real property located at 2275 Interstate 10 South, Beaumont, Texas.

For Further Information Please Visit www.re-auctions.com

Terms of Sale: $250,000.00 deposit in certified or bank cashier's check will be required at the time and place of the sale in order to qualify as a bidder. If you wish to bid remotely then the deposit must be wired to the auctioneer prior to bidding. The balance will be due within 30 days at the offices of the Attorney for the Mortgagee: Phillip J Block, Riemer & Braunstein LLP, 71 South Wacker Drive, Suite 3515 | Chicago, Illinois 60606.

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NOTICE OF SALE
SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

RREF IV – D DLI GS, LLC, Plaintiff, -against- HFZ EAST 51ST STREET RETAIL OWNER LLC, HFZ CAPITAL GROUP LLC, BOARD OF MANAGERS OF HALCYON CONDOMINIUM, EAST 51st STREET DEVELOPMENT COMPANY LLC, 968 KINGSMEN, LLC, JAMES KENNELLY, NEW YORK CITY DEPARTMENT OF FINANCE, NEW YORK STATE DEPARTMENT OF TAXATION AND FINANCE, PERCIBALLI INDUSTRIES, INC., GILLMAN CONSULTING INC., UNITED STATES INFORMATION SYSTEMS INC., TRITON CONSTRUCTION COMPANY LLC, DESIMONE CONSULTING ENGINEERING PC, Defendants. Index No. 850126/2022. PLEASE TAKE NOTICE that pursuant to that certain Final Judgment of Foreclosure and Sale dated May 15, 2025 and entered herein on May 19, 2025, the court-appointed Referee will sell at public auction in Room 130 of the New York County Courthouse, Supreme Court, 60 Centre Street, New York, New York 10007 on July 23, 2025 at 2:15 p.m. that certain premises situate, lying and being in the Borough of Manhattan, County, City and State of New York, more particularly bounded and described as follows: The Condominium Units (the "Units") in the Building known as Halcyon Condominium (the "Building"), located at and known as and by Street Number 303 East 51st Street, New York, NY, designated and described as Unit GAR and RET1 in the Declaration establishing a plan for condominium ownership of said Building and the Land upon which it is situate (the "Land") under Article 9-B of the Real Property Law of the State of New York, dated 3/20/2015 and recorded on 5/4/2015 in the Office of the Register of the City of New York, Couty of New York (the "City Register's Office") under CRFN 2015000148440, said Units also being designated as Tax Lots 1201 and 1202 in Block 1344 of Section 5 of the Borough of Manhattan on the Tax Map of the Real Property Assessment Department of the City of New York (the "Assessment Department") and on the Floor Plans of the said Building filed in the Assessment Department as Condominium Plan No. 2590 and also filed in the City Register's Office on 5/4/2015 as Condominium Map filed under CRFN 2015000148441. TOGETHER, with an undivided 4.6830 percent and 9.7255 percent interest respectively in Common Elements of the Condominium as described in the Declaration. The Land on which the Building containing the Unit is situate is bounded and described as follows: ALL the certain plot, piece or parcel of land, situate, lying and being in the Borough of Manhattan, City, County and State of New York, bounded and described as follows: BEGINNING at the corner formed by the intersection of the northerly side of East 51st Street with the easterly side of Second Avenue; RUNNING THENCE northerly along the easterly side of Second Avenue, 125 feet 5 inches; THENCE easterly parallel with East 51st Street, 100 feet; THENCE southerly parallel with Second Avenue, 25 feet 5 inches (25 feet per tax map); THENCE easterly parallel with East 51st Street, 25 feet; THENCE southerly parallel with Second Avenue, 100 feet to the northerly side of East 51st Street (100 feet five inches tax map); THENCE westerly and along the northerly side of East 51st Street, 125 feet to the point or place of BEGINNING. Said premises to be sold by the undersigned is known as and located at 305 EAST 51ST STREET, UNITS GAR AND RET 1, NEW YORK, NEW YORK a/k/a Block 1344, Lots 1201 and 1202 (the "Premises") together with an undivided 4.6830 percent and 9.7255 percent interest respectively in common elements of the Condominium known as the HALCYON CONDOMINIUM. The approximate amount of lien pursuant to the Final Judgment of Foreclosure and Sal is in the amount of $29,913,652.38 plus interest and costs. The Premises will be sold subject to provisions of the Final Judgment of Foreclosure and Sale and Terms of Sale. HOWARD W. KINGSLEY, ESQ., Court Appointed Referee. Dated: New York, New York, May 29, 2025 HOLLAND & KNIGHT LLP By: /s/ Maximiliano Rinaldi Keith M. Brandofino, Maximilano Rinaldi Dani Estis Attorneys for Plaintiff, 787 Seventh Avenue, New York, New York 10019 (212) 751-3001
keith.brandofino@hklaw.com
maximilano.rinaldi@hklaw.com
dani.estis@hklaw.com

NOTIFICATION OF PUBLIC DISPOSITION OF COLLATERAL

PLEASE TAKE NOTICE THAT, for default in payment of a debt and performance of obligations owed by 788 9th Commercial LLC ("Debtor") to SIG CRE 2023 Venture LLC ("Secured Party"), pursuant to Section 9-610 of the Uniform Commercial Code, at 12:30 p.m. (prevailing Eastern Time), on July 15, 2025, adjourned from its originally scheduled date of June 17, 2025, simultaneously via Zoom (or a similar online platform) and in person at the law offices of Reed Smith LLP, 599 Lexington Avenue, 22nd Floor, New York NY 10022, Secured Party shall sell at public auction to the highest qualified bidder for cash Debtor's interest in the following collateral, defined below or some portion thereof (the "Collateral"): The Cooperative Interest (as such term is defined in section 9-102 of the Uniform Commercial Code (or any successor statute) of the State of New York (the "UCC") or of any other state the laws of which are required by the UCC to be applied in connection with the issue of perfection of security interests) as allocated to 30 cooperative shares of capital stock (the "Shares") of Amblunthorp Holding Inc. (the "Lessor") and an assignment of proprietary lease (the "Lease") by and between the Lessor as landlord and the 788 9th Commercial LLC as tenant covering the commercial cooperative unit known as CU1 (the "Unit") at the building located at 788 9th Avenue, New York, New York 10019, Block 1043, Lot 3 (the "Premises") and any and all replacements of, additions to, substitutions for or amendments of the Lease and Shares, together with, in each case, the proceeds thereof.

All parties seeking to submit a bid at the sale must deliver a deposit in one of the following two ways: (i) by way of a wire payment in immediately available funds at least two (2) business days prior to the sale by delivering to Reed Smith LLP, as escrow agent, a wire in an amount equal to at least ten percent (10%) of the successful bid amount OR (ii) by displaying to the auctioneer a bank, certified check, or money order (no endorsed checks, personal checks, or endorsed money orders will be accepted) in an amount equal to at least ten percent (10%) of the successful bid amount. No cash will be accepted for any portion of the required deposit. All payments and final settlements by way of check or money order must be made payable to "Reed Smith LLP, as escrow agent." Unless proper funds have been verified, you will not be permitted to bid. The balance of the successful bid is payable at closing, which shall be held within thirty (30) days of the auction date, time being of the essence. For wire instructions, you must contact the undersigned. Secured Party reserves the right to reject all bids and terminate or adjourn the sale to another time or place without further publication, and further reserves the right to bid for the Collateral at the sale and to credit bid by applying some or all of its secured debt to the purchase price. For further information you may contact James Faller
(Tel: 212-549-4658;
Email: james.faller@reedsmith.com).

BANKRUPTCIES

IN THE UNITED STATES BANKRUPTCY COURT
FOR THE NORTHERN DISTRICT OF TEXAS, DALLAS DIVISION

In re: Higher Ground Education, Inc., *et al.*,[1] Debtor.	§ Chapter 11 § Case No.: 25-80121-11 (MVL) § (Jointly Administered)

NOTICE OF DEADLINE TO FILE PROOF OF CLAIM

TO ALL PERSONS OR ENTITIES WHO MAY HAVE CLAIMS AGAINST THE ABOVE-CAPTIONED DEBTORS:

On June 17, 2025 and June 18, 2025 (collectively, the "**Petition Date**"), Higher Ground Education, Inc. ("**HGE**") and its affiliated debtors and debtors in possession (collectively, the "**Debtors**") in the above-captioned chapter 11 cases (the "**Chapter 11 Cases**"), filed voluntary petitions for relief under chapter 11 of Title 11 of the United States Code (the "**Bankruptcy Code**") in the United States Bankruptcy Court for the Northern District of Texas (the "**Court**"), thereby initiating the Chapter 11 Cases and creating their respective bankruptcy estates (the "**Estates**"). Set forth below are the name, case number, and last four digits of the federal tax identification number for each of the Debtors, if applicable.

Debtor, Case Number, EID # (Last 4 Digits): Higher Ground Education, Inc., 25-80121, 7265; Guidepost A LLC, 25-80122, 8540; Prepared Montessorian LLC, 25-80123, 6181; Terra Firma Services LLC, 25-80124, 6999; Guidepost Birmingham LLC, 25-80125, 2397; Guidepost Bradley Hills LLC, 25-80126, 2058; Guidepost Branchburg LLC, 25-80127, 0494; Guidepost Carmel LLC, 25-80128, 4060; Guidepost FIC B LLC, 25-80129, 8609; Guidepost FIC C LLC, 25-80130, 1518; Guidepost Goodyear LLC, 25-80131, 1363; Guidepost Las Colinas LLC, 25-80132, 9767; Guidepost Leawood LLC, 25-80133, 3453; Guidepost Muirfield Village LLC, 25-80134, 1889; Guidepost Richardson LLC, 25-80135, 7111; Guidepost South Riding LLC, 25-80136, 2403; Guidepost St. Robert LLC, 25-80137, 5136; Guidepost The Woodlands LLC, 25-80138, 6101; Guidepost Walled Lake LLC, 25-80139, 9118; HGE FIC D LLC, 25-80140, 6499; HGE FIC E LLC, 25-80141, 0056; HGE FIC F LLC, 25-80142, 8861; HGE FIC G LLC, 25-80143, 5500; HGE FIC H LLC, 25-80144, 8817; HGE FIC I LLC, 25-80145, 1138; HGE FIC K LLC, 25-80145, 8558; HGE FIC L LLC, 25-80147, 2052; HGE FIC M LLC, 25-80148, 8912; HGE FIC N LLC, 25-80149, 6774; HGE FIC O LLC, 25-80150, 4678; HGE FIC P LLC, 25-80151, 1477; HGE FIC Q LLC, 25-80152, 3122; HGE FIC R LLC, 25-80153, 9661; LePort Emeryville LLC, 25-80154, 7324; AltSchool II LLC, 25-80155, 0403

On June 20, 2025, the Court entered an order [Docket No. 57] (the "**Bar Date Order**") in the Chapter 11 Cases establishing certain deadlines for filing proofs of claim. Pursuant to the Bar Date Order, the Court has established:

- **August 7, 2025**, as the general bar date for filing prepetition claims in the Debtors' Chapter 11 Cases (the "**General Claims Bar Date**");
- **December 15, 2025**, as the bar date for Governmental Units to file proofs of claim (the "**Governmental Bar Date**"); and
- the later of (i) the General Bar Date or the Governmental Bar Date, as applicable, and (ii) the date that is 30 days following service of an order approving the rejection of any executory contract or unexpired lease of the Debtors as the bar date for claimants asserting claims resulting from the Debtors' rejection of an executory contract or unexpired to file proofs of claim for damages arising from such rejection (the "**Rejection Damages Bar Date**").
- the later of (a) the General Bar Date or (b) on the date that is twenty-one (21) days from the date that the Debtors provide written notice to the affected creditor that the Schedules have been amended (the "**Amended Schedules Bar Date**").

As used in this notice, the term "**claim**" means, as to or against any of the Debtors and in accordance with section 101(5) of the Bankruptcy Code: (i) any right to payment, whether or not such right is reduced to judgment, liquidated, unliquidated, fixed, contingent, matured, unmatured, disputed, undisputed, legal, equitable, secured, or unsecured; or (ii) any right to an equitable remedy for breach of performance if such breach gives rise to a right to payment, whether or not such right to an equitable remedy is reduced to judgment, fixed, contingent, matured, unmatured, disputed, undisputed, secured, or unsecured.

As used in this notice, the term "**entity**" has the meaning given to it in section 101(15) of the Bankruptcy Code and includes all persons, estates, trusts, and governmental units. In addition, the terms "persons" and "governmental units" are defined in sections 101(41) and 101(27) of the Bankruptcy Code, respectively.

THE BAR DATES. The Bar Date Order establishes the following bar dates for filing claims in the Chapter 11 Cases (collectively, the "**Bar Dates**"):

General Claims Bar Date. Pursuant to the Bar Date Order, except as described below, all persons or entities other than governmental units that hold claims (whether secured, unsecured, priority, or unsecured nonpriority, including section 503(b)(9) claims) against the Debtors that arose before the Petition Date must file proofs of claim so as to be **received on or before the General Bar Date** (*i.e.*, received by August 7, 2025).

Governmental Bar Date. Pursuant to the Bar Date Order, except as described below, all governmental units holding claims (whether secured, unsecured, priority, or unsecured nonpriority, including section 503(b)(9) claims) against the Debtors that arose before the Petition Date must file proofs of claim so as to be **received on or before the Governmental Bar Date** (*i.e.*, received by December 15, 2025).

Rejection Damages Bar Date. Pursuant to the Bar Date Order, except as described below, all persons or entities holding claims for damages arising from the rejection of any executory contract or unexpired lease of the Debtors must file proofs of claim with respect to such rejection so as to be **received on or before the Rejection Damages Bar Date**. Notwithstanding the foregoing, a party to an executory contract or unexpired lease that asserts a claim on account of unpaid amounts accrued and outstanding as of the Petition Date pursuant to such executory contract or unexpired lease (other than a rejection damages claim) must file a proof of claim for such amounts on or before the General Bar Date or the Governmental Bar Date, as applicable.

Amended Schedules Bar Date. Pursuant to the Bar Date Order, except as described below, if subsequent to the serving this Notice, the Debtors amend or supplement their Schedules (a) to reduce the undisputed, noncontingent, and liquidated amount of a claim listed in the Schedules, (b) to change the nature or classification of a claim against the Debtors reflected in the Schedules, or (c) to add a new claim to the Schedules, the affected creditor is required to file a Proof of Claim or amend any previously filed Proof of Claim with respect of the amended scheduled claim so as to be **received on or before the Amended Schedules Bar Date**.

INSTRUCTIONS FOR FILING CLAIMS. The following persons or entities must file proofs of claim on or before the applicable Bar Date:

- any person or entity whose claim against a Debtor is not listed in the applicable Debtor's schedules or is listed in such Schedules as "contingent," "unliquidated," or "disputed" if such person or entity desires to participate in any of these Chapter 11 Cases or share in any distribution in any of these Chapter 11 Cases;
- any person or entity who believes that its claim is improperly classified in the Schedules or is listed in an incorrect amount and who desires to have its claim allowed in a different classification or amount other than that identified in the schedules;
- any person or entity who believes that its prepetition claim as listed in the schedules is not an obligation of the specific Debtor against which the claim is listed and who desires to have its claim allowed against a Debtor other than that identified in the schedules; and
- any person or entity who believes that its claim against a Debtor is or may be an administrative expense pursuant to section 503(b)(9) of the Bankruptcy Code.

The fact that you have received this notice does not mean that you have a claim or that the Debtors or the Court believe that you have a claim against the Debtors. You should not file a proof of claim if you do not have a claim against any of the Debtors.

Parties asserting claims against the Debtors that arose before the Petition Date, including section 503(b)(9) claims, must use the copy of the proof of claim form (the "**Proof of Claim Form**") included with this notice.

Persons and entities must file a proof of claim so that it is **received on or before the applicable Bar Date**. Proofs of claim may be submitted: (i) electronically through HGE's website, using the interface available on such website located at www.veritaglobal.net/HigherGround, or (ii) by delivering the original proof of claim to: **If by First-Class Mail, Hand Delivery, or Overnight Mail:** HGE Claims Processing, c/o Verita Global, 222 N. Pacific Coast Highway, Suite 300, El Segundo, CA 90245.

Proofs of claim will be deemed filed when **actually received** by Kurtzman Carson Consultants, LLC d/b/a Verita Global ("**Verita**").

Proofs of claim **may not be delivered via facsimile or electronic mail transmission.** Any facsimile or electronic mail submissions will not be accepted.

Proofs of claim will be collected, docketed, and maintained by Verita. If you would like a copy of your proof of claim returned to you as proof of receipt, please enclose an additional copy of your proof of claim and a self-addressed postage-paid envelope.

All Proof of Claim Forms must be **signed** by the claimant or, if the claimant is not an individual, by an authorized agent of the claimant. The Proof of Claim Form must be completed in English and be denominated in United States currency. You should set forth with specificity the legal and factual basis for the alleged claim and attach to your completed Proof of Claim Form any documents on which the claim is based (or, if such documents are voluminous, attach a summary) or an explanation as to why the documents are not available.

Any person or entity asserting claims against multiple Debtors must file a separate proof of claim with respect to each Debtor. In addition, any person or entity filing a proof of claim must identify on its Proof of Claim Form the particular Debtor against which the person or entity asserts its claim. Any proof of claim filed under the Debtors' jointly administered case number in these Chapter 11 Cases or that otherwise fails to identify a Debtor shall be deemed as filed **only** against Debtor HGE. If an entity lists more than one Debtor on any one proof of claim, the relevant claims will be treated as filed **only** against the first listed Debtor.

CONSEQUENCES OF FAILURE TO FILE A PROOF OF CLAIM. Pursuant to Bankruptcy Rule 3003(c)(2), any person or entity that is required to file a proof of claim in these Chapter 11 Cases pursuant to the Bankruptcy Code, the Bankruptcy Rules, or the Bar Date Order with respect to a particular claim against the Debtors, but that fails to do so properly by the applicable Bar Date, shall not be treated as a creditor with respect to such claim for purposes of (i) voting upon any plan in these Chapter 11 Cases and (ii) distribution from property of the Debtors' Estates.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION. If you require additional information regarding the filing of a claim, you may contact at HigherGroundInfo@veritaglobal.com, (888) 733-1431 (U.S./Canada) (Toll-Free) or (310) 751-2632 (International) or by submitting an inquiry through the Debtors' case website at www.veritaglobal.net/HigherGround/Inquiry.

HGE cannot advise you how to file, or whether you should file, a claim. You may wish to consult an attorney regarding this matter.

[1] The Debtors in these Chapter 11 Cases, along with the last four digits of each Debtor's federal identification number, are: Higher Ground Education Inc. (7265); Guidepost A LLC (8540); Prepared Montessorian LLC (6181); Terra Firma Services LLC (6999); Guidepost Birmingham LLC (2397); Guidepost Bradley Hills LLC (2058); Guidepost Branchburg LLC (0494); Guidepost Carmel LLC (4060); Guidepost FIC B LLC (8609); Guidepost FIC C LLC (1518); Guidepost Goodyear LLC (1363); Guidepost Las Colinas LLC (9767); Guidepost Leawood LLC (3453); Guidepost Muirfield Village LLC (1889); Guidepost Richardson LLC (7111); Guidepost South Riding LLC (2403); Guidepost St Robert LLC (5136); Guidepost The Woodlands LLC (6101); Guidepost Walled Lake LLC (9118); HGE FIC D LLC (6499); HGE FIC E LLC (0056); HGE FIC F LLC (8861); HGE FIC G LLC (5500); HGE FIC H LLC (8817); HGE FIC I LLC (1138); HGE FIC K LLC (8558); HGE FIC L LLC (2052); HGE FIC M LLC (8912); HGE FIC N LLC (6774); HGE FIC O LLC (4678); HGE FIC P LLC (1477); HGE FIC Q LLC (3122); HGE FIC R LLC (9661); LePort Emeryville LLC (7324); AltSchool II LLC (0403). The Debtors' mailing address is 1321 Upland Dr. PMB 20442, Houston, Texas 77043.

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CAREERS

Associate

Associate in NY, NY for Davidson Kempner Capital Management LP: Serve on the Product Control team, focusing on portfolio valuation of the firm's illiquid invstmts. Reqs Master's in Bus. Admin., Fin. or rel. fld or equiv, & 3 yrs of exp performing valuation analyses on illiquid invstmts incl complex businesses, securities, & transaction structures; evaluating & monitoring illiquid invstmts for risk, performance, & compliance, ensuring fin'l reporting & regulatory adherence; preparing & maintaining valuation models & memorandums incl documentation for all key valuation inputs; providing support during year-end audit process incl correspondence w/ & provision of valuation methodologies, assumptions, sensitivity analyses, & underlying fin'l statements to auditors; performing ad-hoc analytics incl stress testing, scenario analysis, & mrkt comparisons, & generating deliverables rel. to valuations; valuing equities & debt ranging from common equity, & complex equity positions w/ different share classes to performing debt & distressed credit using valuation techniques, incl DCF, Trading Multiples, & Option Pricing Models; assisting in the dvlpmt & rollout of technology projs to enhance efficiency of valuation & reporting processes; & ensuring accurate preparation & delivery of valuation & documentation for a subset of illiquid positions. Telecommuting &/or wrk'g from home may be permissible pursuant to co. policies. Salary range: $160,000.00 - $180,000.00/yr. Visit https://www.davidsonkempner.com/careers, click on "Submit your application" & indicate ref. DB8634067.

Airbus Americas, Inc.: Floor Coverings Engineer in Mobile, AL. The job duties for the position include but are not limited to the following: Develop new prod & innovation for aircraft floor coverings. Provide tech & project oversight for Airbus suppliers to ensure delivery of integrated engg solutions mtng tech, weight, program, & schedule & cost targets. Job reqs Bach's deg in Aerospace Engg, Mech Engg, or rltd fld & 5 yrs in any job title including exp in Aircraft Certification & Airworthiness. Up to 15% dmstc & int'l travel rqrd for biz mtgs & training. Tlwk permitted up to 2 days/ wk. To apply, Submit application & resume on our careers page here: https://ag.wd3.myworkdayjobs.com/en-US/Airbus/details/Floor-Coverings-Engineer_JR10332840. AA206

CAREERS

Airbus Americas, Inc.: Customer Acceptance & Delivery Engineer in Mobile, AL. Managing the risks (technical, industrial, certification, definition, planning, & contractual aspects) to protect the deliveries & standing as Airbus single voice for the Customer pre-FAL to Ferry Flight. Job reqs Bach's deg in Aerospace Engg, or rltd fld & 5 yrs in any job title involving exp in a technical aviation capacity in the aeronautical industry. Up to 15% dmstc & int'l travel rqrd for training & biz mtgs. To apply, submit an application and resume on our careers page here: https://ag.wd3.myworkdayjobs.com/en-US/Airbus/details/Customer-Acceptance-and-Delivery-Engineer_JR10333288. Job Code: AA196.

Assoc. Dir., Investment Banking

Scotia Capital (USA) Inc. seeks Assoc. Director, Investment Banking in NY, NY to lead & manage execution of M&A & capital raise transactions. Req'mts: Bachelor's or foreign equiv in Global Fin'ce, Fin'ce or rel. field & 5 yrs of progressively responsible exp in job offered or rel. occupation: utilizing Microsoft Excel to create fin'l models for pitches & deals. 10% trvl req'd nationally. FINRA Series 79TO, Series 63, & SIE registration req'd. Telecommuting &/or work from home may be permissible pursuant to company policies. When not telecommuting, must report to work site. Offered salary is between $275,000 & $275,000/yr. 40 hrs/wk. In alternative employer will accept Master's in one of the stated fields & 3 yrs of exp in above-listed skills. Please apply through https://www.scotiabank.com/careers by searching for Associate Director, Investment Banking & indicate job code RL052825LA.

Financial Services

Morgan Stanley Services Group, Inc. is hiring for following roles throughout facilities in NY, NY: Associate, Cloud & Infrastructure Engineer to perform analysis on raw data to dsgn & deploy plans & create reports & data visualizations that represent data for comp & communication networks. Remote work from anywhere in U.S. (JR000435, salary range $115005 - $150000); Vice President, Software Engineer to dvlp formula softw engine to allow configuration of calculations for Comprehensive Capital Analysis & Review (CCAR) Reporting needs (JR000563, salary range $189000 - $200000); Associate, Java/ Scala Developer to work as Software Engineer w/ expertise in dvlping distributed syst's (JR013017, salary range $151819 - $176000). All positions req rel. degree &/or exp &/or skills. Multiple open positions at various prof'l levels. For more info & to apply online, visit us at https://morganstanley.eightfold.ai/careers?source=mscom & search for these opportunities. No calls pls. EOE

CAREERS

Assistant Vice President, Business Analysis

Morgan Stanley Smith Barney LLC is hiring for following role in Jersey City, NJ: Assistant Vice President, Business Analysis to quantify & assess key client acquisition metrics, along w/ partnering w/ mrkting stakeholders to drive efficient & effective mrkting strategy (salary range $154,000 - $154,000). Position req's rel. degree &/or exp &/or skills. For more info & to apply, visit us at https://morganstanley.eightfold.ai/careers?source=mscom & enter JR000525 in search field. No calls pls. EOE

COMMERCIAL REAL ESTATE

Notice of Disposition of Collateral
Public Auction – UCC Sale

Notice is hereby given that, in accordance with applicable provisions of the Uniform Commercial Code (the "**UCC**"), as enacted in the State of New York, MF1 Capital LLC ("**Secured Party**"), a Delaware limited liability company, will offer for sale (the "**Sale**"), at public auction, all right, title, and interest of DAJ 1500 Pine Manager LLC ("**Pledgor**"), a Delaware limited liability company, in and to 100% of the limited liability company membership interests, together with all economic rights and governance rights associated therewith, in and to DAJ 1500 Pine LLC (the "**Collateral**"). DAJ 1500 Pine LLC is a Delaware limited liability company and the owner of the real property, and improvements thereon, located at 1500 Pine Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19102 (the "**Property**"). The Sale shall occur on **July 22, 2025 at 10:30 a.m. (ET)** at the top of the front steps of the Courthouse of the New York County Supreme Court located at 60 Centre Street, New York, New York 10007 with an option to participate virtually via the following Zoom meeting link: https://bit.ly/DAJ1500, Meeting ID: 845-1412-0695, Password: 047834, Call-in number: 1-646-931-3860 (US). The sale will be conducted by Matthew D. Mannion of Mannion Auctions, LLC. Parties interested in bidding on the Collateral must contact Secured Party's counsel, Jack Doherty, Esq. of Holland & Knight at (212) 751-3003 or jack.doherty@hklaw.com. Upon execution of a non-disclosure agreement, a copy of the Terms of Sale and additional documentation and information will be made available.

Secured Party, as lender, made a loan (the "**Mezzanine Loan**") to Pledgor, in the original principal amount of $2,950,000.00. In connection with the Mezzanine Loan, Secured Party obtained a first-priority lien on the Collateral pursuant to a certain Pledge and Security Agreement. Secured Party is conducting the Sale as a result of Pledgor's default(s) under the applicable Mezzanine Loan documents. The Mezzanine Loan is subject to a senior loan (the "**Senior Loan**") and first-priority mortgage on the Property and the obligations and liabilities set forth in the Senior Loan documents.

The Collateral is being offered as a single lot, "as-is, where-is", with no express or implied warranties, representations, statements or conditions of any kind made by Secured Party or any person acting for or on behalf of the Secured Party, without any recourse whatsoever to the Secured Party or any other person acting for or on behalf of the Secured Party and each bidder must make its own inquiry regarding the Collateral. The successful bidder shall be responsible for the payment of all transfer taxes, stamp duties and similar taxes incurred in connection with the purchase of the Collateral.

The Secured Party reserves the right to credit bid, set a minimum reserve price, reject all bids and terminate or adjourn the sale to another time, without further notice. All bids (other than credit bids of the Secured Party) must be for cash, and the successful bidder must be prepared to comply with the bidding and closing requirements in the Terms of Sale. None of the Collateral has been registered for sale under any federal or state securities or blue sky laws, and as such may not be sold or otherwise transferred by Secured Party or a purchaser of any Collateral except in accordance with applicable law.

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MARKETS DIGEST

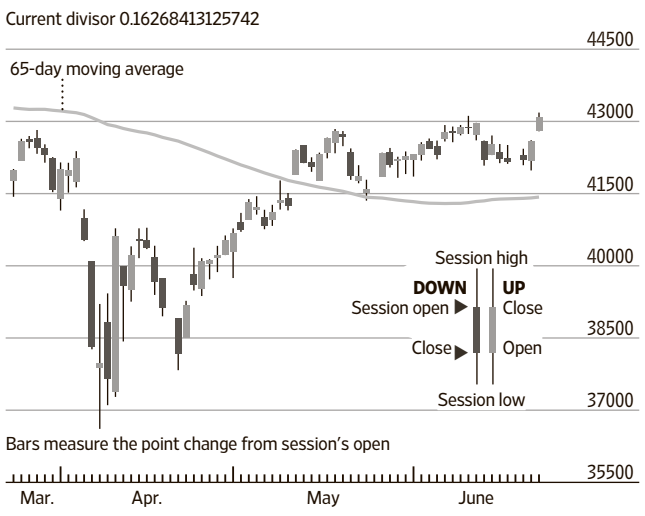
EQUITIES

Dow Jones Industrial Average

43089.02 ▲507.24, or 1.19%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio	24.36	27.14
P/E estimate *	20.28	18.96
Dividend yield	1.68	2.16
All-time high	45014.04, 12/04/24	

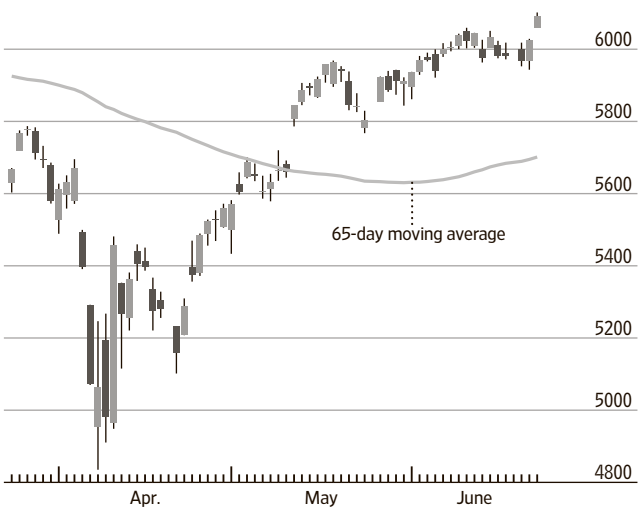


S&P 500 Index

6092.18 ▲67.01, or 1.11%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *	23.58	24.01
P/E estimate *	22.75	22.27
Dividend yield *	1.28	1.34
All-time high	6144.15, 02/19/25	

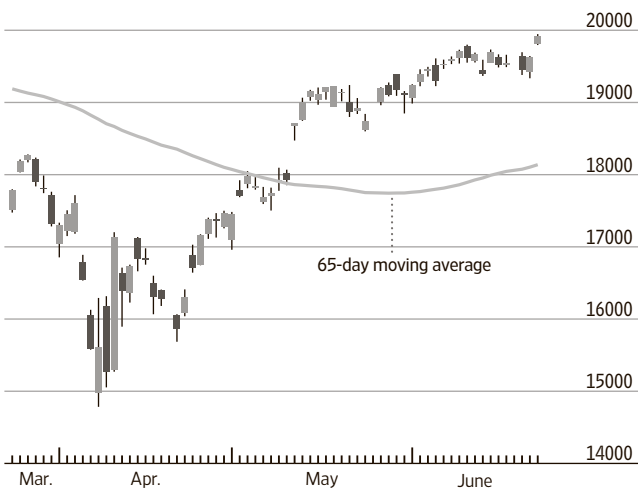


Nasdaq Composite Index

19912.53 ▲281.56, or 1.43%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *†	30.72	31.89
P/E estimate *†	28.58	28.97
Dividend yield *†	0.72	0.78
All-time high:	20173.89, 12/16/24	



*Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Birinyi Associates Inc; †Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Major U.S. Stock-Market Indexes

	Latest High	Low	Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg	YTD % chg	3-yr. ann.
Dow Jones										
Industrial Average	43183.48	42794.08	**43089.02**	507.24	**1.19**	45014.04	37645.59	**10.2**	1.3	**11.0**
Transportation Avg	15388.97	15180.33	**15374.57**	277.47	**1.84**	17754.38	12637.04	**1.7**	-3.3	**4.3**
Utility Average	1055.45	1049.54	**1051.18**	-0.31	**-0.03**	1079.88	898.82	**15.6**	7.0	**3.3**
Total Stock Market	60343.75	59910.54	**60249.52**	688.90	**1.16**	61024.05	49067.76	**11.7**	3.2	**15.3**
Barron's 400	1302.55	1290.88	**1300.20**	15.73	**1.22**	1356.99	1058.38	**15.0**	3.9	**13.7**
Nasdaq Stock Market										
Nasdaq Composite	19946.72	19795.29	**19912.53**	281.56	**1.43**	20173.89	15267.91	**12.4**	3.1	**19.7**
Nasdaq-100	22220.64	22045.63	**22190.52**	334.19	**1.53**	22190.52	17090.40	**12.6**	5.6	**22.4**
S&P										
500 Index	6101.76	6059.25	**6092.18**	67.01	**1.11**	6144.15	4982.77	**11.4**	3.6	**15.9**
MidCap 400	3085.65	3058.83	**3078.88**	28.33	**0.93**	3390.26	2560.93	**5.4**	-1.3	**9.7**
SmallCap 600	1329.14	1315.98	**1326.22**	13.74	**1.05**	1544.66	1106.12	**3.6**	-5.8	**4.8**
Other Indexes										
Russell 2000	2164.90	2142.74	**2161.21**	28.53	**1.34**	2442.03	1760.71	**6.9**	-3.1	**7.0**
NYSE Composite	20262.20	20008.18	**20217.34**	209.17	**1.05**	20272.04	17188.46	**12.0**	5.9	**10.9**
Value Line	597.16	589.26	**596.25**	6.99	**1.19**	656.04	495.50	**2.6**	-2.4	**3.2**
NYSE Arca Biotech	5643.41	5524.32	**5628.77**	104.45	**1.89**	6318.63	5060.12	**5.0**	-2.0	**5.9**
NYSE Arca Pharma	930.45	918.71	**926.78**	7.55	**0.82**	1140.17	860.88	**-14.1**	-0.8	**3.1**
KBW Bank	136.19	134.65	**135.25**	1.63	**1.22**	140.59	102.02	**32.1**	6.1	**8.8**
PHLX§ Gold/Silver	205.01	199.46	**203.81**	-3.97	**-1.91**	210.81	136.20	**49.1**	48.6	**19.5**
PHLX§ Oil Service	59.14	57.76	**58.57**	-0.08	**-0.14**	92.31	50.70	**-30.6**	-19.3	**-3.5**
PHLX§ Semiconductor	5444.39	5335.27	**5441.87**	197.57	**3.77**	5904.54	3562.94	**-0.5**	9.3	**26.0**
Cboe Volatility	18.72	17.33	**17.48**	-2.35	**-11.85**	52.33	12.03	**36.1**	0.7	**-13.7**

§Nasdaq PHLX

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Late Trading

Most-active and biggest movers among NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE Amer. and Nasdaq issues from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. ET as reported by electronic trading services, securities dealers and regional exchanges. Minimum share price of $2 and minimum after-hours volume of 50,000 shares.

Most-active issues in late trading

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	After Hours Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
Snap	SNAP	14,534.6	8.30	-0.02	**-0.24**	8.33	8.27
NVIDIA	NVDA	14,395.4	147.59	-0.31	**-0.21**	156.33	139.64
QuantumScape	QS	10,795.0	5.24	0.91	**21.02**	5.73	4.30
Schwab U.S. TIPs	SCHP	8,790.1	26.56	...	**unch.**	26.56	26.49
Xtrkrs MSCI EM Climt	EMCS	7,472.8	31.10	...	**unch.**	31.10	31.10
Direxion TSLA Bull 2X	TSLL	6,665.7	13.53	-0.09	**-0.66**	13.64	13.43
SPDR Portfolio S&P 500	SPLG	6,582.9	71.59	-0.01	**-0.01**	71.71	71.50
Comcast Cl A	CMCSA	6,392.9	35.29	0.08	**0.23**	35.45	35.17

Percentage gainers...

QuantumScape	QS	10,795.0	5.24	0.91	**21.02**	5.73	4.30
BlackBerry	BB	1,061.6	4.62	0.29	**6.70**	4.64	4.30
Scholar Rock Holding	SRRK	56.3	35.59	2.18	**6.52**	35.59	33.25
eHealth	EHTH	83.0	4.59	0.25	**5.76**	4.70	4.34
Mirion Technologies	MIR	255.1	21.42	1.16	**5.73**	21.54	20.26

...And losers

Torrid Holdings	CURV	162.1	3.80	-1.30	**-25.49**	5.10	3.64
Annovis Bio	ANVS	76.2	2.78	-0.28	**-9.20**	3.06	2.70
Allot	ALLT	62.5	8.89	-0.72	**-7.49**	9.61	8.01
Viavi Solutions	VIAV	213.0	9.23	-0.68	**-6.84**	9.91	9.23
SLM	SLM	193.2	30.51	-1.61	**-5.01**	32.12	30.51

Trading Diary

Volume, Advancers, Decliners

	NYSE	NYSE Amer.
Total volume*	1,231,671,616	24,559,816
Adv. volume*	859,142,209	8,412,169
Decl. volume*	358,510,880	15,537,892
Issues traded	2,854	295
Advances	2,059	157
Declines	727	123
Unchanged	68	15
New highs	87	4
New lows	16	4
Closing Arms†	1.11	1.10
Block trades*	6,122	266

	Nasdaq	NYSE Arca
Total volume*	8,330,099,529	376,522,712
Adv. volume*	6,733,001,610	263,364,623
Decl. volume*	1,381,911,877	111,360,293
Issues traded	4,667	2,275
Advances	3,467	1,952
Declines	1,045	306
Unchanged	155	17
New highs	234	243
New lows	78	34
Closing Arms†	0.68	3.34
Block trades*	52,213	2,004

*Primary market NYSE, NYSE American NYSE Arca only. †(TRIN) A comparison of the number of advancing and declining issues with the volume of shares rising and falling. An Arms of less than 1 indicates buying demand; above 1 indicates selling pressure.

International Stock Indexes

Region/Country	Index	Close	Latest Net chg	% chg	YTD % chg
World	**MSCI ACWI**	**903.03**	12.93	**1.45**	7.3
	MSCI ACWI ex-USA	**373.59**	7.37	**2.01**	14.6
	MSCI World	**3957.83**	51.97	**1.33**	6.7
	MSCI Emerging Markets	**1211.84**	29.59	**2.50**	12.7
Americas	**MSCI AC Americas**	**2305.73**	25.88	**1.14**	4.2
Canada	**S&P/TSX Comp**	**26718.62**	109.26	**0.41**	8.1
Latin Amer.	**MSCI EM Latin America**	**2291.37**	39.13	**1.74**	23.7
Brazil	**Bovespa**	**137164.61**	614.11	**0.45**	14.0
Chile	**S&P IPSA**	**4243.47**	61.68	**1.47**	17.4
Mexico	**S&P/BMV IPC**	**56743.28**	645.57	**1.15**	14.6
EMEA	**STOXX Europe 600**	**540.98**	5.95	**1.11**	6.6
Eurozone	**Euro STOXX**	**559.39**	7.97	**1.45**	10.7
Belgium	**Bel-20**	**4491.42**	49.44	**1.11**	5.3
Denmark	**OMX Copenhagen 20**	**1776.04**	13.42	**0.76**	–15.5
France	**CAC 40**	**7615.99**	78.42	**1.04**	3.2
Germany	**DAX**	**23641.58**	372.57	**1.60**	18.7
Israel	**Tel Aviv**	**2876.50**	35.74	**1.26**	20.1
Italy	**FTSE MIB**	**39474.46**	633.95	**1.63**	15.5
Netherlands	**AEX**	**924.62**	7.83	**0.85**	5.2
Norway	**Oslo Bors All-Share**	**1847.03**	–39.94	**–2.12**	12.3
South Africa	**FTSE/JSE All-Share**	**95887.03**	758.83	**0.80**	14.0
Spain	**IBEX 35**	**14035.10**	195.70	**1.41**	21.0
Sweden	**OMX Stockholm**	**936.54**	10.51	**1.13**	–1.9
Switzerland	**Swiss Market**	**11988.92**	133.96	**1.13**	3.3
Turkey	**BIST 100**	**9448.90**	307.59	**3.36**	–3.9
U.K.	**FTSE 100**	**8758.99**	0.95	**0.01**	7.2
U.K.	**FTSE 250**	**21326.20**	205.25	**0.97**	3.4
Asia-Pacific	**MSCI AC Asia Pacific**	**200.64**	4.59	**2.34**	10.5
Australia	**S&P/ASX 200**	**8555.50**	80.62	**0.95**	4.9
China	**Shanghai Composite**	**3420.57**	38.98	**1.15**	2.1
Hong Kong	**Hang Seng**	**24177.07**	487.94	**2.06**	20.5
India	**BSE Sensex**	**82055.11**	158.33	**0.19**	5.0
Japan	**NIKKEI 225**	**38790.56**	436.47	**1.14**	–2.8
Singapore	**Straits Times**	**3904.30**	25.05	**0.65**	3.1
South Korea	**KOSPI**	**3103.64**	89.17	**2.96**	29.3
Taiwan	**TAIEX**	**22188.76**	456.74	**2.10**	–3.7
Thailand	**SET**	**1100.01**	37.23	**3.50**	–21.4

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Percentage Gainers...

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
Nektar Therapeutics	NKTR	24.45	14.91	**156.29**	27.68	6.48	**52.3**
Youxin Technology Cl A	YAAS	5.58	2.73	**95.45**	6.74	1.58	**...**
Eyenovia	EYEN	9.02	3.54	**64.60**	124.80	0.85	**-82.7**
Sound Group ADR	SOGP	4.21	1.58	**60.08**	4.48	1.18	**97.7**
InMed Pharmaceuticals	INM	3.87	1.42	**57.96**	15.70	1.72	**-25.9**
AIFU	AIFU	6.17	1.94	**45.86**	50.40	1.50	**-86.6**
Nano Labs Cl A	NA	14.85	3.96	**36.36**	31.48	2.75	**240.1**
Rezolve AI	RZLV	2.78	0.74	**36.27**	14.50	1.07	**-75.7**
Carbon Revolution	CREV	3.02	0.77	**34.22**	14.19	2.00	**-55.6**
Liminatus Pharma	LIMN	26.67	6.67	**33.35**	27.00	4.40	**128.5**
JIADE	JDZG	2.71	0.63	**30.27**	21.28	1.61	**-60.6**
Anbio Biotechnology	NNNN	24.08	5.23	**27.75**	24.33	5.18	**...**
Amylyx Pharmaceuticals	AMLX	6.41	1.39	**27.69**	7.27	1.62	**246.5**
Amarin ADR	AMRN	16.04	3.44	**27.26**	17.18	7.08	**10.1**
Skye Bioscience	SKYE	3.62	0.75	**26.13**	8.44	1.14	**-54.1**

Percentage Losers

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
Fast Track Group	FTRK	2.50	-3.81	**-60.38**	9.69	2.50	**...**
Upexi	UPXI	3.97	-6.03	**-60.30**	22.57	1.90	**-55.8**
X3 Holdings	XTKG	1.28	-0.92	**-41.82**	11.60	0.53	**-88.5**
Maase	MAAS	6.79	-3.14	**-31.62**	474.00	2.41	**-98.4**
Houston American Energy	HUSA	12.83	-5.71	**-30.80**	32.00	3.85	**1.0**
Indonesia Energy	INDO	3.47	-1.40	**-28.75**	7.95	2.06	**27.1**
Robin Energy	RBNE	4.85	-1.85	**-27.61**	24.65	1.32	**...**
ViewBix	VBIX	2.91	-0.97	**-24.94**	12.00	0.20	**1475.4**
GrShr 2x Sh COIN Daily	CONI	2.59	-0.81	**-23.82**	28.54	2.49	**...**
Enigmatig	EGG	2.98	-0.88	**-22.80**	13.34	2.53	**...**
TMD Energy	TMDE	1.81	-0.50	**-21.65**	6.27	0.67	**...**
Battalion Oil	BATL	1.63	-0.45	**-21.63**	6.89	1.05	**-50.0**
DeFi Development	DFDV	19.63	-5.18	**-20.88**	53.88	0.48	**1804.5**
Live Ventures	LIVE	8.98	-1.98	**-18.07**	25.88	6.25	**-62.4**
Ernexa Therapeutics	ERNA	1.98	-0.42	**-17.50**	39.38	1.75	**-92.7**

Most Active Stocks

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
OneMedNet	ONMD	**494,399**	455111.9	0.68	**100.65**	1.60	0.30
Healthcare Triangle	HCTI	**372,581**	55.1	0.03	**6.45**	1.90	0.01
BigBear.ai	BBAI	**296,528**	281.6	5.23	**25.12**	10.36	1.17
Direxion TSLA Bull 2X	TSLL	**217,217**	-2.6	13.62	**-4.76**	41.50	6.29
NVIDIA	NVDA	**186,413**	-25.5	147.90	**2.59**	153.13	86.62
DenisonMines	DNN	**182,135**	77.1	1.80	**2.86**	2.47	1.08
Direxion Dly Semi 3 Bear	SOXS	**177,612**	95.2	8.26	**-11.32**	53.43	8.22
Greenlane Holdings	GNLN	**145,967**	-48.4	0.01	**0.00**	21.80	0.01
Direxion Dly SCOND 3 BL	SOXL	**135,168**	-36.1	23.95	**11.33**	70.08	7.23
Intel	INTC	**129,699**	46.1	22.55	**6.42**	37.16	17.67

*Volumes of 100,000 shares or more are rounded to the nearest thousand

Volume Movers

Ranked by change from 65-day average*

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
Bluemonte Core Bond ETF	BDBT	7,405	**57873**	25.17	**0.42**	25.18	25.06
Bluemonte LC Value	BVAL	3,561	**30223**	25.44	**0.89**	25.47	25.06
Bluemonte Dyn Total Mkt	BLUX	7,095	**29431**	25.56	**1.15**	25.59	25.09
Bluemonte Global Eq ETF	BINT	4,738	**28938**	25.50	**1.11**	25.55	25.07
Bluemonte LC Core ETF	BLUC	4,265	**28886**	25.53	**1.09**	25.56	25.11
Bluemonte LC Growth	BLGR	3,536	**28085**	25.65	**1.58**	25.69	25.11
Bluemonte Long Term Bd	BLTD	2,551	**23604**	25.19	**0.48**	25.21	25.04
Bluemonte Divers Incm	BLUI	1,565	**16628**	25.16	**0.42**	25.23	25.05
Nektar Therapeutics	NKTR	36,653	**15374**	24.45	**156.29**	27.68	6.48
Xtrkrs MSCI EM Climt	EMCS	7,525	**13959**	31.10	**2.88**	31.12	24.18

*Common stocks priced at $2 a share or more with an average volume over 65 trading days of at least 5,000 shares †Has traded fewer than 65 days

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CURRENCIES & COMMODITIES

Currencies

U.S.-dollar foreign-exchange rates in late New York trading

Country/currency	Tues in US$	per US$	US$ vs, YTD chg (%)
Americas			
Argentina peso	.00091	173.9951	**13.9**
Brazil real	.1814	5.5113	**-10.9**
Canada dollar	.7286	1.3726	**-4.6**
Chile peso	.001068	936.50	**-5.8**
Colombia peso	.000245	4075.25	**-7.5**
Ecuador US dollar	1	1	**unch**
Mexico peso	.0527	18.9874	**-8.8**
Uruguay peso	.02474	40.4150	**-7.5**
Asia-Pacific			
Australia dollar	.6489	1.5411	**-4.6**
China yuan	.1394	7.1717	**-1.7**
Hong Kong dollar	.1274	7.8499	**1.0**
India rupee	.01163	85.961	**0.4**
Indonesia rupiah	.0000614	16297	**0.2**
Japan yen	.006900	144.93	**-7.8**
Kazakhstan tenge	.001930	518.22	**-1.3**
Macau pataca	.1235	8.0975	**1.2**
Malaysia ringgit	.2356	4.2440	**-5.1**
New Zealand dollar	.6008	1.6644	**-6.9**
Pakistan rupee	.00353	283.650	**1.9**
Philippines peso	.0175	57.154	**-1.6**
Singapore dollar	.7815	1.2796	**-6.3**
South Korea won	.0007358	1359.06	**-8.1**
Sri Lanka rupee	.0033306	300.25	**2.4**
Taiwan dollar	.03392	29.480	**-10.1**
Thailand baht	.03062	32.660	**-4.9**
Vietnam dong	.00003821	26170	**2.7**
Europe			
Czech Rep. koruna	.04685	21.343	**-12.3**
Denmark krone	.1556	6.4260	**-10.8**
Euro area euro	1.1611	.8613	**-10.8**
Hungary forint	.002892	345.81	**-13.0**
Iceland krona	.008187	122.15	**-12.1**
Norway krone	.0988	10.1234	**-11.1**
Poland zloty	.2730	3.6633	**-11.3**
Sweden krona	.1049	9.5302	**-13.9**
Switzerland franc	1.2418	.8053	**-11.3**
Turkey lira	.0253	39.6009	**12.0**
Ukraine hryvnia	.0240	41.7500	**-0.7**
UK pound	1.3614	.7345	**-8.1**
Middle East/Africa			
Bahrain dinar	2.6518	.3771	**unch**
Egypt pound	.0200	50.0468	**-1.6**
Israel shekel	.2939	3.4025	**-6.5**
Kuwait dinar	3.2715	.3057	**-0.9**
Oman sul rial	2.5990	.3848	**-0.1**
Qatar rial	.2744	3.645	**-0.01**
Saudi Arabia riyal	.2666	3.7514	**-0.1**
South Africa rand	.0563	17.7611	**-5.9**

	Close	Net Chg	% Chg	YTD % Chg
WSJ Dollar Index	94.91	–0.44	–0.46	**–7.63**

Sources: Tullett Prebon, Dow Jones Market Data

Commodities

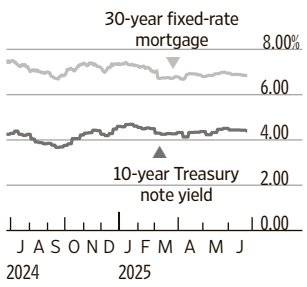
	Tuesday Close	Net chg	% Chg	52-Week High	Low	% Chg	YTD % chg
DJ Commodity	**1056.52**	-29.92	**-2.75**	1115.06	942.52	**2.83**	3.34
FTSE/CC CRB Index	**296.97**	-8.09	**-2.65**	316.63	265.48	**1.68**	0.08
Crude oil, $ per barrel	**64.37**	-4.14	**-6.04**	83.88	57.13	**-20.36**	-10.25
Natural gas, $/MMBtu	**3.537**	-0.161	**-4.35**	4.491	1.904	**28.34**	-2.64
Gold, $ per troy oz.	**3317.40**	-60.30	**-1.79**	3431.20	2299.20	**43.20**	26.18

CREDIT MARKETS

Consumer Rates and Returns to Investor

U.S. consumer rates

A consumer rate against its benchmark over the past year



Selected rates

30-year mortgage, Rate

Bankrate.com avg†:	**6.85%**
El Dorado Savings Bank	**6.00%**
Sacramento, CA	800-874-9779
First Savings Bank of Hegewisch	**6.10%**
Chicago, IL	773-646-4200
Huntington FSB	**6.13%**
Huntington, WV	304-528-6200
Chemung Canal Trust Company	**6.25%**
Elmira, NY	607-737-3711
Security State Bank of Aitkin	**6.25%**
Aitkin, MN	218-927-3765

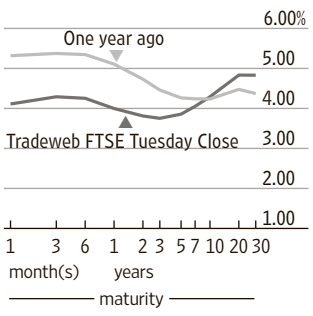
Interest rate	Yield/Rate (%) Last (●)	Week ago	52-Week Range (%) Low	High	3-yr chg (pct pts)
Federal-funds rate target	**4.25-4.50**	4.25-4.50	4.25	5.50	**2.75**
Prime rate*	**7.50**	7.50	7.50	8.50	**2.75**
SOFR	**4.29**	4.32	4.26	5.40	**2.85**
Money market, annual yield	**0.44**	0.44	0.40	0.56	**0.34**
Five-year CD, annual yield	**1.72**	1.72	1.62	1.73	**0.37**
30-year mortgage, fixed†	**6.85**	6.88	6.68	7.50	**0.97**
15-year mortgage, fixed†	**6.15**	6.17	6.02	6.92	**1.05**
Jumbo mortgages, $726,200-plus†	**6.99**	7.01	6.75	7.60	**1.13**
Five-year adj mortgage (ARM)†	**6.14**	6.29	5.88	6.63	**1.84**
New-car loan, 48-month	**7.20**	7.20	6.81	7.94	**2.64**

Bankrate.com rates based on survey of over 1,500 online banks. *Base rate posted by 70% of the nation's largest banks. † Excludes closing costs.

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data; Bankrate.com

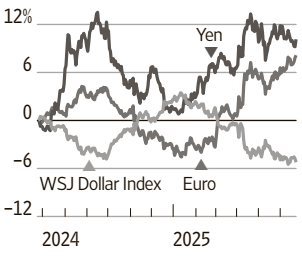
Treasury yield curve

Yield to maturity of current bills, notes and bonds



Forex Race

Yen, euro vs. dollar; dollar vs. major U.S. trading partners



Sources: Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close; Tullett Prebon; Dow Jones Market Data

Corporate Borrowing Rates and Yields

Bond total return index	Close	Yield (%) Last	Week ago	52-Week High	Low	Total Return (%) 52-wk	3-yr
U.S. Treasury, Bloomberg	2266.940	**4.100**	4.210	4.640	3.630	**4.167**	1.639
U.S. Treasury Long, Bloomberg	3108.310	**4.850**	4.920	5.120	3.990	**–1.661**	–3.374
Aggregate, Bloomberg	2166.530	**4.580**	4.700	5.110	4.100	**4.824**	2.616
Fixed-Rate MBS, Bloomberg	2143.710	**5.000**	5.110	5.520	4.340	**5.132**	2.469
High Yield 100, ICE BofA	3973.625	**6.228**	6.586	7.793	6.208	**9.490**	9.209
Muni Master, ICE BofA	590.196	**3.725**	3.739	4.179	3.074	**0.661**	2.252
EMBI Global, J.P. Morgan	940.509	**7.363**	7.449	8.073	7.084	**8.321**	7.583

Sources: J.P. Morgan; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; ICE Data Services

BIGGEST 1,000 STOCKS

How to Read the Stock Tables

The following explanations apply to NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market listed securities. Prices are consolidated from trades reported by various market centers, including securities exchanges, Finra, electronic communications networks and other broker-dealers. The list comprises the 1,000 largest companies based on market capitalization.

Underlined quotations are those stocks with large changes in volume compared with the issue's average trading volume.

Boldfaced quotations highlight those issues whose price changed by 5% or more if their previous closing price was $2 or higher.

Footnotes:
▲-New 52-week high; ▼-New 52-week low; **dd**-Indicates loss in the most recent four quarters.

Stock tables reflect composite regular trading as of 4 p.m. ET and changes in the official closing prices from 4 p.m. ET the previous day.

Tuesday, June 24, 2025

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
A B C			
AECOM	ACM	112.36	0.82
Aflac	AFL	104.16	-0.68
AGNC Invt	AGNC	9.31	0.11
ASE Tech	ASX	10.60	0.32
ASML	ASML	813.36	33.64
▲ **AST Space**	**ASTS**	**53.22**	**3.02**
AT&T	T	28.28	0.08
ATI	ATI	84.12	0.67
AXIS Capital	AXS	102.92	-0.85
AbbottLabs	ABT	138.08	4.82
AbbVie	ABBV	185.55	1.79
Accenture	ACN	300.72	5.72
Acuity	AYI	284.44	3.60
Adobe	ADBE	382.34	2.22
AdvDrainageSys	WMS	118.03	1.11
AdvMicroDevices	**AMD**	**138.43**	**8.85**
Aegon	AEG	6.90	0.14
AerCap	AER	116.01	0.91
AeroVironment	AVAV	193.28	2.05
AffirmA	**AFRM**	**65.66**	**3.47**
AgilentTechs	A	117.64	1.51
AgnicoEagleMines	AEM	120.49	-1.87
AgreeRealty	ADC	74.90	-0.90
AirProducts	APD	281.00	7.82
Airbnb	ABNB	132.15	1.62
AkamaiTech	AKAM	80.06	0.78
AlamosGold	AGI	25.85	-0.89
Albertsons	ACI	21.69	-0.44
Alcon	ALC	87.21	1.86
AlexandriaRlEst	ARE	75.37	2.45
Alibaba	BABA	117.01	3.92
AlignTech	ALGN	186.58	3.16
Allegion	ALLE	143.61	1.16
AlliantEnergy	LNT	61.16	-0.18
Allstate	ALL	196.05	-2.28
AllyFinancial	ALLY	37.95	0.94
▲ AlnylamPharm	ALNY	325.00	11.87
Alphabet C	GOOG	167.74	1.73
Alphabet A	GOOGL	166.77	1.58
Altria	MO	59.91	-0.58
Amazon.com	AMZN	212.77	4.30
Ambev	ABEV	2.40	-0.02
Amcor	AMCR	9.18	0.11
▲ Amdocs	DOX	92.62	0.69
AmerSports	AS	37.68	0.56
Ameren	AEE	96.37	0.36
AmericaMovil	AMX	17.25	0.25
AEP	AEP	103.28	-0.03
AmerExpress	AXP	308.38	8.75
AmericanFin	AFG	126.13	0.05
AmHomes4Rent	AMH	36.67	-0.13
AIG	AIG	85.46	-0.36
AmerTowerREIT	AMT	223.91	2.28
AmerWaterWorks	AWK	142.18	-1.81
Ameriprise	AMP	521.34	2.38
Ametek	AME	179.24	1.96
Amgen	AMGN	277.49	5.05
▲ Amphenol	APH	95.80	0.55
AnalogDevices	ADI	234.98	4.00
AngloGoldAsh	AU	46.40	-1.90
AB InBev	BUD	70.21	-1.27
AnnalyCap	NLY	19.36	0.22
Ansys	ANSS	338.27	3.27
AnteroMidstream	AM	18.50	0.13
AnteroResources	AR	42.35	0.03
Aon	AON	360.68	0.73
APi Group	APG	50.73	-0.11
ApolloGlbMgmt	APO	139.91	5.88
AppFolio	APPF	232.58	4.05
Apple	AAPL	200.30	-1.20
AppliedIndlTechs	AIT	234.89	2.93
ApplMaterials	AMAT	180.18	8.22
AppLovin	APP	349.48	14.08
Aptargroup	ATR	153.87	0.08
Aptiv	APTV	68.45	1.94
Aramark	ARMK	40.86	0.44
ArcelorMittal	MT	30.98	0.43
ArchCapital	ACGL	90.97	-0.14
ADM	ADM	52.93	0.11
AresMgmt	ARES	169.82	4.47
argenx	**ARGX**	**568.06**	**27.30**
AristaNetworks	ANET	94.97	3.02
Arm	ARM	156.41	7.08
AscendisPharma	ASND	179.10	3.32
Assurant	AIZ	198.02	-1.66
AsteraLabs	ALAB	87.26	1.31
AstraZeneca	AZN	70.54	-0.10
Atlassian	TEAM	200.67	7.93
AtmosEnergy	ATO	156.44	0.07
AuroraInnov	AUR	5.45	0.03
Autodesk	ADSK	304.19	3.24
▲ Autoliv	ALV	111.93	1.49
ADP	ADP	311.40	1.16
AutoZone	AZO	3577.54	-132.00
Avalonbay	AVB	206.13	-1.54
Avantor	AVTR	13.46	0.03
AveryDennison	AVY	179.13	-0.25
AxonEnterprise	AXON	794.25	11.01
BCE	BCE	21.98	0.10
BHP Group	BHP	47.29	0.46
BJ'sWholesale	BJ	114.09	-0.72
BP	BP	29.83	-0.49
BWX Tech	BWXT	142.31	0.25
BXP	BXP	70.34	-0.65
Baidu	BIDU	86.68	2.45
BakerHughes	BKR	37.97	0.14
Ball	BALL	56.98	0.30
BBVA	BBVA	15.32	0.42
BancoBradesco	BBDO	2.64	0.03
BancodeChile	BCH	29.57	0.42
BancSanBrasil	BSBR	5.39	0.09
BcoSantChile	BSAC	24.44	0.78
BancoSantander	SAN	8.27	0.27
BankofAmerica	BAC	46.66	0.36
BankMontreal	BMO	106.73	1.41
BankNY Mellon	BK	91.20	1.57
BankNovaScotia	BNS	54.35	0.20
▲ Barclays	BCS	18.26	0.66
BarrickMining	B	20.68	-0.50
BaxterIntl	BAX	30.59	0.60
BectonDicknsn	BDX	171.57	1.85
▲ BentleySystems	BSY	52.55	0.72
BeOneMed	ONC	266.80	9.29
Berkley	WRB	73.27	-0.65
BerkHathwy A	BRK.A	740085	7617.23
BerkHathwy B	BRK.B	493.48	5.71
BestBuy	BBY	68.84	2.47
Bilibili	BILI	20.70	0.79
Biogen	BIIB	126.31	1.55
BioMarinPharm	BMRN	54.69	0.61
BioNTech	BNTX	105.09	2.08
Birkenstock	BIRK	50.42	-1.72
BlackRock	BLK	1004.97	18.67
Blackstone	BX	144.05	5.73
Block	XYZ	65.34	1.72
BlueOwlCapital	OWL	19.11	0.54
BlueprintMed	BPMC	128.26	-0.14
Boeing	BA	200.94	-0.37
Booking	BKNG	5482.23	148.81
▼ BoozAllen	BAH	100.16	-0.53
BostonSci	BSX	104.12	1.76
▲ **BridgeBioPharma**	**BBIO**	**44.45**	**2.28**
BrinkerIntl	EAT	180.00	1.36
BristolMyers	BMY	47.03	0.11
BritishAmTob	BTI	48.50	-0.26
BrixmorProp	BRX	26.07	-0.11
▲ Broadcom	AVGO	263.77	10.00
BroadridgeFinl	BR	241.80	1.44
BrookfieldAsset	BAM	55.68	1.67
Brookfield	BN	61.32	1.70
BrookfieldInfr	BIP	33.15	0.48
BrookWealth	BNT	61.40	1.84
Brown&Brown	BRO	110.95	0.03
Brown-Forman B	BF.B	26.29	-0.19
Brown-Forman A	BF.A	26.86	-0.17
BuildersFirst	BLDR	118.84	-0.29
BungeGlobal	BG	83.59	-0.56
BurlingtonStrs	BURL	228.10	5.25
CACI Intl	CACI	452.17	-5.44
CAVA	CAVA	74.23	-1.02
CBRE Group	CBRE	139.13	0.53
CDW	CDW	179.84	6.07
CF Industries	CF	94.68	-1.85
CGI A	GIB	105.53	-0.54
CH Robinson	CHRW	94.28	0.33
CME Group	CME	271.38	-1.28
CMS Energy	CMS	69.71	-0.16
CNA Fin	CNA	46.09	0.28
CNH Indl	CNH	12.88	0.15
CRH	CRH	91.52	1.59
CSX	CSX	32.48	0.06
CVS Health	CVS	67.58	0.77
CadenceDesign	CDNS	296.80	3.24
CAE	CAE	26.44	0.17
CamdenProperty	CPT	115.53	-0.73
▲ Cameco	CCJ	72.34	2.62
Campbell's	CPB	32.17	0.16
▲ CIBC	CM	70.25	0.59
CanNtlRlwy	CNI	102.12	-0.16
CanadianNatRscs	CNQ	31.52	-0.60
CdnPacKC	CP	79.26	-0.57
CapitalOne	COF	206.36	4.72
CardinalHealth	CAH	164.21	0.22
Carlisle	CSL	371.91	7.65
Carlyle	CG	49.13	1.92
CarMax	KMX	69.21	2.04
Carnival	**CCL**	**25.70**	**1.66**
Carnival	**CUK**	**23.26**	**1.69**
▲ CarpenterTech	CRS	265.52	4.15
CarrierGlobal	CARR	72.46	0.68
Carvana	CVNA	322.97	2.89
▲ CaseysGenStores	CASY	510.91	0.48
Caterpillar	CAT	373.02	6.79
Celestica	**CLS**	**143.84**	**7.50**
CelsiusHldg	**CELH**	**45.41**	**2.58**
Cemex	CX	6.94	0.15
Cencora	COR	294.12	0.99
CenovusEnergy	CVE	13.71	-0.21
Centene	CNC	54.05	0.65
CenterPointEner	CNP	36.48	0.21
CentraisElBras	EBR	7.33	0.08
CharterComms	CHTR	403.50	10.92
CheckPoint	CHKP	219.56	-3.81
Chemed	CHE	557.32	5.74
CheniereEnergy	LNG	239.95	7.42
CheniereEnerPtrs	CQP	56.40	0.64
Chevron	CVX	143.55	-3.31
Chewy	CHWY	43.39	0.03
Chipotle	CMG	54.65	0.87
Chubb	CB	286.78	-1.41
ChunghwaTel	CHT	46.15	0.12
Church&Dwight	CHD	96.02	-0.93
Ciena	**CIEN**	**79.35**	**3.91**
Cigna	CI	316.83	-0.14
CincinnatiFinl	CINF	146.69	-0.55
Cintas	CTAS	223.20	2.30
▲ CiscoSystems	CSCO	67.89	0.51
Citigroup	C	81.14	1.78
CitizensFin	CFG	42.92	0.42
CleanHarbors	CLH	232.65	2.65
Clorox	CLX	122.02	-0.28
▲ Cloudflare	NET	186.43	2.56
Coca-Cola	KO	70.21	0.47
Coca-ColaCon	COKE	109.25	0.61
CocaColaEuropac	CCEP	92.67	-0.32
CognizantTech	CTSH	77.59	0.87
Coherent	COHR	80.96	0.32
CoinbaseGlbl	**COIN**	**344.82**	**37.23**
ColgatePalm	CL	88.18	-0.49
Comcast A	CMCSA	35.21	0.62
ComfortSystems	FIX	513.32	10.34
CommerceBcshrs	CBSH	61.47	0.11
SABESP	SBS	20.79	0.19
ComstockRscs	CRK	29.57	-0.14
ConagraBrands	CAG	21.46	-0.15
Confluent	CFLT	24.00	0.74
ConocoPhillips	COP	89.39	-2.32
ConEd	ED	100.19	-0.96
ConstBrands A	STZ	164.49	1.19
ConstellationEner	CEG	320.66	5.45
Cooper	COO	70.93	1.41
Copart	CPRT	48.65	0.93
CorceptTherap	CORT	76.77	2.49
Core&Main	CNM	59.40	1.06
CorebridgeFin	CRBG	33.25	0.48
CoreWeave	CRWV	172.62	-1.06
Corning	GLW	51.42	-0.38
Corpay	CPAY	329.47	7.62
Corteva	CTVA	73.29	-1.15
CoStar	CSGP	81.00	0.96
Costco	COST	1001.92	-2.56
CoterraEnergy	CTRA	26.81	0.10
▲ Coupang	CPNG	28.95	0.57
Crane	CR	184.35	0.61
Credicorp	BAP	217.79	1.66
▲ **CredoTech**	**CRDO**	**91.92**	**7.35**
CrowdStrike	CRWD	485.38	-6.43
CrownCastle	CCI	103.19	0.66
▲ Crown Holdings	CCK	104.39	0.22
CubeSmart	CUBE	43.11	0.22
Cullen/Frost	CFR	126.50	-0.01
Cummins	CMI	323.85	7.51
Curtiss-Wright	CW	476.02	-0.01
CyberArkSoftware	CYBR	397.13	0.07
D E F			
DTE Energy	DTE	133.22	-0.82
DT Midstream	DTM	107.38	1.21
Danaher	DHR	197.47	1.13
Darden	DRI	220.83	-0.51
Datadog	DDOG	130.83	1.31
DaVita	DVA	140.95	4.61
Dayforce	DAY	57.75	0.59
DeckersOutdoor	DECK	102.22	1.78
Deere	DE	514.10	0.02
DellTechC	DELL	120.59	2.57
DeltaAir	DAL	49.56	1.31
DescartesSystems	DSGX	103.43	2.66
▲ **DeutscheBank**	**DB**	**29.31**	**1.51**
DevonEnergy	DVN	32.35	-0.48
DexCom	**DXCM**	**87.57**	**7.73**
Diageo	DEO	101.20	0.90
DiamondbkEner	FANG	139.35	-1.80
Dick's	DKS	178.27	2.48
DigitalRealty	DLR	177.66	0.32
Disney	DIS	118.65	1.40
DocuSign	DOCU	75.64	1.72
DollarGeneral	DG	113.31	-1.64
DollarTree	DLTR	98.68	-1.83
DominionEner	D	55.98	0.10
Domino's	DPZ	459.97	2.36
Donaldson	DCI	69.36	0.24
▲ DoorDash	DASH	236.17	5.85
Dover	DOV	179.94	2.41
Dow	DOW	27.53	0.66
Doximity	DOCS	58.64	0.66
DrReddy'sLab	RDY	15.59	0.28
DraftKings	DKNG	42.81	1.35
Dropbox	DBX	28.84	0.12
DukeEnergy	DUK	116.95	-0.02
Duolingo	**DUOL**	**422.79**	**-25.75**
DuPont	DD	68.21	1.21
DutchBros	BROS	70.39	1.12
Dynatrace	DT	55.76	1.19
EMCOR	EME	500.65	6.05
ENI	E	31.97	-0.32
EOG Rscs	EOG	120.68	-1.31
EPAM Systems	EPAM	172.75	4.74
EQT	EQT	60.34	0.97
EastWestBncp	EWBC	98.96	1.45
EastGroup	EGP	173.72	0.22
EastmanChem	EMN	76.46	1.45
Eaton	ETN	343.26	10.31
eBay	EBAY	74.35	-2.51
Ecolab	ECL	266.84	0.89
Ecopetrol	EC	9.40	-0.05
EdisonIntl	EIX	51.39	1.23
EdwardsLife	EW	75.85	0.53
Elastic	ESTC	83.91	1.79
ElbitSystems	ESLT	422.54	-16.42
ElectronicArts	EA	157.95	3.54
ElevanceHealth	ELV	376.42	4.00
Embraer	ERJ	53.23	-0.05
Emera	EMA	44.89	0.07
EmersonElec	EMR	130.73	1.32
Enbridge	ENB	45.04	0.11
EncompassHealth	EHC	120.92	0.70
EnergyTransfer	ET	17.69	0.05
EnsignGroup	ENSG	153.57	1.40
Entegris	**ENTG**	**81.73**	**5.76**
Entergy	ETR	82.97	0.36
EnterpriseProd	EPD	31.12	0.24
Equifax	EFX	261.81	6.73
Equinix	EQIX	906.50	16.52
Equinor	**EQNR**	**25.15**	**-1.34**
Equitable	EQH	53.99	0.15
EquityLife	ELS	63.53	-0.50
EquityResdntl	EQR	67.54	-0.83
ErieIndemnity	ERIE	353.63	-3.24
EssentialUtil	WTRG	37.86	-0.15
EssexProp	ESS	286.03	0.23
EsteeLauder	EL	77.05	-1.78
EvercoreA	EVR	265.13	8.25
Everest	EG	340.83	-0.99
Evergy	EVRG	68.78	0.31
EversourceEner	ES	63.84	0.47
ExactSciences	EXAS	51.17	-1.37
Exelixis	**EXEL**	**45.72**	**2.35**
Exelon	EXC	43.10	-0.10
ExpandEnergy	EXE	122.53	1.08
Expedia	EXPE	169.22	3.40
ExpeditorsIntl	EXPD	114.16	-0.23
ExtraSpaceSt	EXR	148.53	-0.44
ExxonMobil	XOM	108.34	-3.40
F5	FFIV	295.90	0.81
FTAI Aviation	FTAI	135.05	4.82
Fabrinet	FN	276.50	6.63
FactSet	FDS	437.60	0.57
FairIsaac	FICO	1926.52	45.27
Fastenal	FAST	41.53	0.23
FederalRealty	FRT	96.27	-0.11
FedEx	FDX	229.51	0.28
FergusonEnts	FERG	219.15	4.15
Ferrari	RACE	472.42	11.34
Ferrovial	FER	52.10	0.83
FidNatlFinl	FNF	56.02	0.08
FidNatlInfo	FIS	82.13	1.63
FifthThirdBncp	FITB	40.59	0.44
FirstCitizBcshA	FCNCA	1908.42	18.91
FirstHorizon	FHN	20.38	0.15
FirstSolar	FSLR	151.18	6.51
FirstEnergy	FE	40.51	0.19
FirstService	FSV	177.32	1.47
Fiserv	FI	172.66	2.12
▲ Flex	FLEX	47.91	1.56
Floor&Decor	FND	76.68	1.08
Fluor	FLR	51.24	2.13
FlutterEnt	FLUT	275.83	5.30
FEMSA	FMX	101.23	0.60
FordMotor	F	10.73	-0.02
Fortinet	FTNT	104.42	1.27
Fortis	FTS	47.37	-0.21
Fortive	FTV	70.67	0.35
FoxA	FOXA	55.90	-0.18
FoxB	FOX	51.31	-0.09
Franco-Nevada	FNV	165.20	-2.05
FranklinRscs	BEN	23.23	0.34
FreedomHolding	FRHC	145.18	3.64
FreeportMcM	FCX	42.01	1.07
FreseniusMedCare	FMS	27.80	0.66
FrontierComms	FYBR	36.36	0.16
FullTruck	**YMM**	**12.54**	**0.68**
G H I			
GE Aerospace	GE	248.75	0.94
GE HealthCare	GEHC	71.98	0.82
▲ GE Vernova	GEV	510.84	10.96
GFLEnvironmental	GFL	50.02	-0.03
GSK	GSK	38.68	0.42
Gallagher	AJG	325.98	1.86
GameStop	GME	23.29	0.47
Gaming&Leisure	GLPI	47.33	0.12
Gap	GAP	21.57	0.14
Garmin	GRMN	205.08	3.34
Gartner	IT	400.39	1.89
GenDigital	GEN	29.37	0.56
Generac	GNRC	135.98	2.45
GeneralDynamics	GD	281.05	-1.27
GeneralMills	GIS	53.41	-0.06
GeneralMotors	GM	49.00	0.48
Genmab	GMAB	20.74	0.06
GenuineParts	GPC	121.20	-0.09
GileadSciences	GILD	107.20	1.01
GlobalPayments	GPN	78.98	2.63
GlobalFoundries	GFS	39.09	1.04
GlobeLife	GL	122.91	0.80
GlobusMedical	GMED	58.66	0.85
GoDaddy	GDDY	179.49	2.29
GoldFields	GFI	23.84	-0.83
GoldmanSachs	GS	662.11	15.23
Grab	GRAB	4.74	0.18
Graco	GGG	85.54	0.20
Grainger	GWW	1041.38	3.05
GAP	PAC	221.01	3.08
ASUR	ASR	306.59	4.76
▲ **GrupoCibest**	**CIB**	**44.97**	**2.35**
GpoFinGalicia	GGAL	52.68	2.31
Guidewire	GWRE	237.45	-0.95
HCA Healthcare	HCA	379.02	0.30
HDFC Bank	HDB	75.10	0.12
HP	HPQ	24.54	0.63
HSBC	HSBC	60.72	1.79
H World	HTHT	34.55	0.34
Haleon	HLN	10.49	...
Halliburton	HAL	20.78	0.01
HarmonyGold	HMY	14.09	-0.47
HartfordIns	HIG	126.58	-0.85
Hasbro	HAS	72.58	1.98
HealthEquity	HQY	104.18	2.97
HealthpeakProp	DOC	17.49	...
▲ Heico	HEI	317.61	-1.59
▲ HeicoA	HEI.A	249.36	-2.94
HenrySchein	HSIC	72.68	0.79
Hershey	HSY	172.05	-1.08
Hess	HES	138.60	-2.92
HessMidstream	HESM	38.22	0.19
HewlettPackard	HPE	18.15	0.34
Hilton	HLT	255.93	3.59
Hims&HersHealth	HIMS	42.95	0.97
Hologic	HOLX	64.83	0.40
HomeDepot	HD	360.42	3.46
HondaMotor	HMC	28.88	0.18
Honeywell	HON	224.60	-0.14
HormelFoods	HRL	30.40	-0.45
DR Horton	DHI	129.63	0.97
HostHotels	HST	15.67	-0.10
HoulihanLokey	HLI	179.85	2.70
▲ HowmetAerospace	HWM	176.57	0.94
Hubbell	HUBB	402.99	8.30
HubSpot	HUBS	557.32	20.81
Humana	HUM	238.79	4.13
JBHunt	JBHT	143.43	0.74
HuntingtonBcshs	HBAN	16.26	0.19
HuntingIngalls	HII	231.63	-5.47
HyattHotels	H	136.02	3.36
ICICI Bank	IBN	32.90	0.17
ICL Group	ICL	6.64	-0.12
IDEX	IEX	174.88	2.16
▲ IdexxLab	IDXX	530.50	5.85
ING Groep	ING	21.36	0.62
IQVIA	IQV	158.58	3.41
ITT	ITT	155.02	1.67
IcahnEnterprises	IEP	8.13	-0.02
Icon	ICLR	148.54	1.24
IllinoisToolWks	ITW	245.80	1.60
Illumina	ILMN	91.52	0.91
ImperialOil	IMO	78.75	-0.29
Incyte	INCY	69.01	1.75
Informatica	INFA	24.20	0.05
Infosys	INFY	18.30	0.20
IngersollRand	IR	83.69	1.76
Ingredion	INGR	137.50	-1.73
▲ Insmed	INSM	105.90	0.48
Insulet	PODD	310.90	3.23
Intel	**INTC**	**22.55**	**1.36**
InteractiveBrkrs	IBKR	51.64	1.11
ICE	ICE	180.85	1.12
InterContHtls	IHG	115.06	2.12
▲ IBM	IBM	293.79	4.61
IntlFlavors	IFF	74.72	0.96
IntlPaper	IP	46.59	0.50
Interpublic	IPG	24.69	0.26
Intuit	INTU	759.03	-3.52
IntuitiveSurgical	ISRG	523.08	7.99
InvitatHomes	INVH	33.83	-0.19
IonQ	IONQ	40.86	-0.28
IronMountain	IRM	105.25	2.20
ItauUnibanco	ITUB	6.79	0.14
J K L			
JBS	JBS	13.81	0.41
JD.com	JD	32.58	0.99
▲ JPMorganChase	JPM	281.26	2.99
▲ Jabil	JBL	211.95	3.60
JackHenry	JKHY	181.02	...
JacobsSolns	J	129.54	1.28
JamesHardie	JHX	24.63	0.11
JefferiesFinl	JEF	55.34	1.43
J&J	JNJ	152.19	0.87
JohnsonControls	JCI	103.60	0.25
JonesLang	JLL	250.88	3.30
JuniperNetworks	JNPR	36.56	0.26
▲ KB Financial	KB	82.44	3.73
KE Holdings	BEKE	18.45	0.36
KKR	KKR	127.77	5.63
KLA	KLAC	889.03	32.75
KT	KT	20.27	0.53
Kanzhun	BZ	18.09	0.41
Kaspi.kz	KSPI	81.54	1.82
Kellanova	K	78.52	-0.09
Kenvue	KVUE	21.19	-0.18
KeurigDrPepper	KDP	33.55	0.29
KeyCorp	KEY	16.75	0.26
KeysightTech	KEYS	164.73	3.66
KilroyRealty	KRC	34.78	-0.22
KimberlyClark	KMB	129.95	-0.18
KimcoRealty	KIM	21.24	0.02
KinderMorgan	KMI	28.54	0.45
KinrossGold	KGC	15.31	-0.39
KinsaleCapital	KNSL	478.33	0.31
Klaviyo	KVYO	32.96	0.49
Philips	**PHG**	**23.90**	**1.22**
▲ **KoreaElecPwr**	**KEP**	**12.61**	**2.23**
KraftHeinz	KHC	26.03	0.11
Kroger	KR	73.42	-0.58
Kyndryl	KD	40.88	1.57
LatamAirlines	LTM	39.22	1.32
LKQ	LKQ	37.65	0.29
LPL Financial	**LPLA**	**354.10**	**-20.26**
L3HarrisTech	LHX	246.65	-4.46
Labcorp	LH	262.53	1.49
LamResearch	LRCX	95.63	4.02
LamarAdv	LAMR	121.60	0.68
LasVegasSands	LVS	42.63	0.68
Leidos	LDOS	152.23	1.56
Lennar A	LEN	111.69	1.06
Lennar B	LEN.B	106.62	1.07
LennoxIntl	LII	569.15	4.97
LeonardoDRS	DRS	43.12	-1.61
LiAuto	LI	28.53	0.45
LibertyBroadbandC	LBRDK	95.98	2.59
LibertyBroadbandA	LBRDA	95.03	2.58
LibertyLiveC	LLYVK	79.52	-1.35
▲ LibertyLiveA	LLYVA	78.06	-1.51
▲ LibertyFormOne C	FWONK	104.99	0.71
▲ LibertyFormOne A	FWONA	94.82	0.90
EliLilly	LLY	778.08	7.44
LincolnElectric	LECO	206.12	-0.61
Linde	LIN	463.16	3.41
Lineage	LINE	46.29	0.72
LithiaMotors	LAD	339.35	3.62
LiveNationEnt	LYV	147.78	-2.91
LloydsBanking	LYG	4.21	0.10
LockheedMartin	LMT	460.20	-12.26
Loews	L	89.98	-0.69
LogitechIntl	LOGI	87.90	1.97
Lowe's	LOW	219.98	1.41
lululemon	LULU	232.93	7.37
LyondellBasell	LYB	58.33	0.99

Continued on Page B11

Borrowing Benchmarks

wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Money Rates

June 24, 2025

Key annual interest rates paid to borrow or lend money in U.S. and international markets. Rates below are a guide to general levels but don't always represent actual transactions.

Inflation

	May index level	Chg From (%) April '25	May '24
U.S. consumer price index			
All items	321.465	0.21	2.4
Core	327.509	0.21	2.8

International rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Prime rates				
U.S.	7.50	7.50	8.50	7.50
Canada	4.95	4.95	6.95	4.95
Japan	1.875	1.875	1.875	1.475
Policy Rates				
Euro zone	2.15	2.15	4.25	2.15
Switzerland	0.50	0.75	1.75	0.50
Britain	4.25	4.25	5.25	4.25
Australia	3.85	3.85	4.35	3.85
Overnight repurchase				
U.S.	4.37	4.36	5.45	4.00

U.S. government rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	52-Week Low
Discount				
	4.50	4.50	5.50	4.50
Federal funds				
Effective rate	4.3300	4.3300	5.3400	4.3200
High	4.5500	4.5500	5.6500	4.3700
Low	4.3200	4.3200	5.3300	4.3000
Bid	4.3200	4.3200	5.3300	4.3200
Offer	4.3300	4.3300	5.3600	4.3300
Treasury bill auction				
4 weeks	4.060	4.080	5.285	4.060
13 weeks	4.195	4.240	5.240	4.175
26 weeks	4.120	4.155	5.140	4.000

Other short-term rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week high	52-Week low
Call money				
	6.25	6.25	7.25	6.25
Commercial paper (AA financial)				
90 days	n.a.	n.a.	5.35	4.19
Secured Overnight Financing Rate				
	4.29	4.32	5.40	4.26

	Latest	Value Traded	52-Week High	52-Week Low
DTCC GCF Repo Index				
Treasury	4.361	43.500	5.471	4.286
MBS	4.365	71.084	5.526	4.294

Weekly survey

	Latest	Week ago	Year ago
Freddie Mac			
30-year fixed	6.81	6.84	6.87
15-year fixed	5.96	5.97	6.13

Notes on data:

U.S. prime rate is the base rate on corporate loans posted by at least 70% of the 10 largest U.S. banks, and is effective December 19, 2024. **Other prime rates** aren't directly comparable; lending practices vary widely by location; **Discount rate** is effective December 19, 2024. **Secured Overnight Financing Rate** is as of June 23, 2025. **DTCC GCF Repo Index** is Depository Trust & Clearing Corp.'s weighted average for overnight trades in applicable CUSIPs. Value traded is in billions of U.S. dollars. **Federal-funds rates** are Tullett Prebon rates as of 5:30 p.m. ET.

Sources: Federal Reserve; Bureau of Labor Statistics; DTCC; FactSet; Tullett Prebon Information, Ltd.

Cash Prices

Tuesday, June 24, 2025

These prices reflect buying and selling of a variety of actual or "physical" commodities in the marketplace—separate from the futures price on an exchange, which reflects what the commodity might be worth in future months.

	Tuesday
Energy	
Coal,C.Aplc.,12500Btu,1.2SO2-r,w	79.000
Coal,PwdrRvrBsn,8800Btu,0.8SO2-r,w	14.300
Metals	
Gold, per troy oz	
Engelhard industrial	3317.00
LBMA Gold Price AM	*3363.00
LBMA Gold Price PM	*3380.55
Krugerrand,wholesale-e	3465.62
Maple Leaf-e	3548.53
American Eagle-e	3548.53
Mexican peso-e	4278.46
Austria crown-e	3253.72
Austria phil-e	3482.20
Silver, troy oz.	
Engelhard industrial	36.0500
Handy & Harman base	35.7220
Handy & Harman fabricated	44.6530
LBMA spot price	*£27.0000
(U.S.$ equivalent)	*36.1300
Coins,wholesale $1,000 face-a	26660
Other metals	
LBMA Platinum Price PM	*1295.0
LBMA Palladium Price PM	*1069.0
Platinum,Engelhard industrial	1309.0
Palladium,Engelhard industrial	1080.0
Aluminum, LME, $ per metric ton	*2599.0
Copper,Comex spot	4.8670
Iron Ore, 62% Fe CFR China-s	*94.2
Steel, HRC USA, FOB Midwest Mill-s	*865.0
Battery/EV metals	
BMI Lithium Carbonate, EXW China, =99.5%-v,w	8375
BMI Lithium Hydroxide, EXW China, =56.5% -v,w	8375
BMI Cobalt sulphate, EXW China, >20.5% -v,w	6325
BMI Nickel Sulphate, EXW China, >22%-v,k	3600
BMI Flake Graphite, FOB China, -100 Mesh, 94-95% -v,m	435
Fibers and Textiles	
Burlap,10-oz,40-inch NY yd-n,w	0.8950
Cotton,1 1/16 std lw-mdMphs-u	0.6619
Cotlook 'A' Index-t	*77.55
Hides,hvy native steers piece fob-u	n.a.
Wool,64s,staple,Terr del-u,w	n.a.

	Tuesday
Grains and Feeds	
Bran,wheat middlings, KC-u,w	69
Corn,No. 2 yellow,Cent IL-bp,u	3.9800
Corn gluten feed,Midwest-u,w	102.3
Corn gluten meal,Midwest-u,w	426.3
Cottonseed meal-u,w	n.a.
Hominy feed,Cent IL-u,w	112
Meat-bonemeal,50% pro Mnpls-u,w	263
Oats,No.2 milling,Mnpls-u	3.9350
Rice, Long Grain Milled, No. 2 AR-u,w	34.88
Sorghum,(Milo) No.2 Gulf-u	n.a.
SoybeanMeal,Cent IL,rail,ton48%-u,w	279.10
Soybeans,No.1 yllw IL-bp,u	10.2100
Wheat,Spring14%-pro Mnpls-u	7.7500
Wheat,No.2 soft red,St.Louis-u	5.3275
Wheat - Hard - KC (USDA) $ per bu-u	5.4975
Wheat,No.1soft white,Portld,OR-u	6.2000
Food	
Beef,carcass equiv. index	
choice 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	371.04
select 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	357.00
Broilers, National comp wtd. avg.-u,w	1.3676
Butter,AA Chicago-d	2.5350
Cheddar cheese,bbl,Chicago-d	161.50
Cheddar cheese,blk,Chicago-d	159.50
Milk,Nonfat dry,Chicago lb.-d	125.00
Coffee,Brazilian,Comp-y	3.3199
Coffee,Colombian, NY-y	3.4995
Eggs,large white,Chicago-u,w	2.9550
Flour,hard winter KC-p	15.75
Hams,17-20 lbs,Mid-US fob-u	n.a.
Hogs,Iowa-So. Minnesota-u	106.65
Pork bellies,12-14 lb MidUS-u	2.2349
Pork loins,13-19 lb MidUS-u	1.1707
Steers,Tex.-Okla. Choice-u	n.a.
Steers,feeder,Okla. City-u,w	360.75
Fats and Oils	
Degummed corn oil, crude wtd. avg.-u,w	n.a.
Grease,choice white,Chicago-h	0.5750
Lard,Chicago-u	n.a.
Soybean oil,crude;Centl IL-u,w	0.5597
Tallow,bleach;Chicago-h	0.6175
Tallow,edible,Chicago-u	n.a.

KEY TO CODES: A=ask; B=bid; BP=country elevator bids to producers; C=corrected; D=CME; E=Manfra,Tordella & Brookes; H=American Commodities Brokerage Co; K=bi-weekly; M=monthly; N=nominal; n.a.=not quoted or not available; P=Sosland Publishing; R=SNL Energy; S=Platts-TSI; T=Cotlook Limited; U=USDA; V=Benchmark Mineral Intelligence; W=weekly; Y=International Coffee Organization; Z=not quoted. *Data as of 6/23

Source: Dow Jones Market Data

Dividend Changes

Company	Symbol	Yld %	Amount New/Old	Frq	Payable / Record
Increased					
Allstate 5.1% Deb. 2053	ALLpB	7.8	.4855 /.48304	Q	Jul15 /Jul01
Cadiz Pfd. A	CDZIP	13.1	.56 /.55	Q	Jul15 /Jul03
Foreign					
Banco Bradesco Pref ADR	BBD	4.7	.03506		Feb10 /Jul02
Banco Bradesco Pref ADR	BBD	4.7	.00345	M	Aug11 /Jul03
Transportadora Gas ADR	TGS	...	.92787		Jul08 /Jun30

Note: Dividend yields as of 3:30 p.m. ET

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

KEY: A: annual; M: monthly; Q: quarterly; r: revised; SA: semiannual; S2:1: stock split and ratio; SO: spin-off.

BANKRATE.COM® MMA, Savings and CDs

Average Yields of Major Banks

Tuesday, June 24, 2025

Type	MMA	1-MO	2-MO	3-MO	6-MO	1-YR	2-YR	2.5YR	5YR
National average									
Savings	0.44	0.87	0.94	1.48	1.94	2.02	1.79	1.59	1.72
Jumbo	1.23	0.48	0.39	1.66	1.96	2.13	1.88	1.58	1.80
Weekly change									
Savings	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.01	0.00	0.01	0.01	0.00	0.00
Jumbo	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.01	0.00	0.00	-0.01	0.00

Consumer Savings Rates

Below are the top federally insured offers available nationwide according to Bankrate.com's weekly survey of highest yields. For latest offers and reviews of these financial institutions, please visit bankrate.com/banking/reviews. Information is believed to be reliable, but not guaranteed.

High yield savings

Bank / Phone number	Minimum	Yield (%)
Money market account		
Peak Bank 866-484-5705	$100	4.44
Newtek Bank 888-681-7238	$0	4.35
Primis Bank 833-477-4647	$1	4.35
One-month CD		
State Bank of India California 877-707-1995	$1,000	0.50
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$1,000	0.20
Bank of Hope 855-325-2226	$1,000	0.15
Two-month CD		
State Bank of India California 877-707-1995	$1,000	4.25
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$1,000	0.20
Presidential Bank, FSB 800-383-6266	$1,000	0.10
Three-month CD		
Merrick Bank 866-638-6851	$25,000	4.45
Popular Direct 800-274-5696	$10,000	4.40
America First FCU 801-627-0900	$500	4.35
Six-month CD		
Rising Bank 888-222-9484	$1,000	4.51
Newtek Bank 888-681-7238	$2,500	4.50
First Internet Bank of Indiana 888-873-3424	$1,000	4.49
One-year CD		
Rising Bank 888-222-9484	$1,000	4.45
Popular Direct 800-274-5696	$10,000	4.40
First Internet Bank of Indiana 888-873-3424	$1,000	4.40
Two-year CD		
Newtek Bank 888-681-7238	$2,500	4.20
KS StateBank 785-587-4000	$500	4.15
Popular Direct 800-274-5696	$10,000	4.15
Five-year CD		
America First FCU 801-627-0900	$500	4.25
Popular Direct 800-274-5696	$10,000	4.20
Synchrony Bank 866-226-5638	$0	4.15

High yield jumbos - Minimum is $100,000

Bank / Phone number	Minimum	Yield (%)
Money market account		
Presidential Bank, FSB 800-383-6266	$100,000	4.37
Western Alliance Bank 602-389-3500	$100,000	4.30
Banesco USA 888-228-1597	$100,000	4.15
One-month CD		
State Bank of India California 877-707-1995	$100,000	0.50
Bank of Hope 855-325-2226	$100,000	0.20
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$100,000	0.20
Two-month CD		
State Bank of India California 877-707-1995	$100,000	4.25
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$100,000	0.20
Applied Bank 888-839-7952	$100,000	0.05
Three-month CD		
Goldwater Bank 480-281-8200	$100,000	4.30
State Bank of India California 877-707-1995	$100,000	4.25
Lone Star Bank 713-358-9400	$100,000	4.05
Six-month CD		
BankFive 508-679-8551	$100,000	4.40
Goldwater Bank 480-281-8200	$100,000	4.30
MyBankingDirect 516-683-4100	$100,000	4.25
One-year CD		
BankFive 508-679-8551	$100,000	4.40
Goldwater Bank 480-281-8200	$100,000	4.30
MyBankingDirect 516-683-4100	$100,000	4.25
Two-year CD		
Luana Savings Bank 800-666-2012	$100,000	4.30
Connexus Credit Union 800-845-5025	$100,000	4.16
GTE Financial Credit Union 888-871-2690	$100,000	4.07
Five-year CD		
GTE Financial Credit Union 888-871-2690	$100,000	4.33
Luana Savings Bank 800-666-2012	$100,000	4.09
Morgan Stanley Private Bank 800-387-2331	$100,000	3.90

Notes: Accounts are federally insured up to $250,000 per person. Yields are based on method of compounding and rate stated for the lowest required opening deposit to earn interest. CD figures are for fixed rates only. MMA: Allows six (6) third-party transfers per month, three (3) of which may be checks. Rates are subject to change.

Source: Bankrate.com, a publication of Bankrate, Inc., Palm Beach Gardens, FL 33410
Internet: www.bankrate.com

New Highs and Lows

The following explanations apply to the New York Stock Exchange, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market stocks that hit a new 52-week intraday high or low in the latest session. **% CHG**-Daily percentage change from the previous trading session.

Tuesday, June 24, 2025

Highs

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
ASML ADRhedged	ASMH	55.04	4.0
AST Space	ASTS	54.05	6.0
AbCelleraBio	ABCL	3.77	10.5
AcadianAsset	AAMI	33.15	2.1
AdvEnergyInds	AEIS	134.82	1.9
AevaTech	AEVA	31.25	9.7
AevaTechWt	AEVAW	0.61	57.9
Allient	ALNT	36.08	3.7
Allot	ALLT	9.92	2.7
AlnylamPharm	ALNY	326.03	3.8
AlphaTimeWt	ATMCW	0.04	33.3
Amarin	AMRN	17.18	27.3
Amdocs	DOX	95.41	0.8
AmerPubEduc	APEI	30.95	-1.2
Amphenol	APH	96.69	0.6
AnbioBiotechnology	NNNN	24.33	27.7
ApollomicsWt	APLMW	0.05	114.1
ApyxMedical	APYX	2.30	13.5
Arm ADRhedged	ARMH	66.45	4.0
ArmadaAcqnII	AACIU	10.22	0.4
AscentagePharma	AAPG	40.39	6.9
AtlantaBravesA	BATRA	49.54	0.4
AtlanticAmerican	AAME	2.22	1.7
AtlasNts2027	ATCOL	25.30	...
Autoliv	ALV	112.11	1.3
AutoNation	AN	201.58	1.4
AvisBudget	CAR	174.04	16.9
BankofButterfield	NTB	44.63	0.7
Barclays	BCS	18.32	3.8
BelFuse B	BELFB	95.00	-0.9
BentleySystems	BSY	52.68	1.4
BiglariB	BH	296.40	-1.6
BiglariA	BH.A	1444.87	-2.1
Brainsway	BWAY	12.39	6.7
BridgeBioPharma	BBIO	44.75	5.4
Broadcom	AVGO	265.87	3.9
BrookfieldBus	BBUC	31.39	4.1
BrookfieldBusPtr	BBU	26.96	2.6
CalRedwoodAcqn	CRAQU	10.25	0.2
Calix	CALX	49.63	2.4
Cameco	CCJ	72.79	3.8
CIBC	CM	70.86	0.8
CantorEqPtrsII	CEPT	11.87	-1.2
CarpenterTech	CRS	265.84	1.6
CartesianGrwIII	CGCTU	10.22	0.4
CaseysGenStores	CASY	514.32	0.1
CheesecakeFct	CAKE	61.21	-0.7
ChurchillCapIX	CCIXU	12.50	4.8
CidaraTherap	CDTX	56.83	4.2
CiscoSystems	CSCO	68.04	0.8
Cloudflare	NET	187.90	1.4
ColumbusAcqn	COLA	10.13	...
CommScope	COMM	7.44	13.5
CompoSecureWt	CMPOW	6.60	5.1
ConcordeIntl	CIGL	8.94	8.5
ConsldWater	CWCO	30.40	-1.4
Coupang	CPNG	29.14	2.0
CraneHarborRt	CHACR	0.27	...
CredoTech	CRDO	92.20	8.7
Crown Holdings	CCK	105.05	0.2
DeutscheBank	DB	29.34	5.4
DieboldNixdorf	DBD	53.66	3.2
DoorDash	DASH	237.42	2.5
Ducommun	DCO	82.70	1.5
DuneAcqnIIWt	IPODW	0.25	...
EPR Prop	EPR	59.31	-1.7
EPR PropPfdE	EPRpE	31.73	-1.1
ESCO Tech	ESE	190.63	-0.7
Enact	ACT	37.86	0.3
EnlightRenewableEn	ENLT	23.03	4.6
EsquireFinancial	ESQ	94.90	-0.9
EvolvTech	EVLV	6.25	2.5
FARO Tech	FARO	43.99	...
FGMergerII	FGMC	9.89	...
FederalSignal	FSS	104.91	0.8
FifthEraAcqnIRt	FERAR	0.32	-3.6
51TalkOnlineEd	COE	33.65	1.8
FirstBuseyPfdB	BUSEP	25.21	0.3
FirstFinancial	THFF	53.63	0.3
Flex	FLEX	48.03	3.4
FourLeafAcqnA	FORL	11.65	0.9
FuelTech	FTEK	2.41	7.8
GE Vernova	GEV	512.82	2.2
G Willi-Food	WILC	17.86	1.9
GenesisEnergy	GEL	17.29	1.6
GenieEnergy	GNE	28.00	1.8
GenworthFin	GNW	8.00	-0.3
GeospaceTech	GEOS	18.99	-8.4
GigCapital7Wt	GIGGW	0.17	...
GoresX	GTENU	10.51	0.3
GoresX A	GTEN	10.53	...
GrupoCibest	CIB	45.24	5.5
HappyCity	HCHL	7.25	...
Heico	HEI	320.01	-0.5
HeicoA	HEI.A	253.02	-1.2
HelloGroup	MOMO	8.73	2.7
HingeHealth	HNGE	48.85	7.4
HowmetAerospace	HWM	177.50	0.5
IdexxLab	IDXX	530.74	1.1
Insmed	INSM	106.58	0.5
InterDigital	IDCC	237.50	1.0
IBM	IBM	294.34	1.6
iRhythmTechs	IRTC	154.51	1.8
Itron	ITRI	131.48	-0.2
JPMorganChase	JPM	282.71	1.1
JVSPAC Acqn	JVSAU	14.49	20.7
JVSPAC Acqn A	JVSA	15.40	14.3
Jabil	JBL	212.07	1.7
JenaAcqnII	JENA.U	10.35	0.3
K&FGrowthII	KFII	10.18	0.1
KB Financial	KB	82.58	4.7
KeenVisionAcqn	KVAC	11.39	0.7
KenonHoldings	KEN	39.45	3.0
KoreaElecPwr	KEP	12.68	21.5
LibertyFormOne A	FWONA	95.39	1.0
LibertyFormOne C	FWONK	106.00	0.7
LibertyLiveA	LLYVA	80.54	-1.9
LifecoreBiomed	LFCR	8.29	12.0
Limbach	LMB	144.00	0.6
LiminatusPharma	LIMN	27.00	33.4
LiminatusWt	LIMNW	0.45	18.2
MGIC Investment	MTG	28.28	1.4
M3-BrigadeV	MBAVU	15.00	2.4
MYR Group	MYRG	188.71	2.6
MagicSoftware	MGIC	18.03	2.9
MagyarBancorp	MGYR	17.00	2.4
ManchesterUnited	MANU	19.65	1.3
MasTec	MTZ	170.09	1.9
mF Intl	MFI	6.69	16.7
Microsoft	MSFT	491.85	0.8
Mint	MIMI	7.35	-2.9
MountainLakeA	MLAC	10.27	0.2
MrCooper	COOP	156.35	2.4
NACCO Inds	NC	41.54	3.9
NanoLabs	NA	31.48	36.4
Nasdaq	NDAQ	88.44	1.6
Nayax	NYAX	49.84	5.5
NektarTherap	NKTR	27.68	156.3
NetEase	NTES	134.12	2.9
Netflix	NFLX	1282.57	2.0
NewMarket	NEU	690.73	1.5
O-I Glass	OI	14.83	2.2
Ollie'sBargain	OLLI	129.92	0.3
OrmatTech	ORA	87.20	-0.3
OstinTech	OST	8.65	4.4
Ouster	OUST	24.99	1.2
PagayaTech	PGY	19.97	6.5
ParkHaBio	PHH	31.61	4.4
Paysign	PAYS	6.53	8.6
PelicanAcqn	PELI	10.02	0.5
PelicanAcqnRt	PELIR	0.25	22.2
Pheton	PTHL	20.55	-5.4
PhoenixAsia	PHOE	11.99	24.2
PioneerBancorp	PBFS	12.27	2.1
Pitanium	PTNM	7.42	0.7
PlanetFitness	PLNT	110.95	-0.7
Popular	BPOP	109.66	0.5
PostalRealty	PSTL	15.42	-0.4
PowerSolutions	PSIX	65.97	5.8
Primech	PMEC	1.46	...
PriorityIncmPfdK	PRIFpK	23.60	0.9
Prudential	PUK	24.89	2.0
QXO Pfd B	QXOpB	68.39	-1.9
QuantaServices	PWR	373.30	1.8
RBC Bearings	RBC	390.67	1.8
Radware	RDWR	28.90	0.4
RealAssetAcqnA	RAAQ	10.29	0.3
Robinhood	HOOD	82.27	7.4
Roblox	RBLX	105.22	1.2
RocketLab	RKLB	34.23	2.1
RoyalCaribbean	RCL	285.75	2.5
RoyaltyPharma	RPRX	36.32	2.1
Sagimet	SGMT	10.43	17.6
Sanmina	SANM	93.86	2.1
SatixFyComms	SATX	2.99	...
Seagate	STX	137.54	2.4
SensientTech	SXT	99.17	-0.4
Sezzle	SEZL	161.60	10.4
Shift4PayPfdA	FOURpA	114.60	4.9
SmartStop	SMA	37.79	0.3
Snowflake	SNOW	224.61	4.4
SoYoungIntl	SY	2.24	3.3
SolenoTherap	SLNO	85.36	3.4
SonicAutomotive	SAH	82.53	2.0
SoundGroup	SOGP	4.48	60.1
Sportradar	SRAD	27.28	4.2
Spotify	SPOT	754.21	2.6
StateStreet	STT	103.99	1.6
StoneCo	STNE	15.79	5.4
Stran	SWAG	1.60	8.1
TSS	TSSI	29.81	5.6
TTM Tech	TTMI	37.93	2.5
Take-TwoSftwr	TTWO	245.08	0.6
TalenEnergy	TLN	296.89	0.9
Tecogen	TGEN	7.62	-1.3
TelefonicaBras	VIV	11.10	0.5
Telesat	TSAT	26.07	3.9
TerraPropNts2026	TPTA	18.80	3.3
TitanAcqnWt	TACHW	0.34	21.4
TorontoDomBk	TD	72.11	0.9
TrancntlRlty	TCI	43.97	2.5
TutorPerini	TPC	44.72	2.8
UGI	UGI	36.74	0.2
UL Solutions	ULS	72.94	2.0
UMBFinPfdB	UMBFO	25.84	0.3
VeronaPharma	VRNA	99.01	0.2
ViaRenewablesPfdA	VIASP	25.55	-0.1
VineHillCapWt	VCICW	0.37	-3.6
WF	WFF	16.84	-7.1
WesternDigital	WDC	62.32	2.8
Willdan	WLDN	59.47	1.2
WintrustFinPfdF	WTFCN	26.09	...
Woodward	WWD	243.78	0.4
WooriFinl	WF	48.83	5.4
YatsenHolding	YSG	9.84	1.5
YouxinTechnologyA	YAAS	6.74	95.4
Zscaler	ZS	314.64	-0.6

Lows

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
Ayro	AYRO	0.32	-2.8
AdvancedBiomed	ADVB	0.68	3.1
Agriforce	AGRI	0.92	-4.9
Alumis	ALMS	2.76	7.5
AlzamendNeuro	ALZN	2.79	-0.7
AquaMetals	AQMS	0.55	-2.1
AspenInsurance	AHL	30.78	-1.5
AvitaMedical	RCEL	4.77	-3.9
Azitra	AZTR	0.23	7.1
B.RileyPfdB	RILYL	1.86	-4.3
BaiyaIntl	BIYA	0.62	0.2
BeasleyBroadcast	BBGI	3.82	-5.7
BoozAllen	BAH	98.95	-0.5
BoundlessBio	BOLD	1.00	4.9
BrookfldBRP7.25Nt	BEPJ	22.81	1.5
BrookfieldNts2084	BIPJ	22.61	1.1
CalidiBiotherap	CLDI	0.23	-8.7
ChampionsGateRt	CHPGR	0.15	-11.1
ChansonIntl	CHSN	0.14	-5.5
DermataTherap	DRMA	0.61	-0.3
EksoBionics	EKSO	2.73	8.5
Enigmatig	EGG	2.53	-22.8
Equillium	EQ	0.27	22.6
ErnexaTherap	ERNA	1.75	-17.5
FastTrack	FTRK	2.50	-60.4
FirstNWBncp	FNWB	7.45	1.5
ForesightAuto	FRSX	0.45	-4.4
FourLeafAcqnWt	FORLW	0.01	-49.4
FreightTech	FRGT	1.54	-3.4
Freshpet	FRPT	70.35	0.8
FusionFuelGreen	HTOO	0.19	-6.3
GIBO	GIBO	0.35	-36.1
GabelliEquityPfdK	GABpK	20.49	-0.1
GabelliMultPfdE	GGTpE	22.25	-0.9
GabelliUtilPfdC	GUTpC	22.40	-0.9
GoldenHeaven	GDHG	0.99	2.0
HCW Biologics	HCWB	4.05	-6.4
HappyCity	HCHL	4.50	...
HighPeakEnerWt	HPKEW	0.31	-44.3
HuachenAIPkg	HCAI	0.89	-7.3
HudsonGlobal	HSON	8.32	0.6
INVO Fertility	IVF	0.97	-6.5
InflectionPtA	IPCX	10.10	-0.2
Ioneer	IONR	2.30	-0.1
IspireTechnology	ISPR	2.26	-4.5
JinxinTech	NAMI	1.02	10.7
KrispyKreme	DNUT	2.50	-0.8
LeeEnterprises	LEE	5.83	-1.1
Leslie's	LESL	0.45	5.1
MicroAlgo	MLGO	0.56	-10.2
MullenAuto	MULN	1.00	-9.0
MultiSensorAIWt	MSAIW	0.01	0.7
NaaSTechnology	NAAS	0.60	4.1
NeOncTech	NTHI	3.51	-17.4
NexaResources	NEXA	4.44	0.2
NexalinTechWt	NXLIW	0.05	-4.1
Ontrak	OTRK	1.02	-21.1
OxfordIndustries	OXM	37.98	-4.8
P3HealthPtrs	PIII	6.00	-2.3
PerfectMoment	PMNT	0.38	6.6
PrairieOperating	PROP	3.34	-6.6
REE Automotive	REE	0.56	-0.7
RockwellMedical	RMTI	0.86	-0.8
SCYNEXIS	SCYX	0.72	1.5
Shineco	SISI	0.18	-13.5
SimonPropPfdJ	SPGpJ	54.08	0.9
SimulationsPlus	SLP	16.83	0.4
SmartKem	SMTK	0.78	0.5
Soligenix	SNGX	1.32	-19.4
TNF Pharm	TNFA	0.13	1.3
Talphera	TLPH	0.43	-2.2
TelomirPharm	TELO	1.65	4.1
UWM Wt	UWMC.WS	0.06	-15.1
ValarisWt	VAL.WS	3.50	-2.3
VinceHolding	VNCE	1.02	-6.0
WellgisticsHealth	WGRX	0.97	-5.6
WindtreeTherap	WINT	0.38	-1.1
XCFGlobal	SAFX	1.50	4.9
X4 Pharm	XFOR	2.26	-5.0

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MARKETS

Spain Puts Pause on BBVA-Sabadell Deal

Banks must be kept independent for at least three years, government says

By Elena Vardon

The Spanish government said it would clear **Banco Bilbao Vizcaya Argentaria**'s hostile bid for smaller peer **Banco de Sabadell** on the condition that the banks don't legally merge for up to five years.

Madrid can't stop BBVA from buying shared tendered by Sabadell shareholders, but is able to impose conditions on a legal merger.

Spain's Ministry of Economy, Commerce and Business said Tuesday that both entities and their assets will have to be kept separate and manage their activities independently for at least three years.

Decision-making will need to be autonomous in areas such as financing and credit, especially for small and medium enterprises, human resources as well as for its branch networks and banking services, Economy Minister Carlos Cuerpo said.

Ahead of the three-year deadline, the banks will need to submit reports; the cabinet will determine the effectiveness of the condition, and decide whether to extend it for two more years, Cuerpo said. He confirmed the remedies previously green-lighted by the country's competition regulator that related to keeping some branches open and maintaining commercial terms for specific customers.

The ministry last month referred the offer to the cabinet on general-interest grounds other than competition, citing the potential impact of the deal on the sector, territorial cohesion and social policy, among other reasons.

BBVA set its sights on Catalan lender Sabadell in May 2024 to bolster its presence in its home market, and went hostile in its pursuit after encountering opposition from management, sparking political backlash. The value of the initial $12 billion-plus deal has fluctuated as the share component of the offer is tied to the stock prices of both banks, which have increased over the almost 14 months since the initial deal.

Government officials and union leaders have said the deal would harm competition, employment and financial inclusion. The proposed transaction has been approved by the European Central Bank and Spain's competition watchdog.

The overarching condition of prolonged separation has been chosen to favor an orderly transition, preserving intangible assets, and the public interest, the ministry said. The decision follows a 30-day cabinet review of the bid.

Shares in BBVA rose 2.5% in Madrid, while Sabadell stock edged up 0.4%.

BBVA said it is evaluating the decision.

BBVA Chair Carlos Torres Vila has previously said the bank could walk away from the bid if the conditions were too harsh.

MICHAEL ROBINSON CHAVEZ/BLOOMBERG NEWS

BBVA set its sights on Sabadell last year.

A Sabadell representative reiterated the bank's confidence and conviction in its stand-alone future. If BBVA moves forward with the deal, it must provide shareholders information about the impact of the conditions on its ability to deliver synergies and distribute capital, Sabadell said.

Oil Falls, Stocks Rise On Mideast

Continued from page B1

on Tuesday, with **Exxon Mobil** sliding 3%.

Overseas, the pan-continental Stoxx Europe 600 rose 1.1%. In Asia, major stock indexes in Hong Kong, South Korea and Taiwan were all up more than 2% for the day.

TUESDAY'S MARKETS

As geopolitical worries subsided, the Cboe Volatility Index—known as Wall Street's "fear gauge"—tumbled 12%. Gold, which is seen as a safe-haven asset in times of volatility, also fell, with futures on the precious metal declining 1.8%.

Israel and Iran continued to exchange fire in the hours after Trump's cease-fire announcement, but signs later emerged that the truce was beginning to stick. Israel said it had achieved its war aims and was reopening its airports. Iran's foreign minister had said his country would stop its attacks as long as Israel did.

U.S. stocks have also gotten a boost in recent days from signs that at least some members of the Federal Reserve's key rate-setting committee are open to adopting a looser monetary policy.

Fed Chair Jerome Powell reaffirmed the central bank's wait-and-see stance on rate cuts in testimony on Capitol Hill on Tuesday, citing concerns that price increases from Trump's tariff policies could fuel inflation. But rifts have opened on the Fed, with two Fed governors—both Trump appointees—signaling in recent days they would consider cutting rates in July.

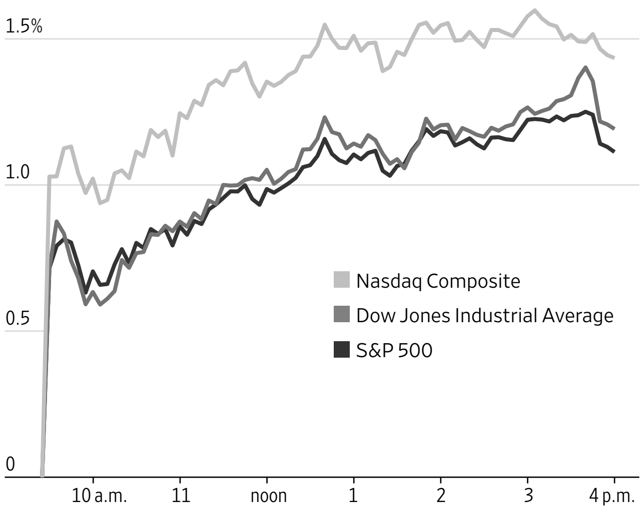
"More and more members are breaking ranks," said Thomas Hayes, chairman of Great Hill Capital.

The Fed chief is also facing pressure from the president to lower rates. Ahead of Powell's testimony, Trump posted on social media that he hoped Congress "really works this very dumb, hardheaded person over."

Fresh survey data from the Conference Board showed consumer confidence fell in June, in a sign that Americans remained nervous about tariffs, even after the White House took steps to de-escalate the trade war. Analysts polled by The Wall Street Journal had expected the index to improve.

The weak consumer-sentiment data helped send U.S. Treasury yields lower, with the 10-year yield declining to 4.291%, as investors have become more hopeful that the Fed will pivot back to cutting interest rates. After lowering rates in 2024, the Fed has held interest rates steady this year, citing inflation risks.

Index performance on Tuesday



Source: FactSet

STOCK SPOTLIGHT

Occidental Petroleum, Exxon Mobil and APA
Shares of energy companies dropped, mirroring the decline in oil prices after Israel confirmed a cease-fire with Iran. Occidental lost 3.3%, Exxon Mobil declined 3% and APA slipped 1.1%. Defense contractors also retreated, with Lockheed Martin dropping 2.6% and RTX falling 2.7%.

Advanced Micro Devices
The semiconductor company's stock rose 6.8%, adding to gains Monday amid analyst upgrades to its shares. CFRA Research cited the company's progress in AI chips in its upgrade note. Fellow chip players gained, including Broadcom, up 3.9%, and Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing, which increased 4.6%.

Mastercard
The credit-card company is adopting Fiserv's blockchain-based token across products, allowing merchants and shoppers to use digital assets for transactions. Mastercard rose 2.8% and Fiserv shares rallied 1.2%.

Uber
The ride-hailing service and Waymo launched a self-driving taxi service in Atlanta, just days after Tesla launched its robotaxi service. Uber shares jumped 7.5%, while Tesla fell 2.4%.

WEDNESDAY'S EVENTS:

◆ Economic data: New-home sales data for May; EIA weekly petroleum report

◆ Fed speaker: Jerome Powell will testify before the Senate Committee on Banking, Housing, and Urban Affairs at 10 a.m.

EARNINGS EXPECTED:
A.M.
General Mills
P.M.
Micron and Jefferies

Biggest 1,000 Stocks | WSJ.com/stocks

Continued From Page B10

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
M N			
Macom Tech	MTSI	139.84	1.19
M&T Bank	MTB	190.12	0.71
MGM Resorts	MGM	34.20	0.95
MPLX	MPLX	51.84	0.71
MSCI	MSCI	575.69	20.57
MagnaIntl	MGA	37.61	0.22
MakeMyTrip	MMYT	95.99	4.48
ManhattanAssoc	MANH	194.64	1.97
ManulifeFinl	MFC	31.52	0.21
Maplebear	CART	44.97	1.11
MarathonPetrol	MPC	165.29	-1.32
Markel	MKL	1988.98	4.24
MarketAxess	MKTX	222.73	1.92
Marriott	MAR	268.73	4.62
Marsh&McLen	MMC	219.67	0.56
MartinMarietta	MLM	552.37	0.41
MarvellTech	**MRVL**	**75.21**	**4.43**
Masco	MAS	63.78	0.83
Masimo	MASI	170.27	2.15
MasTec	MTZ	169.51	3.17
Mastercard	MA	557.53	15.18
McCormickVtg	MKCV	74.44	-0.27
McCormick	MKC	74.71	-0.18
McDonald's	MCD	291.47	1.95
McKesson	MCK	720.82	-1.01
Medpace	MEDP	315.28	6.64
Medtronic	MDT	86.08	0.12
MercadoLibre	MELI	2528.95	76.06
Merck	MRK	80.32	0.16
MetaPlatforms	META	712.20	13.67
MetLife	MET	79.66	0.03
Mettler-Toledo	MTD	1185.18	21.57
MicrochipTech	MCHP	70.43	1.85
MicronTech	MU	127.91	5.83
Microsoft	MSFT	490.11	4.11
MicroStrategy	MSTR	377.02	9.84
MidAmApt	MAA	149.17	-0.99
MitsubishiUFJ	MUFG	13.77	0.34
MizuhoFin	MFG	5.60	0.18
Mobileye	**MBLY**	**17.95**	**1.53**
Moderna	MRNA	26.80	1.13
MolinaHealthcare	MOH	294.51	3.37
MolsonCoorsB	TAP	48.22	0.17
monday.com	MNDY	300.33	11.64
Mondelez	MDLZ	68.43	-0.06
MongoDB	MDB	209.25	6.01
MonolithicPower	MPWR	716.58	23.96
MonsterBev	MNST	63.57	0.36
Moody's	MCO	489.00	12.73
MorganStanley	MS	135.90	1.90
Morningstar	MORN	309.88	7.04
Mosaic	MOS	35.54	-0.50
MotorolaSol	MSI	418.35	7.48
MrCooper	COOP	155.96	3.62
MuellerIndustries	MLI	77.53	0.55
MurphyUSA	MUSA	415.44	-9.77
NICE	NICE	165.21	2.65
NNN REIT	NNN	43.00	-0.42
NRG Energy	NRG	153.68	1.63
NXP Semicon	NXPI	218.51	7.65
NVR	NVR	7277.59	-61.58
Nasdaq	NDAQ	88.12	1.39
Natera	NTRA	171.87	1.50
NationalGrid	NGG	73.25	-0.08
NatWest	NWG	14.01	0.39
Nebius	**NBIS**	**51.02**	**3.54**
NetApp	NTAP	106.13	1.86
NetEase	NTES	134.05	3.72
Netflix	NFLX	1279.11	25.57
Neurocrine	NBIX	128.18	2.38
NYTimes A	NYT	54.76	0.04
Newmont	NEM	58.09	-1.37
NewsCorp A	NWSA	29.25	0.39
NewsCorp B	NWS	33.60	0.37
NextEraEnergy	NEE	71.40	0.67
Nextracker	NXT	57.26	1.06
Nike	NKE	61.42	0.64
NiSource	NI	40.52	0.01
Nokia	NOK	5.20	0.03
Nomura	NMR	6.25	0.11
Nordson	NDSN	213.36	0.34
NorfolkSouthern	NSC	257.46	0.88
NorthernTrust	NTRS	118.18	-2.63
NorthropGrum	NOC	484.00	-15.67
NorwegCruise	NCLH	19.40	0.80
Novartis	NVS	118.83	1.31
NovoNordisk	NVO	70.73	-1.01
NuHoldings	**NU**	**13.43**	**1.09**
Nucor	NUE	128.20	2.21
NuScalePower	**SMR**	**43.24**	**6.74**
Nutanix	NTNX	74.27	0.99
Nutrien	NTR	59.42	-0.91
nVentElectric	NVT	72.34	1.59
NVIDIA	NVDA	147.90	3.73
O P Q			
OGE Energy	OGE	44.72	-0.03
ONEOK	OKE	80.56	0.71
ON Semi	ON	54.21	1.04
O'ReillyAuto	ORLY	89.18	-2.08
OccidentalPetrol	OXY	42.48	-1.47
Oklo	**OKLO**	**60.71**	**5.60**
Okta	OKTA	98.53	-0.13
OldDomFreight	ODFL	161.97	0.61
OldRepublic	ORI	37.96	-0.25
Ollie'sBargain	OLLI	129.55	0.34
OmegaHealthcare	OHI	37.11	-0.19
Omnicom	OMC	72.48	0.78
OnHolding	ONON	52.46	-0.61
Oracle	ORCL	215.27	8.23
Orix	IX	21.60	0.12
OtisWorldwide	OTIS	97.41	1.43
Ovintiv	OVV	38.67	-0.24
OwensCorning	OC	137.99	2.55
PDD	**PDD**	**107.16**	**5.21**
PG&E	PCG	14.16	0.35
PNC Finl	PNC	182.02	1.27
POSCO	**PKX**	**49.19**	**2.53**
PPG Ind	PPG	113.88	1.55
PPL	PPL	34.21	-0.09
PTC	PTC	169.93	3.47
Paccar	PCAR	94.01	2.26
PackagingCpAm	PKG	189.41	0.71
PalantirTech	PLTR	143.23	3.31
PaloAltoNtwks	PANW	201.69	-1.63
PanAmerSilver	PAAS	28.39	-0.64
ParamountA	PARAA	22.79	-0.04
ParamountB	PARA	12.21	-0.11
ParkerHannifin	PH	675.25	13.63
Paychex	PAYX	152.25	1.00
PaycomSoftware	PAYC	235.05	2.08
Paylocity	PCTY	182.62	4.82
PayPal	PYPL	73.58	1.57
Pearson	PSO	14.57	0.02
Pegasystems	PEGA	51.61	1.66
PembinaPipeline	PBA	36.93	0.08
PenskeAuto	PAG	177.56	2.26
Pentair	PNR	101.23	1.67
Penumbra	PEN	255.72	1.26
PepsiCo	PEP	131.05	1.96
PerformanceFood	PFGC	86.77	-0.46
PermianRscs	PR	14.01	-0.09
PetroleoBrasil	PBR	12.41	-0.29
PetroleoBrasilA	PBR.A	11.35	-0.27
Pfizer	PFE	24.31	0.28
PhilipMorris	PM	184.49	-0.46
Phillips66	PSX	119.46	-1.57
Pilgrim'sPride	PPC	46.62	0.54
PinnacleFinPtrs	PNFP	108.51	0.97
PinnacleWest	PNW	90.17	0.52
Pinterest	**PINS**	**35.74**	**1.74**
PlainsAllAmPipe	PAA	18.12	-0.13
PlainsGP	PAGP	19.32	-0.11
PlanetFitness	PLNT	108.04	-0.78
Pool	POOL	300.74	6.78
Primerica	PRI	268.58	1.82
PrimoBrands	PRMB	29.63	-0.45
PrincipalFinl	PFG	77.82	0.40
ProcoreTech	PCOR	68.32	2.14
Procter&Gamble	PG	160.36	-0.67
Progressive	PGR	266.01	-0.37
Prologis	PLD	108.13	1.00
PrudentialFinl	PRU	106.30	0.70
Prudential	PUK	24.85	0.49
PSEG	PEG	83.13	-0.21
PublicStorage	PSA	295.60	0.84
PulteGroup	PHM	105.49	0.64
PureStorage	PSTG	54.71	1.46
QXO	QXO	23.51	-0.61
Qiagen	QGEN	47.23	0.52
Qualcomm	QCOM	155.71	2.57
QuantaServices	PWR	372.26	6.50
QuestDiag	DGX	179.90	0.18
R S			
RBC Bearings	RBC	388.19	6.94
RB Global	RBA	105.61	1.32
RELX	RELX	53.31	0.20
RPM	RPM	110.22	1.25
RTX	RTX	141.85	-3.96
RalphLauren	RL	273.79	3.24
RangeResources	RRC	41.93	0.55
RaymondJames	RJF	150.88	-0.08
RealtyIncome	O	57.98	-0.39
Reddit	RDDT	140.79	6.65
RegalRexnord	RRX	145.13	4.12
RegencyCtrs	REG	71.66	-0.61
RegeneronPharm	REGN	522.27	10.35
RegionsFinl	RF	22.88	0.24
ReinsGrp	RGA	197.53	-0.67
Reliance	RS	308.90	-0.43
RenaissanceRe	RNR	244.19	-0.71
RentokilInit	RTO	23.84	0.33
RepublicSvcs	RSG	250.75	0.07
ResMed	RMD	255.91	1.39
RestaurantBrands	QSR	65.51	0.19
Revvity	RVTY	96.39	1.44
RexfordIndlRealty	REXR	37.16	0.21
RioTinto	RIO	57.19	0.10
Rivian	RIVN	13.81	0.16
Robinhood	**HOOD**	**82.01**	**5.66**
Roblox	RBLX	104.78	1.29
RocketCos.	RKT	14.95	0.26
RocketLab	RKLB	33.46	0.68
Rockwell	ROK	325.95	2.14
RogersComm B	RCI	29.14	0.98
RoivantSciences	ROIV	11.54	0.04
Roku	ROKU	83.69	2.79
Rollins	ROL	57.52	0.39
RoperTech	ROP	571.02	4.84
RossStores	ROST	128.33	0.46
RoyalBkCanada	RY	128.32	1.13
RoyalCaribbean	RCL	280.47	6.79
RoyalGold	RGLD	178.14	-4.93
RoyaltyPharma	RPRX	36.14	0.74
Rubrik	RBRK	90.10	0.39
RyanSpecialty	RYAN	69.17	0.51
Ryanair	RYAAY	57.12	2.14
SAP	SAP	297.08	6.28
S&P Global	SPGI	522.97	8.39
SBA Comm	SBAC	236.60	2.48
SEI Investments	SEIC	86.15	1.42
SK Telecom	SKM	23.04	0.51
SS&C Tech	SSNC	81.43	0.66
SailPoint	SAIL	24.26	0.74
Salesforce	CRM	271.17	7.76
Samsara	IOT	40.28	1.05
Sanofi	SNY	48.42	0.24
Schlumberger	SLB	33.50	-0.23
SchwabC	SCHW	89.32	0.94
Sea	SE	158.29	4.77
Seagate	STX	136.31	3.23
Sempra	SRE	76.09	0.30
ServiceIntl	SCI	79.60	0.16
ServiceNow	NOW	996.32	15.92
ServiceTitan	TTAN	105.94	1.97
SharkNinja	SN	94.43	2.68
Shell	SHEL	70.14	-0.70
SherwinWilliams	SHW	345.69	1.92
Shift4Payments	FOUR	97.14	3.59
ShinhanFin	SHG	44.40	1.22
Shopify	SHOP	114.42	4.44
SimonProperty	SPG	160.12	1.04
SkechersUSA	SKX	62.77	0.10
Skyworks	SWKS	73.42	1.07
SmithAO	AOS	64.94	0.80
Smith&Nephew	SNN	29.85	0.68
SmithfieldFds	SFD	23.56	-0.05
Smucker	SJM	97.19	-0.14
SmurfitWestrock	SW	43.50	1.08
Snap	**SNAP**	**8.32**	**0.41**
Snap-On	SNA	308.46	0.13
Snowflake	SNOW	223.14	9.43
SOQUIMICH	SQM	33.95	1.04
SoFiTech	SOFI	15.85	0.49
Solventum	SOLV	74.98	1.73
Somnigroup	SGI	67.22	1.09
Sony	SONY	24.99	0.57
SouthState	SSB	89.63	1.42
Southern	SO	90.89	0.22
SoCopper	SCCO	96.91	2.26
SouthwestAir	LUV	31.86	-0.02
Sportradar	SRAD	26.97	1.08
Spotify	SPOT	749.91	18.76
SproutsFarmers	SFM	166.47	-6.82
StandardAero	SARO	30.13	0.17
StanleyB&D	SWK	66.36	0.70
Stantec	STN	106.92	0.29
Starbucks	SBUX	91.50	-0.84
StateStreet	STT	102.90	1.66
SteelDynamics	STLD	128.22	0.79
Stellantis	STLA	9.59	0.23
Steris	STE	239.59	2.68
StifelFinancial	SF	100.64	1.51
STMicroelec	STM	30.17	1.16
Stryker	SYK	386.46	7.30
SumitomoMits	SMFG	15.17	0.42
SummitTherap	SMMT	20.92	0.53
SunComms	SUI	128.10	0.16
SunLifeFinancial	SLF	65.10	0.28
SuncorEnergy	SU	38.28	-0.69
Sunoco	SUN	52.80	-0.38
SuperMicroComp	SMCI	42.84	1.95
Suzano	SUZ	9.41	0.04
Symbotic	SYM	32.20	-0.69
SynchronyFinl	SYF	64.74	1.49
Synopsys	SNPS	478.98	8.00
Sysco	SYY	75.87	-0.04
T U V			
TC Energy	TRP	47.19	-0.05
TD Synnex	**SNX**	**136.88**	**9.28**
TE Connectivity	TEL	166.48	0.66
Telus	TU	16.03	-0.16
TIM	TIMB	19.21	-0.02
TJX	TJX	124.60	-0.16
TKO	TKO	176.89	1.36
T-MobileUS	TMUS	229.82	2.84
TPG	TPG	52.12	1.43
T.RowePrice	TROW	95.10	1.11
TaiwanSemi	TSM	220.09	9.77
Take-TwoSftwr	TTWO	243.05	1.46
TakedaPharm	TAK	15.08	0.36
TalenEnergy	TLN	294.17	2.58
Tapestry	TPR	87.26	1.51
TargaResources	TRGP	167.73	3.00
Target	TGT	97.53	1.00
TechnipFMC	FTI	34.05	-0.09
TeckResourcesB	TECK	38.55	0.34
TeledyneTech	TDY	494.63	3.63
Ericsson	ERIC	8.38	0.16
TelefonicaBras	VIV	11.05	0.05
Telefonica	TEF	5.26	0.03
TelekomIndns	TLK	16.06	0.16
TempusAI	TEM	68.28	2.63
Tenaris	TS	35.70	...
TencentMusic	TME	18.76	0.40
TenetHealthcare	THC	171.52	2.40
Teradyne	TER	90.39	3.03
Tesla	TSLA	340.47	-8.21
TetraTech	TTEK	35.73	0.69
TevaPharm	TEVA	17.09	0.12
TexasInstruments	TXN	205.81	4.42
TexasPacLand	TPL	1059.94	9.94
TexasRoadhouse	TXRH	188.79	0.20
Textron	TXT	78.76	1.26
ThermoFisher	TMO	404.37	4.16
ThomsonReuters	TRI	197.19	1.30
3M	MMM	149.87	2.27
Toast	TOST	44.67	1.31
TollBros	TOL	113.30	0.82
TopBuild	BLD	326.59	2.05
TorontoDomBk	TD	71.80	0.62
TotalEnergies	TTE	60.40	-0.88
ToyotaMotor	TM	171.58	0.70
TractorSupply	TSCO	53.51	-0.15
TradeDesk	TTD	71.84	2.97
Tradeweb	TW	141.46	1.36
TraneTech	TT	429.02	2.10
TransDigm	TDG	1472.95	2.27
TransUnion	TRU	89.81	2.92
Travelers	TRV	266.14	-1.48
Trimble	TRMB	73.71	1.00
Trip.com	TCOM	58.89	1.28
TruistFinl	TFC	41.45	0.40
Twilio	TWLO	121.62	3.86
TylerTech	TYL	588.63	8.56
TysonFoods	TSN	55.51	0.40
UBS Group	UBS	32.05	0.99
UDR	UDR	40.98	-0.41
U-Haul	UHAL	61.33	-0.26
U-Haul N	UHAL/B	54.45	-0.27
UL Solutions	ULS	72.91	1.44
US Foods	USFD	76.69	0.36
Uber	**UBER**	**91.65**	**6.41**
Ubiquiti	UI	397.64	8.90
UltaBeauty	ULTA	464.49	-7.07
Unilever	UL	62.34	-0.01
UnionPacific	UNP	227.91	2.03
UnitedAirlines	UAL	79.02	2.05
UnitedMicro	UMC	7.89	0.25
UPS B	UPS	100.62	0.22
UnitedRentals	URI	740.77	24.20
US Bancorp	USB	44.54	0.45
UnitedTherap	UTHR	289.94	3.55
UnitedHealth	UNH	305.62	4.94
UnitySoftware	U	24.04	0.74
UniversalHealthB	UHS	175.20	1.68
UnumGroup	UNM	79.43	-0.64
VICI Prop	VICI	32.81	...
Vale	VALE	9.21	0.03
ValeroEnergy	VLO	135.85	-1.21
VeevaSystems	VEEV	281.63	1.33
Ventas	VTR	63.35	-0.18
VentureGlobal	VG	16.72	0.18
Veralto	VLTO	100.31	1.86
VeriSign	VRSN	285.03	2.14
VeriskAnalytics	VRSK	309.93	1.52
Verizon	VZ	42.63	0.27
VeronaPharma	VRNA	97.22	0.17
VertexPharm	VRTX	450.27	6.73
Vertiv	VRT	122.32	5.70
Viatris	VTRS	8.95	0.16
Viking	VIK	51.38	1.68
VinFastAuto	VFS	3.47	0.04
ViperEnergy	VNOM	38.59	-0.09
Visa	V	351.63	7.88
Vistra	VST	186.17	-0.38
Vodafone	VOD	10.44	0.23
VornadoRealty	VNO	38.46	-1.12
VulcanMatls	VMC	264.48	4.44
W X Y Z			
WEC Energy	WEC	105.36	-0.14
W.P.Carey	WPC	64.39	-0.14
Wabtec	WAB	205.87	3.68
WalgreensBoots	WBA	11.35	...
Walmart	WMT	98.00	0.13
WarnerBrosA	WBD	10.90	0.22
WarnerMusic	WMG	27.02	0.18
WasteConnections	WCN	188.16	0.53
WasteMgt	WM	234.14	-0.57
Waters	WAT	346.80	3.97
Watsco	WSO	431.21	1.82
WattsWater	WTS	246.14	1.02
WebsterFin	WBS	53.68	0.57
WellsFargo	WFC	78.11	1.10
Welltower	WELL	154.25	0.13
WescoIntl	WCC	184.99	3.98
WestPharmSvcs	WST	222.68	5.98
WestAllianceBcp	WAL	75.91	1.21
WesternDigital	WDC	62.07	1.69
WesternMidstrm	WES	38.16	-0.53
Westlake	WLK	75.78	2.22
Weyerhaeuser	WY	26.65	0.07
WheatonPrecMtls	WPM	88.57	-1.60
Williams	WMB	61.12	0.64
Williams-Sonoma	WSM	157.88	-0.01
WillisTowers	WTW	302.38	-1.31
Wingstop	WING	364.11	3.92
WintrustFinl	WTFC	122.89	0.46
Wipro	WIT	3.07	0.05
Wix.com	WIX	161.21	2.53
WoodsideEnergy	WDS	15.58	-0.60
Woodward	WWD	242.68	1.01
WooriFinl	**WF**	**48.59**	**2.48**
Workday	WDAY	239.19	2.61
WynnResorts	WYNN	90.97	1.27
XP	XP	19.41	0.16
XPO	XPO	125.93	1.50
XcelEnergy	XEL	68.23	0.32
XPeng	XPEV	19.85	0.68
Xylem	XYL	127.15	1.66
YPF	YPF	34.35	0.56
YumBrands	YUM	142.70	1.31
YumChina	YUMC	44.40	0.44
ZTO Express	ZTO	17.61	0.25
ZebraTech	ZBRA	298.94	2.69
Zillow C	Z	70.22	1.16
Zillow A	ZG	68.67	1.19
ZimmerBiomet	ZBH	92.34	0.84
Zoetis	ZTS	157.77	0.43
ZoomComms	ZM	76.45	-0.82
Zscaler	ZS	308.46	-2.00

AUCTION RESULTS

Here are the results of Tuesday's Treasury auctions. All bids are awarded at a single price at the market-clearing yield. Rates are determined by the difference between that price and the face value.

SIX-WEEK BILLS

Applications	$173,116,178,800
Accepted bids	$57,332,746,700
" noncompetitively	$1,181,480,500
" foreign noncompetitively	$0
Auction price (rate)	99.484333 (4.420%)
Coupon equivalent	4.505%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	98.65%
Cusip number	912797MG9

The bills, dated June 26, 2025, mature on Aug. 7, 2025.

TWO-YEAR NOTES

Applications	$184,613,997,200
Accepted bids	$75,866,447,200
" noncompetitively	$300,073,700
" foreign noncompetitively	$5,000,000
Auction price (rate)	99.931283 (3.786%)
Interest rate	3.750%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	4.18%
Cusip number	91282CNL1

The notes, dated June 30, 2025, mature on June 30, 2027.

Mutual Funds

Data provided by LSEG

Top 250 mutual-funds listings for Nasdaq-published share classes by net assets.

e-Ex-distribution. **f**-Previous day's quotation. **g**-Footnotes x and s apply. **j**-Footnotes e and s apply. **k**-Recalculated by LSEG, using updated data. **p**-Distribution costs apply, 12b-1. **r**-Redemption charge may apply. **s**-Stock split or dividend. **t**-Footnotes p and r apply. **v**-Footnotes x and e apply. **x**-Ex-dividend. **z**-Footnote x, e and s apply. **NA**-Not available due to incomplete price, performance or cost data. **NE**-Not released by LSEG; data under review. **NN**-Fund not tracked. **NS**-Fund didn't exist at start of period.

Tuesday, June 24, 2025

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret
AB Funds			
MunilncmShares	10.88	-0.01	-0.4
AB Funds - ADV			
LgCpGrAdv	114.45	+2.03	4.6
American Century Inv			
Ultra	93.47	+1.33	0.2
American Funds Cl A			
AmcpA	43.29	+0.74	5.8
AMutlA	58.71	+0.41	7.2
BalA	36.20	+0.37	6.7
BondA	11.31	+0.03	3.6
CapIBA	75.59	+0.55	11.0
CapWGrA	69.77	+0.98	10.7
EupacA	59.57	+1.07	14.0
FdInvA	86.17	+1.32	9.6
GwthA	80.30	+1.36	7.8
HI TrA	9.79	+0.02	3.4
ICAA	61.62	+0.89	8.4
IncoA	26.40	+0.13	9.5
N PerA	68.56	+0.97	10.4
NEcoA	66.55	+1.48	8.9
NwWrldA	87.58	+1.82	13.6
SmCpA	71.20	+1.01	5.7
TxExA	12.12	...	-0.8
WshA	62.89	+0.64	7.3
Artisan Funds			
IntlVal Inst	52.21	+0.66	11.2
Baird Funds			
AggBdInst	9.81	...	3.6
CorBdInst	10.16	-0.01	3.5
IntBdInst	10.45	-0.02	3.7
BlackRock Funds			
HiYBlk	7.16	+0.01	4.2
HiYldBd Inst	7.16	+0.02	4.2
BlackRock Funds III			
iShS&P500IdxK	707.27	...	6.1
BlackRock Funds Inst			
StratIncOpptyIns	9.66	+0.03	4.3
Calamos Funds			
MktNeutI	15.35	+0.02	3.3
CausewayInst			
CausewayInst	22.21	+0.43	19.7
Columbia Class I			
DivIncom I	34.49	+0.23	5.4
Dimensional Fds			
EmgMktVa	33.91	+0.80	13.6
EmMktCorEq	26.16	+0.61	12.6
IntlCoreEq	18.34	+0.19	19.2
IntSmCo	23.25	+0.25	20.0
IntSmVa	27.19	+0.28	25.1
LgCo	40.51	+0.45	4.2
US CoreEq1	44.54	+0.46	3.3
US CoreEq2	39.63	+0.41	3.0
US Small	47.77	+0.54	-2.1
US SmCpVal	46.30	+0.41	-4.2
US TgdVal	33.27	+0.33	-2.8
USLgVa	50.72	+0.33	3.4
Dodge & Cox			
Balanced	107.68	+0.69	7.6
Income	12.71	+0.04	3.8
Intl Stk	60.36	+0.89	21.0
Stock	268.40	+2.24	6.0
DoubleLine Funds			
TotRetBdI	8.84	+0.03	4.0
Edgewood Growth Instituti			
EdgewoodGrInst	46.25	+1.07	4.0
Fidelity			
500IdxInstPrem	212.14	+2.33	6.2
Contrafund K6	34.04	+0.47	9.7
ExtMktIdxInstPre	91.77	+1.34	1.0
FidSer5	7.65	+0.02	4.2
FidSerInt	8.73	...	1.1
FidSerToMarket	19.87	+0.22	3.8
FIDZroLgCpIx	23.61	+0.26	6.4
GlexUSIdxInstPre	16.90	+0.25	17.2
GrowthCompanyK6	31.12	+0.53	2.3
IntlIdxInstPrem	56.38	+0.69	18.6
LgCpGwId InstPre	40.51	+0.57	3.4
MidCpInxInstPrem	35.13	+0.40	4.0
SAIUSLgCpIndxFd	24.22	+0.26	4.2
SeriesBondFd	9.01	+0.03	3.5
SeriesOverseas	15.85	+0.22	17.9
SerLTTreBdIdx	5.34	+0.03	2.4
SmCpIdxInstPrem	27.01	+0.36	-2.4
TMktIdxInstPrem	167.32	+1.92	3.8
TotalMarketIndex	21.16	+0.24	3.9
TtlIntIdxInstPr	15.72	+0.23	17.1
USBdIdxInstPrem	10.40	+0.03	3.9
Fidelity Advisor			
TotBdFdClZ	9.53	+0.03	3.6
Fidelity Freedom			
Freedom2030 K	18.48	+0.17	7.7
Idx2030InsPre	21.39	+0.18	6.6
Idx2035InsPre	24.86	+0.23	7.1
Idx2040InsPre	26.48	+0.29	7.9
Idx2045InsPre	28.02	+0.30	8.2
Idx2050InsPre	28.12	+0.32	8.2
Fidelity Invest			
Balanc	30.54	+0.22	3.8
BluCh	229.98	+3.82	1.2
BluChpGr K6	37.88	+0.70	2.9
Contra	22.77	+0.30	9.1
ContraK	22.86	+0.30	9.2
CpInc	10.39	+0.07	4.6
DivIntl	49.22	+0.62	16.7
GroCo	40.86	+0.66	1.3
InvGrBd	10.06	+0.03	3.9
LowP	43.02	+0.44	5.6
Magin	15.29	+0.22	8.2
NASDAQ	253.15	+3.59	3.4
OTC	21.54	+0.29	3.6
Puritn	25.72	+0.23	4.1
SAIUSMinVolIndFd	22.47	+0.15	4.8
SAIUSQtyIdx	22.22	+0.27	4.4
SrsBlChGroRetail	20.08	+0.35	1.2
SrsEmrgMkt	21.26	+0.53	16.0
SrsGlobal	16.61	+0.24	17.1
SrsGroCoRetail	24.41	+0.39	1.8
SrsIntlGrw	19.43	+0.24	11.5
SrsIntlVal	15.00	+0.15	25.8
TotalBond	9.55	+0.03	3.7
Fidelity SAI			
FidSaiInfltnFnd	10.20	+0.02	4.2
TotalBd	9.05	+0.03	3.8
Fidelity Selects			
Semiconductors r	34.30	+1.14	8.3
Tech	37.50	+0.78	4.5
Fidelity Strategic A			
StratAdEmrMrt	NA	...	NA
First Eagle Funds			
GlbA	76.21	+0.42	13.7
Franklin A1			
IncomeA1	2.40	+0.01	4.6
FrankTemp/Frank Adv			
IncomeAdv	2.37	+0.01	4.2
FrankTemp/Franklin A			
DynaTech A	185.06	+3.45	6.0
Growth A	139.91	+1.78	4.8
RisDv A	93.04	+0.99	4.7
Guggenheim Funds Tru			
TotRtBndFdClInst	23.82	+0.07	4.1
Harbor Funds			
CapApInst	118.93	+1.83	4.6
JHF III DispVal			
DispValMCI	28.26	+0.15	4.9
John Hancock			
BondR6	13.52	+0.05	3.6
JPMorgan I Class			
CoreBond	10.30	+0.03	3.7
EqInc	24.93	+0.20	4.6
LgCpGwth	62.82	+1.29	3.9
JPMorgan R Class			
CoreBond	10.32	+0.03	3.8
CorePlusBd	7.23	+0.02	3.7
Lord Abbett I			
ShtDurInc p	3.88	+0.01	3.1
Metropolitan West			
TotRetBdI	NA	...	NA
MFS Funds			
IIE	38.95	+0.47	15.2
MFS Funds Class I			
GrowthI	210.62	+3.30	4.4
ValueI	51.20	+0.31	5.4
Natixis Funds			
InvGradeBdY	9.85	+0.03	3.4
LSGrowthY	31.09	+0.44	5.2
Northern Funds			
StkIdx	61.73	+0.49	4.2
Old Westbury Fds			
LrgCpStr	NA	...	NA
Parnassus Fds			
ParnEqFd	62.78	+0.74	5.4
PGIM Funds Cl Z			
TotalReturnBond	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Fds Instl			
TotRt	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds A			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds I2			
Income	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds Instl			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
Putnam Funds Class A			
PutLargCap p	36.34	+0.21	5.7
Putnam Funds Class Y			
PutLargCap	36.37	+0.22	5.9
Schwab Funds			
1000 Inv r	131.14	+1.49	4.2
Intl Sel r	26.79	+0.33	18.5
S&P Sel	94.10	+1.04	4.2
TSM Sel r	102.88	+1.18	3.8
Strategic Advisers			
StratAdCorInFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdFdCoreS	9.15	+0.03	3.7
StratAdFdEmr	13.84	+0.33	14.2
StratAdFdUS	18.10	+0.20	4.4
StratAdIntlFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdMuniBnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdvFidIntl	14.00	+0.16	18.6
TIAA/CREF Funds			
EqIdxInst	NA	...	NA
IntlEqIdxInst	NA	...	NA
LgCpGrIdxInst	69.25	+0.97	3.4
VANGUARD ADMIRAL			
500Adml	563.80	+6.22	4.4
BalAdml	50.14	+0.29	4.5
CAITAdml	11.21	...	2.8
CapOpAdml r	197.56	+3.08	4.4
DivAppIdxAdm	55.10	+0.54	4.2
EMAdmr	NA	...	NA
EqIncAdml	92.31	+0.62	6.0
ExplrAdml	104.80	+1.31	-1.9
ExtndAdml	145.00	+2.11	1.0
GroIncAdml	106.46	+1.35	4.4
GrwthAdml	220.47	+3.16	4.5
HlthCareAdml r	73.04	+0.91	-3.2
HYCorAdml r	5.50	+0.01	4.6
InfProAd	23.38	+0.03	4.1
IntlGrAdml	131.69	+1.74	16.6
ITBondAdml	NA	...	NA
ITIGradeAdml	8.74	+0.03	4.4
LarCapAd	141.84	+1.60	4.3
MidCpAdml	344.17	+3.44	5.8
MuHYAdml	10.32	-0.02	-1.5
MuIntAdml	13.39	-0.01	0.2
MuLTAdml	10.47	-0.02	-1.6
MuLtdAdml	10.88	...	1.9
MuShtAdml	15.80	...	1.8
PrmcpAdml r	175.78	+2.55	5.7
RealEstatAdml	129.58	+0.41	3.7
SmCapAdml	113.18	+1.25	-1.3
SmGthAdml	96.83	+1.32	-1.5
STBondAdml	NA	...	NA
STIGradeAdml	10.44	+0.01	3.5
STIPSIxAdm	25.14	-0.01	3.7
TotBdAdml	9.64	+0.03	3.6
TotIntBdIdxAdm	19.78	+0.02	1.8
TotIntlAdmIdx r	NA	...	NA
TotStAdml	145.88	+1.66	3.8
TxMCapAdml	313.03	+3.49	4.0
TxMIn r	18.02	+0.23	18.8
USGroAdml	195.80	+3.25	2.8
ValAdml	68.62	+0.50	4.5
WdsrllAdml	81.31	+0.83	4.5
WellsIAdml	61.80	+0.30	4.9
WelltnAdml	NA	...	NA
WndsrAdml	71.42	+0.60	2.3
VANGUARD FDS			
DivdGro	36.02	+0.30	2.0
IntlVal	NA	...	NA
LifeGro	NA	...	NA
LifeMod	NA	...	NA
PrmcpCor	35.66	+0.50	6.6
STAR	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2020	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2025	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2030	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2035	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2040	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2045	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2050	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2060	NA	...	NA
TgtRet2055	NA	...	NA
TgtRetInc	NA	...	NA
Welltn	NA	...	NA
WndsrII	45.84	+0.47	4.4
VANGUARD INDEX FDS			
ExtndIstPl	357.82	+5.21	1.0
IdxIntl	NA	...	NA
MdCpGrAdml	120.24	+1.91	10.2
MdCpVlAdml	85.20	+0.46	2.3
SmValAdml	83.58	+0.76	-1.2
TotBd2	9.51	+0.03	3.5
TotIntlInstIdx r	NA	...	NA
TotItlInstPlId r	NA	...	NA
TotSt	145.82	+1.65	3.8
VANGUARD INSTL FDS			
DevMktsIndInst	18.05	+0.23	18.9
DevMktsInxInst	28.21	+0.36	18.8
ExtndInst	144.99	+2.11	1.0
FTScInst	41.85	+0.55	3.6
GrwthInst	220.48	+3.15	4.5
InPrSeIn	9.52	+0.01	4.1
InstIdx	496.60	+5.47	4.2
InstPlus	496.60	+5.47	4.2
InstTStPlus	101.90	+1.16	3.8
MidCpInst	76.03	+0.76	5.8
MidCpIstPl	374.98	+3.76	5.8
SmCapInst	113.18	+1.25	-1.3
SmCapIstPl	326.67	+3.60	-1.3
STIGradeInst	10.44	+0.01	3.5
STIPSIxins	25.16	-0.01	3.7
TotBdInst	9.64	+0.03	3.6
TotBdInst2	9.51	+0.03	3.5
TotBdInstPl	9.64	+0.03	3.6
TotIntBdIdxInst	29.68	+0.03	1.8
TotStInst	145.90	+1.66	3.8
ValueInst	68.61	+0.50	4.5
WCM Focus Funds			
WCMFocIntlGrwIns	26.64	+0.40	22.4

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HEARD ON THE STREET

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS & COMMENTARY

Visa and Mastercard Can Survive Stablecoin

The cryptocurrencies' quickest path to consumer wallets may be working with today's players

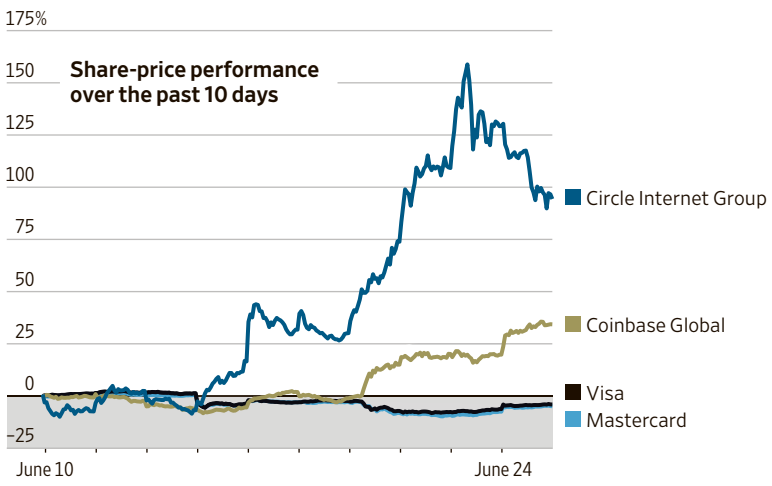
Stablecoins have a shot at being used in a lot of consumer payments. If they play their cards right.

Investors seem to be betting that stablecoins—digital tokens meant to represent a fixed amount of a fiat currency such as the U.S. dollar—could rapidly disrupt how we pay for things.

Following the Senate's passage of a stablecoin-regulation bill last week, shares of crypto companies such as **Circle Internet Group** and **Coinbase Global** surged 49% and 36% respectively. Shares of **Visa** and **Mastercard**, by contrast, are both down around 2%.

But before the market runs away with this trade, it is important to understand what drives the consumer-payments business—and just how hard it is to dislodge cards.

The key thing about consumer payments is that it isn't just about technology. There are already many so-called rails, both public and private, on which money can move. Instead, what keeps cards at the center of payments are their unique economics, and their universality. In places such as the U.S., credit or debit cards are held by virtually every consumer and accepted by almost every merchant. They provide banks and consumers with financial incentives to keep using them. And they have mechanisms to handle security, as well as disputes between buyers and sellers.



Source: FactSet

Of course, merchants are the ones who in a sense pay for all that, by paying fees to accept card payments. So merchants are usually among the first to rush to embrace other ways to pay. The Wall Street Journal reported that some giant merchants are exploring issuing stablecoins.

Many payment forms have found specific lanes, or operate in the background. But especially in the U.S., cards have remained central to consumer commerce, whether in physical or digital form.

Could this time be different for stablecoins? Stablecoins can use public blockchains to move over the internet, making them widely accessible to adopt in payments. They are especially appealing in countries where people want to operate in U.S. dollars, but can't get U.S. dollar bank accounts.

However, card networks are adapting. Both Visa and Mastercard enable partners to offer cards whose payments can be funded by cryptocurrencies, including stablecoins.

Merchants can then collect the payments the way they would with any card transaction. No new setup is required. These network operators are also offering ways for merchants and others to themselves be paid in stablecoins. That includes USDC, which is issued by Circle.

Then there is the incentive question of why a consumer would want to transact directly in stablecoins over cards. The latter often pay out generous rewards to holders.

Stablecoins have a potential mechanism to do something similar. Each coin has a reserve fund that aims to ensure it can be redeemed for its fixed fiat currency value.

Those funds generate interest revenue. That creates a kitty that can fund rewards to people who pay with those tokens, as with discounts or points.

But that reserve income goes to the coin issuers, not merchants who accept the payments. Merchants would need to negotiate with those players, whether they are banks or others, to get a share of the economics.

If merchants pursue their own coins, then they could in theory fully fund their own rewards programs. It would be similar to how some retailers today, such as **Starbucks**, hold customers' preloaded dollars in accounts. They can also earn interest on that cash.

But this pathway might only be available to the biggest merchants. And, to make customers more willing to hold money in those accounts, merchants might want to issue cards linked to their wallets. Then customers can use those funds to pay at other sellers.

All this only applies to people paying with existing funds. What about credit? That requires a lender, and typically a card network to facilitate the transaction. Coinbase, for example, has announced it is launching a rewards credit card via the **American Express** network.

Stablecoins will have many uses in payments, particularly outside the U.S., and in behind-the-scenes transactions. But the fastest way into most people's wallets will still be through a card.

—Telis Demos

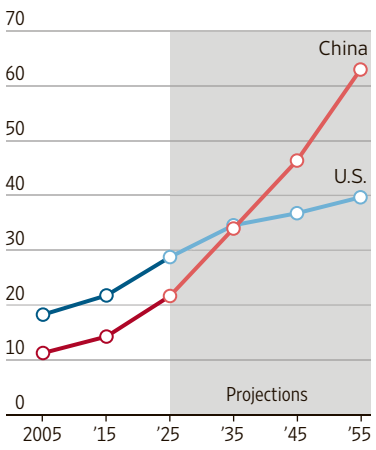
How Diapers Predict The Stock Market

Demography may be destiny, but can understanding it make you money?

Growing or aging populations have been behind some of the wrongest economic predictions ever. The most infamous was by Thomas Malthus who in the late 18th century foresaw global war and starvation. And it was barely a decade ago that author Harry S. Dent Jr. said the Dow Jones Industrial Average would fall as low as 5500 as retiring baby boomers caused a depression.

But getting the analysis right, which required some nuance, could have paid off big time. For example, the migration of hundreds of millions of young Chinese people from the countryside to coastal factories helps explain the U.S. investing bubbles of the last few decades.

It kept inflation low and, indirectly, money cheap, but at the cost of hollowing out American manufacturing. Retiring baby boomers notwithstanding, America's younger population and friendliness to immigration helped make economic growth stronger than that of export powerhouses like Japan.



Sources: Capital Economics; Census Bureau

The next 30 years don't look as rosy. A measure called the dependency ratio—the number of people above retirement age for every 100 still in their working years—is now around 29 in the U.S. compared with 19 back in 2010. A report from Vicky Redwood at Capital Economics predicts it will be above 39 by 2055.

PETER CHARLESWORTH/LIGHTROCKET/GETTY IMAGES

China's one-child policy and rising life expectancy helped cause an epic deterioration in its dependency ratio.

That matters. Working people pay taxes that fund new roads, help governments finance deficits and, crucially, pay for the health and living expenses of all those retirees. Japan, where adult diapers have outsold baby ones for years, is far worse off today than America at 51. Germany, another export powerhouse facing anemic growth, is at 40.

But the scariest deterioration will be in the country that helped make America's boom possible: China's yearslong one-child policy, rising life expectancy and babies seemingly going out of fashion have combined to cause an epic deterioration. Its dependency ratio was an ultralow 10.3 at the turn of the century. It is twice that now and is seen reaching 63 in 2055—23 points higher than America's projected level.

The upshot for investors is that owning both stocks and bonds in the developed world could be less rewarding. Higher interest rates, expensive labor and more money diverted to benefits will sap economic growth. And faltering pension plans—America's main Social Security trust fund might be exhausted by 2034—could even spark intergenerational conflict.

For developing countries other than China, though, the picture is brighter. India, Mexico, South Africa and Brazil have lots of young people and slowly rising dependency ratios. More troubled ones like Nigeria are even lower and falling. Meanwhile, many of their long-shunned stocks are cheap—emerging markets overall fetch a little over half of America's earnings multiple.

Lots of babies aren't the only reason they might be good places to invest, but it's a big one.

—Spencer Jakab

MARKETS

Emirati Oil Boss Grabs U.S. Energy Moment

By Christopher M. Matthews And Benoît Morenne

Standing in one of Abu Dhabi's ornate palaces last month, the oil boss Sultan Ahmed Al Jaber presented President Trump with a gift: a single drop of oil from the emirate's Murban Bab oil field.

"The highest-quality oil there is on the planet, and they only gave me a drop," Trump joked at the time. "So I'm not thrilled."

If Al Jaber's ambitions are realized, the chief executive officer of Adnoc—**Abu Dhabi National Oil** Co., Abu Dhabi's state-owned oil company—will soon have far greater offerings for Trump.

XRG, the company's international investment arm, plans to deploy billions of dollars in the U.S. It is part of the United Arab Emirates' goal to boost the value of its energy investments there to $440 billion over the next decade—about $50 billion less than **Exxon Mobil**'s market capitalization.

It aims to take stakes in U.S. oil and gas fields and chemical and gas export plants as well as power projects to support the development of artificial intelligence. Those aspirations position XRG to become one the largest foreign investors in U.S. energy.

During Trump's visit to Abu Dhabi, Al Jaber briefed the president on the plans as the pair stood before a giant screen emblazoned with the phrase "Making Energy Great Again." Trump, who has aggressively courted foreign investment, was thrilled, said people familiar with the matter.

The investment plan puts Al Jaber at the center of the relationship between the U.S. and the U.A.E., one of Washington's closest allies in the region based on their longstanding trade and security ties.

Adnoc, once a middling player on the international stage, has emerged as one of the world's most ambitious—and well-funded—energy companies under his stewardship.

Al Jaber has deftly navigated his country's palace politics to become a key adviser to the ruling Emiratis. In addition to his role as Adnoc CEO and XRG executive chairman, he is the U.A.E. minister of industry and advanced technology. In March, he traveled with Sheikh Tahnoon bin Zayed Al Nahyan, the national-security adviser, to the White House. There, the delegation said the U.A.E. would invest $1.4 trillion in the U.S.

"The U.A.E. has become a bridge between East and West, and we have become a global economic center," Al Jaber said in an interview.

About a year ago, Adnoc purchased a 11.7% stake in a $18 billion natural-gas export terminal being built by the developer NextDecade at the Port of Brownsville in Texas. The plant, which is expected to start producing liquefied natural gas in 2027, will be one of the largest in the world.

$1.4T

Amount the U.A.E. said it would invest in the U.S. at a White House meeting.

Such an investment would have been almost unthinkable for Adnoc a decade ago. Al Jaber has trained the company's eye abroad to diversify its assets and make it less dependent on producing oil domestically.

He said he is particularly bullish about the U.S., which teems with fossil fuels and low-carbon energy, as well as big technology companies scrambling to find enough power for their AI ambitions.

"Investing in the U.S. will probably be the highest representation on our balance sheet going forward," he said.

The U.A.E.'s presence in international energy has long been eclipsed by that of its powerful ally—and sometimes rival—Saudi Arabia. **Aramco**, Saudi Arabia's national oil company, is a petrochemical powerhouse in dozens of countries. But the U.A.E. has started to catch up.

Abu Dhabi-owned companies and funds, including Adnoc and Mubadala Energy, invested billions of dollars in stakes in natural-gas projects and energy companies in the U.S., Mozambique, Egypt and Azerbaijan—as well as chemical ventures in Europe.

In 2022, a unit of the Abu Dhabi Investment Authority acquired a 10% noncontrolling interest in Sempra Infrastructure, which is developing several LNG projects in the U.S. and Mexico. Mubadala Energy in April agreed to acquire a 24.1% interest in private-equity firm Kimmeridge's SoTex, which owns companies that drill for shale gas in Texas and are developing an LNG project on the Gulf Coast.

Ben Dell, a managing partner of Kimmeridge, said America offers the U.A.E. low-cost energy supplies needed to develop AI capabilities. "The U.A.E. and the U.S. are becoming natural partners," he said.

The U.A.E. has sought to build a dominant AI sector to bolster its postoil economy. During Trump's visit, Emirati officials persuaded his team to greenlight a deal to give their country access to millions of **Nvidia**'s most-advanced chips. Al Jaber views AI as driving the next stage of evolution and said the U.A.E. is making decadeslong bets to align its economy with it.

A chemical engineer by training, Al Jaber earned scholarships from Adnoc and studied at the University of Southern California before working his way up the rungs of his country's energy industry. He has said it was his dream to work for Adnoc.

In 2016, U.A.E. President Sheikh Mohammed bin Zayed al Nahyan tapped him to restructure Adnoc. Al Jaber cut staff and courted foreign investment, causing a stir at home. He boosted Adnoc's oil production. The company's transformation earned him the trust of the president, according to people close to the company.

MAXIM SHEMETOV/REUTERS

Sultan Ahmed Al Jaber, CEO of Abu Dhabi's Adnoc.

Daniel Yergin, vice chairman of S&P Global and a veteran energy expert, said he first met Al Jaber in 2007, when he was tasked with building a renewable business in Abu Dhabi. Today, the U.A.E. is one of the world's biggest state financiers of clean energy. "He makes things happen," Yergin said of Al Jaber.

Al Jaber courted controversy as the president of the United Nations' 2023 climate-change conference in Dubai. The selection of the oil boss angered environmentalists. For his part, Al Jaber was incensed over what he said were misrepresentations about his views on climate change. Under his leadership, the summit reached a first-of-its-kind deal calling for "transitioning away from fossil fuels," though it didn't explicitly commit to phasing them out.